



BOOK TWO Resource Reports



Collective Bargaining In The
Digital Era

Building Trust

Managing Dispute

Ensuring Good Governance

Table of Content

1. PSCBC 2020-2025 PERFORMANCE AT STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES LEVEL	4
2. TRADE UNION MEMBERSHIP TRENDS 2021/2022-2025/2026	17
3. TRADE UNION DUAL MEMBERSHIP TRENDS.....	40
4. REPORT – GENES (WOMEN EMPOWERMENT PROGRAM)	60
5. GEMS MENTAL HEALTH CLAIMS REPORT	80
6. MENTAL HEALTH CRISIS AMONG SOUTH AFRICAN POLICE: A CALL FOR URGENT SUPPORT.....	111
7. LONGITUDINAL STUDY: PSETA PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION LEADERSHIP TRAINING PROGRAMME SURVEY (ROUND 2)	115
8. PSETA PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION PROCUREMENT PROGRAM LEARNER'S WITHDRAWAL REPORT 2024.....	134
9. CSR IMPACT ASSESSMENT REPORT	142
10. REPORT ON THE COLLABORATOR SOFTWARE SYSTEM UTILISED BY THE PSCBC	166
11. PSCBC SOCIAL MEDIA STATISTICS.....	173
12. RISK ASSESSMENT REPORT	189

**2020-2025
PERFORMANCE AT A
STRATEGIC LEVEL**

1. PSCBC 2020-2025 PERFORMANCE AT STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES LEVEL

#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
1	Coordinate effective public service labour relations contributing to the overall strategy of labour relations in the public service.	• Council, EXCO, FINCO, Committees, Task teams' meetings were conducted. • Workshops conducted for council and Chambers). • Salary Negotiations and Implementation of the collective agreements. • Successful pre-negotiations and debriefing sessions. • Public Service Summit on Collective Bargaining (28-31 March 2022 – Emperors Palace Kempton Park). • Signed Resolutions: - Res 1 of 2021 (Salary Adjustment in the PS) - Res 1 of 2022 (Adoption of the Public Service Summit Declaration) - Res 1 of 2023 (BMA Resolution) - Res 2 of 2023 (Salary Adjustments 2023/2024 & 2024/2025) - Res 3 of 2023 (Enforcement of Collective Agreements)	The implementation cycle has led to improved and effective labour relations in the Public service. The PSCBC coordinated effectively labour relations leading to effective, collective bargaining and dispute management.	Signed Council, EXCO Task Teams & Chambers minutes. Signed Resolutions Pre-negotiations and debriefing reports Public Service Summit Declaration PSCBC Annual Reports

		- Res 1 of 2024 (Rules for the conduct of proceedings before the PSCBC) - Res 2 of 2024 (Amendment of PSCBC Resolution 3 of 2017) - Res 1 of 2025 (Salary Adjustments in the PS) - Res 2 of 2025 (Matters referred to further process for research, investigation, and negotiations in the financial year 2026/2026).		
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
2	Manage the Trade Union membership through a centralised system to give effect to the fair application of organizational rights within the provisions of the LRA and the constitution of Council.	• In line with the decision of Council to centralise the trade union membership system within the PSCBC. • Appointment of a service provider to develop the management of trade union management system. • Parties to council were workshopped on the system. • Task team was established • Approval of the report and recommendation for implementation.	Awareness have been created on managing trade union membership.	-Proposal for the development of the centralised system was received. - Workshop Report - Signed Council Minutes - Approved Report

3	Strengthening centralised collective bargaining within the Public Service by expanding the scope of the PSCBC as representative of public administration as per the provisions of the Public Administration Management Act and consider the impact of such on the current structures of Council as to develop new contours.	- Resolution 1 of 2022 Public Service Summit declaration clauses 4.2.1 and 4.2.2 review of bargaining structures to include the public sector in progress. - A Committee was established in collaboration with the ILO and Sector Councils on expanding the scope of the PSCBC by considering the Public Service Entities.	A working committee developed a concept paper on the establishment of the bargaining council.	- Delegations to the Committee - Committee Meetings Reports - Council report - Resolution 1 of 2022
4	Implement outstanding decisions, agreements and ensuring the future enforcement of collective agreements by implementing the provisions of section 33A of the LRA and the applicable provisions of the Public Service Act and Regulations.	- Resolution 1 of 2022 Public Service Summit declaration Clause 4.2.5 monitor implementation of collective agreements implemented - Collective agreements audit report updated quarterly to track progress in the implementation of agreements	Enforcement process led to higher level Commitment by parties to council	Audit Report
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence

5	Develop and strengthen strategic partnership with NEDLAC making submissions to NEDLAC on issues that protect and advance centralised collective bargaining in the public service.	Not achieved due to unwillingness by NEDLAC to recognise the PSCBC as interested party.	Not able to contribute to legislation amendments.	
6	Reinvigorate the social contract by considering and implementing the provisions of ILO conventions and the National Development Plan.	Resolution 1 of 2022 Public service Summit declaration Clause 5.1 and 5.2 compliance to ILO convention 190 implemented The empowerment of women, people with disability and youth in the public service	Women in leadership have been empowered with various leaderships skills. Relations were establishment with ILO and review of partnership and training.	Women in leadership empowerment report.
7	Promote good governance in the PSCBC through the implementation of the King IV code on good governance of council to ensure transparency, accountability and to establish structures that will complement the principles of the code and	- Implemented International financial reporting standards (IFRS). - Delegation of authority adopted. Adopted delegation of authority allowing the separation of roles and responsibilities.	Transparency and accountability promoted in financial controls. The council have achieved Unqualified audits for the past 5 years.	Unqualified audited financial statements, adopted policy on delegation of authority

	what is appropriate to the organization.			
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
8	Develop a funding model for Council that is based on an equitable distribution of the levy income, reflective of the social and economic composition of the employees falling within the scope of the Council.	Review of the funding model in progress.		
9	Adapt and embrace 4IR in council processes promoting digitization of the workplace	- The ICT environment transitioned from a traditional server-based infrastructure to a fully virtual, cloud-based platform. - Digital portal introduced within the dispute resolution environment to facilitate online case submission, tracking, and streamlined case management.	Transition of council from physical to hybrid/virtual processes. Efficiencies in-keeping with latest technological development	Collaborator software, ZOOM, TEAMS Microsoft 365, SOPHOS antivirus software,
10	Conduct and manage current and future research within labour relations, democratization of the	Research projects conducted that informed council decisions. Monitoring and Evaluation	-Improved implementation of council's mandate through informed decision	-Research and M&E project reports - Trade Union Dual membership report

	workplace, economic development, social justice and labour peace.	- Monitoring implementation of council's collective agreements • Publications - Book titled: From Struggle to Structure: One agreement at a time. It provides an outline of the 30 years of labour relations in South Africa. • Regional and International Conference Papers were presented at Regional and international conferences.	-Improved regional and international recognition of the PSCBC through conference participations. -Improved collective bargaining and dispute management	-Trade union membership trend report
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
11	Empower council members through skilling and reskilling in order to create a culture of lifelong learning.	• PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022 Public service summit declaration clause 4.2.11 upskilling of negotiators in the PSCBC through grooming of new teams of negotiators to prepare for the future. • Various training programmes were conducted to empower Council members, and chamber representatives through: - PSETA training - Mental health workshops across provinces	Council, members (2312) have been empowered, skilled and reskilled through various training and a culture of learning have been installed.	- Reports & Attendance - Public Service Wellbeing - rat Plans Reports - Strategic Engagement - nt Programs Reports - esentations - ual Reports

		- SASLAW 23RD Annual Hybrid Conference (5 - 6 November 2020 - Lindo Park JHB/ My Planner) - ALLS Hybrid Conference (23 - 24 November 2020 - Botswana) - POPI Act Workshop (7, 21, 25 & 31 May 2021) - SASLAW Conference (7 - 8 October 2021) - Virtual Skills Programme on Conflict Management and Ethics (6-10 & 13-17 September 2021) - Bullying in the workplace - for provinces (12-25 October 2021) - Virtual 19th ILERA World Congress (21 - 24 June 2021) - 9th ILERA Africa Congress (26 - 29 September 2021 – Mpumalanga Skukuza). - PSCBC 25th Anniversary Awareness Workshops for Provinces - GENES Women Empowerment Program (24-26 August 2022 on Ethics, 2 - 4 November 2022 on Governance, 8 - 10 February 2023 on Strategy & 24 - 26 April 2023 on Negotiations) - 5th ALLS Conference 29-30 March 2023 - Mauritius		
--	--	---	--	--

		- Virtual Workshop on the effective Management of Meetings – 27, 28 & 31 January 2022 - Virtual Computer Proficiency -24 January – 4 February 2022 - Workshop on the COFI Bill and the Two-Pot System – 13 June 2023 - Maslow Time Square Hotel in Pretoria - ILERA 10th African Regional Congress (3-4 April 2024 – Zambia) - ILERA 20th World Congress (27-30 June 2024 - New York) - ILO - Lesotho Public Service Study Visit (8-9 May 2024 – PSCBC Offices)		
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
12	Establish strategic partnerships with institutions, including Parliament and its committees that will allow council to further its objectives.	• Partnership developed with PSETA, Department of Public Works and Infrastructure, Research Institutions such as Labour Research Service (LRS), Public Service Commission, South African Association of Public Administration Management (SAAPAM), Africa Evaluation Association on M and E. ILERA Africa,	Strong partnerships have been established with various institutions improving the PSCBC contribution to the wider labour relations community.	MOU with PSETA
13	Advocate for gender mainstreaming in the Public	• Signing of PSCBC 1 of 2022 Public service declaration summit clause 5.3 Fair	Women have been empowered and there are	- Resolution 1 of 2022.

	service allowing for a fair representation of women, persons with disability and youth in the structures of Council inclusive of Provincial chambers and Governance structures;	representation of women, persons with disability and youth. Dedicated Workstream focused on gender mainstreaming and made recommendations to Council for consideration.	more women representatives in council	- Workstream Report
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
14	Empower women, persons with disability and youth to allow them to occupy roles and positions that will enhance the overall recognition of these individuals	- Resolution 1 of 2022 Public service declaration summit clause 5.4. Developing women, persons with disability and youth to occupy roles and positions that will enhance them. - The PSCBC implemented women, persons with disability and youth programme. - The GENES training Programme – 1st intake on Ethics, Governance, Strategy and Negotiations - The GENES Programme implemented – 2nd intake (13 Participants).	Women, persons with disability and youth have been empowered and gained skills across the public service and gradually have occupied different roles and positions in government (national & provincial) and trade unions.	- Women Empowerment Report - Annual report - Women enrolled in university course. - Council Annual Reports
15	Develop an inclusive, integrated and gender-responsive approach for the prevention	Signing of PSCBC 1 of 2022 Public service Summit declaration Clause 5.1. rights of everyone to the world of work free of violence.	Awareness has been created through various workshops and awareness	Resolution 1 of 2022 Public service summit declaration summit.

	and elimination of violence and harassment at the workplace.	Awareness campaigns and GBV workshops conducted.	campaigns through social media platforms.	
16	Develop an alternative dispute resolution management system to ensure the enhancement of dispute prevention initiatives that resolve disputes at the earliest possible opportunity.	- Telephonic conciliations were introduced to deal with matters as close to the source and as early as possible. - Virtual hearings were introduced to optimize on the digitalisation of Council processes. - The Enforcement procedure resolution (Resolution 03 of 2023) Enforcement. - Case Law webinars, publications and workshops were conducted. - DR Committee meetings held for disputes deliberations.	Expedited dispute resolution and reduced costs. Renewed commitment from the employer.	PSCBC Annual report, DR committee meeting reports Res 02 of 2023 – Enforcement of Collective Agreements in the Public Service PSCBC Website and YouTube Channel
#	Strategic Objectives	Achievements	Impact	Proof of Evidence
17	Develop targeted interventions in areas identified in order to enhance and expedite the resolution of disputes also reducing the number of disputes referred.	- Establishment of the Resident Panellist unit in 2023/24 Conciliations and arbitration processes were enhanced. - Quality reports for Awards and rulings - Virtual and physical conciliations and hearings processes introduced across chambers.	Legislative compliance Expedition of dispute processes.	Annual reports - DR, Annual Report – RP.

		- Case management system (Collab) developed for referrals on a digital platform. - Portal and e-referral form system developed to enhance referral accessibility. - The enforcement process was developed and implemented. - Stakeholder capacity building skills programme conducted.		
18	Dispute resolution functions to ensure disputes were dealt with under uniform rules, norms and standards within the public service.	- The DR Rules were amended and collective agreement was signed. - Draft Picketing Rules were tabled. - Workshops conducted to educate and inform parties of the signed resolutions. - The Enforcement procedure Resolution was signed.	Legislative compliance of case laws Improved User education	Resolution 1 of 2023 - DR Rules Draft picketing rules Resolution 2 of 2023 – Enforcement Workshop report
19	Enhance the dispute resolution process, by considering a central panel of conciliators and arbitrators applying similar policy and standards	- Service Level Agreements were reviewed, and an adjusted daily fee was adopted. - A data fee was introduced and adopted to cater for the virtual hearings held by Council.	Governance and performance improved and management of costs	Exco report on daily fee
20	Coordinate the advancement of a case management system for public service bargaining	Developed a case management system, Portal and e-referral form to enhance referral accessibility.	Effective expedition of dispute referrals and	Annual report

	council as to enhance dispute management functions specific to the councils.		processes. Simplified administrative procedures.	
--	--	--	--	--

Challenges encountered during implementation of the strategy

	Challenge	Corrective Action
1	Outbreak of Covid period led to adjustment of council from a physical to virtual which caused a risk to collective bargaining processes.	Remote work policy development and implementation
2	Non implementation of resolution 1 of 2018 Clause 3.3 subsequent constitutional court decision.	Social dialogue among parties to council
3	Breakdown in the trust relationship between the parties.	Continuous social dialogue
4	Breakdown of Inter relationship among Trade Unions.	Strengthen engagement among Trade Unions
5	Industrial action during wage negotiations.	Multiple wage agreement
6	Funding limitations during the period. Constitutional amendment to entrench a governance model.	New funding model to be developed
7	Cyber-attack to the PSCBC network environment	Improved ICT system

**TRADE UNION
MEMBERSHIP TRENDS
2021/22-2025/26**



2. TRADE UNION MEMBERSHIP TRENDS 2021/2022-2025/2026

Introduction

The landscape of trade union membership in South Africa's public service reveals a complex and varied picture of organisational fortunes, with different unions experiencing different trajectories over the period from 2021 to 2026. While some organizations have demonstrated remarkable resilience and growth, others face existential challenges that call into question their long-term viability. This analysis examines membership trends across a diverse range of trade unions, from the largest organizations commanding hundreds of thousands of members to smaller, specialised unions representing niche constituencies within the public service.

The data reveals several recurring patterns that transcend individual union circumstances. Most notably, seasonal fluctuations appear to be a structural feature of public service union membership, with the fourth quarter of each financial year consistently marking a low point for the majority of organisations.

Beneath these seasonal variations, however, lie more fundamental stories of organisational success and failure. The largest unions in the dataset, SADTU, PSA, NEHAWU, and POPCRU have generally maintained or expanded their membership bases, demonstrating both the advantages of scale and the capacity to navigate changing conditions. SADTU's growth to over 280,000 members and PSA's stabilisation above 213,000 members reflect not only effective recruitment but also sustained relevance to their core constituencies. Similarly, mid-sized unions such as DENOSA, HOSPERSA, and SAPU have recorded meaningful gains, suggesting that well-positioned organizations with clear sectoral identities can thrive even in challenging environments.

Yet the data also exposes the fragility of smaller. UNIPSAWU's catastrophic decline from 652 to 287 members represents a loss of organisational capacity that raises questions about sustainability. PAWUSA's steady erosion from over 6,500 members to below 4,500 tells a similar story of gradual but relentless weakening.

This report proceeds by examining each union individually, analysing not only the raw membership numbers but also the patterns within those numbers. By understanding these dynamics across the full spectrum of public service unions, from the thriving to the struggling, we gain insight into the factors that sustain collective bargaining.

Non-PSCBC Registered Trade Unions

Figure 1 shows the membership trends of three trade unions that are not registered with the (PSCBC) but yet enjoy stop-order facilities. These unions are:

- SA Agricultural Plantation and Allied Workers Union (SAAPAWU)
- Society of State Advocates & Prosecutors of South Africa (SSAPSA)
- South African Correctional Services Workers Union (SACOSWU)

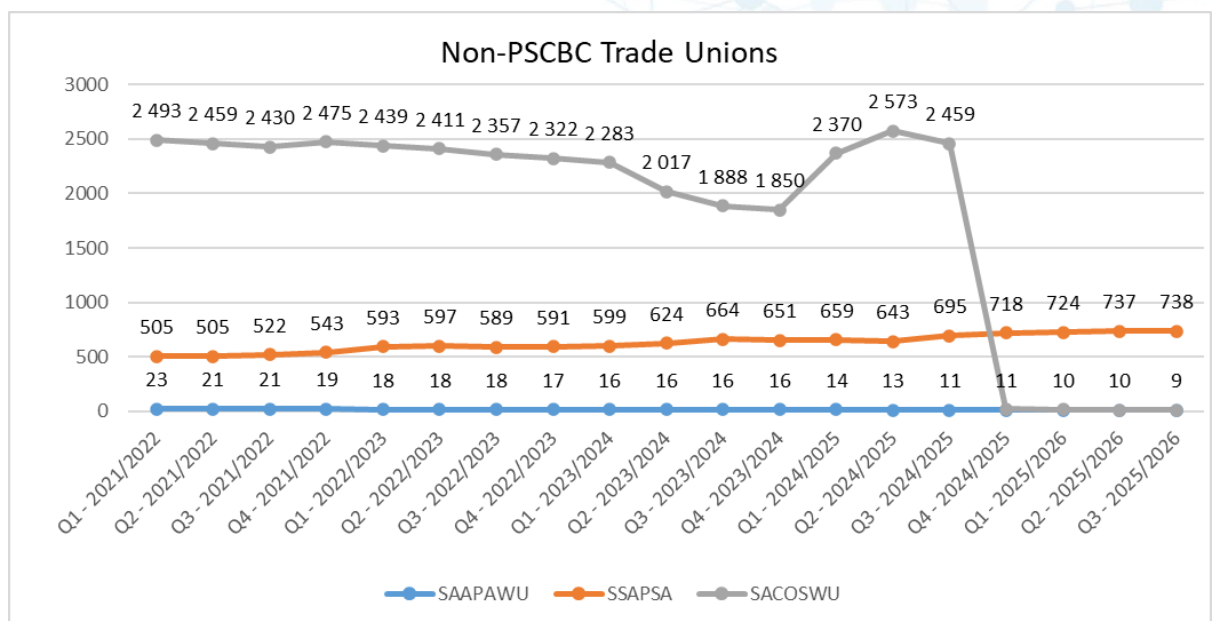


Figure 1: Non-PSCBC trade unions

SAAPAWU presents a consistent pattern of gradual membership contraction throughout the entire period under review. Beginning with 23 members in Q1 2021/2022, the union experienced a steady erosion of its membership base, declining to just 9 members by Q3 2025/2026.

SSAPSA demonstrates a clear upward membership trajectory throughout most of the observation period. Starting from a base of 505 members in Q1 2021/2022, the union experienced sustained growth, reaching 738 members by Q3 2025/2026. This represents an increase of approximately 46% over the period.

For much of the initial observation period, SACOSWU maintained a relatively stable membership base in the range of 2,300 to 2,500 members, making it by far the largest of the three organisations. However, between Q4 2023/2024 and Q1 2024/2025, the union

experienced notable fluctuations, with membership dropping to approximately 1,850 members before rebounding to 2,573 members. The most drastic shift occurred between Q3 2024/2025 and Q4 2024/2025, when membership dropped from 2,459 to just 21 members. This steep decline, as noted in the contextual information, coincides with the deregistration of the trade union.

PSCBC Registered Trade Unions

DENOSA

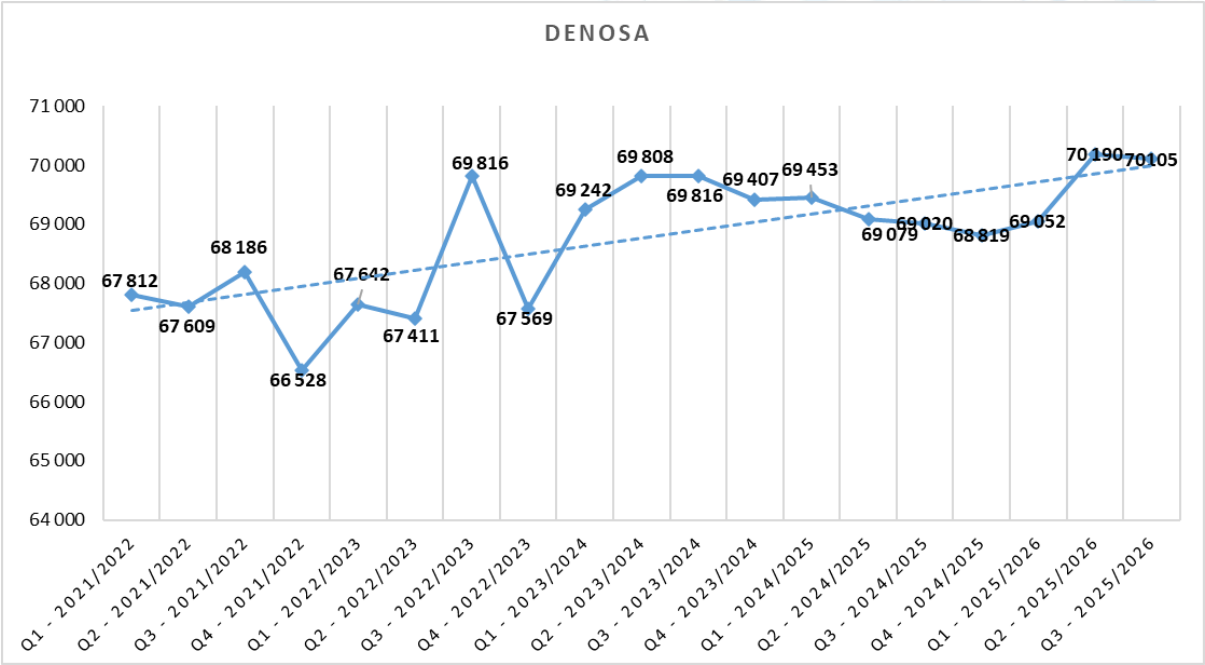


Figure 2: DENOSA membership trends

Overall, DENOSA has maintained a relatively consistent membership base of approximately 67,000 to 70,000 members throughout this period, suggesting a degree of organizational resilience in retaining its core constituency.

The initial phase of the data, covering the 2021/2022 financial year, shows DENOSA operating within a fairly narrow band around 67,000 members, with minimal fluctuation between quarters. This stability continued into the 2022/2023 period, though a notable upward movement in the third quarter, where membership increased to nearly 70,000. However, this gain proved temporary, as membership retreated in the subsequent quarter.

A more sustained increase became evident from the 2023/2024 financial year onward. During this period, the organisation maintained this elevated level throughout 2023/2024, demonstrating an improved capacity to retain members at this higher threshold (Figure 2).

The current financial year (2025/2026) offers a more encouraging picture, with membership reaching 70,190 in the second quarter, the highest figure recorded in the entire dataset.

HOSPERSA

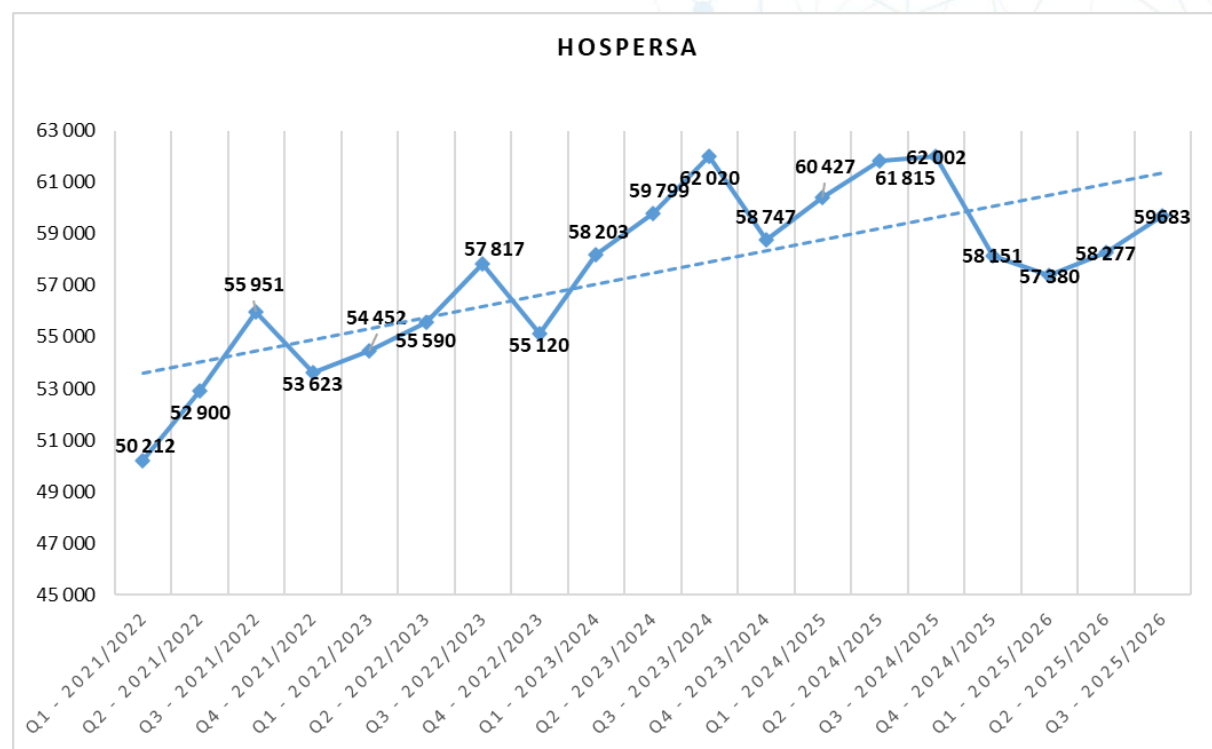


Figure 3: HOSPERSA membership trends

The Trade Union membership data for HOSPERSA over the period from 2021/2022 to 2025/2026 reveals a pattern of steady growth punctuated by consistent seasonal fluctuations. Overall, the union has experienced meaningful expansion in its membership base, growing from approximately 50,200 members at the start of the period to nearly 59,700 members by the third quarter of 2025/2026, representing an increase of roughly 19% over the four-and-a-half-year period (Figure 3).

The growth has been consistent year-on-year, with membership typically reaching new peaks during the third quarter of each financial year before declining in the fourth quarter.

This seasonal pattern is pronounced and recurrent. In every year observed, membership numbers increase through the first three quarters, with Q3 consistently marking the annual high point, only to experience a notable decline in Q4. The magnitude of these fourth-quarter declines ranges from approximately 2,000 to 4,000 loss of members, suggesting that institutional or administrative factors may be driving these fluctuations, possibly related to contract renewals, or employment cycles within the health sector.

Despite these seasonal variations and the recent moderation in growth, the overall trend remains positive. The union has demonstrated resilience and consistent appeal to health sector workers, maintaining an upward trajectory even as it navigates the cyclical membership losses that appear to be an inherent feature of its operational environment.

NAPTOSA

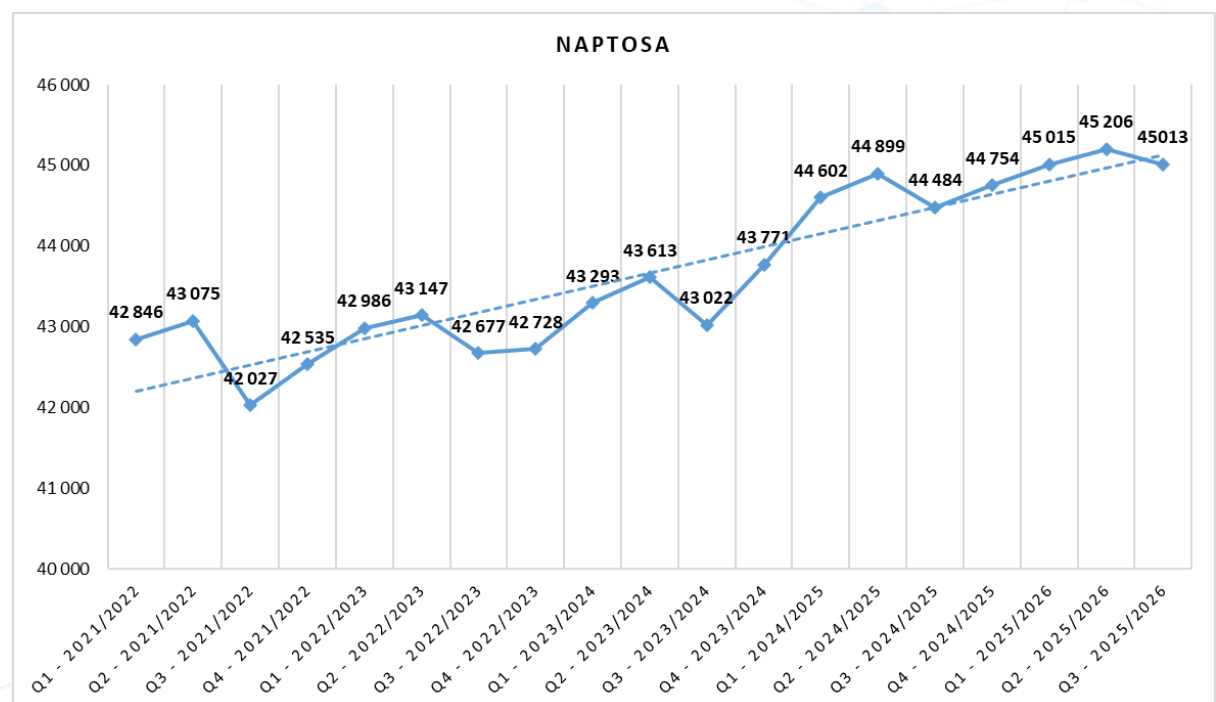
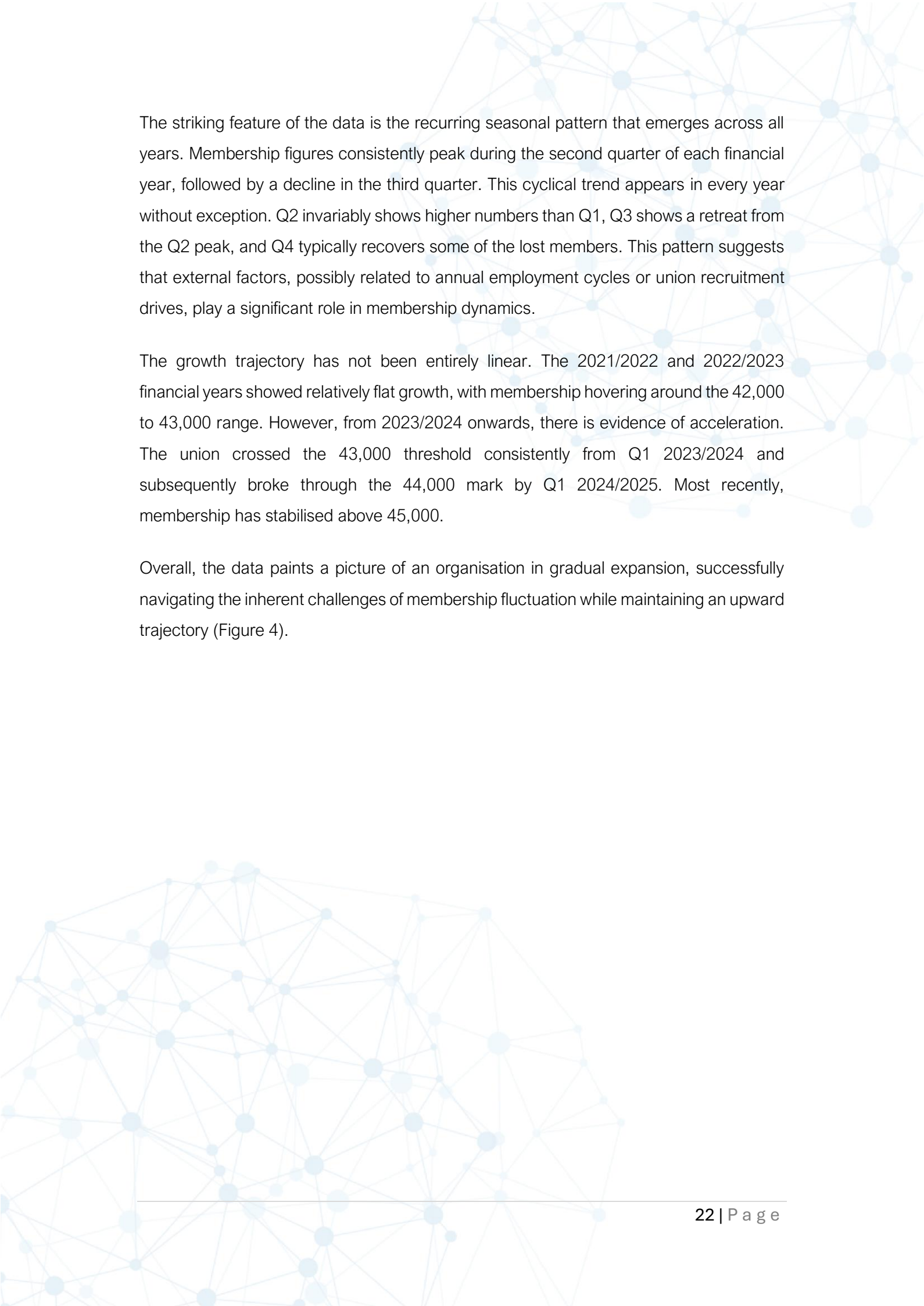


Figure 4: NAPTOSA membership trends

The Trade Union began with a membership base of 42,846 in the first quarter of 2021/2022. The union has expanded to 45,013 members by the third quarter of 2025/2026, representing an overall increase of approximately 2,167 members or roughly 5% growth over the period. While this growth rate may appear modest in percentage terms, it demonstrates consistent organisational strength and member retention.



The striking feature of the data is the recurring seasonal pattern that emerges across all years. Membership figures consistently peak during the second quarter of each financial year, followed by a decline in the third quarter. This cyclical trend appears in every year without exception. Q2 invariably shows higher numbers than Q1, Q3 shows a retreat from the Q2 peak, and Q4 typically recovers some of the lost members. This pattern suggests that external factors, possibly related to annual employment cycles or union recruitment drives, play a significant role in membership dynamics.

The growth trajectory has not been entirely linear. The 2021/2022 and 2022/2023 financial years showed relatively flat growth, with membership hovering around the 42,000 to 43,000 range. However, from 2023/2024 onwards, there is evidence of acceleration. The union crossed the 43,000 threshold consistently from Q1 2023/2024 and subsequently broke through the 44,000 mark by Q1 2024/2025. Most recently, membership has stabilised above 45,000.

Overall, the data paints a picture of an organisation in gradual expansion, successfully navigating the inherent challenges of membership fluctuation while maintaining an upward trajectory (Figure 4).

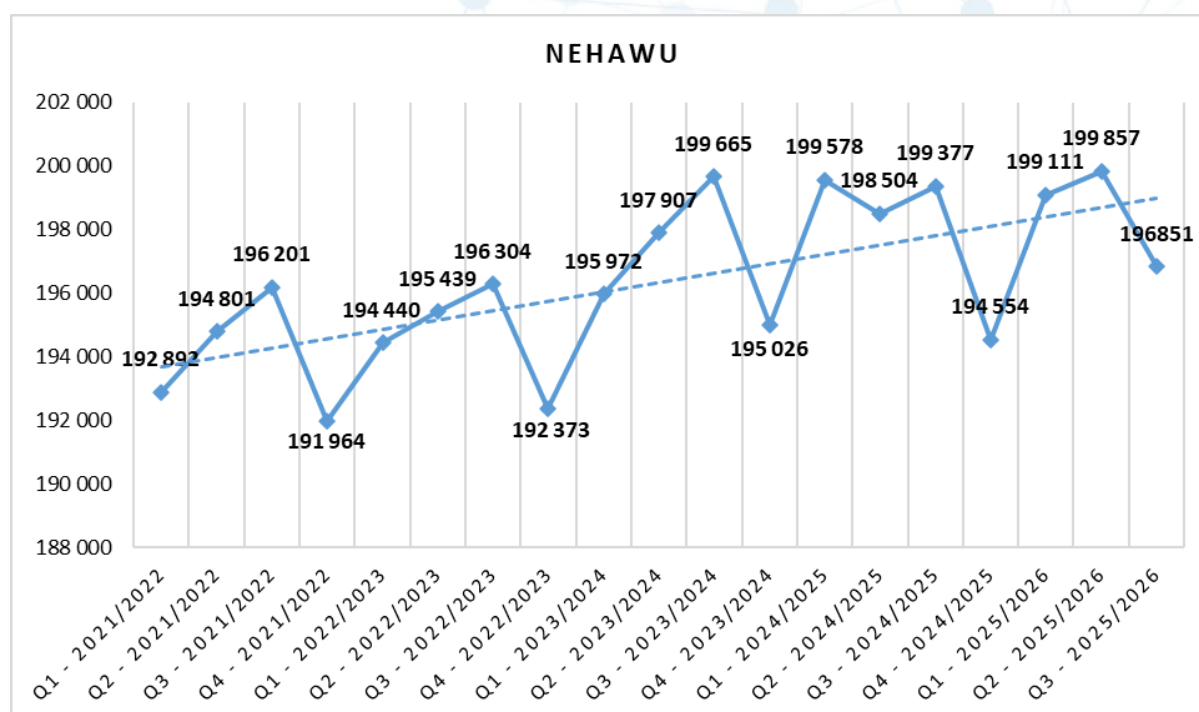


Figure 5: NEHAWU membership trends

NEHAWU's membership has remained consistent, hovering around the 195,000 to 200,000 range throughout the entire 5 year period, suggesting that the union has maintained a solid and stable base despite the fluctuations.

A closer examination of the data reveals a seasonal pattern that repeats consistently across the years. Membership tends to grow during the first three quarters of each financial year, typically peaking in Q3, before experiencing a notable decline in Q4. This pattern is evident across all four complete financial years in the dataset. The Q4 declines are particularly pronounced, with membership dropping by approximately 4,000 to 5,000 members each year. This recurring phenomenon suggests a seasonal dynamic, possibly linked to employment cycles in the public sector, annual contract renewals, or membership retention challenges at the end of each financial year (Figure 5).

Despite these quarterly fluctuations, the overall trajectory shows modest but steady growth. Starting from approximately 192,892 members in Q1 of 2021/2022, membership has gradually increased to 196,851 by Q3 of 2025/2026, representing an overall growth of roughly 4,000 members or about 2% over the four-and-a-half-year period. This growth, while not so great, demonstrates resilience and an ability to maintain relevance.

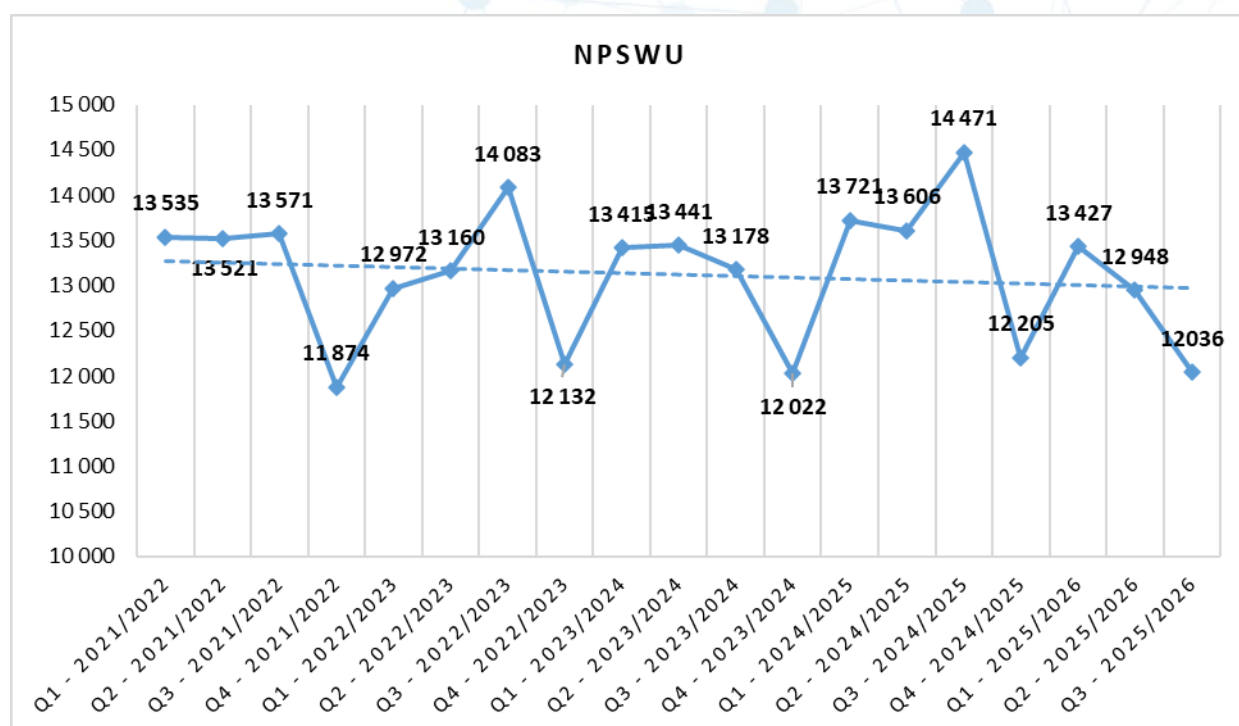


Figure 6: NPSWU membership trends

Over this five-year period, membership numbers have remained relatively stable, hovering consistently within a band of approximately 11,800 to 14,500 members.

The most striking characteristic of this dataset is the pronounced seasonal pattern that emerges across all years examined. Each financial year demonstrates a decline in fourth quarter membership, with Q4 figures consistently dropping to the lowest points of their respective years. This pattern is remarkably consistent. Q4 2021/2022 saw membership fall to 11,874, Q4 2022/2023 recorded 12,132, Q4 2023/2024 dropped to 12,022, and Q4 2024/2025 registered 12,205. This recurring pattern suggests systematic factors at play, potentially related to annual employment cycles, contract renewals, or seasonal workforce changes within the sectors represented by the union (See Figure 6).

Following each fourth quarter decline, membership typically rebounds in the subsequent first quarter, only to experience gradual erosion as the year progresses. The third quarter generally represents a peak within each annual cycle, with membership reaching its highest point before the inevitable fourth quarter decline. This pattern has held remarkably

steady across the period, indicating deeply entrenched factors affecting membership retention and recruitment.

NATU

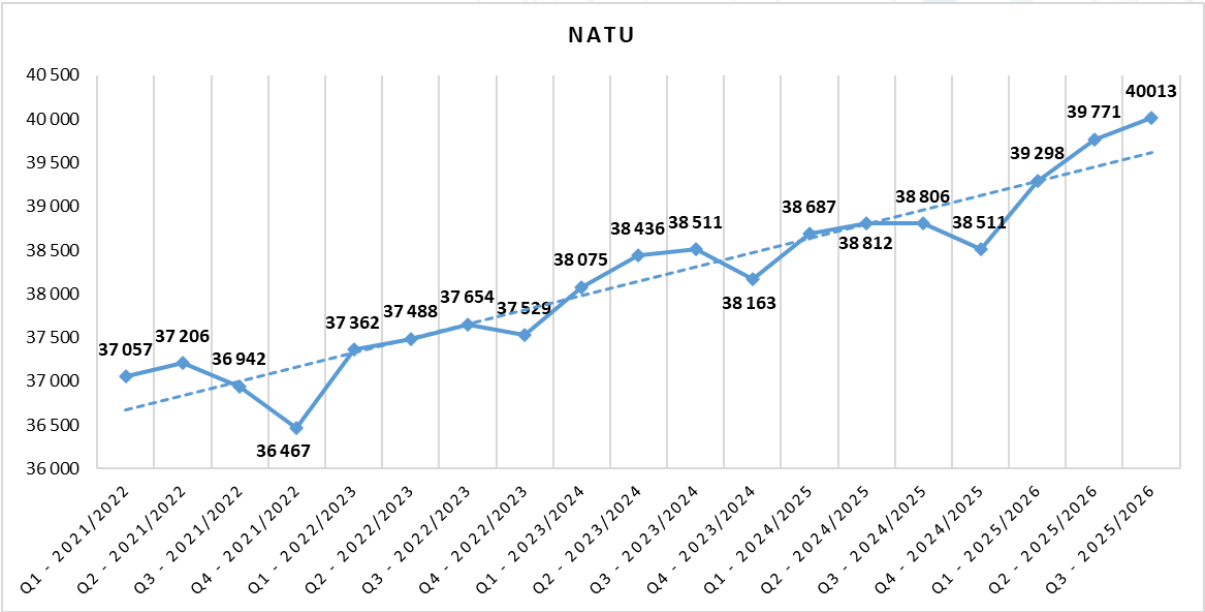


Figure 7: NATU membership trends

The Trade Union began at just over 37,000 members in the first quarter of 2021/2022, NATU has experienced steady expansion, reaching approximately 40,000 members by the third quarter of 2025/2026. This represents an overall growth of roughly 8% across the period, demonstrating the union's sustained appeal and organisational strength. However, this growth has not been uniform (Figure 7).

A notable feature of the data is the presence of seasonal fluctuations within each financial year. The union consistently experiences a decline in membership during the fourth quarter of each year, with recoveries typically occurring in the first quarter of the following year. This seasonal pattern suggests possible connections to employment cycles and academic calendars. The fourth quarter declines are particularly evident in 2021/2022, 2023/2024, and 2024/2025, indicating this is not a random occurrence but rather a structural characteristic of NATU's membership dynamics (Figure 7).

Despite these quarterly fluctuations, the underlying trend remains decidedly positive. Each financial year shows a net gain when comparing year-end figures, with the most substantial growth occurring between 2023/2024 and 2025/2026. The acceleration in

growth during this recent period is particularly striking, with membership increasing by over 2,000 members from the start of 2023/2024 to the most recent quarter. The stability of the growth pattern is perhaps as significant as the growth itself.

NUPSAW

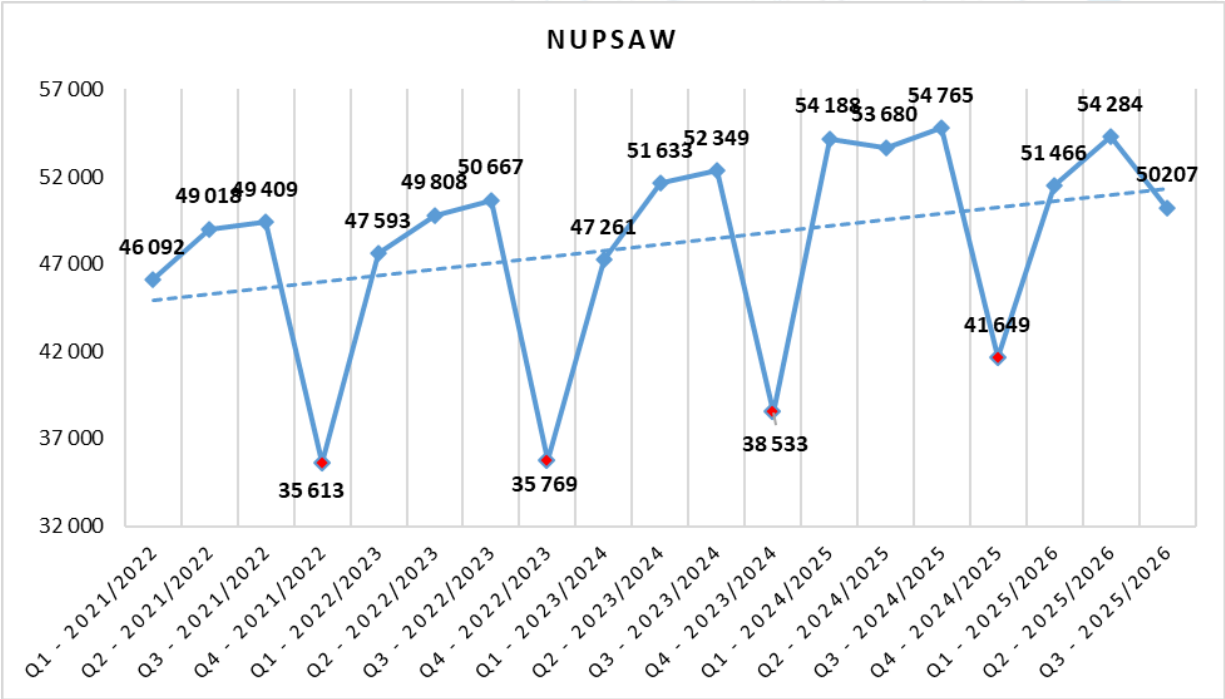


Figure 8: NUPSAW membership trends

The membership data for NUPSAW over the period 2021/2022 to 2025/2026 reflects a pattern of underlying growth that is repeatedly disrupted by sharp declines, particularly at the end of each financial year. Rather than a steady upward or downward trajectory, the union’s membership profile is best described as one of expansion constrained by instability.

Across the period under review, NUPSAW demonstrates a clear capacity to grow its membership base. Peak membership levels rise progressively over time, moving from just under 50,000 in the early years to consistently exceeding 54,000 by 2024/2025 and 2025/2026. This upward shift in the union’s high points suggests successful recruitment efforts. The fact that post-decline recoveries tend to return to higher levels than in previous cycles reinforces the view that the long-term trend is one of gradual consolidation rather than stagnation (Figure 8).

However, this positive trajectory is repeatedly undermined by pronounced declines that occur with notable regularity in the fourth quarter of each year. These declines are substantial, often erasing gains accumulated earlier in the year and pushing membership figures well below 40,000 in earlier cycles, and only marginally above that threshold in later years. The consistency and timing of these declines strongly suggest that they are not driven by member dissatisfaction.

Importantly, the union's ability to rebound after each decline points to organisational resilience. Membership levels recover quickly in subsequent quarters, often surpassing previous peaks. This pattern implies that losses are, to a large extent, reversible and that the underlying membership base remains intact. It also indicates that NUPSAW's recruitment and re-engagement mechanisms are sufficiently robust to offset periodic shocks.

POPCRU

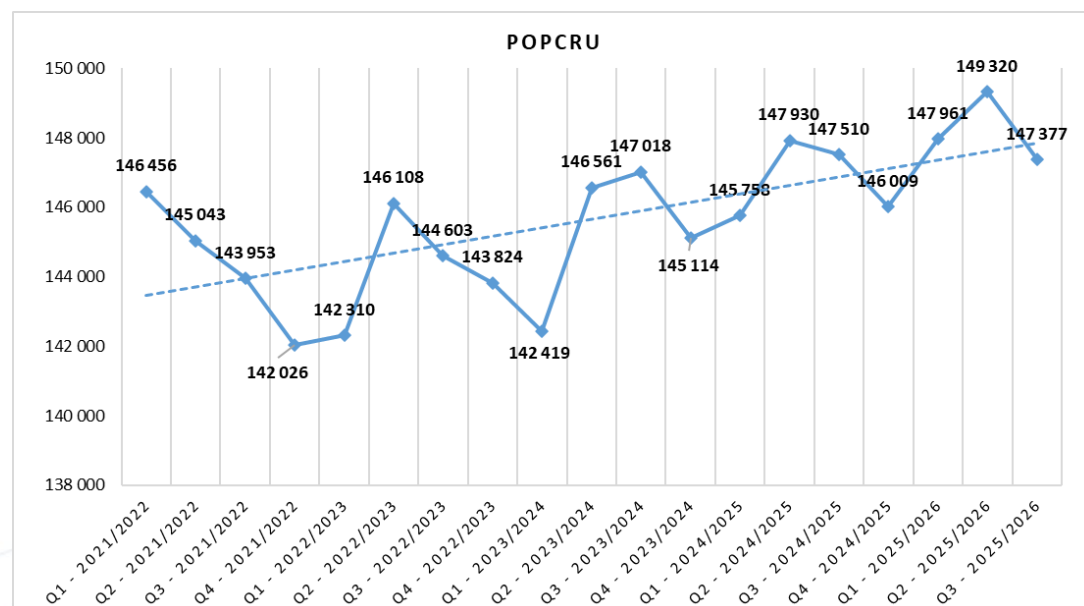


Figure 9: POPCRU membership trends

The membership data for POPCRU over the period from 2021/2022 to 2025/2026 reflects a picture of relative stability, marked by modest fluctuations rather than dramatic growth or decline. Unlike unions that experience sharp seasonal changes, POPCRU's membership base remains consistently within a narrow band, indicating a mature and largely consolidated organisation.

Across the period, overall membership levels hover in the mid-140,000 range, with gradual upward movement becoming more evident in the later years. While the early part of the series shows a mild erosion from the initial high point in 2021/2022, this small decline does not persist. Instead, it is followed by a phase of recovery and stabilisation, suggesting that any early losses were either temporary or successfully offset through ongoing recruitment and retention efforts (Figure 9).

A notable feature of the data is the recurring pattern of mid-year increases followed by slight end-of-year decline. These movements are relatively small in scale and do not materially alter the union's overall membership position.

PEU

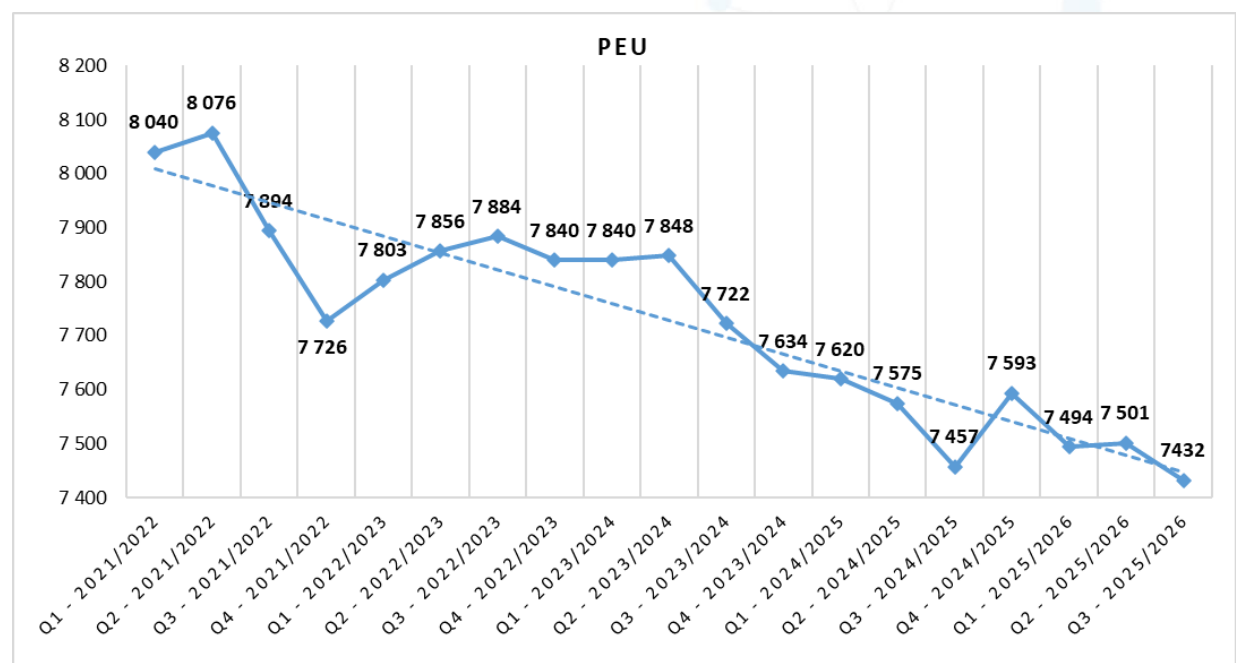


Figure 10: PEU membership trends

At the start of the 2021/2022 period, PEU's membership is just above 8,000, representing its strongest position in the dataset. This level is not sustained. Over subsequent years, the union settles into a narrow band below this peak, with membership generally fluctuating around the high-7,000 range. These fluctuations are small and incremental, suggesting that PEU is neither experiencing sudden losses nor achieving meaningful growth through recruitment.

From around 2023/2024 onwards, the downward drift becomes more apparent. Membership levels gradually edge lower, falling towards the mid-7,000s and failing to recover to earlier highs. The absence of strong rebound phases indicates limited recruitment momentum and points instead to a steady erosion of members (Figure10).

In summary, the data suggests that PEU is experiencing slow membership contraction. While the scale of decline is not dramatic, the long-term trend is clearly negative, with no evidence of a turnaround. This pattern signals underlying challenges in recruitment and highlights the need for targeted strategies if PEU is to stabilise and eventually rebuild its membership base.

PAWUSA

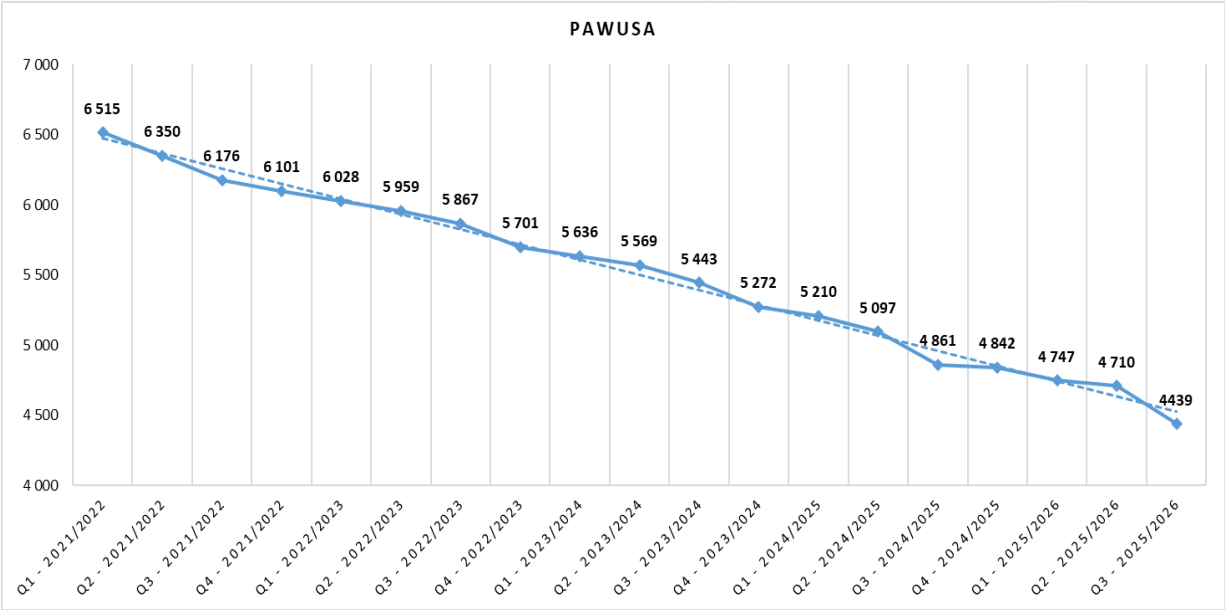
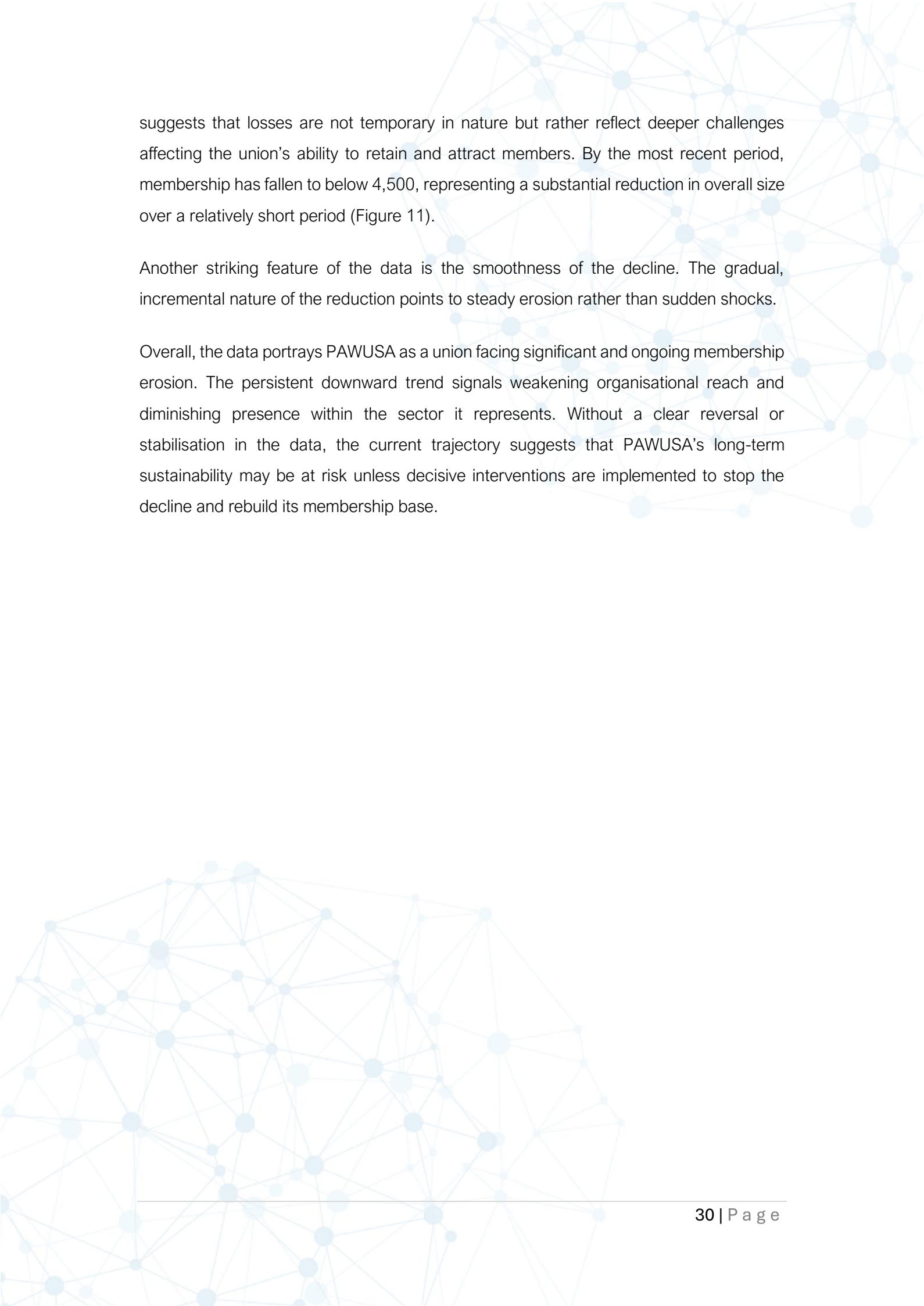


Figure 11: PAWUSA membership trends

The membership data for PAWUSA over the period from 2021/2022 to 2025/2026 reveals a clear and sustained downward trajectory, marked by consistent decline. Unlike unions that experience seasonal fluctuations or episodic recoveries, PAWUSA’s membership figures show a steady contraction across the entire period, indicating a structural weakening of its membership base.

At the beginning of the period, PAWUSA’s membership stands at just over 6,500. From that point onward, the data reflects an almost uninterrupted pattern of loss, with membership declining year after year. The absence of any meaningful recovery phases



suggests that losses are not temporary in nature but rather reflect deeper challenges affecting the union's ability to retain and attract members. By the most recent period, membership has fallen to below 4,500, representing a substantial reduction in overall size over a relatively short period (Figure 11).

Another striking feature of the data is the smoothness of the decline. The gradual, incremental nature of the reduction points to steady erosion rather than sudden shocks.

Overall, the data portrays PAWUSA as a union facing significant and ongoing membership erosion. The persistent downward trend signals weakening organisational reach and diminishing presence within the sector it represents. Without a clear reversal or stabilisation in the data, the current trajectory suggests that PAWUSA's long-term sustainability may be at risk unless decisive interventions are implemented to stop the decline and rebuild its membership base.

PSA

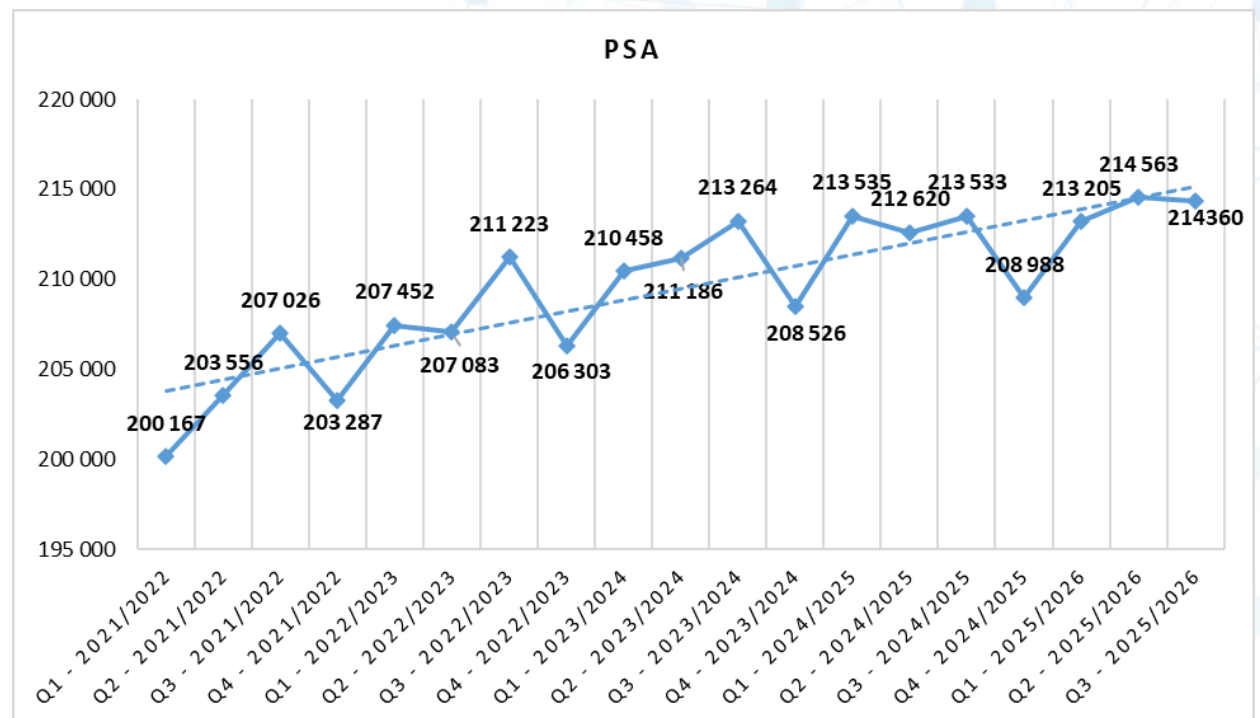


Figure 12: PSA union membership trends

At the outset of the period, PSA's membership is already substantial, at just over 200,000. Over subsequent years, the union consistently expands beyond this level, with peak membership gradually shifting upwards into the 210,000–214,000 range. This upward movement suggests sustained recruitment capacity and effective retention within a large and diverse membership base. Importantly, each successive period of recovery tends to return PSA to a higher level than before, indicating cumulative growth rather than mere fluctuation.

A recurring feature of the data is the presence of small declines towards year end, where membership numbers temporarily dips before rebounding in the following periods. These declines are relatively small when viewed against the overall size of the union and do not disrupt the broader growth trajectory. The regularity and limited scale of these dips in quarter 4 consecutively point to administrative or seasonal factors rather than genuine loss of organisational support or relevance.

In the more recent years, PSA's membership appears to stabilise at historically high levels, consistently exceeding 213,000. This plateauing effect suggests that the union may be approaching saturation within its core constituency, where opportunities for rapid

expansion are naturally constrained. Nevertheless, maintaining membership at this scale in a challenging public service environment reflects institutional strength and continued relevance (Figure 12).

Overall, the data portrays PSA as a mature and resilient union with a strong and stable membership base. While growth is gradual rather than dramatic, the long-term trend is clearly positive. PSA’s ability to absorb minor fluctuations and sustain membership at elevated levels underscores its position as a dominant and enduring actor within the public service labour landscape.

SAOU

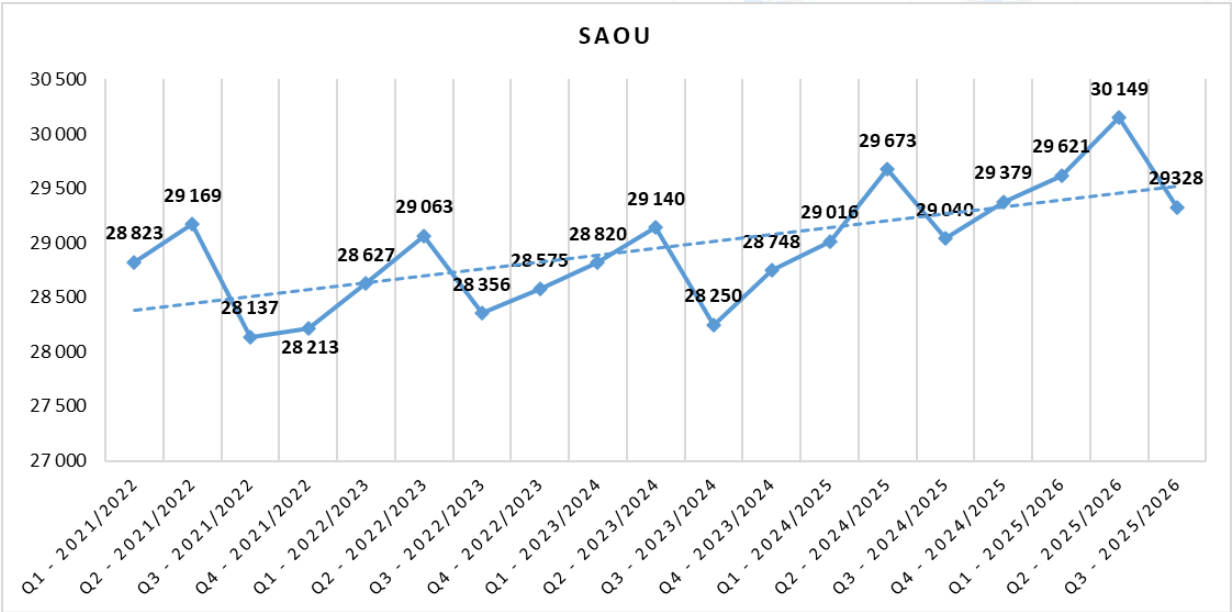


Figure 13: SAOU membership trends

Rather than experiencing sharp expansions or contractions, SAOU’s membership trajectory is characterised by controlled fluctuations around a gradually rising baseline.

In the earlier years, membership levels largely move within the high 28,000 to low 29,000 range, suggesting a stable but relatively contained organisational footprint. These movements do not point to instability, but rather to normal adjustments within a fairly fixed constituency. Importantly, there is no evidence of sustained decline during this phase, indicating that SAOU was largely successful in retaining its core membership base.

From 2023/2024 onwards, a subtle upward shift becomes more apparent. Peak membership levels move closer to, and eventually beyond, the 30,000 mark in the most

recent period. Although these gains are not dramatic, they are consistent, signalling a positive long-term direction.

Another notable feature of the data is the absence of severe end-of-year contractions. While minor softening does occur, these declines are limited in scale and are typically followed by recovery (Figure 13).

Overall, the data portrays SAOU as a union that is stable, resilient, and slowly expanding. Its membership trends reflect effective retention combined with measured growth, rather than aggressive expansion or decline. The steady movement towards higher membership levels suggests a union that is strengthening its position over time and maintaining relevance within its sector.

SADTU

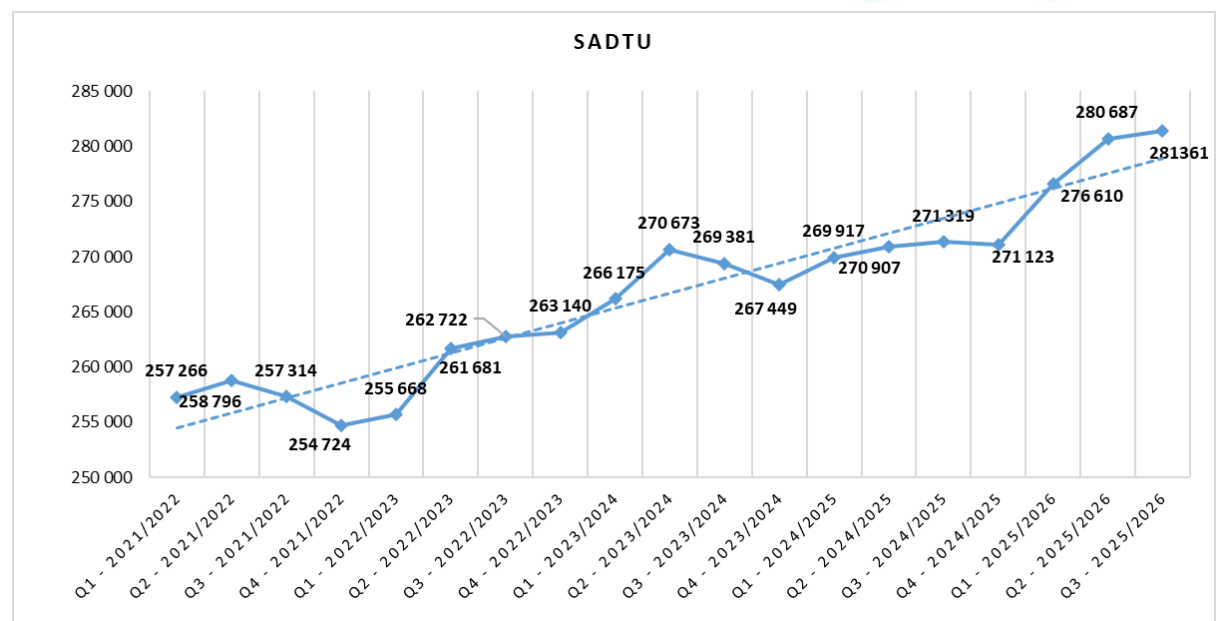


Figure 14: SADTU membership trends

Unlike unions that exhibit seasonal instability or stagnation, SADTU's trend is clearly upward, with growth consolidating over time.

At the beginning of the period, SADTU already commands a substantial membership of just over 257,000. Although there is a brief decline in the early phase, this does not translate into a prolonged decline. Instead, the data shows a decisive upward movement from 2022/2023 onwards, with membership levels steadily increasing and establishing higher baselines year after year. This pattern indicates effective recruitment and retention

strategies within the education sector, as well as the union's continued relevance to educators (Figure 14).

A key feature of the data is the progressive increase in peak membership levels. Each successive year sees SADTU reaching new highs, moving from the mid-260,000 range to well above 280,000 by 2025/2026. This is despite slight declines in each fourth quarter.

The later years of the dataset are particularly notable for the acceleration of growth. Membership expands more rapidly during this phase, pushing SADTU to its highest recorded levels.

Overall, the data portrays SADTU as a dominant and growing union with a robust and resilient membership base. The long-term trend is positive, characterised by sustained expansion rather than fluctuation. SADTU's ability to not only maintain but significantly grow its membership over this period underscores its institutional strength and entrenched position within the public education labour landscape.

SAEPU

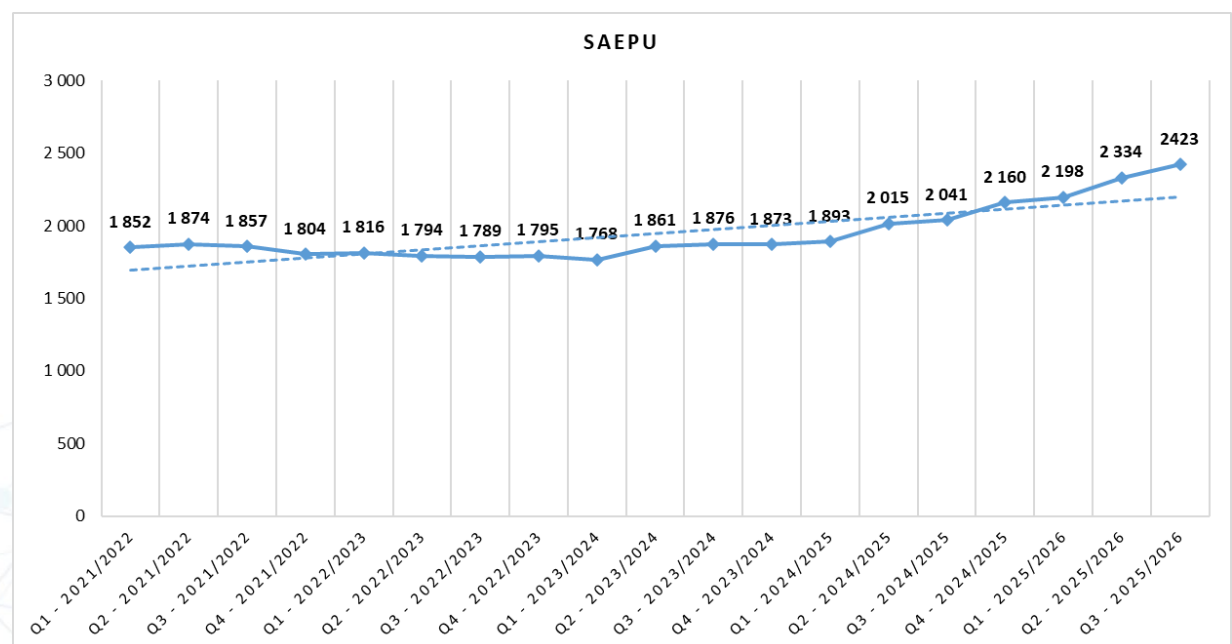


Figure 15: SAEPU membership trends.

For much of the early period, the union's membership base remains relatively small and tightly clustered, indicating limited expansion but also a degree of stability.

In the initial years, membership fluctuates narrowly around the 1,800 mark, with minor increases and declines that do not materially alter the union’s overall size. There is little evidence during this phase of sustained momentum in either direction.

A turning point becomes evident from around 2023/2024 onwards. Membership begins to trend upward, breaking out of the earlier level. This upward shift strengthens significantly in the subsequent period, with membership surpassing 2,000 and continuing to rise steadily thereafter. There are no identifiable declines in each fourth quarter (Figure 15).

By the most recent periods, SAEPU reaches its highest membership levels in the dataset, exceeding 2,400 members.

SAMATU

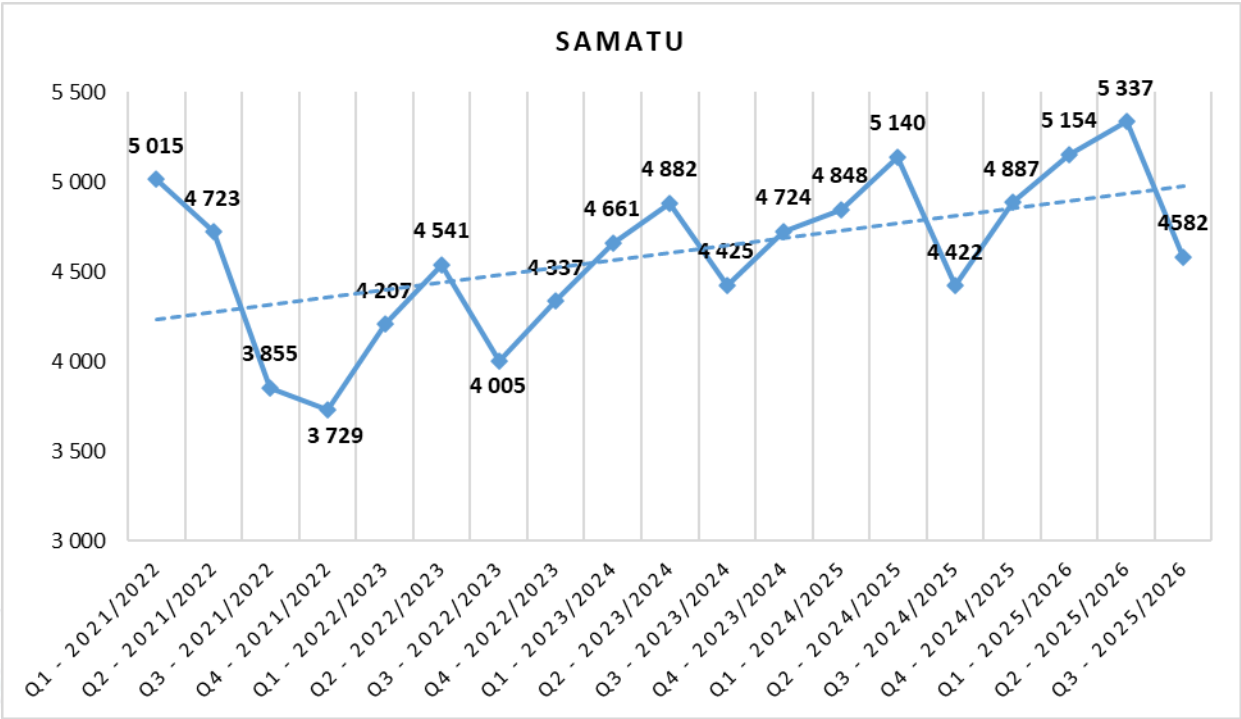


Figure 16: SAMATU membership trends

From 2021/2022, SAMATU experiences a sharp reduction in membership, falling from just over 5,000 to below 4,000 within a relatively short space of time. This early decline represents the most significant shock in the dataset and suggests challenges. However, this downturn does not persist indefinitely.

From 2022/2023 onwards, the data indicates a recovery phase. Membership levels begin to climb back into the mid-4,000 range and, over time, approach and intermittently exceed the 5,000 mark. Importantly, the union is able to regain much of the members lost in the initial decline, demonstrating organisational resilience. The quarter 4 trend has been on the rise in each financial year to 2025/2026 except in 2021/2022.

Despite this recovery, the growth path is not smooth. The data shows recurring dips that interrupt upward movement, preventing sustained consolidation at higher levels. These fluctuations suggest that while SAMATU has capacity to attract members, it faces ongoing challenges in retaining them consistently (Figure 16).

SAPU

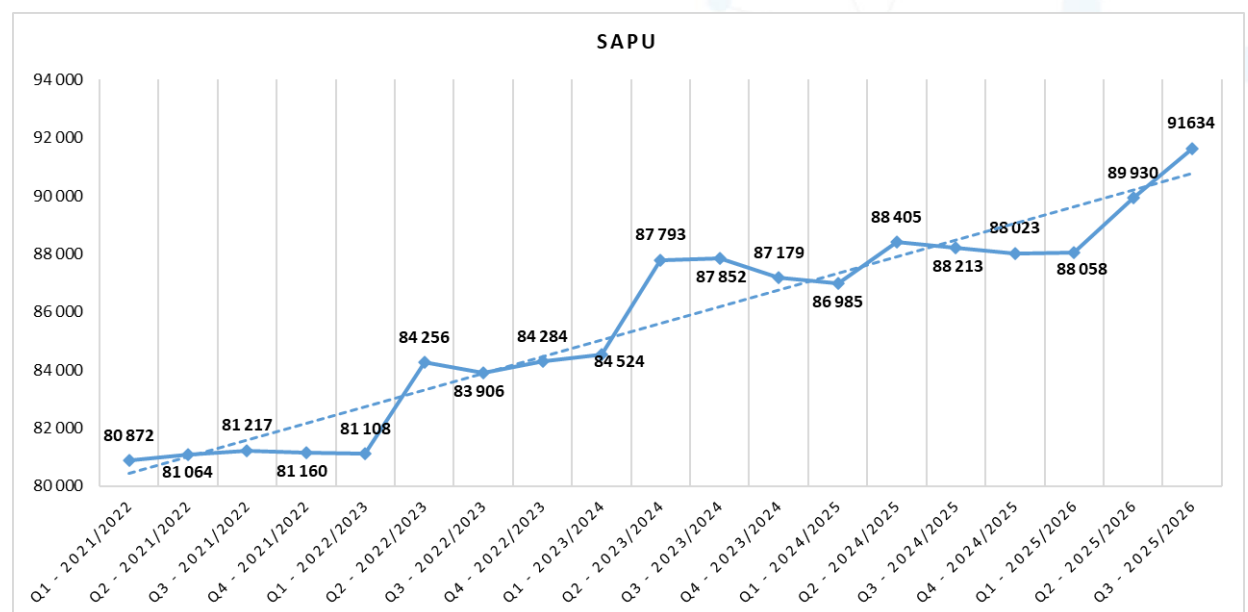


Figure 17: SAPU membership trends

At the start of the period, SAPU's membership is already substantial, standing at just over 80,000. In the early phase, growth is modest. However, from 2022/2023 onwards, the union enters a more pronounced growth phase, with membership levels moving decisively into the mid-80,000 range and continuing to rise thereafter. This upward shift indicates strengthened recruitment efforts and growing appeal within the policing sector with new recruitments.

A notable feature of the data is the consistency of SAPU's gains. While minor fluctuations do occur, particularly towards the end of some periods, these adjustments are limited in scale and do not disrupt the overall upward trend.

In the most recent periods, SAPU reaches its highest membership levels, exceeding 90,000 for the first time in the dataset. This milestone signals a meaningful expansion of the union's footprint and confirms that earlier gains have translated into sustained growth rather than temporary spikes (Figure 17).

Overall, the data portrays SAPU as a union on a solid growth trajectory. SAPU appears to be steadily reinforcing its position within the public safety sector, with the data suggesting continued potential for stable growth going forward.

UNIPSAWU

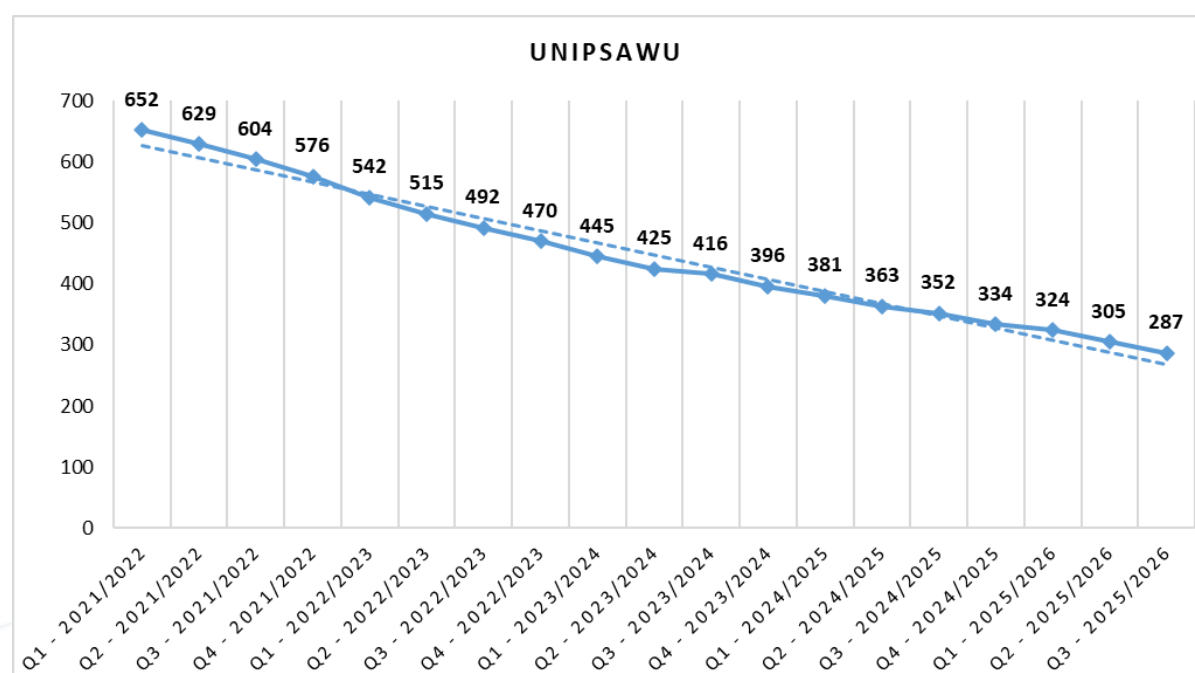


Figure 18: UNIPSAWU membership trends

Over the four-and-a-half-year period from 2021 to 2025, UNIPSAWU has experienced a catastrophic erosion of its membership base, falling from 652 members in the first quarter of 2021/2022 to just 287 members by the third quarter of 2025/2026. This represents a loss of over 56% of its membership, losing more than half of its members in less than five years. Such dramatic decline is not merely concerning but potentially existential for an

organisation that depends on membership numbers for both financial sustainability and bargaining power.

What makes this decline particularly alarming is its relentless consistency. Unlike organizations that might experience periodic setbacks combined with recovery phases, UNIPSAWU shows no quarter of stabilisation or growth throughout the entire dataset. Every single quarter recorded fewer members than the one before, creating an unbroken downward trajectory. The absence of even modest rebounds indicates that whatever factors driving members away, they remain unaddressed and possibly worsening.

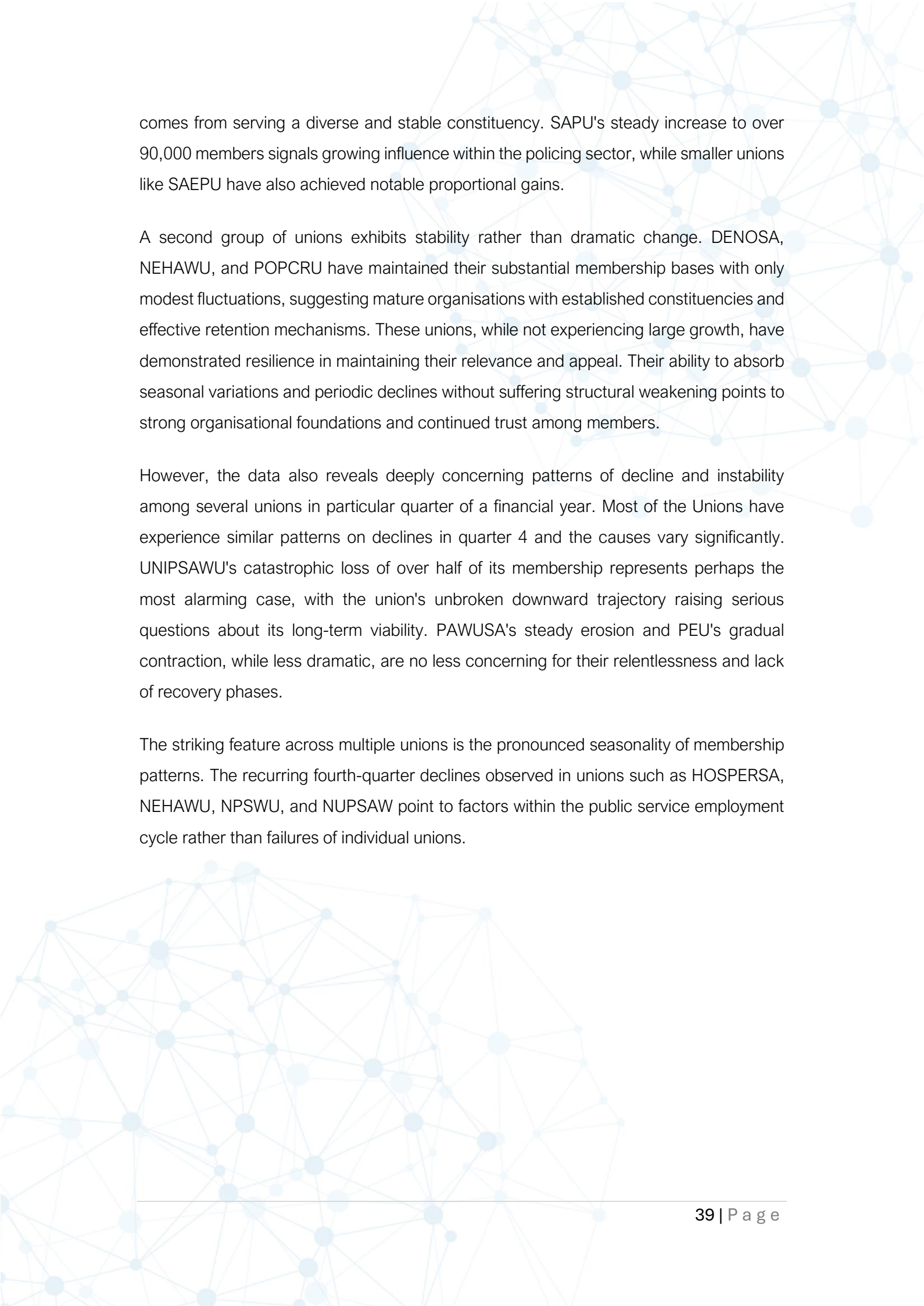
The rate of decline has shown some variation over time. The early periods saw larger absolute losses, with the union losing approximately 76 members in the first year alone. The proportional impact remains severe, with the union continuing to lose roughly 5-6% of its remaining membership each quarter in recent periods (Figure 18).

Without intervention or significant strategic changes, UNIPSAWU's trajectory suggests it may struggle to maintain relevance or operational capacity. The union now operates at less than half its 2021 strength, raising urgent questions about whether it can effectively represent members, or reverse what appears to be a terminal decline.

Conclusion

The membership data for South African public sector trade unions over the period 2021/2022 to 2025/2026 reveals a landscape of considerable diversity, where organisational trajectories range from robust expansion to abrupt decline. This analysis of Trade Unions demonstrates that the public service labour movement is far from uniformity, with different organisations experiencing different fortunes even as they operate within broadly similar institutional and economic contexts.

At one end of the scale, several unions have demonstrated impressive growth and organisational strength. SADTU stands out as the most successful, consolidating its position as the largest union in the dataset while achieving sustained membership expansion that has pushed its numbers well beyond 280,000. This growth trajectory, particularly pronounced in recent years, underscores the union's continued relevance to educators and its effectiveness in both recruitment and retention. Similarly, PSA has maintained its position as a major player in the public service landscape, consistently exceeding 213,000 members and demonstrating the kind of institutional strength that



comes from serving a diverse and stable constituency. SAPU's steady increase to over 90,000 members signals growing influence within the policing sector, while smaller unions like SAEPU have also achieved notable proportional gains.

A second group of unions exhibits stability rather than dramatic change. DENOSA, NEHAWU, and POPCRU have maintained their substantial membership bases with only modest fluctuations, suggesting mature organisations with established constituencies and effective retention mechanisms. These unions, while not experiencing large growth, have demonstrated resilience in maintaining their relevance and appeal. Their ability to absorb seasonal variations and periodic declines without suffering structural weakening points to strong organisational foundations and continued trust among members.

However, the data also reveals deeply concerning patterns of decline and instability among several unions in particular quarter of a financial year. Most of the Unions have experience similar patterns on declines in quarter 4 and the causes vary significantly. UNIPSAWU's catastrophic loss of over half of its membership represents perhaps the most alarming case, with the union's unbroken downward trajectory raising serious questions about its long-term viability. PAWUSA's steady erosion and PEU's gradual contraction, while less dramatic, are no less concerning for their relentlessness and lack of recovery phases.

The striking feature across multiple unions is the pronounced seasonality of membership patterns. The recurring fourth-quarter declines observed in unions such as HOSPERSA, NEHAWU, NPSWU, and NUPSAW point to factors within the public service employment cycle rather than failures of individual unions.

**TRADE UNION DUAL
MEMBERSHIP TRENDS**

Introduction

The report examines multiple union membership within PSCBC-affiliated Trade Unions. Multiple union membership refers to public servants who hold membership in more than one Trade Union simultaneously, offering insights into overlapping affiliations and the dynamics of union representation in the public service.

Total Number of Public Servants Belonging to More than One Trade Union

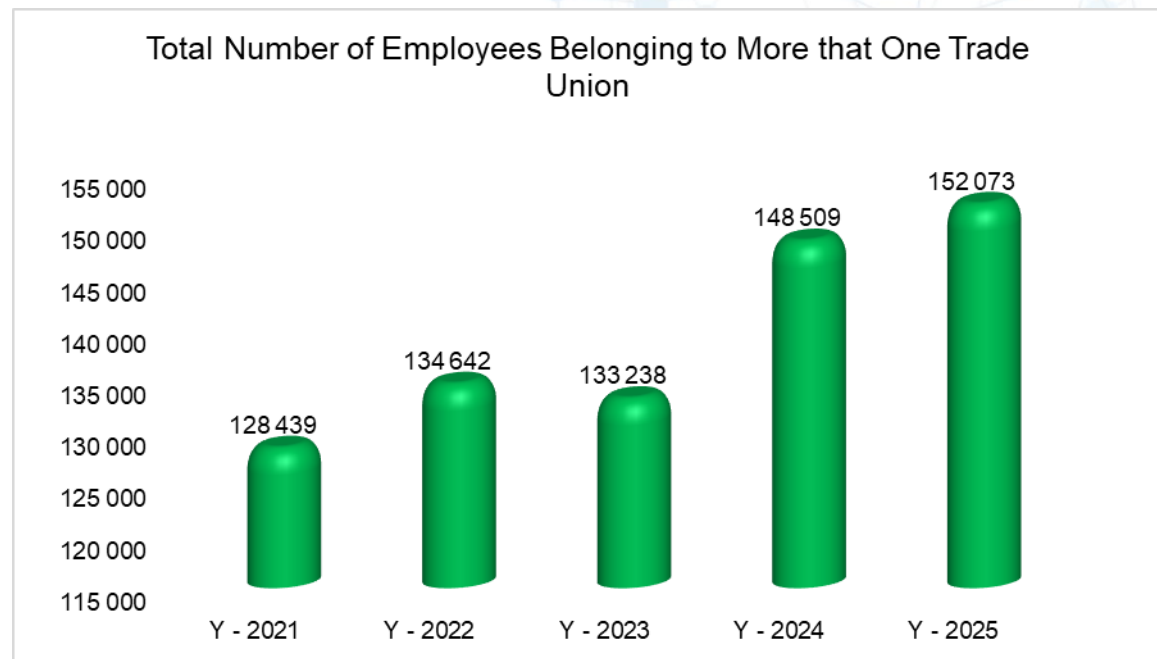


Figure 1: Number of employees with more than one trade union from 2021 to 2025

In 2021, the baseline year recorded 128,439 public servants with multiple union affiliations. This figure experienced a notable increase the following year, rising to 134,642 in 2022, representing an increase of 6,202 members. However, 2023 witnessed a slight decline, dropping to 133,238.

The trend increased again in 2024 surging to 148,509 public servants holding multiple union memberships, representing the most substantial annual increase in the dataset at over 15,000 additional members. This upward momentum continued into 2025, although at a more modest pace, with the figure reaching 152,073 (Figure 1).

Number of Public Servants Belonging to More than one Trade Union Broken Down to Provincial & National Government

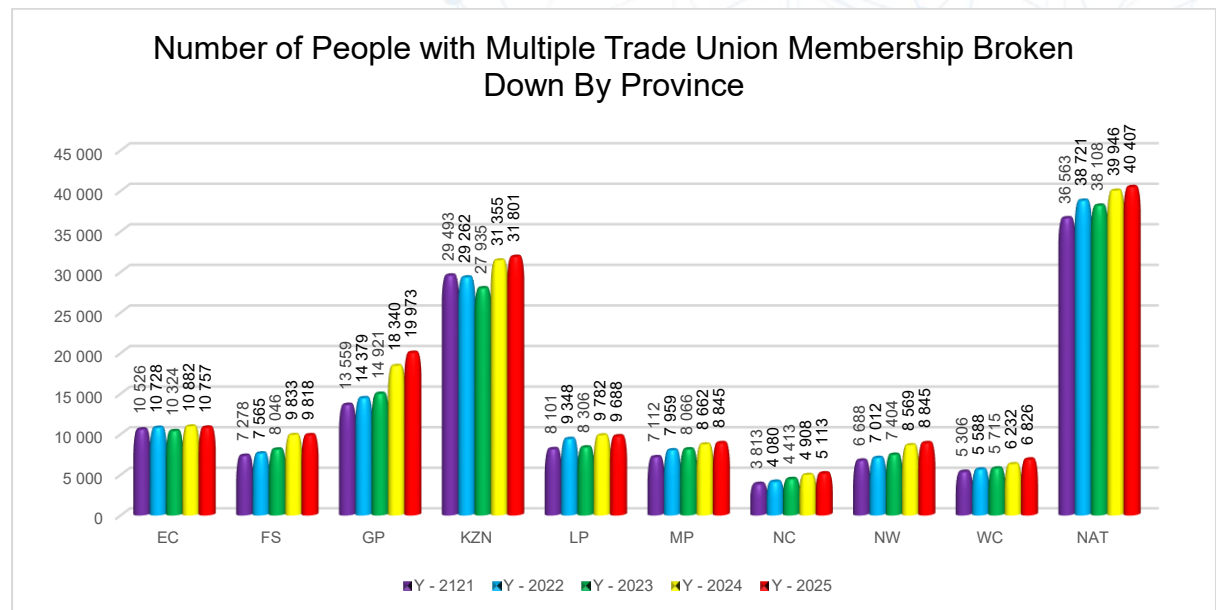


Figure 2: Number of public servants with dual membership broken down to provincial and national government for the past 5 years.

The data reveals a persistent and growing trend of multi-union membership within public service. At the national level, the scale of the multiple union membership is extensive, hovering consistently around 40,000 individuals throughout the period. Starting at approximately 36,500 in 2021, this figure grew steadily to just over 40,000 by 2025, representing an increase of roughly 11% over the five years.

Provincially, the KwaZulu-Natal province consistently dominates the landscape, maintaining the highest numbers throughout the entire period, beginning at nearly 29,500 cases in 2021 and reaching almost 32,000 by 2025. Gauteng emerges as the second highest, with an increasing trajectory. Starting from around 13,500 cases in 2021, Gauteng experienced a sharp upward trend, nearly reaching 20,000 by 2025—a staggering 47% increase that outpaces all other provinces.

The Free State presents another case of increase, with affiliations jumping from approximately 7,300 to nearly 10,000, a 35% increase. In contrast, the Western Cape shows relatively modest growth from about 5,300 to 6,800, while the Northern Cape, despite its smaller public service, experienced proportionally significant growth of dual membership from roughly 3,800 to 5,100 which is around 34% growth.

All other provinces demonstrated a generally upward trend, though with some instability year-to-year. The Eastern Cape, Limpopo, Mpumalanga, and North West all show net increases over the period, though lower than Gauteng or the Free State.

Breakdown of Multiple Union Membership Categories by Number of Employees on Each category.

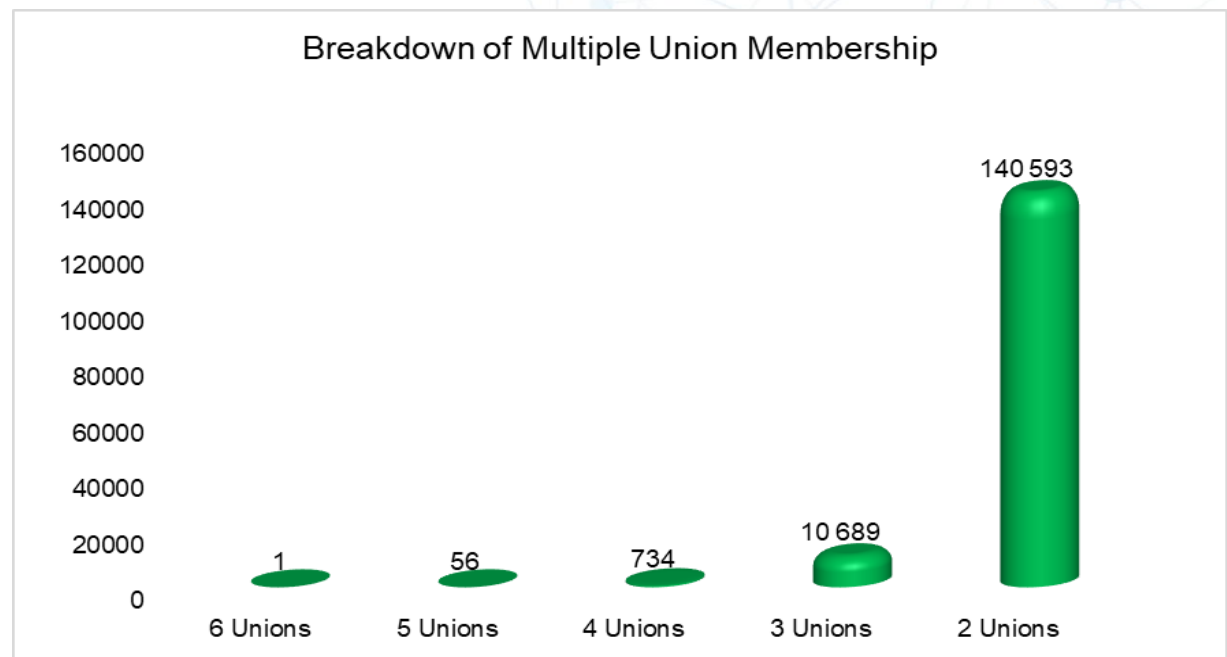


Figure 3: Breakdown of multiple union membership categories by number of employees on each category as of end December 2025.

The overwhelming majority of employees with multiple union membership maintain membership in two unions, representing 140,593 individuals. The employee count decreases substantially with a greater number of affiliations. Those affiliated with three unions amount to 10,689, while membership in four unions dropped sharply to 734 employees. The pattern continues at the upper levels, with only 56 employees holding five union memberships and only one individual maintaining affiliation with 6 unions.

Percentage of Members Each Trade Union Share with Others Due to Multiple Trade Union Membership.

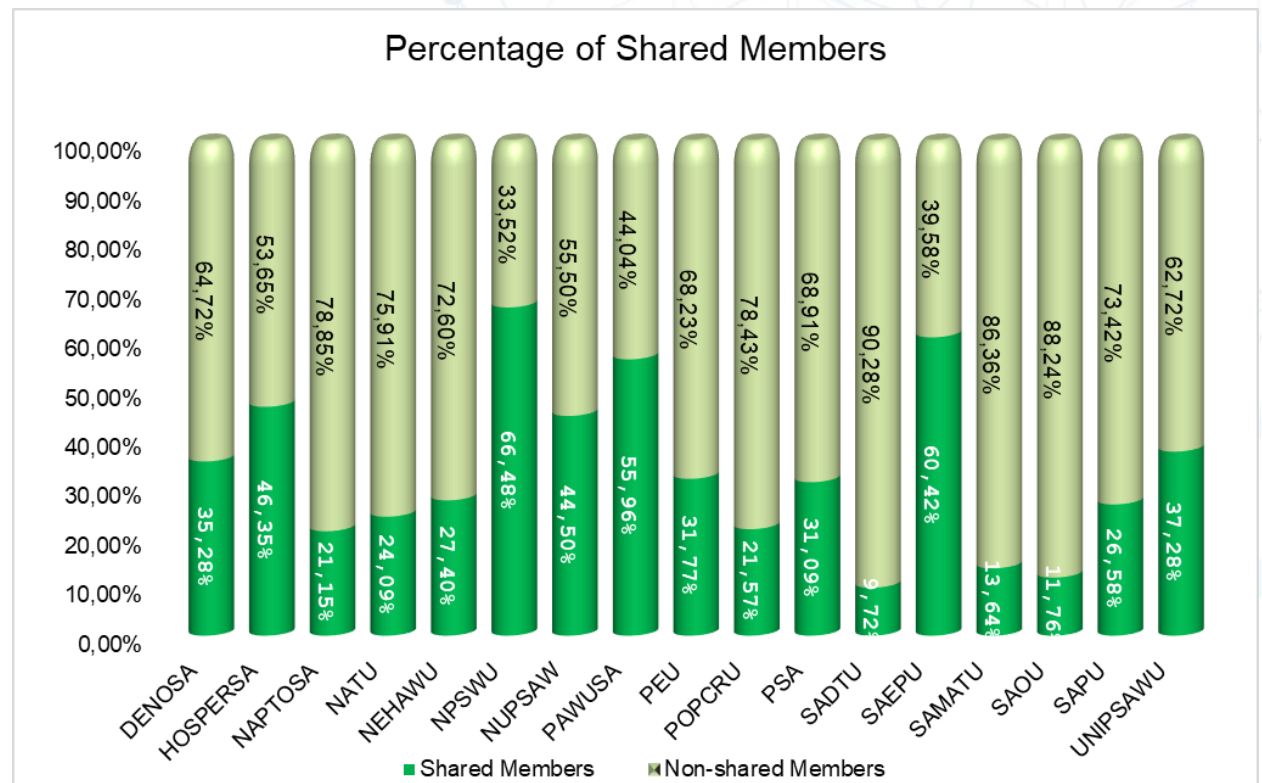


Figure 3: Percentage of dual membership against total number of each Trade Union members as per 31/12/2025 DPSA data.

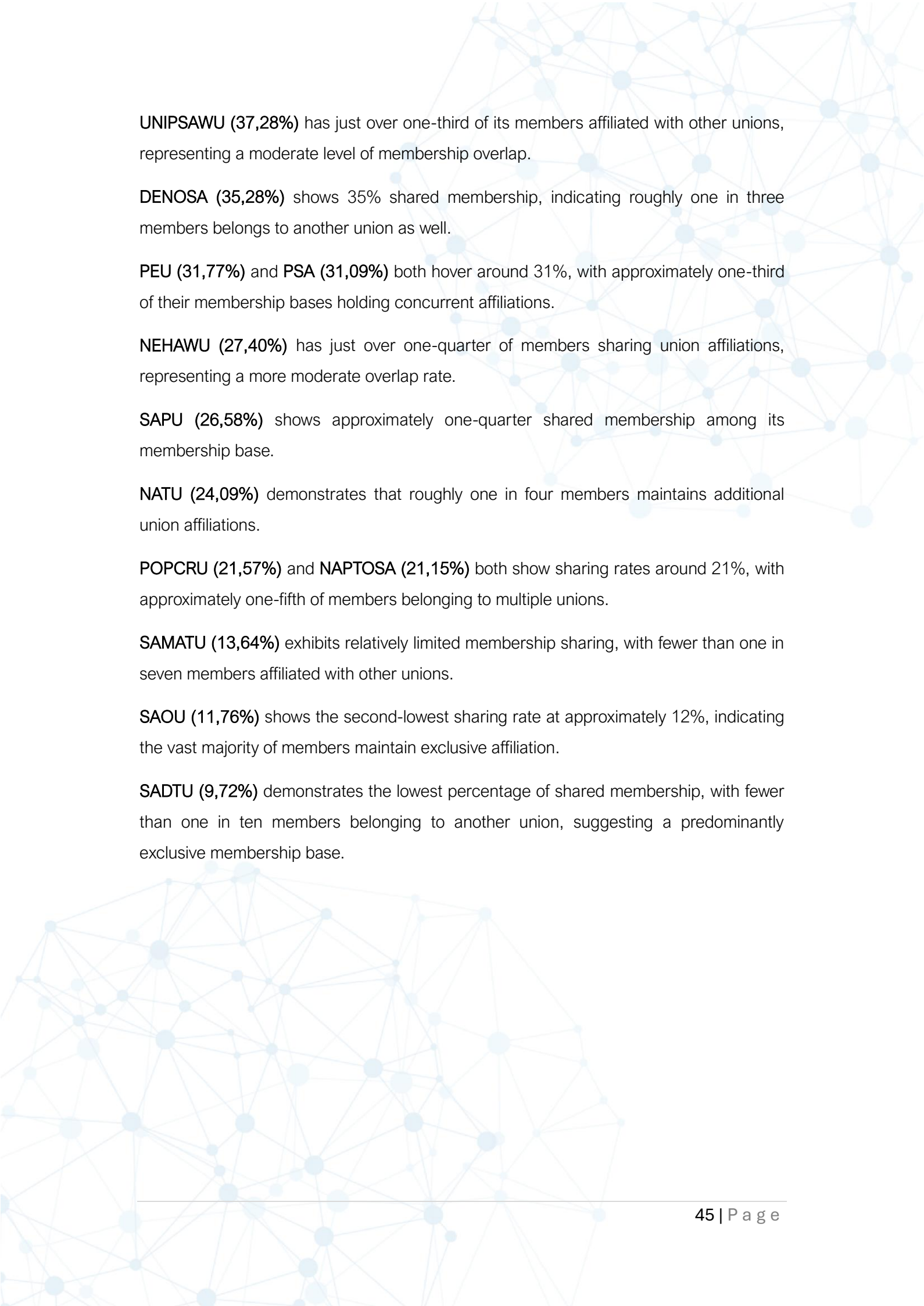
This data reveals varying levels of multi-union affiliation across South African public service Trade Unions as of 31 December 2025.

NPSWU (66,48%) exhibits the highest proportion of shared membership, indicating that approximately two-thirds of its members also belong to at least one other trade union. This suggests NPSWU members actively maintain multiple union affiliations.

SAEPU (60,42%) shows the second-highest sharing rate, with three-fifths of members holding concurrent memberships elsewhere. This reflects a pattern where SAEPU members frequently supplement their representation through additional union affiliations.

PAWUSA (55,96%) demonstrates that over half its membership base simultaneously belongs to other unions, indicating substantial overlap in the worker constituencies it serves.

HOSPERSA (46,35%) and **NUPSAW (44,50%)** both show sharing rates between 44-46%, meaning nearly half of their members maintain dual or multiple union memberships.



UNIPSAWU (37,28%) has just over one-third of its members affiliated with other unions, representing a moderate level of membership overlap.

DENOSA (35,28%) shows 35% shared membership, indicating roughly one in three members belongs to another union as well.

PEU (31,77%) and **PSA (31,09%)** both hover around 31%, with approximately one-third of their membership bases holding concurrent affiliations.

NEHAWU (27,40%) has just over one-quarter of members sharing union affiliations, representing a more moderate overlap rate.

SAPU (26,58%) shows approximately one-quarter shared membership among its membership base.

NATU (24,09%) demonstrates that roughly one in four members maintains additional union affiliations.

POPCRU (21,57%) and **NAPTOSA (21,15%)** both show sharing rates around 21%, with approximately one-fifth of members belonging to multiple unions.

SAMATU (13,64%) exhibits relatively limited membership sharing, with fewer than one in seven members affiliated with other unions.

SAOU (11,76%) shows the second-lowest sharing rate at approximately 12%, indicating the vast majority of members maintain exclusive affiliation.

SADTU (9,72%) demonstrates the lowest percentage of shared membership, with fewer than one in ten members belonging to another union, suggesting a predominantly exclusive membership base.

Total Number of Employees with Multiple Trade Union Membership VS Contributed Number of Memberships

Eastern Cape

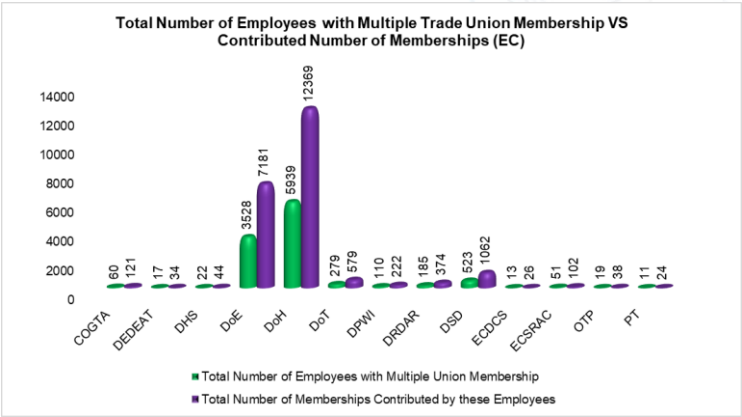


Figure 4: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data reveals a substantial presence of multiple union membership across Eastern Cape provincial departments as of December 31, 2025, with a total of 10,757 employees holding dual or multiple union affiliations, collectively contributing 22,176 memberships across the thirteen departments.

The distribution of multiple union membership demonstrates considerable variation across departments, with clear concentration in specific sectors. The Department of Education emerges as the most significant contributor, with 3,528 employees holding multiple memberships that translate into 7,181 total affiliations. This substantial figure reflects both the department's large workforce and the prevalence of dual union affiliation within the education sector. Similarly, the Department of Health shows pronounced multiple membership activity, with 5,939 employees contributing 12,369 memberships, representing the highest absolute numbers in the province.

Beyond these two dominant departments, the data shows meaningful multiple union participation in several other sectors. The Department of Social Development records 523 employees with 1,062 memberships, while the Department of Transport reflects 279 employees contributing 579 affiliations. The Department of Rural Development and Agrarian Reform shows 185 employees with 374 memberships, indicating moderate but notable dual affiliation activity.

The membership ratio—calculated as total memberships divided by employees with multiple affiliations—provides insight into the extent of union overlap. Across all

departments, this ratio approximates 2.06, suggesting that employees with multiple union memberships typically belong to approximately two unions. This consistency is evident across most departments, with ratios ranging between 2.0 and 2.18, indicating a relatively uniform pattern of dual union affiliation rather than membership in three or more organizations.

Several smaller departments demonstrate more modest but proportionally similar patterns. The Department of Public Works and Infrastructure shows 110 employees with 222 memberships, while COGTA records 60 employees contributing 121 affiliations. The smaller departments, including the Office of the Premier (19 employees, 38 memberships), Provincial Treasury (11 employees, 24 memberships), and ECDCS (13 employees, 26 memberships)—reflect lower absolute numbers that correspond with their smaller overall workforce sizes while maintaining comparable membership ratios.

Free State

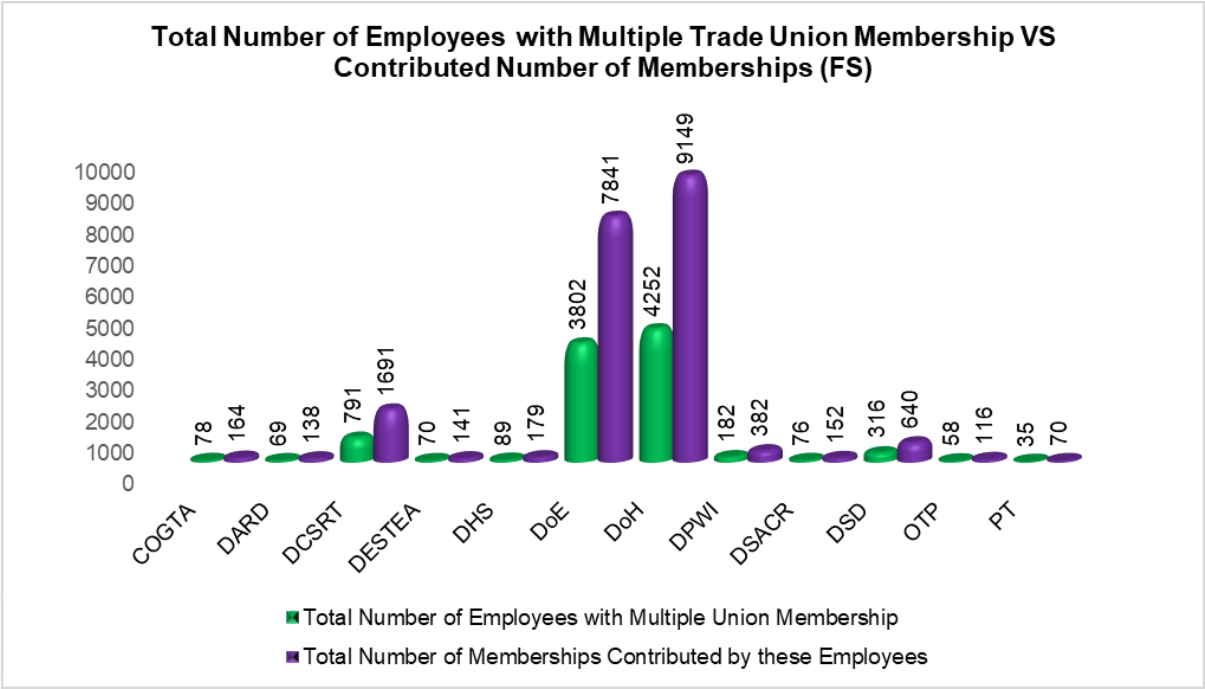


Figure 5: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data reveals notable patterns in multiple union membership across Free State provincial departments as of December 31, 2025. The most notable feature is the substantial concentration of employees with multiple union affiliations in two major service delivery departments: the Department of Education (DoE) with 3,802 employees holding 7,841 memberships, and the Department of Health (DoH) with 4,252 employees

maintaining 9,149 memberships. These two departments alone account for the overwhelming majority of multiple union membership activity in the province, representing approximately 80% of all employees with such affiliations.

The average membership ratio across departments shows that employees with multiple union affiliations typically belong to approximately two unions each, with this ratio remaining fairly consistent across most departments. For instance, DoE employees average 2.06 memberships per person, while DoH employees average 2.15 memberships. This consistency suggests a relatively uniform pattern of union engagement among those who choose to affiliate with multiple organizations.

Beyond the two dominant departments, the Department of Community Safety and Transport Management (DCSRT) stands out as the third-largest contributor with 791 employees holding 1,691 memberships, followed by the Department of Social Development with 316 employees. The remaining departments show considerably smaller numbers, with most having fewer than 100 employees holding multiple memberships. Smaller administrative departments such as the Office of the Premier (58 employees) and Provincial Treasury (35 employees) demonstrate proportionally lower figures, which aligns with their smaller overall workforce sizes.

Gauteng

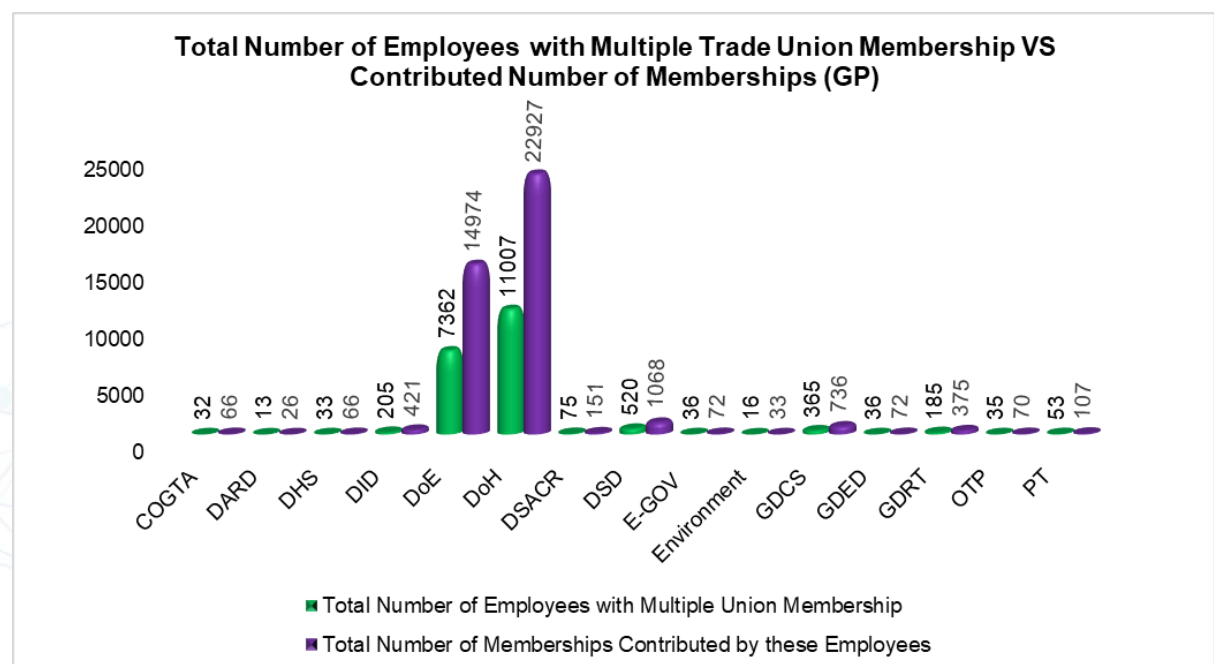
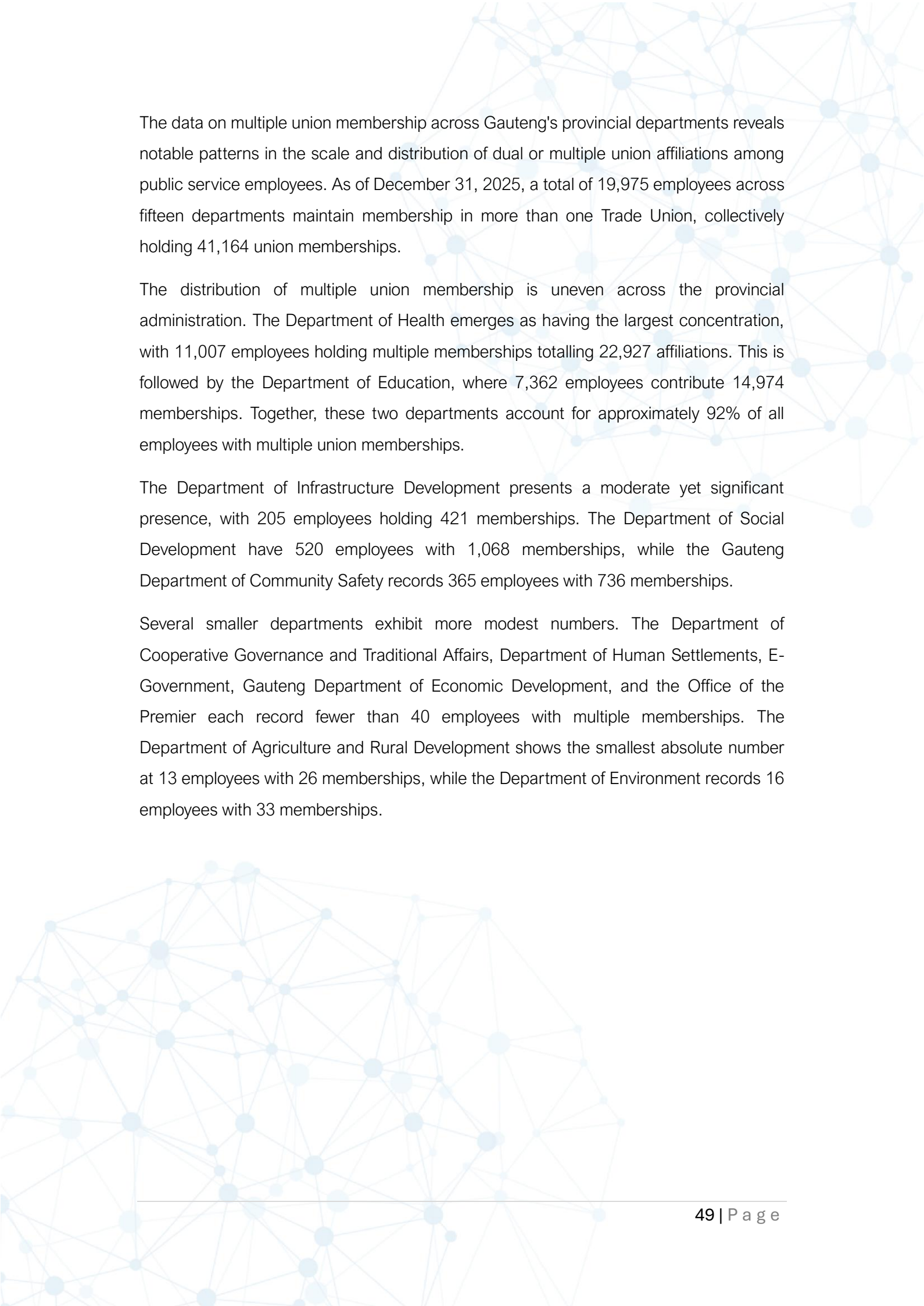


Figure 6: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.



The data on multiple union membership across Gauteng's provincial departments reveals notable patterns in the scale and distribution of dual or multiple union affiliations among public service employees. As of December 31, 2025, a total of 19,975 employees across fifteen departments maintain membership in more than one Trade Union, collectively holding 41,164 union memberships.

The distribution of multiple union membership is uneven across the provincial administration. The Department of Health emerges as having the largest concentration, with 11,007 employees holding multiple memberships totalling 22,927 affiliations. This is followed by the Department of Education, where 7,362 employees contribute 14,974 memberships. Together, these two departments account for approximately 92% of all employees with multiple union memberships.

The Department of Infrastructure Development presents a moderate yet significant presence, with 205 employees holding 421 memberships. The Department of Social Development have 520 employees with 1,068 memberships, while the Gauteng Department of Community Safety records 365 employees with 736 memberships.

Several smaller departments exhibit more modest numbers. The Department of Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs, Department of Human Settlements, E-Government, Gauteng Department of Economic Development, and the Office of the Premier each record fewer than 40 employees with multiple memberships. The Department of Agriculture and Rural Development shows the smallest absolute number at 13 employees with 26 memberships, while the Department of Environment records 16 employees with 33 memberships.

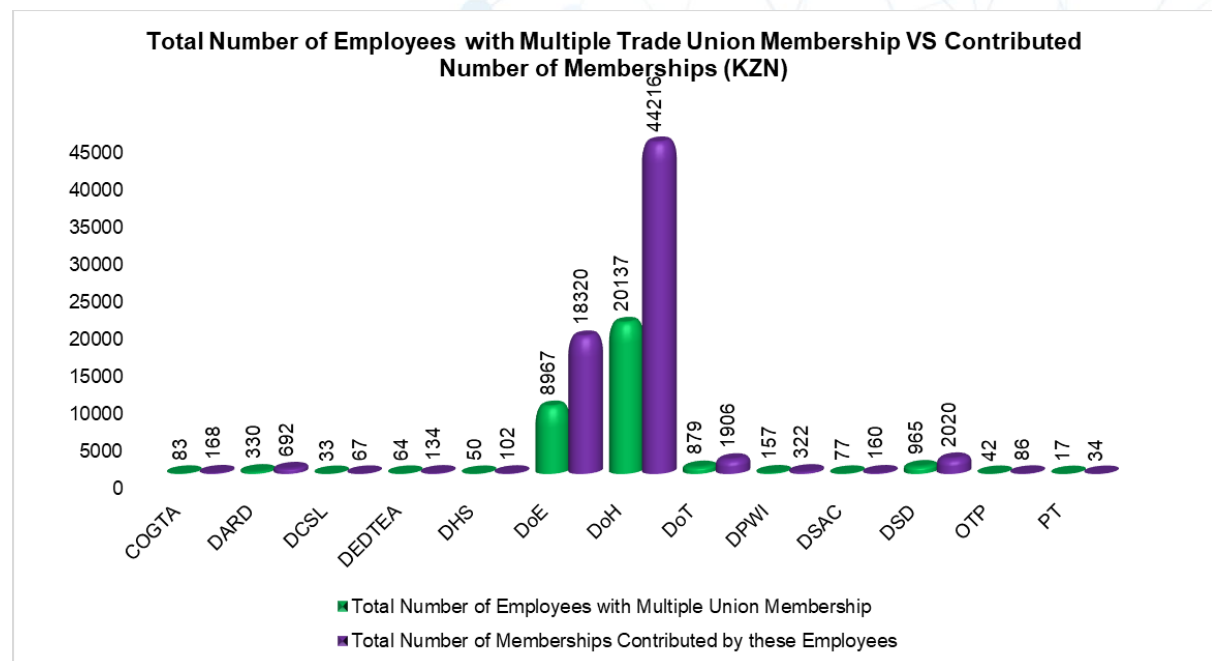


Figure 7: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data on multiple union membership across KwaZulu-Natal's provincial departments reveals distinct patterns in employee union affiliation as of December 31, 2025. Across the thirteen departments examined, a total of 31,801 employees hold membership in more than one trade union, collectively contributing 68,227 union memberships.

The distribution of multiple union membership varies considerably across departments, largely correlating with overall departmental size and workforce composition. The Department of Health emerges as the most substantial contributor, with 20,137 employees holding multiple memberships and contributing 44,216 total memberships. This figure represents nearly two-thirds of all multiple union memberships in the province and reflects the department's position as the largest employer among provincial departments. The Department of Education similarly shows significant numbers, with 8,967 employees maintaining multiple union affiliations and contributing 18,320 memberships, accounting for approximately 28% of employees with multiple memberships across the provincial departments.

Beyond these two dominant departments, the Department of Transport registers notable activity with 879 employees holding 1,906 memberships, while the Department of Social Development records 965 employees with 2,020 memberships. The Department of

Agriculture and Rural Development shows 330 employees contributing 692 memberships. The remaining departments, including COGTA, DEDTEA, DPWI, DSAC, DHS, DCSL, OTP, and PT, each record fewer than 200 employees with multiple union memberships, reflecting their relatively smaller workforce sizes.

Limpopo

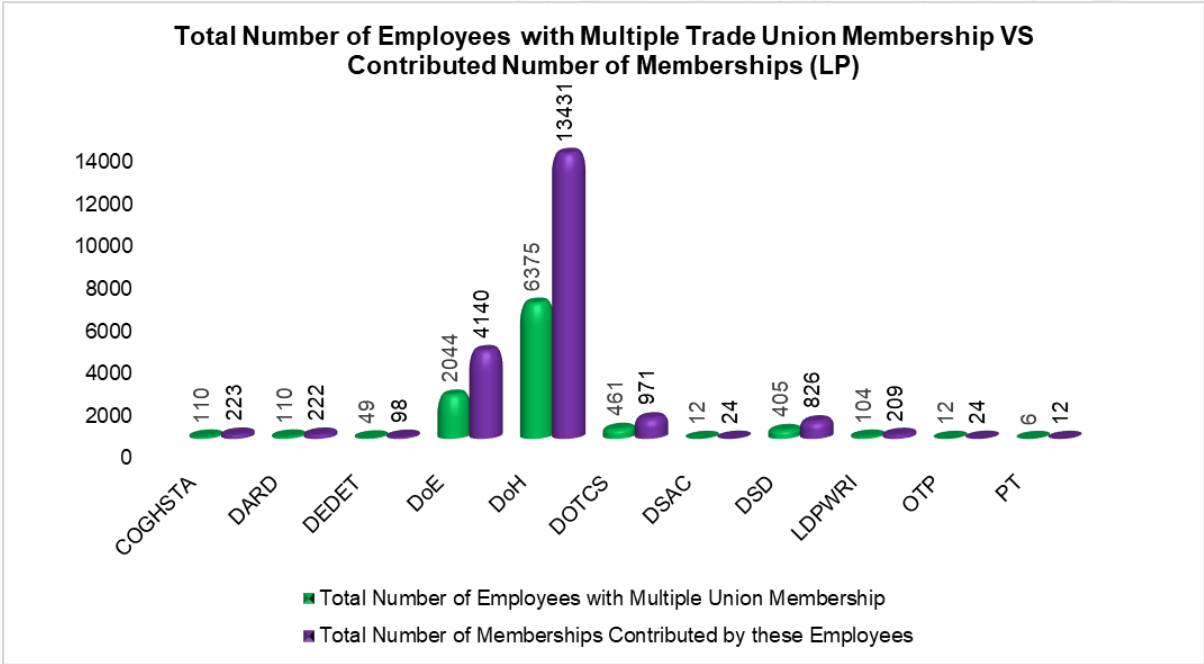


Figure 8: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data on multiple union membership across Limpopo Provincial departments reveals several noteworthy patterns regarding employee union affiliation as of December 31, 2025. Across eleven departments, a total of 9,688 employees hold membership in more than one Trade Union, collectively contributing 20,180 union memberships. This indicates that employees with multiple affiliations maintain an average of approximately 2.08 union memberships each, suggesting that dual membership is the predominant pattern rather than affiliation with three or more unions.

The distribution of multiple union membership across departments shows considerable variation in scale and intensity. The Department of Health stands as the most significant case, with 6,375 employees holding multiple memberships and contributing 13,431 total memberships. This represents nearly two-thirds of all employees with multiple union affiliations across the province and accounts for over 66% of the total memberships

contributed. The Department of Education follows as the second-largest department in this regard, with 2,044 employees contributing 4,140 memberships.

The remaining departments demonstrate substantially smaller scales of multiple union membership. The Department of Transport & Community Safety, and the Department of Social Development show moderate levels with 461 and 405 employees respectively, each maintaining approximately two memberships per employee. Several departments, including COGHSTA and DARD, show identical figures of 110 employees contributing 222 and 223 memberships respectively, while smaller departments such as the Premier's Office and DSAC record only 12 employees each with dual affiliations.

Mpumalanga

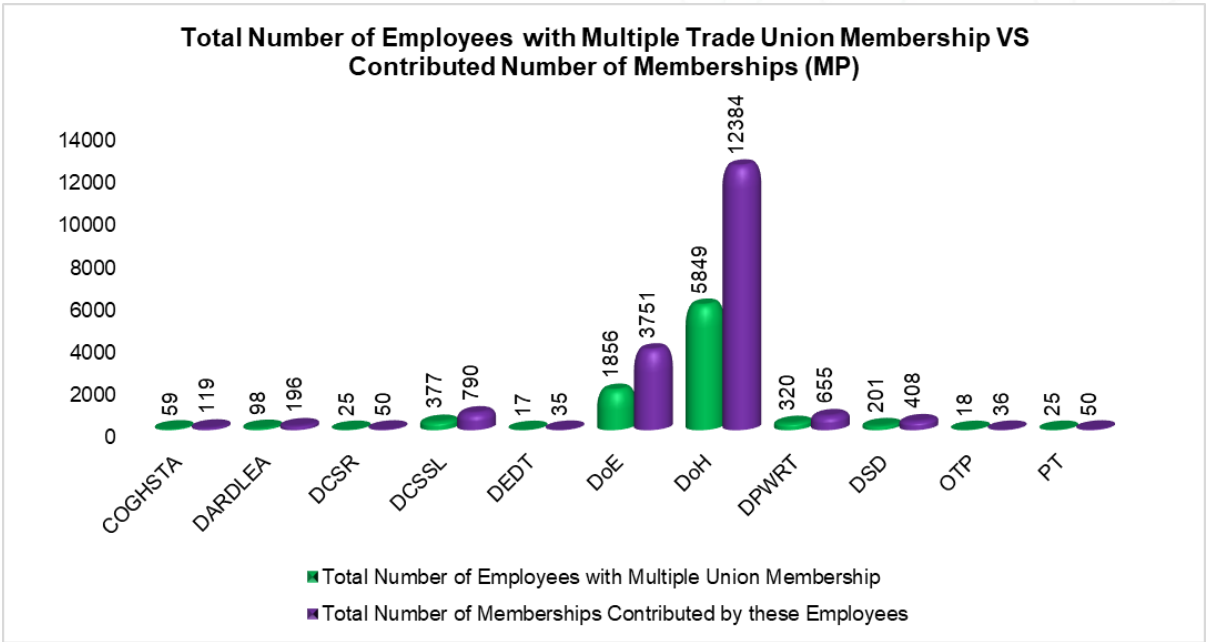


Figure 9: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data from Mpumalanga Province's departments reveals a notable pattern of multiple Trade Union membership among public servants as of December 2025. Collectively, the eleven provincial departments recorded 7,845 employees holding dual or multiple union memberships, which translates to a total of 16,474 individual union affiliations across the province.

The distribution varies considerably across departments, with clear patterns emerging when examining the scale and concentration of multiple memberships. The Department of Health stands out in the dataset, accounting for 5,849 employees with multiple union

affiliations who contribute 12,384 total memberships. This represents nearly three-quarters of all employees with multiple union memberships across the province.

The Department of Education presents another significant concentration, with 1,856 employees holding 3,751 union memberships. The Department of Community Safety and Security Liaison follows as the third largest contributor to this pattern, recording 377 employees with 790 total memberships.

The remaining departments show considerably smaller numbers, ranging from DPWRT with 320 employees holding 655 memberships, through to several departments with fewer than 100 employees in this category. Department of Economic Development and Tourism (DEDT) and the Office of the Premier (OTP) record the smallest figures among the departments, with 17 and 18 employees respectively maintaining multiple union affiliations.

Northern Cape

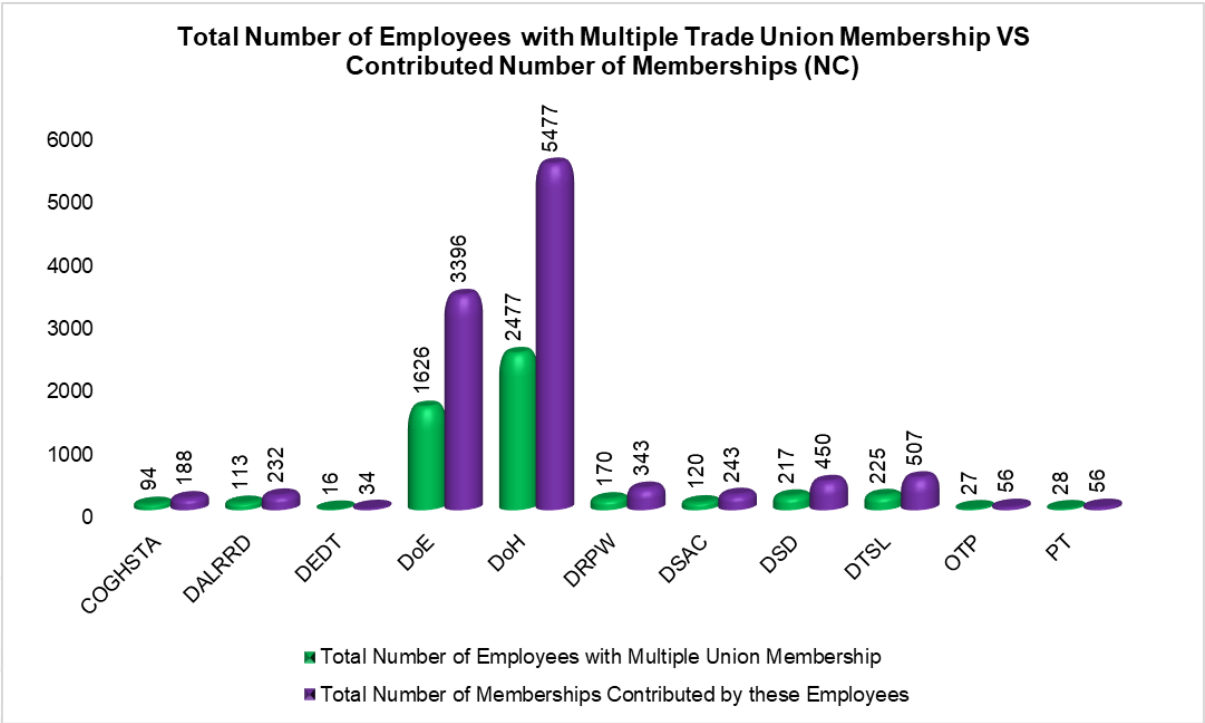


Figure 10: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The provincial departments in the Northern Cape Province demonstrate varying degrees of multiple union membership among their employees, with notable patterns emerging across the administrative landscape as of December 31, 2025. The data reveals that

5,113 employees hold membership in more than one trade union simultaneously, contributing to a total of 10,982 memberships across these departments.

The Department of Health stands out the most in this regard, with 2,477 employees holding multiple union memberships and contributing 5,477 total memberships. This represents nearly half of all employees with multiple affiliations across the province. Similarly, the Department of Education shows significant numbers, with 1,626 employees contributing 3,384 memberships, indicating that education sector employees also demonstrate considerable engagement with multiple union structures.

The distribution of multiple memberships across departments reveals an interesting pattern when examining the ratio between employees and total memberships. Most departments show an approximate doubling effect, where employees with multiple memberships typically belong to two unions. However, some departments demonstrate slightly higher ratios—the Department of Health, for instance, shows an average of approximately 2.2 memberships per employee with multiple affiliations, while Transport, Safety and Liaison show about 2.25 memberships per employee, suggesting that in certain sectors, employees are more likely to affiliate with more than two unions simultaneously.

The smaller departments, including the Office of the Premier and the Provincial Treasury, show more modest numbers, with 27 and 28 employees respectively holding multiple memberships.

North West

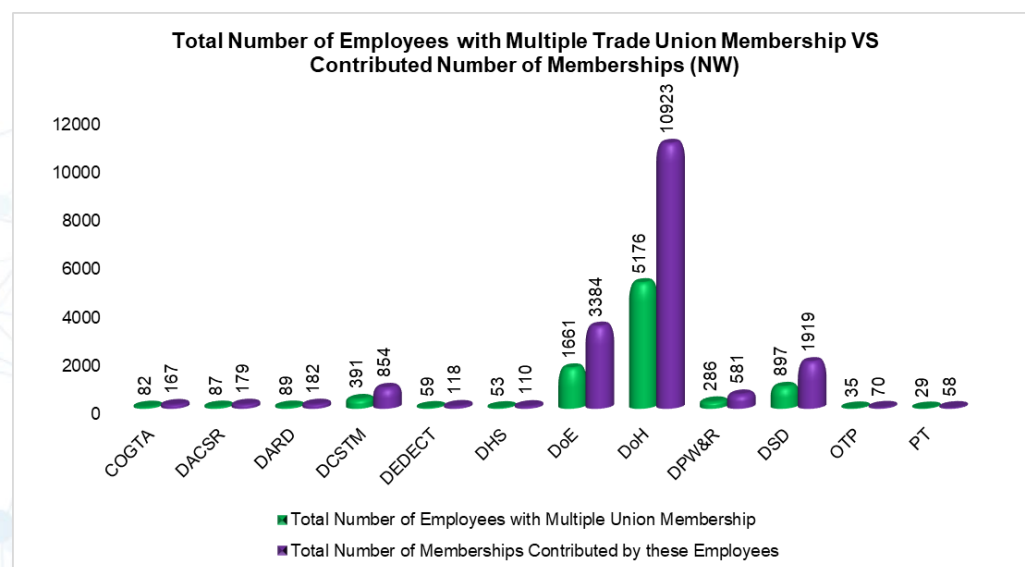


Figure 11: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of Membership.

The data reveals patterns of multiple union membership across twelve provincial departments in North West Province, encompassing a total of 8,845 employees holding 18,545 memberships collectively.

The distribution of multiple membership varies considerably across departments, with three distinct tiers emerging from the figures. The Department of Health dominates significantly, accounting for 5,176 employees with dual or multiple memberships, representing nearly 59% of all such employees. The Department of Education follows as the second-largest contributor with 1,661 employees, while the Department of Social Development records 897 employees maintaining multiple affiliations. These three departments alone account for approximately 87% of all employees with multiple union memberships across the province.

The Department of Community Safety and Transport Management shows 391 employees with 854 total memberships, and the Department of Public Works and Roads records 286 employees contributing 581 memberships. The Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, Department of Arts, Culture, Sport and Recreation, and the Department of Cooperative Governance, Traditional Affairs demonstrate comparable levels, each ranging between 82 and 89 employees with multiple affiliations.

The remaining departments, Economic Development, Environment, Conservation and Tourism; Human Settlements; Office of the Premier; and Provincial Treasury—collectively represent a smaller proportion, with membership numbers ranging from 29 to 59 employees each.

Western Cape

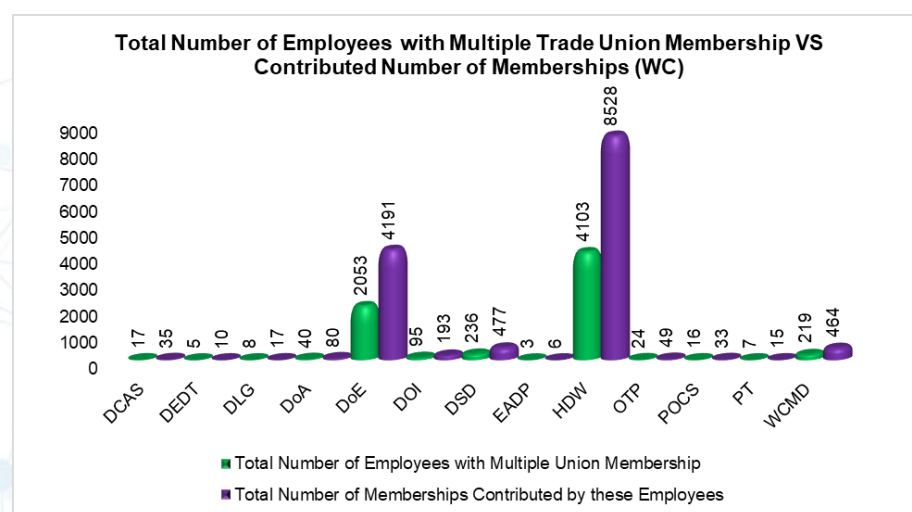
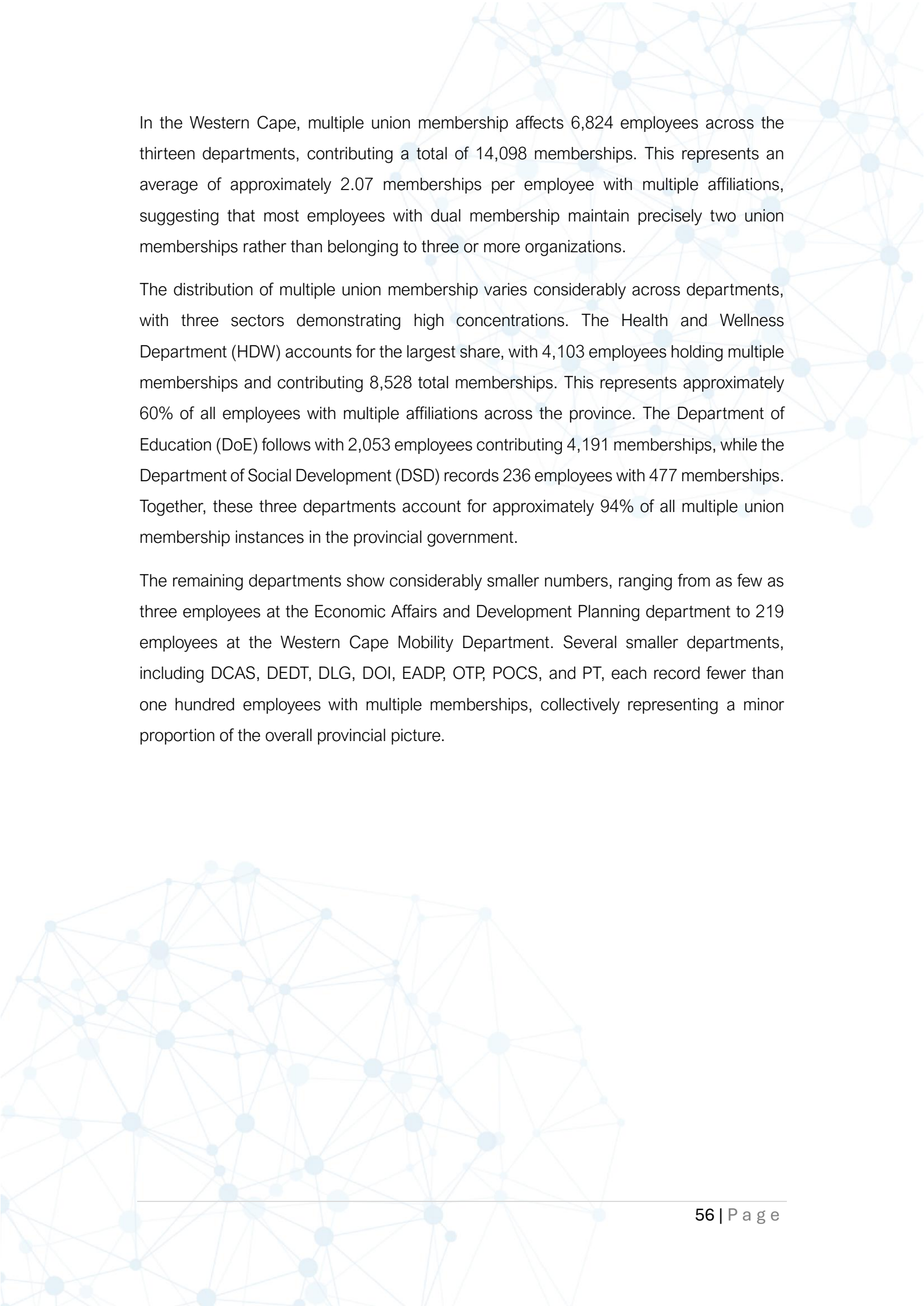


Figure 12: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.



In the Western Cape, multiple union membership affects 6,824 employees across the thirteen departments, contributing a total of 14,098 memberships. This represents an average of approximately 2.07 memberships per employee with multiple affiliations, suggesting that most employees with dual membership maintain precisely two union memberships rather than belonging to three or more organizations.

The distribution of multiple union membership varies considerably across departments, with three sectors demonstrating high concentrations. The Health and Wellness Department (HDW) accounts for the largest share, with 4,103 employees holding multiple memberships and contributing 8,528 total memberships. This represents approximately 60% of all employees with multiple affiliations across the province. The Department of Education (DoE) follows with 2,053 employees contributing 4,191 memberships, while the Department of Social Development (DSD) records 236 employees with 477 memberships. Together, these three departments account for approximately 94% of all multiple union membership instances in the provincial government.

The remaining departments show considerably smaller numbers, ranging from as few as three employees at the Economic Affairs and Development Planning department to 219 employees at the Western Cape Mobility Department. Several smaller departments, including DCAS, DEDT, DLG, DOI, EADP, OTP, POCS, and PT, each record fewer than one hundred employees with multiple memberships, collectively representing a minor proportion of the overall provincial picture.

National Departments

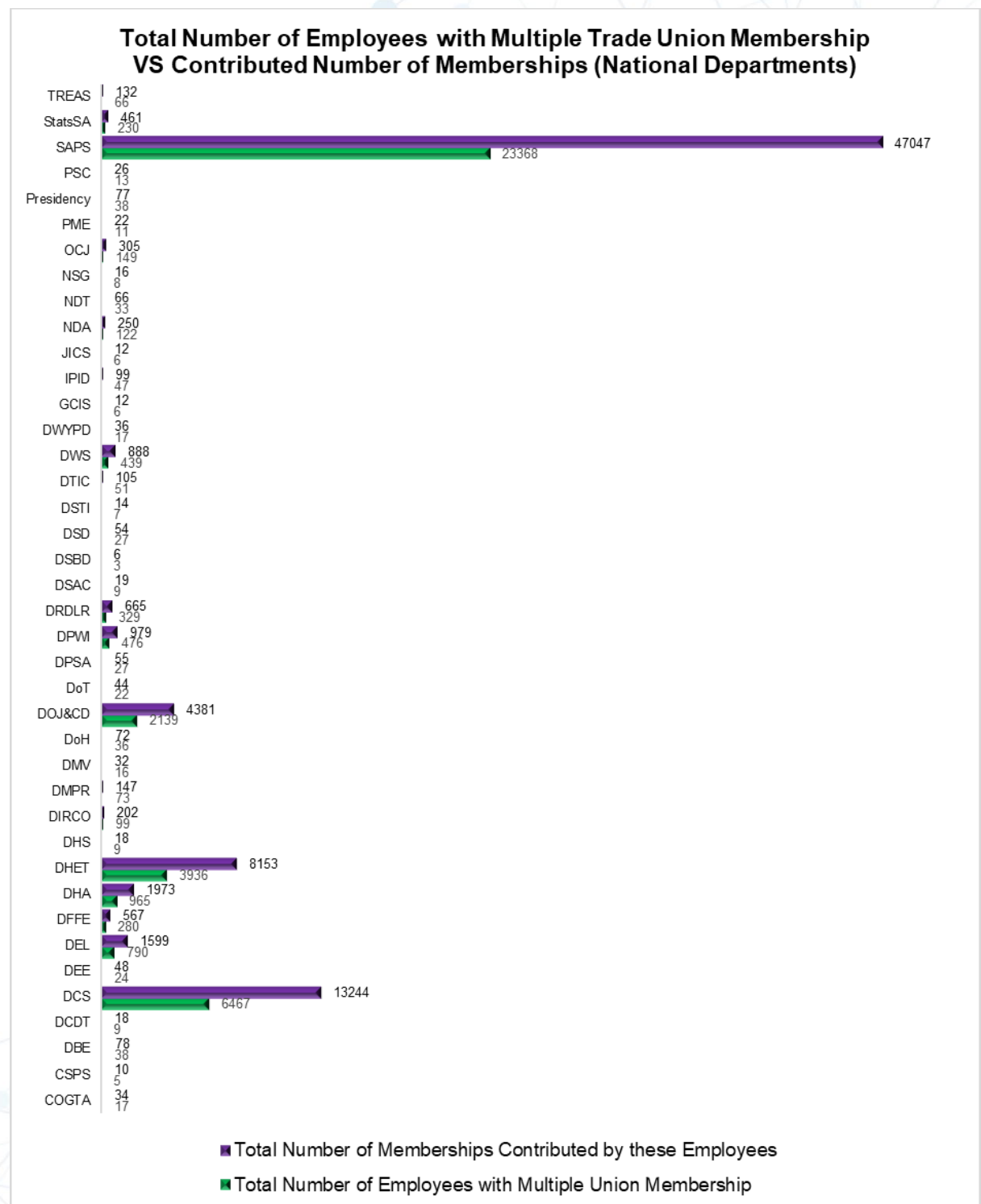


Figure 13: Number of public servants with dual membership vs contributed number of membership.

The data on multiple union membership across South African national departments as of December 31, 2025, reveals distinct patterns in how public servants engage with Trade Union representation. Across all departments, a total of 39,443 employees hold membership in more than one union, collectively contributing 79,951 union memberships.

The distribution of multiple union membership across departments is notably uneven, reflecting both the size and nature of different state entities. The South African Police Service dominates the landscape with 23,368 employees holding multiple memberships, representing approximately 59% of all such employees across national departments.

Beyond SAPS, certain departments demonstrate substantial numbers of employees with multiple union affiliations. The Department of Correctional Services records 6,467 employees with dual memberships, while the Department of Higher Education and Training shows 3,936 such employees, and the Department of Justice and Constitutional Development accounts for 2,139.

In contrast, numerous smaller departments exhibit minimal multiple union membership. Several departments, including the Department of Small Business Development, the Department of Communications and Digital Technologies, and the Government Communication and Information System, register fewer than ten employees with multiple memberships.

Conclusion

The data on multiple trade union membership among South African public servants reveals a persistent and expanding phenomenon across all levels of government. Between 2021 and 2025, the total number of employees maintaining multiple union affiliations increased by approximately 18%, rising from 128,439 to 152,073. This upward trajectory, particularly the substantial surge of over 15,000 members in 2024, indicates that dual union membership has become an increasingly normalised practice within the public service.

The provincial analysis demonstrates clear sectoral concentration, with the Departments of Health and Education collectively accounting for the majority of multiple membership cases across all nine provinces. KwaZulu-Natal consistently maintains the highest provincial numbers throughout the period, while Gauteng's 47% increase represents the most dramatic growth trajectory. At the national level, the South African Police Service emerges as the dominant contributor, with nearly 60% of all national employees holding multiple union affiliations.

The membership distribution patterns reveal that dual membership, affiliation with precisely two unions represents the predominant practice, accounting for over 92% of all cases (140,593 out of 152,073 employees). Membership in three or more unions decreases exponentially, suggesting that employees typically supplement their primary



REPORT - GENES (WOMEN EMPOWERMENT PROGRAM)

4. REPORT – GENES (WOMEN EMPOWERMENT PROGRAM)

Background and Introduction

Council in March 2022 held Public Service Summit on Collective Bargaining, emanating from the Summit PSCBC Resolution 1 of 2022 (*Adoption of PSCBC Summit Declaration on Collective Bargaining*) and the implementation plan thereof was agreed to by all parties to Council.

Parties to the Summit committed in Paragraph 5.6 of the Summit Declaration, to develop and implement a program in the 2022/2023 Financial Year. The program aimed at strengthening the role of women negotiators in the public service.

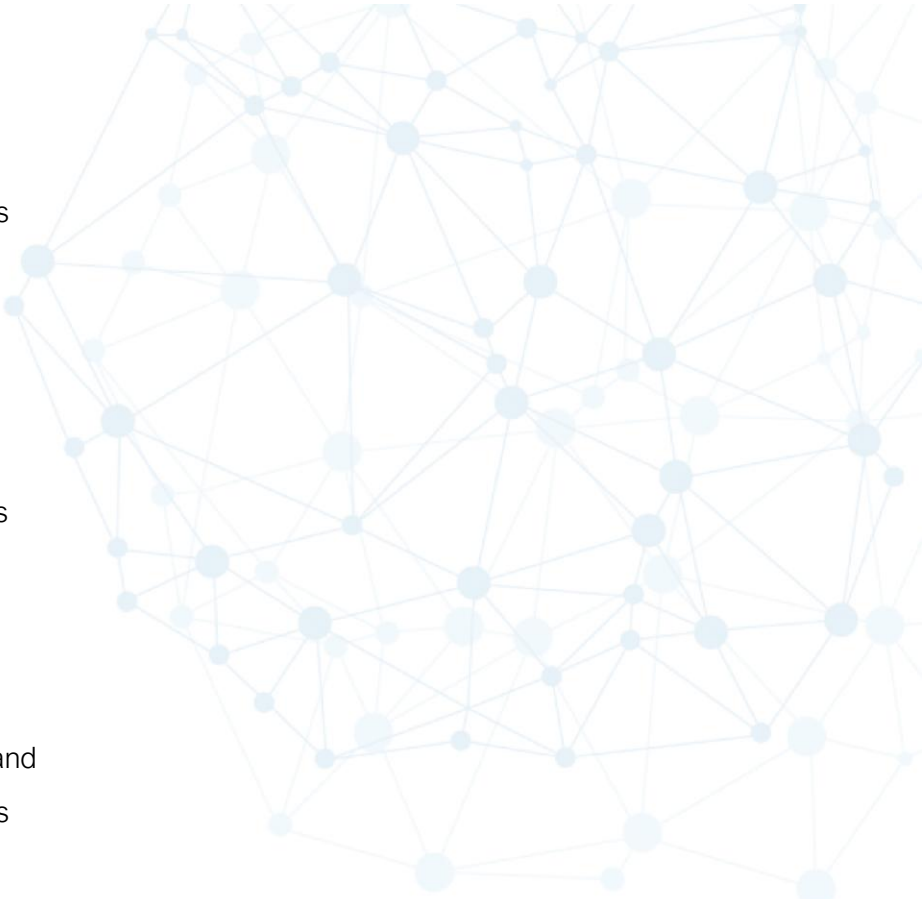
In line with the above commitment, a four months' program focusing on Ethics, Governance, Strategy and Negotiations Skills was compiled and endorsed by the Council for roll-out in the public service. The GENES (*Governance, Ethics, Negotiations and Strategy*) Women Empowerment Program was set up. The objective of the program was to equip participants with critical skills required to unlock and enhance their confidence and efficiency levels within their roles.

Sector Councils were also invited to participate in the program, of which the GPSSBC and PHSDSBC opted to take part. The ELRC and SSSBC did indicate that due to other prior commitments they will not be able to participate. A total of 30 participants were registered, one participant from GPSSBC could not make it due to ill health and another participant from PHSDSBC never showed up.

A total of 28 women took part from both PSCBC and the stated sectors. The composition was as follows:

PSCBC

- Chairperson
- Vice-Chairperson
- 1 Secretariat member

- 
- 6 Employer representatives
 - 6 Labour representatives

GPSSBC

- General Secretary
- 4 employer representatives
- 4 Labour representatives

PHDSBC

- 2 Labour representatives and
- 2 Employer representatives

The program commenced in August 2022 and was structured to be rolled out in a period of four (4) months. The first 3 months of the program were rolled out in Gauteng, South Africa and the last part of the program which took place in the fourth month was conducted in Geneva, Switzerland.

Objective of the program

The objective of the program was to equip participants with critical skills to unlock and enhance their confidence and efficiency levels within their roles. The overall program was anchored on the envisaged outcome of *Owning your Strengths and Skills*. The program was anchored on key pillars of development of (i) Ethics, (ii) Governance, (iii) Strategic Management and (iv) Negotiation skills.

Structure of the program

The roll out of the program was structured in two parts, the first part consisted of the three (3) pillars and offered by HATFIELD City Collage, based in Kempton Park Gauteng. The focus was on Ethics, Governance and Strategy. The aim was to explore the history of women in the workforce and offer personal opportunities for exploration, identification and development of leadership strengths and skills.

This first part of the program was rolled out in a period of three (3) months, and took place in Gauteng in August 2022, November 2022 and February 2023 as follows

FOCUS AREA	DATES	VENUE
Ethics	24 – 26 August 2022	Kievits Kroon Country Estate, Kameeldrift-East, Pretoria
Governance	2 – 4 November 2022	Silverstar Casino, Krugersdorp, Gauteng
Strategy	8 – 10 February 2023	Emperors Palace, Kempton Park, Gauteng

The above sessions were facilitated by different subject matter experts with vast experience and knowledge on related focus areas.

Different guest speakers were also invited for each session to share with the participants their experiences (either work or personal life experience) and knowledge on different topics.

Guest speakers that were invited during the first part of the program in Gauteng:

The Deputy Minister of Public Service and Administration: Dr Pilane Machaka - she emphasised the rationale of why the resolution on empowering women in the Public Service was taken at the Summit in March 2022. She also touched on her experience and role as a women leader in her current and previous employment.

Ms Tshepo Motsepe – Women in Mining. A dynamic businesswoman who is part of the women in mining in South Africa, she touched on her experience in a business environment which is mostly dominated by men, she motivated participants on how to go about such kind of business and how to overcome being oppressed in the mining and business in general.

The CEO of Transnet – Portia Derby is an independent and dynamic leader with vast experience in the public and private sectors. She is also a former director-general of the Department of Public Enterprise which has Transnet as one of the State-Owned entities it oversees. She also gave a word of encouragement and motivation to the participants and how to overcome the obstacles of being harassed as women in the workplace.

The former General Secretary of the PSCBC Ms Shamira Huluman also gave a word of encouragement on how to overcome obstacles in the world of work dominated by men more especially in the labour relations fraternity.

ILO Geneva, Switzerland

The last leg (fourth month) of the program took place in Geneva, Switzerland from 24 - 26 April 2023. Participants embarked on a Study Visit to the International Labour Organisation (ILO) in Geneva, as a means to provide the participants with practical exposure to collective bargaining on an international platform.

Amongst others the following topics were covered by the ILO:

- Violence and harassment (Convention 190)
- Collective Bargaining in the public service (convention No 151),
- ILO Standards (convention 100 & 111)
- Collective Bargaining for Essential Services

ILO programmes addressing the empowerment of women workers mainly concentrate on awareness raising and capacity-building of organizations to address women workers' needs and focusing on the training of women activists to take leadership roles.

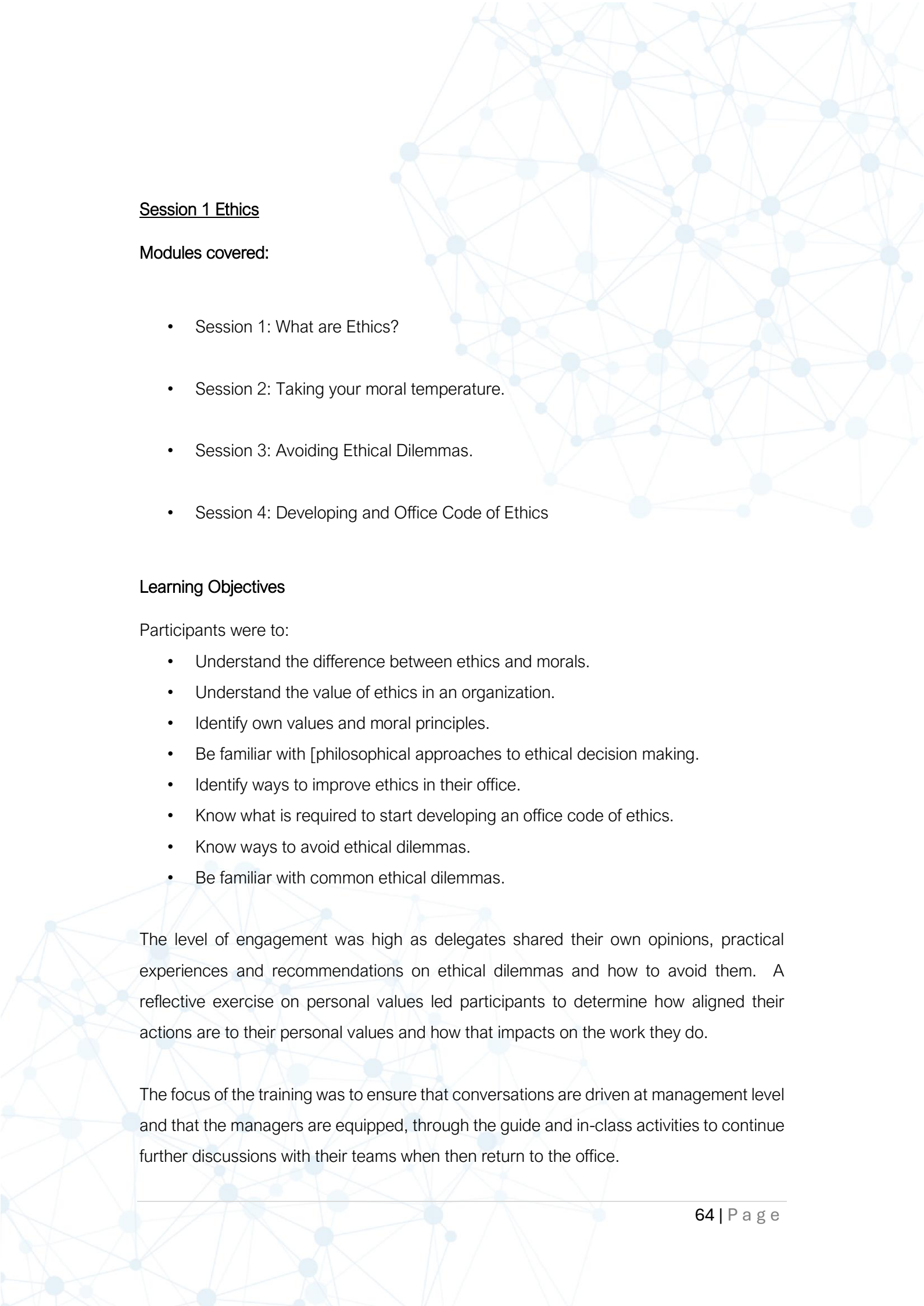
Training by Hatfield College

Hatfield College rolled out the training over three (3) sessions, in August, November 2022 and February 2023.

Different learning methods were used aiming at reinforcing learning and content absorption rate. Over and above the critical lecture sessions, participants were tasked with group work and practical simulations. Learners also had the opportunity to get one on one support from the facilitators.

Day one and two were dedicated to content and guest speakers.

The practical / simulation sessions were designed to give learners an opportunity to try out the elements covered in the theory section.



Session 1 Ethics

Modules covered:

- Session 1: What are Ethics?
- Session 2: Taking your moral temperature.
- Session 3: Avoiding Ethical Dilemmas.
- Session 4: Developing and Office Code of Ethics

Learning Objectives

Participants were to:

- Understand the difference between ethics and morals.
- Understand the value of ethics in an organization.
- Identify own values and moral principles.
- Be familiar with [philosophical approaches to ethical decision making.
- Identify ways to improve ethics in their office.
- Know what is required to start developing an office code of ethics.
- Know ways to avoid ethical dilemmas.
- Be familiar with common ethical dilemmas.

The level of engagement was high as delegates shared their own opinions, practical experiences and recommendations on ethical dilemmas and how to avoid them. A reflective exercise on personal values led participants to determine how aligned their actions are to their personal values and how that impacts on the work they do.

The focus of the training was to ensure that conversations are driven at management level and that the managers are equipped, through the guide and in-class activities to continue further discussions with their teams when then return to the office.

Participants learned about barriers: how to identify them, work with them, and how to turn them into benefits that can strengthen their leadership.

Session 2 - Governance

Learning objectives:

Participants were to:

- Reflect on what the of leaders they are. Are they self-actualized individuals who are aware of their strengths, their limitations, and their emotions.
- Self-reflect deeply (how do I lead myself) and by extension, how does this translate to how I lead others.

Training Methodology

Participants were encouraged to self-reflect and finding themselves.

- The day started with building the case for why Authentic Leadership matters. Delegates were introduced to VUCA – an acronym used to describe the nature of volatility, uncertainty, complexity, and ambiguity that characterizes much of the world we live in.
- Unpacked the concept of Authentic Leadership and used George Bill's Model of Authentic Leadership which focuses on the different qualities an authentic leader has or can develop.

Participants served the history of social and emotional theory and were introduced to the five Social and Emotional Competencies. They reflected on examples of good social and emotional intelligence examples from their own experiences.

The post-activity reflection was quite powerful as individuals reflected on their leadership style assessments from others to reflect on their strengths and abilities.

Session 3 - Strategy

Learning Objectives:

Participants were to:

- Identify the values that support both an individual and the organization;
- Define the vision and write a mission statement that explains the purpose for the organization;
- Complete meaningful SWOT analyses;
- Apply tools and techniques to create, implement, evaluate, and review a strategic plan that directs the organization;
- Identify how related tools, such as the strategy map and balanced scorecard, can help you develop a strategic plan.
- Connect at a deeply emotional level and cause them to reflect on their personal stories and the impact these stories/ narratives play in the Leaders they are today.

Training Method

A combination of training methodologies was used to achieve the learning objectives. The participants were provided with a workbook to reference during the session. The practical activities helped to reinforce the learnings through simulations.

This is where participants learned ways in which women can deliver unique forms of leadership, and how best to maximize the benefits. They learned several tips they can use to make better decisions and some of the common decision traps. They were also introduced to the Decision Wheel as a tool in good decision-making.

The session encouraged delegates to develop a Philosophy Statement and gather other components necessary to draft an Individual Action Plan.

Conclusion

The following issues came very strongly as challenges during the sessions:

- Gender Discrimination in respective departments/trade unions and Bargaining Council
- Sexual Discrimination and predatory behaviour from the men in the Council who occupy roles of power and influence
- Silencing of women's voices
- Challenges around the role played by the Chief Negotiator

Recommendations by facilitators:

- Identification and classification of the critical issues that need to be addressed.
- To flesh out a concrete plan of action to address these issues.
- To engage the male counterparts and bring them into the conversation to enable buy-in and commitment from all members of the Council.

The first part of program was very much interactive and practical with all participants been given various exercise and roles to play during training sessions.

Session 4 – Negotiations Skills

The last focus area on Negotiation Skills (*Capacity Building with the ILO*) took place from 24-26 April 2023 as a study visit to ILO, Geneva, Switzerland. This constituted the expeditionary learning aspect of the program and provided participants with practical exposure to collective bargaining on an international platform.

The delegates arrived in Geneva on 21 April 2022 and were accommodate at InterContinental hotel which is a walking distance to the ILO. On 22 April a city tour was arranged for all delegates to explore Geneva.

The delegation was led by the Chairperson of Council, Ms Ingrid Dimo, Vice-Chairperson Labour in the PSCBC, Ms Kgopana Matome, The Vice Chairperson Labour at the GPSSBC, Mr Casper Nanto, the General Secretary of the PSCBC Mr Frikkie De Bruin and the General Secretary of the GPSSBC Ms Sharlaine Oodit.

The Ambassador for South Africa in Switzerland, Ambassador Mxolisi Nkosi graced the study visit, he met with the delegate at the ILO campus. He applauded the PSCBC for coming up with such a progressive program of empowering women, he mentioned the importance of women empowerment particularly in the Public Services. He motivated the participants and wished them well during their stay in Geneva.

The following ILO convention were part of the engagements 87,98, 135,151, 154, 190, 111, as well as the right to strike, essential and minimum services and Recommendation 92.

SUMMARY OF THE CONVENTIONS THAT WERE PRESENTED DURING THE ENGAGEMENT WITH THE ILO

Convention 190

Convention 190 was the overarching convention during the study tour as it formed the base of the Resolution taken during the summit *Recognising the role of women, youth and people with disabilities in the workplace, providing the necessary support to allow for equal opportunities and eradicating of practices of discrimination, harassment and victimisation. Furthermore to recognise the role of women in being the primary care giver of their families through the implementation of a basic childcare policy.*

The summit resolved to undertake a collaborative process of ensuring compliance to Convention 190¹, which was ratified by South Africa on 29 November 2021. The convention recognize the following in the world of work:

- right of everyone to a world of work free from violence and harassment, including gender-based violence and harassment.
- violence and harassment in the world of work can constitute a human rights violation or abuse, and that violence and harassment is a threat to equal opportunities, is unacceptable and incompatible with decent work,
- the importance of a work culture based on mutual respect and dignity of the human being to prevent violence and harassment, and
- domestic violence has an impact in the world of work and the following is recommended on recommendation 206:

- Leave for victims
- Flexible work arrangements
- Temporary protection against dismissal
- Including domestic violence in workplace risk assessments
- Awareness-raising.

Convention No. 190 together with Recommendation 206 recognizes the right of everyone to a world of work free from violence and harassment and provides a common framework

¹ https://www.ilo.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/---dgreports/---dcomm/---publ/documents/publication/wcms_721160.pdf

for action. It provides the first internationally accepted definition of violence and harassment in the world of work, including gender-based violence and harassment.

The term “violence and harassment” in the world of work refers to a range of unacceptable behaviours and practices, or threats thereof, whether a single occurrence or repeated, that aim at, result in, or are likely to result in physical, psychological, sexual or economic harm, and includes gender-based violence and harassment.

The term “gender-based violence and harassment” means violence and harassment directed at persons because of their sex or gender, or affecting persons of a particular sex or gender disproportionately and includes sexual harassment.

This Convention protects workers and other persons in the world of work, including employees as defined by national law and practice, as well as persons working irrespective of their contractual status, persons in training, including interns and apprentices, workers whose employment has been terminated, volunteers, jobseekers and job applicants, and individuals exercising the authority, duties, or responsibilities of an employer. It applies to all sectors, whether private or public, both in the formal and informal economy, and whether in urban or rural areas.

Countries like South Africa that ratified the convention acknowledged that gender-based violence and harassment disproportionately affects women and girls, and recognizing that an inclusive, integrated and gender-responsive approach, which tackles underlying causes and risk factors, including gender stereotypes, multiple and intersecting forms of discrimination, and unequal gender-based power relations, is essential to ending violence and harassment in the world of work.

It has also been noted that domestic violence can affect employment, productivity and health and safety, governments, employers’ and workers’ organizations and labour market institutions can help, as part of other measures, to recognize, respond to and address the impacts of domestic violence.

The objective of convention 190 is to protect workers and other persons in the world of work, including employees as defined by national law and practice, as well as persons

working irrespective of their contractual status, persons in training, including interns and apprentices, workers whose employment has been terminated, volunteers, jobseekers and job applicants, and individuals exercising the authority, duties, or responsibilities of an employer.

Convention 100 and 111

The convention 100 and 111 are on fundamental instruments and equality.

Convention 100² is about equal pay (equal remuneration) for equal work.

Objectives of this convention:

- Equal remuneration (ER) for men and women for work of equal value.
- Rates of remuneration without discrimination based on sex.
- To ensure ER in the public sector.
- To promote ER the private sector.

It was learned that the early 1950s, emphasis shifted to the promotion of equality in employment between men and women, and, more recently, to recognition that equality implies sharing of family responsibilities between men and women.

Convention No.100 and Recommendation No.90, of 1951, laid down the guiding principles of equal remuneration for work of equal value regardless of sex. In 1958, Convention No. 111 and Recommendation No. 111 were adopted to establish the principle of non-discrimination on a number of grounds including sex, with regard to access to vocational training, access to employment, and terms and conditions of employment.

Convention 111³ touches on issues of discrimination in the workplace direct (less favourable treatment based on one or more prohibited grounds) and indirect (neutral law

²

https://www.ilo.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/@dgreports/@gender/documents/genericdocument/wcms_14185.pdf

³

or practice, disproportionate negative impact on a particular group). South Africa adopted this convention in 2022 and it was published in 2023.

The objectives of the convention are:

- To eliminating discrimination in employment and occupation and achieving equal opportunities for all.
- To be realized progressively but steps have to be taken immediately and on a continuing basis.
- Certain immediate obligations

The South African Government is encouraged to continue to strengthen its efforts in promoting equality of treatment and opportunities in employment and occupation of all the designated groups and to provide information on: (i) the results achieved in the transformation of the labour market towards a more equitable representation of the designated groups (including statistical data as shown in the annual report of the Commission for Employment Equity); and (ii) the assessment of its affirmative action measures with a view to determining whether they remain effective and are in line with the principle of non-discrimination.

The Government also needs to provide information on: (i) the actions taken within the framework of the National Action Plan to Combat Racism, Racial Discrimination, Xenophobia and Related Intolerance, the obstacles identified and the results achieved; and (ii) the implementation of section 53 of the Employment Equity Act as amended (measures put in place to evaluate the assessment criteria for the issuing of employment equity compliance certificates and number of certificates denied based on this assessment).

**Fundamental Conventions on freedom of association and collective bargaining:
Conventions 87, 98, 135, 151 and 154**

https://www.ilo.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/@dgreports/@gender/documents/genericdocument/wcms_14189.pdf

The conventions 98, 135, 151, 154 covers collective bargaining and 87 covers collective bargaining within Essential Services.

According to ILO Collective bargaining is a fundamental right. It is rooted in the ILO Constitution and reaffirmed as such in the 1998 ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work. Collective bargaining is a key means through which employers and their organizations and trade unions can establish fair wages and working conditions. It also provides the basis for sound labour relations. Typical issues on the bargaining agenda include wages, working time, training, occupational health and safety and equal treatment. The objective of these negotiations is to arrive at a collective agreement that regulates terms and conditions of employment. Collective agreements may also address the rights and responsibilities of the parties thus ensuring harmonious and productive industries and workplaces. Enhancing the inclusiveness of collective bargaining and collective agreements is a key means for reducing inequality and extending labour protection.

Convention 87: Collective Bargaining vs Essential Services

The concept of essential services is based on Article 3 of Convention No. 87⁴, which establishes the right of workers' organizations to organize their administration and activities and to formulate their programmes without interference by the public authorities. With the recognition of the Committee on Freedom of Association, some member States do, however, limit rights flowing from Article 3 to groups of workers that are considered essential services.

Article 7 of the convention states that "the acquisition of legal personality by workers' and employers' organisations, federations and confederations shall not be made subject to conditions of such a character as to restrict the application of the provisions of Articles 2, 3 and 4 hereof.

In terms of Article 8, in exercising the rights provided for in this Convention workers and employers and their respective organisations, like other persons or organised collectivities, shall respect the law of the land. The law of the land shall not be such as to

⁴ <https://www.ilo.org/legacy/english/inwork/cb-policy-guide/freedomofassocandrighttoorganise87.pdf>

impair, nor shall it be so applied as to impair, the guarantees provided for in this Convention.

In South Africa Section 213 of the Labour Relations Act (LRA), defines essential service as a service the interruption of which endangers the life, personal safety or health of the whole or any part of the population and includes the Parliamentary service and the South African Police Services. Section 70(1) of the LRA establishes an Essential Services Committee decide on dispute regarding whether or not a service is an essential service and whether or not an employee or employer is engaged in a service designated as an essential service. The Essential Services Committee, established by section 70 of the LRA, may only determine a service as essential where, in terms of Section 213, it can be shown that an interruption of that service would present a clear and imminent threat that would “endanger the life, personal safety or health of the whole or any part of the population”

The right to strike

For essential services employees the right to strike may only be restricted or prohibited in the public service for public servants exercising authority in the name of the State or in essential services in the strict sense of the term.

ILO defines essential services as those services which, if interrupted, would endanger the life, personal safety or health of the whole or part of the population. The determination of which services are essential in the strict sense of the term depends to a large extent on the particular circumstances prevailing in a country. Concept is not absolute; a non-essential service may become essential if a strike lasts beyond a certain time or extends beyond a certain scope.

The following services are regarded as essential by the ILO: Hospital sector, electricity services, water supply services, telephone services, police and armed forces, air traffic control fire-fighting services, Public/private prison services, nutrition to pupils cleaning services of schools.

Minimum services

In situations, in which a substantial restriction or total prohibition of strike action would not appear to be justified, a minimum service could be agreed upon between the parties or establishment by an independent body “where, without calling into question the right to strike of the large majority of workers, one might consider ensuring that the public’s basic needs are met or that facilities operate safely and without interruption.”

Participants were of the view that it would be important for the PSCBC to drive the issue of signing of an agreement on Minimum Service Level in the Public Service, as that will assist in service delivery not being compromised during a strike, more especially for those services that are regarded as essential in the country.

Convention 98: Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining

Convention 98⁵ allows governments to determine the extent to which the guarantees provided shall apply to the armed forces and the police, excludes from its application the position of public servants engaged in the administration of the State. This shall not “be construed as prejudicing their rights or status in any way.”

Article 4 of the convention states that measures appropriate to national conditions shall be taken, where necessary, to encourage and promote the full development and utilisation of machinery for voluntary negotiation between employers or employers' organisations and workers' organisations, with a view to the regulation of terms and conditions of employment by means of collective agreements.

Article 5 (1) states that the extent to which the guarantees provided for in this convention shall apply to the armed forces and the police shall be determined by national laws or regulations. (2). the ratification of this Convention shall not be deemed to affect any existing law, award, custom or agreement in virtue of which members of the armed forces or the police enjoy any right guaranteed by this Convention.

In terms of Article 6 this Convention does not deal with the position of public servants engaged in the administration of the State, nor shall it be construed as prejudicing their rights or status in any way.

⁵ https://www.ilo.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/---asia/---ro-bangkok/---ilo-hanoi/documents/publication/wcms_721934.pdf

Convention 135: Right to Organise

Convention 135 gives workers the right for representation. It states that workers' representatives in the undertaking shall enjoy effective protection against any act prejudicial to them, including dismissal, based on their status or activities as a workers' representative or on union membership or participation in union activities, in so far as they act in conformity with existing laws or collective agreements or other jointly agreed arrangements.

Workers' representatives means persons who are recognised as such under national law or practice, whether they are: (a) trade union representatives, namely, representatives designated or elected by trade unions or by members of such unions; or (b) elected representatives, namely, representatives who are freely elected by the workers of the undertaking in accordance with provisions of national laws or regulations or of collective agreements and whose functions do not include activities which are recognised as the exclusive prerogative of trade unions in the country concerned.

National laws or regulations, collective agreements, arbitration awards or court decisions may determine the type or types of workers' representatives which shall be entitled to the protection and facilities provided for in this Convention.

Convention, No. 151: Right to Organize and Collective Bargaining

Convention 151⁶ is about labour relations in the Public Service. It applies to all persons employed in the public service. Article 1(2): states that it is possible to exclude "high-level employees whose functions are normally considered as policy-making or managerial" or "employees whose duties are of a highly confidential nature". The ILO supervisory bodies have restricted which officials may be excluded and there is no distinction between permanent and temporary or contract staff.

It is allowed to bar public servants in senior positions to hold trade union office. Article 1(3): "the Government may determine, through national laws or regulations, the extent to which C151 applies to the armed forces and the police, like in C98."

⁶ <https://www.ilo.org/legacy/english/inwork/cb-policy-guide/labourrelationspublicserviceconventionno151.pdf>

Being white-collar employees does not automatically mean they are engaged in the administration of the State.

The convention provides protection in terms of the rights to organise. The Article 4(1) provides adequate protection against acts of anti-union discrimination in respect of public employees' employment and adequate protection against any acts of interference by a public authority in their establishment, functioning or administration in Article 5 (2).

Article 8 of Convention No. 151: Settling Interest Disputes

The settlement of disputes arising *in connection with the determination of terms and conditions of employment* shall be sought through negotiation between the parties or independent and impartial machinery, such as mediation, conciliation and arbitration. This is a voluntary process.

A comparative study of different countries was presented.

Convention 154: Collective Bargaining

Convention 154⁷ applies to all branches of economic activity. The extent to which the guarantees provided for in this convention apply to the armed forces and the police may be determined by national laws or regulations or national practice. With regards the public service, special modalities of application of this Convention may be fixed by national laws or regulations or national practice.

Collective Bargaining in the Public Service

The Global Dialogue Forum on Challenges to Collective Bargaining in the Public Service, in 2014 concluded that collective bargaining should aim to deal not only with technical conditions of work, but also to strive to create conditions that allow public service workers to carry out their duties with motivation and efficiency by creating transparent conditions in which the Public Service develops an ethical culture that prevents corruption.

In the public service, a broader scope of bargaining encourages a deeper level of collaboration while limits to this scope increase the possibilities for conflict. Consultations

⁷ <https://www.ilo.org/legacy/english/inwork/cb-policy-guide/collectivebargainingconvention1981No154.pdf>

increased the speed of implementation of ant crisis measures. Local governments continued social dialogue even where national governments did not.

Participants were taken through the difference between positional and mutual-gains bargaining.

Settling of dispute in terms of this convention, Article 5 (e) states that bodies and procedures for the settlement of labour disputes should be so conceived as to contribute to the promotion of collective bargaining.

In terms of Article 6 the provisions do not preclude collective bargaining within the framework of conciliation and/or arbitration machinery or institutions, if the parties to the collective bargaining process voluntarily participate.



Conclusion

The engagement provided participants with exposure to ILO legal framework on gender equality, which is embedded in most of the ILO's conventions, in particular Convention 190 and key resolutions around collective bargaining. It was learned that Convention 190 should be added on the agenda for negotiations as it places responsibility on the employer to ensure a safe workplace for all and that the wage and non-wage demands should be balanced during negotiations.

During the engagements there was full participation by participants by either asking questions, comments, and debates. The program prepared by the ILO was comprehensive and highly informative. The PSCBC encourages participants to apply the lessons learnt and practice them within their different environments. It is anticipated that from the lessons learned, the participants will engage more meaningfully and improve in areas such as negotiations skills, unequitable practices, gender-based bias, violence and harassment within the workplace.

Through inclusion of women in leadership roles of social partners and in collective bargaining teams will make the PSCBC to realise its objective of empowering women negotiators. The joint venture proved to be fruitful, we look forward to more collaboration with the ILO in future.

It is anticipated that the outcomes of the program will yield benefits which will go beyond the program's lifespan.

**GEMS MENTAL HEALTH CLAIMS
REPORT & STATISTICS**



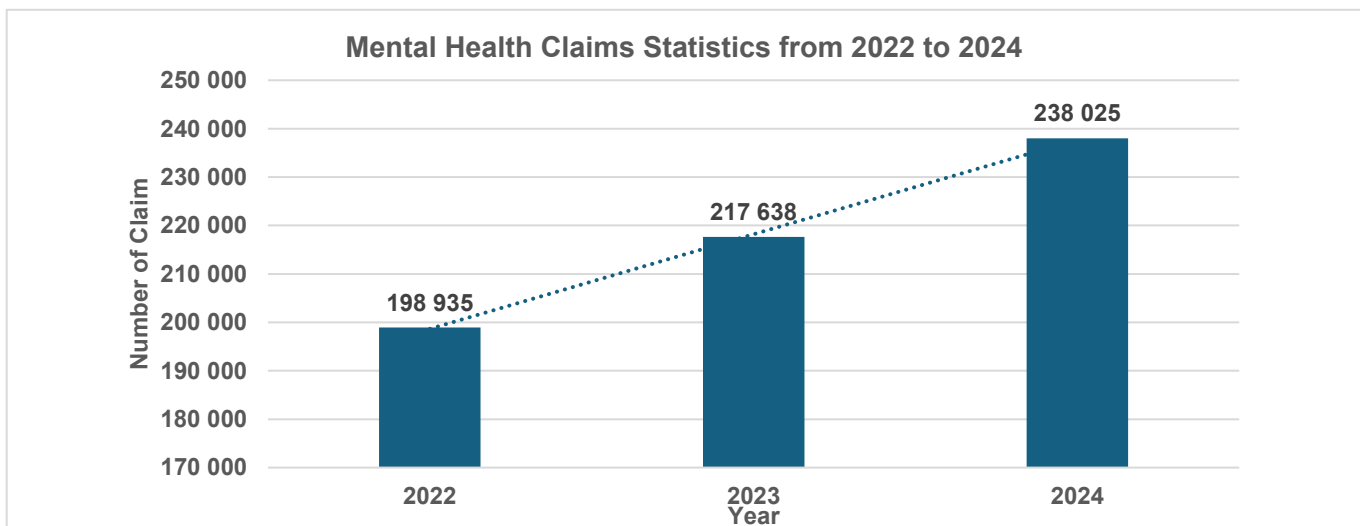
5. GEMS MENTAL HEALTH CLAIMS REPORT

INTRODUCTION

This report presents an analysis of mental health claims recorded by GEMS between 2022 and 2024. The findings reveal a consistent upward trend in both in-hospital and out-of-hospital mental health claims, with increases across gender, salary levels, age bands, scheme options, and major employer groups. Depression and anxiety remain the most prevalent conditions, while hospital-based admissions for severe conditions such as bipolar disorder and psychosis also demonstrate increases. The data further indicates that females and employees within the level 6–12 salary band bear a disproportionate burden of mental health conditions. These trends underline the growing demand for mental health services interventions including workplace wellness programmes.

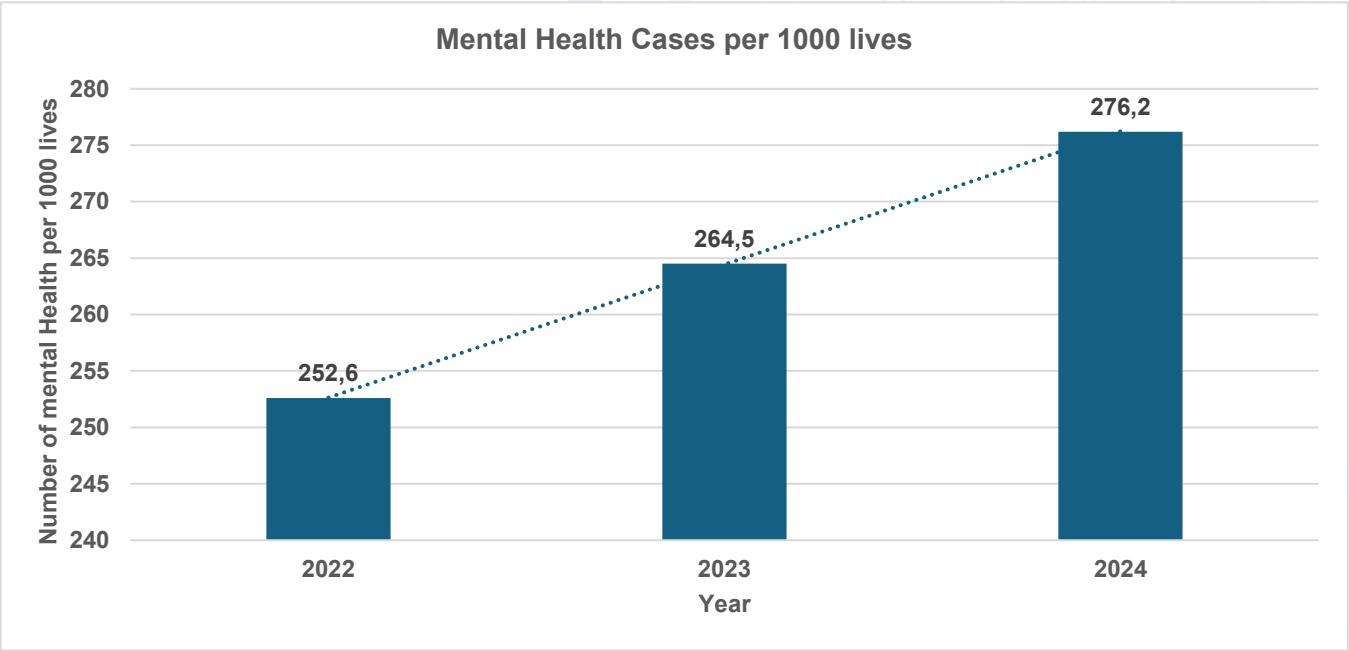
Mental Health Analysis

Graph 1: Mental Health Claims Statistics from 2022 to 2024



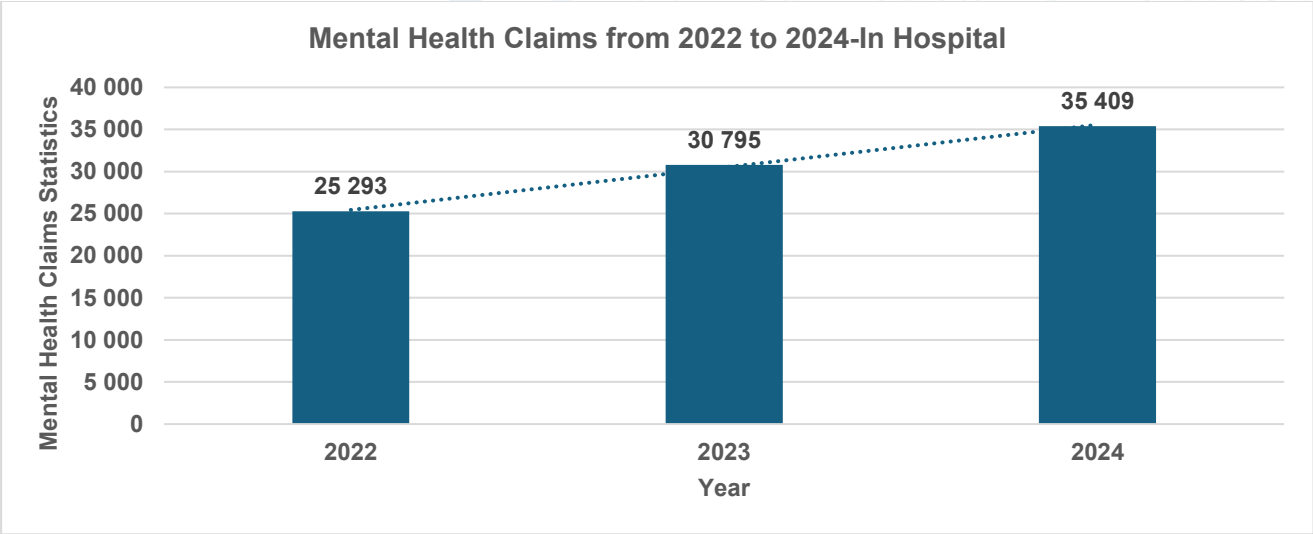
Graph 1 presents annual statistics on mental health claims from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a clear upward trend in the number of mental health claims over the three-year period. In 2022, there were 198 935 claims, which increased to 217 638 in 2023, and further to 238 025 in 2024. This consistent annual growth indicates a steady rise in mental health-related claims. In 2024, Depression and Anxiety were the most common mental health conditions with 124 990 and 70 670 claims respectively, while Schizophrenia and Psychosis had the fewest claims with 1 746 and 667 respectively.

Graph 2: Mental Health Cases per 1000 lives



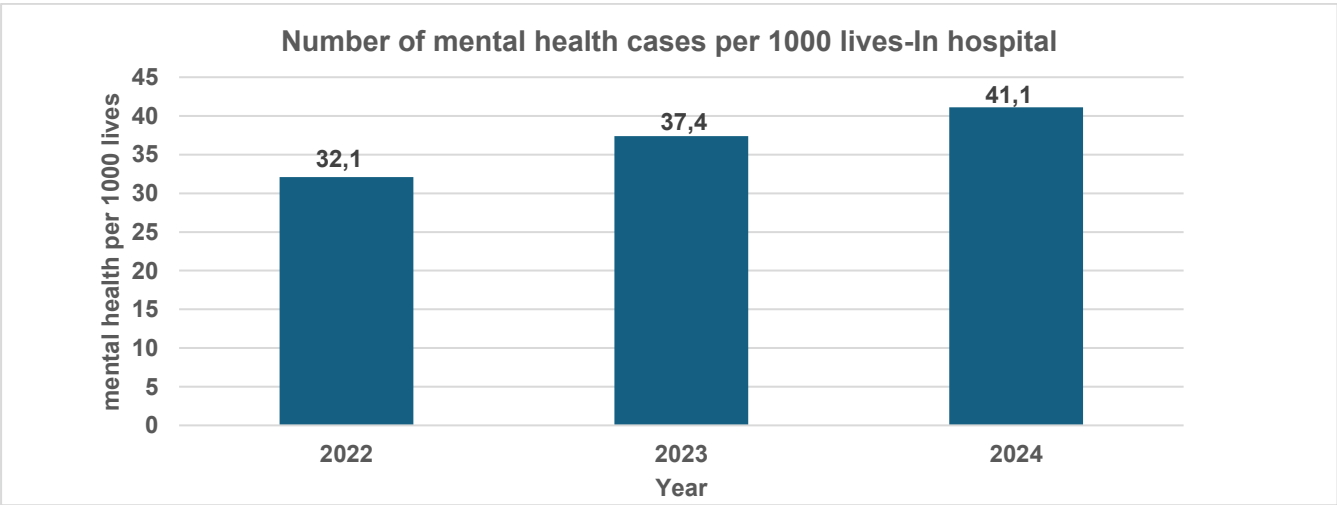
Graph 2 presents annual Mental Health Cases per 1000 lives, and the graph illustrates a steady increase in the number of mental health cases reported per 1000 individuals from 2022 to 2024. In 2022, the rate was 252.6 cases per 1000 lives, rising to 264.5 in 2023, and further to 276.2 in 2024. This consistent upward trend indicates a growing prevalence of mental health issues in the population over the three-year period and a possible rise in mental health challenges. In 2024, Depression and Anxiety were the most common mental health conditions with 145 and 82 claims respectively, while Schizophrenia and Psychosis had the fewest claims with 2 and 0.8 respectively.

Graph 3: Mental Health Claims Statistics- In Hospital



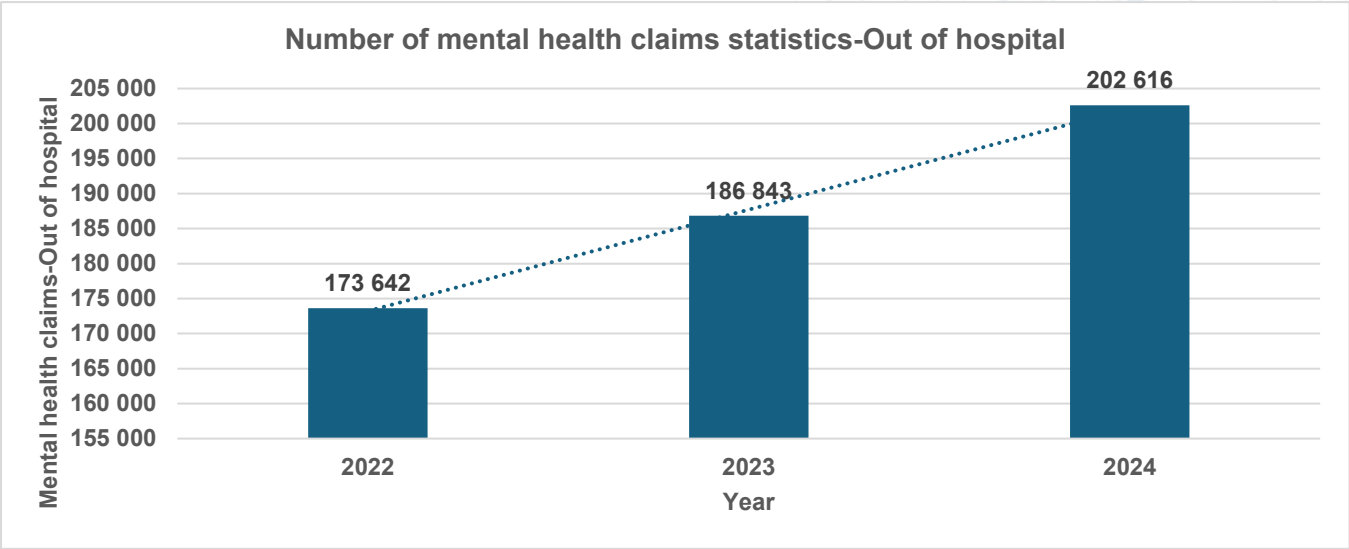
Graph 3 is about the mental health claims from 2022 to 2024, and it shows an upward trend in the number of in-hospital mental health claims over the three-year period. In 2022, there were 25 293 claims, which rose to 30 795 in 2023, and further increased to 35 409 in 2024. This steady increase, emphasised by the dotted trend line, reflects a growing demand for inpatient mental health services. The highest hospital-based claims were for Depression which rose from 16738 in 2022 to 24345 in 2024, and for Bipolar disorder which also increased from 3251 to 3767 claims over the same period. ADHD and Sleep disorder remained rare in hospitals, with ADHD increasing slightly from 43 to 57 claims, and sleep disorder from 114 to 129 between 2022 and 2024.

Graph 4: Mental Health Cases per 1000 lives- In Hospital



Graph 4 illustrates a steady rise in the number of in-hospital mental health claims over the three-year period. In 2022, there were 25293 claims, increasing to 30 795 in 2023, and reaching 35 409 in 2024. For Hospital-based Depression recorded highest claims which increased from 21.3 in 2022 to 28.2 in 2024. The second highest was bipolar disorder claims which rose from 4.1 to 4.4 in the same period. ADHD claims remained at 0.1 for the past three years. Sleep disorder claims rose to 0.2 in 2023 but returned to 0.1 in 2024.

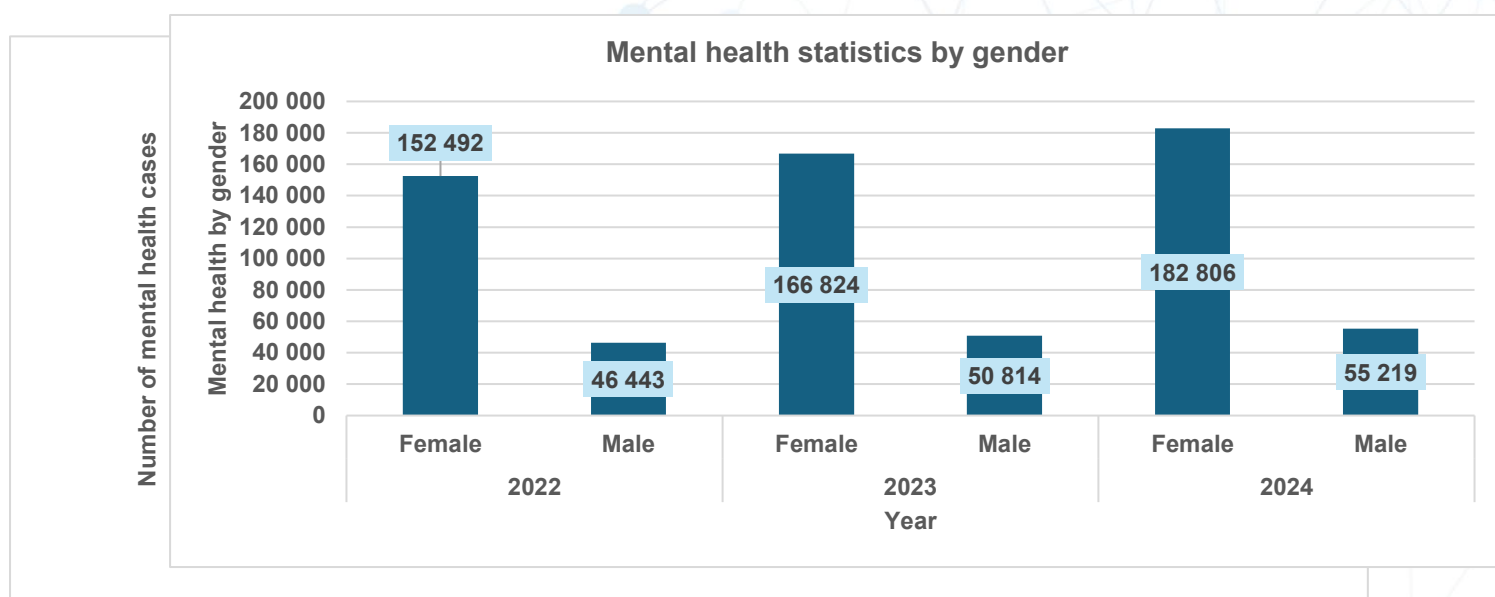
Graph 5: Mental Health Claims Statistics- Out-of-hospital



Graph 5 displays the number of mental health claims made out of hospital for the over the three-year period from 2022 to 2024. The number of claims was 173 642 in 2022, there was an increase to 186 843 claims in 2023 indicating a rise of 13 200 claims compared to 2022. Moreover, in 2024 the claims further increased to 202 616, showing a growth of 15773 claims from 2023. The increase shows a consistent upward trend in the number of mental health claims out of hospital over these three years.

Depression recorded highest with claims which increased from 83,796 in 2022 to 100,645 in 2024. The second highest was Anxiety which also rose from 59,280 to 67,566 for the same period. Substance abuse and Psychosis showed minimal growth, increasing from 452 to 458 and 284 to 386 respectively over the same period.

Graph 6: Mental Health Cases per 1000 lives- Out-of-hospital



Graph 6 illustrates the number of mental health cases per 1000 lives-out of hospital for the years 2022, 2023, and 2024. Moreover, in 2022 there was 220.5 cases per 1000 lives-out of hospital, this increased to 227.1 in 2023, showing a rise of 6.6 cases compared to 2022. The cases further increased to 235.1 in 2024, indicating an increase of 8 cases from 2023. Overall, there is an upward trend in the rate of mental health cases per 1,000 lives-out of hospital over these three years.

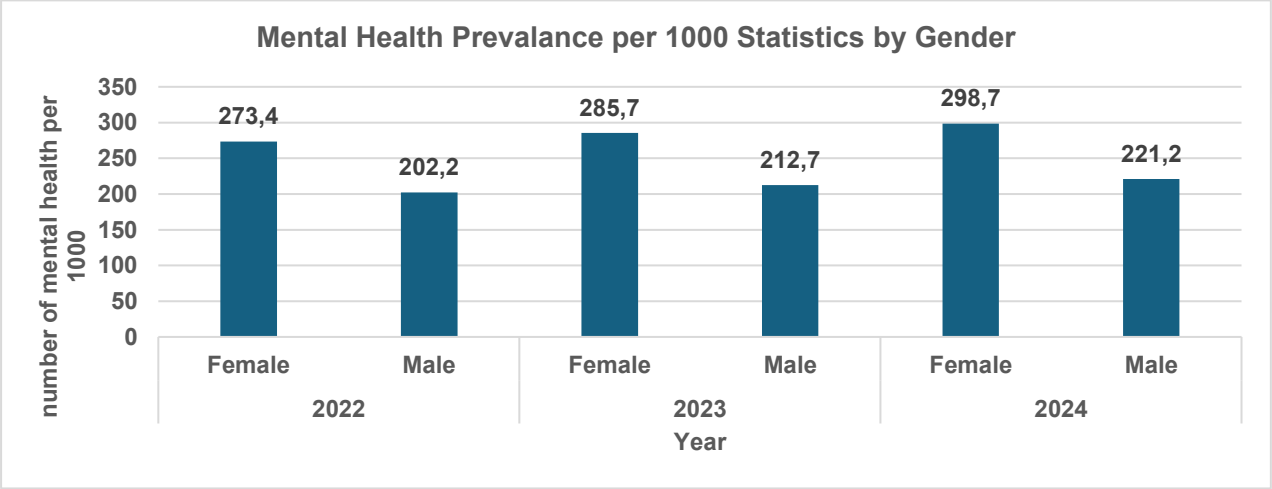
Out of hospital claims Depression and Anxiety ranked the highest while Substance and Psychosis ranked the lowest respectively. Depression claims increased from 106.4 in 2022 to 116.8 in 2024, and Anxiety rose from 75.3 to 78.4. Substance abuse decrease from 0.6 in 2022 to 0.5 in 2024 while Psychosis on 0.4 over the same period.

Graph 7: Mental Health Statistics by Gender

Graph 7 illustrates the number of mental health cases by gender from 2022 to 2024. Females have significantly higher mental health cases compared to males. In 2022 there were 152492 cases for females and 46443 cases males. Moreover, both genders show an increase from 2022, with females still having a higher number of cases. In 2023 female's cases increased to 166 824 while males' cases increased to 50 814.

182 806 and 55 219 cases were reported for females and males for 2024, respectively. Females consistently report more cases than males, and the gap is wide. In 2024, females had significantly more claims for Depression (97,712) and Anxiety (55,047) than males (27,278 and 15,623, respectively. On the other hand, females had higher prevalence in Schizophrenia (1108 vs 638) and Psychosis (438 vs 229).

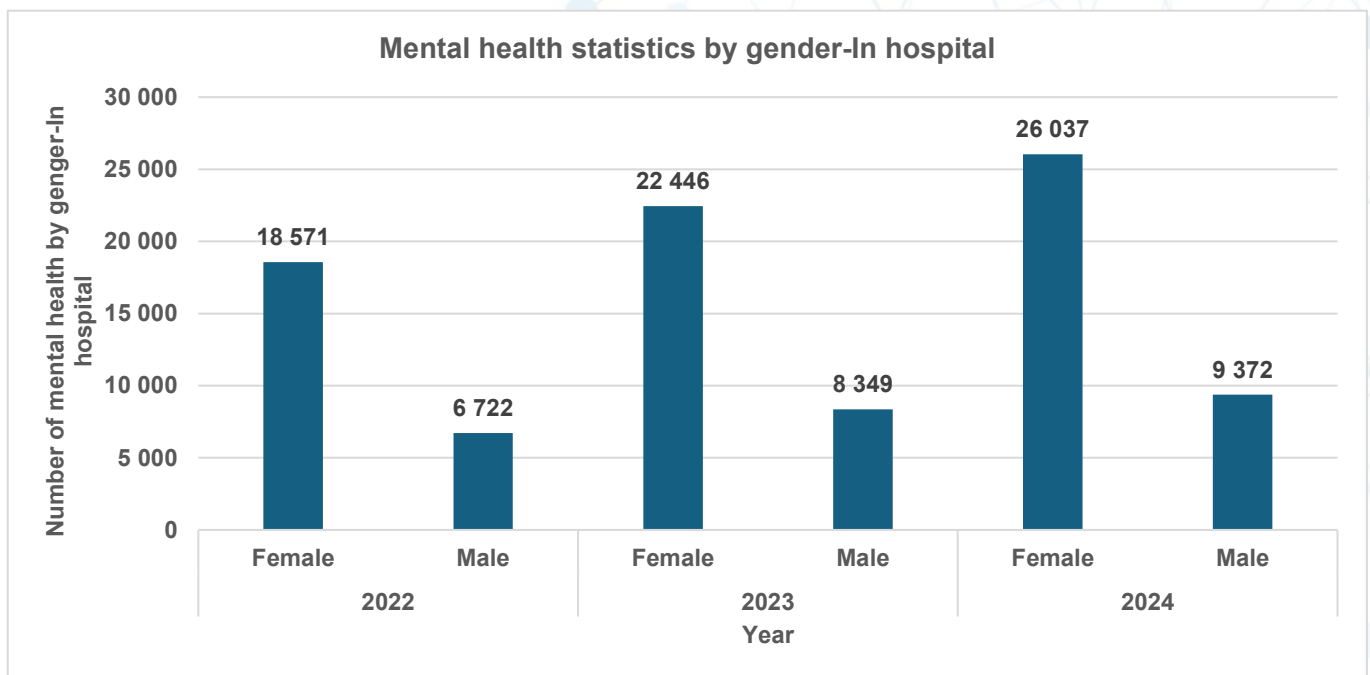
Graph 8: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives Statistics by Gender



Graph 8 shows the prevalence of mental health issues per 1000 statistics, differentiated by gender from 2022 to 2024. Females have a higher prevalence of mental health issues than males. In 2022 females reported 273.4 cases per 1000 lives while males only reported 202.2. In 2023 both genders show an increase compared to 2022, with females still having a higher prevalence. The females increased to 285.7 cases per 1000 lives while for males increased 212.7 cases. In 2024 the cases for females were 298.7 cases per 1000 lives while it was 221.2 cases per 1,000 lives for males. The prevalence continues to rise for both genders.

The data indicates an upward trend in mental health prevalence per 1000 lives for both females and males over these three years, however, females consistently show a higher prevalence than males, and the gap persists, suggesting that mental health issues are more prevalent among females, and the trend of increasing prevalence continues over time. In 2024, Prevalence among females was 159.6 for Depression and 89.9 for Anxiety, compared to 109.2 and 62.6 for males. On the lower end, males had higher prevalence in Schizophrenia (2.6 vs 1.8) and Psychosis (0.9 vs 0.7), despite lower total claim volumes.

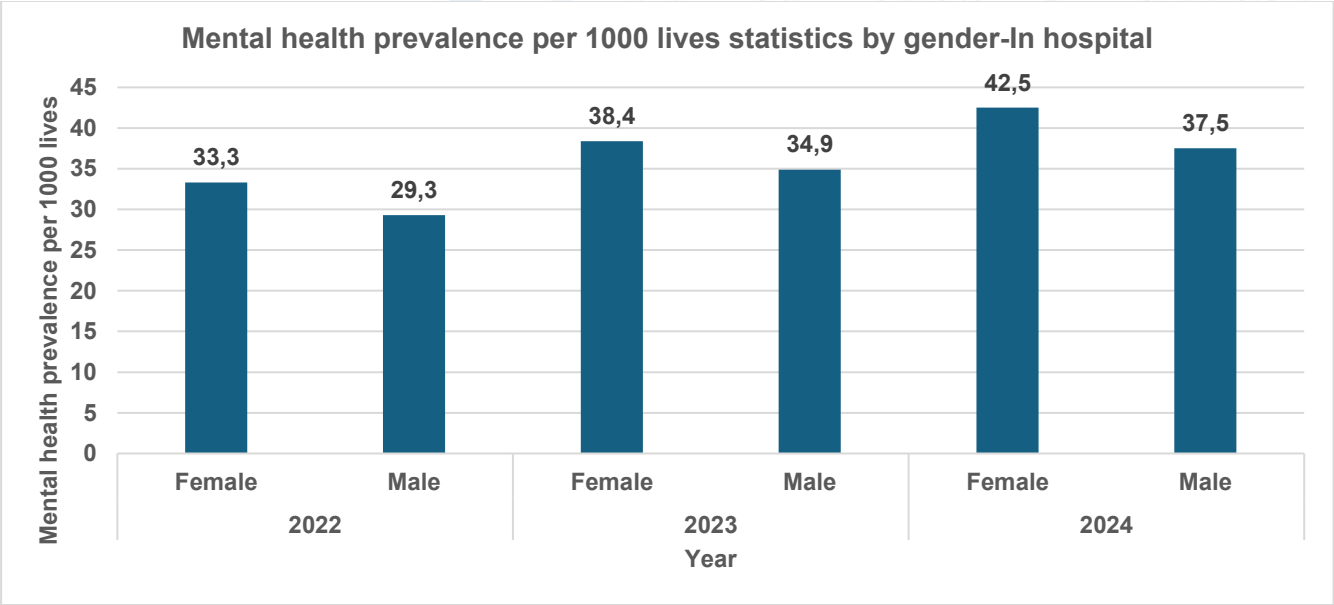
Graph 9: Mental Health Statistics by Gender- In Hospital



Graph 9 presents the number of mental health cases by gender from 2022 to 2024. Females have significantly more mental health cases than males. In 2022 females reported 18 571 cases while males reported 6 722 cases. Both genders show an increase from 2022, with females continuing to have higher case numbers. Therefore, in 2023 females reported 22 446 cases and it was 8 349 cases for males.

The number of cases increases further for both genders, maintaining the pattern of higher prevalence among females. In 2024 females reported 26 037 cases and males 9 372 cases. Depression claims rose for both females (12,664 to 18,498) and males (4,074 to 5,847) between 2022 and 2024. bipolar disorder, ranking second rose from 2,474 to 2,840 for females, and for males from 777 to 927. ADHD claims remained low but rose from 31 in 2022 to 43 in 2024 for females, and for males was 12 and decline to 11 in 2023, then up to 14 in 2024.

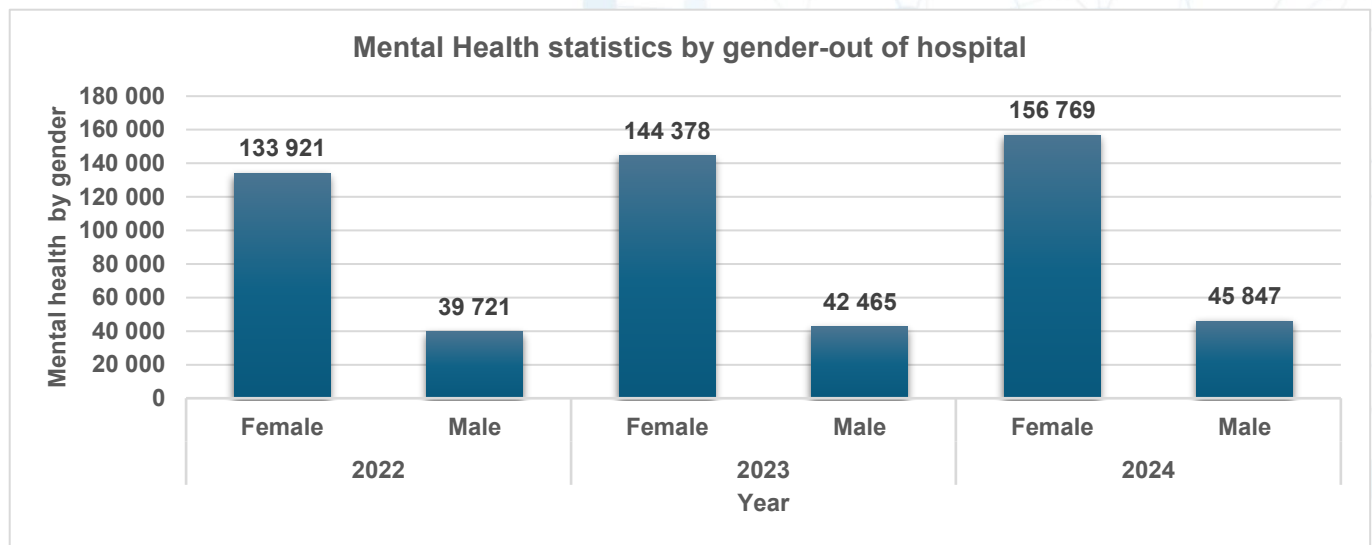
Graph 10: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives Statistics by Gender- In Hospital



Graph 10 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives, broken down by gender from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady increase in mental health prevalence per 1,000 lives for both genders over these three years. Females consistently experience a higher prevalence than males, and the gap remains relatively stable, indicating that mental health issues are more prevalent among females. In 2022 females reported 33.3 cases per 1000 lives while males only reported 29.3 cases per 1000 lives. The prevalence increases for both genders compared to 2022, with females still higher.

In 2023 females reported 38.4 cases per 1000 lives while males reported 34.9 cases per 1000 lives. This increased to 42.5 cases for females and increased to 37.5 cases for males, therefore the upward trend continues, with females maintaining a higher prevalence. Depression claims increased for both females (22.7 to 30.2) and males (17.7 to 23.4) between 2022 and 2024. Psychosis claims remained consistently low at 0.1 for both genders throughout the period.

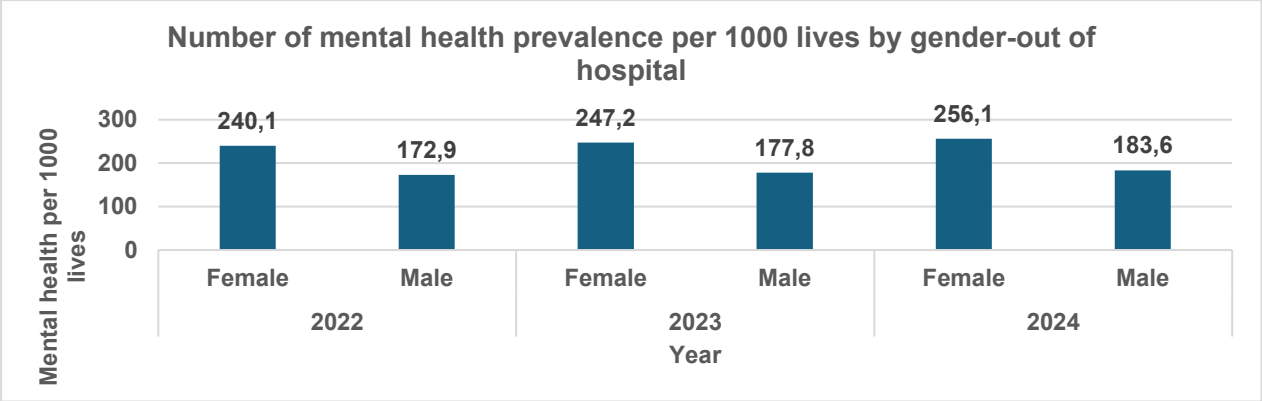
Graph 11: Mental Health Statistics by Gender- Out-of-hospital



Graph 11 displays the number of mental health cases by gender from 2022 to 2024. The graph indicates a steady upward trend in mental health cases for both genders over the three years. Females consistently report more cases than males, and the gap remains relatively stable, which suggests that mental health issues are more prevalent among females. In 2022 females reported 133 921 cases while males 39 721 cases. Both genders show an increase from 2022, with females continuing to have higher case.

In 2023 females reported 144 378 cases while males reported 42 465 cases. On the other hand, females reported 156 769 cases while males 45 847 cases in 2024. Depression remains the most common diagnosis, with female claims increasing from 65827 in 2022 to 79214 in 2024, and male claims increasing from 17969 to 21431. Psychosis had the fewest claims, with female cases rising from 184 to 254 and male cases from 100 to 132 during the same period.

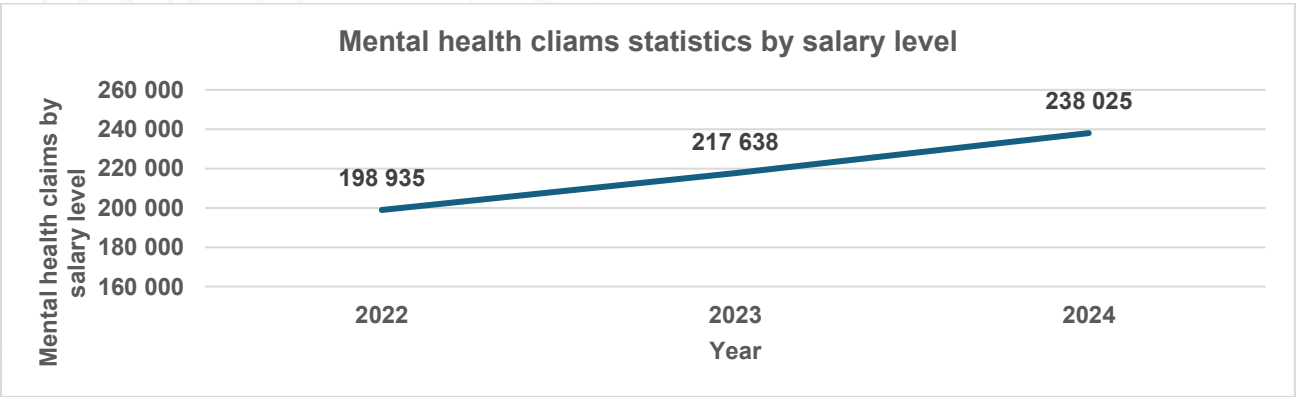
Graph 12: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 Lives Statistics by Gender- Out-of-hospital



Graph 12 illustrates the number of mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by gender from 2022 to 2024. The data from the graph indicates a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence per 1,000 lives over these three years, with females experiencing a higher rate than males throughout. The increasing trend suggests a growing burden of mental health issues, particularly among females. In 2022 female reported 240.1 cases per 1,000 lives which was high compared male with 172.9 cases per 1,000 lives.

In 2023 female reported 247.2 cases per 1,000 lives which was also high when compared to males with 177.8 cases per 1,000 lives. Even in 2024 females reported 256.1 cases per 1,000 lives which was higher when compared to males with 183.6 cases per 1,000 lives. Depression remains the most common diagnosis, with female claims increasing from 118 in 2022 to 129.4 in 2024, and male claims increasing from 78.2 to 85.8. Psychosis had the fewest claims, with female cases rising from 0.3 to 0.5 and male cases from 0.4 to 0.5 during the same period.

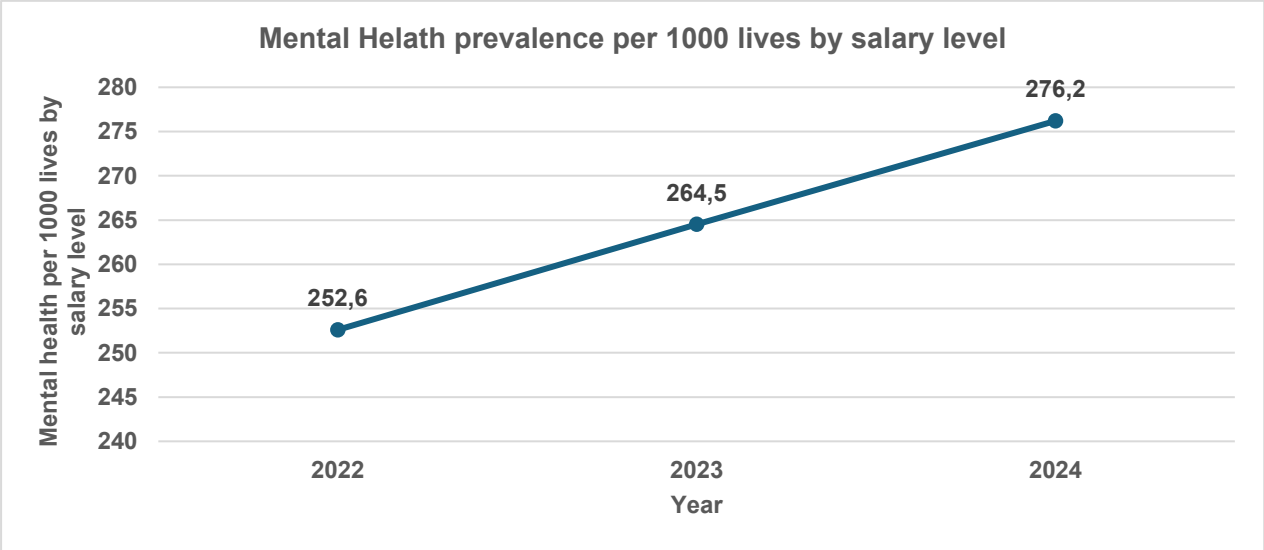
Graph 13: Mental Health Claims Statistics by Salary Level



Graph 13 displays the number of mental health claims by salary level from 2022 to 2024. The number of claims was 198 935 in 2022, then the claims increased to 217 638 in 2023, showing a rise of 18703 claims compared to 2022. Thereafter, in 2024 the claims further increased to 238 025, indicating an increase of around 20 387 claims from 2023. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health claims across salary levels over these three years.

Mental health claims were most prevalent among individuals in the 6–12 salary level, with claims increasing significantly from 124,996 in 2022 to 146,600 in 2024. In contrast, the 13+ salary level recorded the fewest claims, rising only modestly from 888 in 2022 to 1,365 in 2024. The consistent increase suggests that mental health issues are becoming more prevalent or better reported among individuals at 6-12 salary levels, with the total number of claims growing each year.

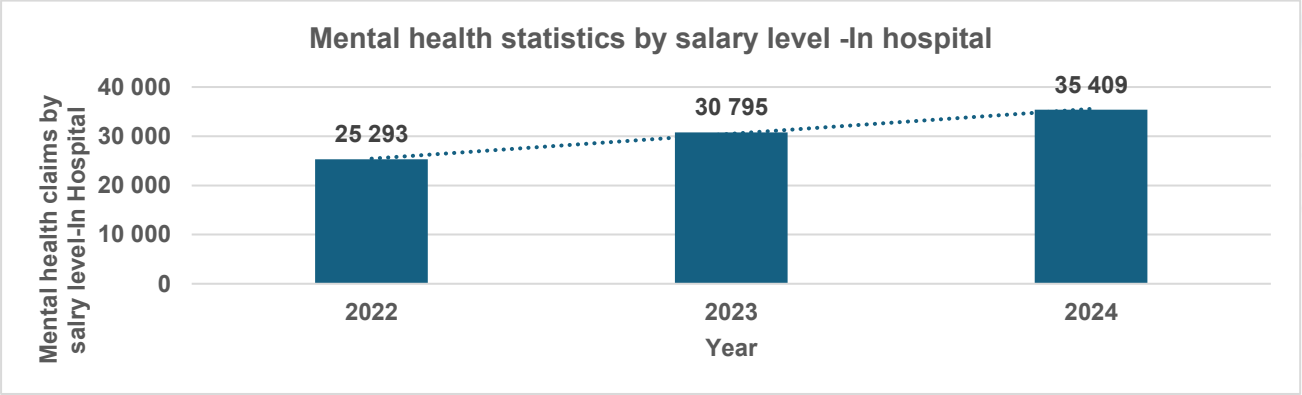
Graph 14: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives by Salary Level



Graph 14 illustrates the prevalence of mental health per 1,000 lives by salary level from 2022 to 2024. The graph indicates a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence per 1000 lives across salary levels over these three years. The increasing numbers suggest that mental health issues are becoming more prevalent among the population in this context, with the trend steadily rising each year. The prevalence was 252.6 per 1000 lives in 2022, then increased to 264.5 per 1 000 lives in 2023, indicating a rise of 11.9 from 2022. Thereafter, in 2024 the prevalence further increased to 276.2 per 1000 lives, an increase of 11.7 from 2023.

The highest prevalence rate of mental health issues was found in the 6–12 salary level, increasing from 337.6 per 1000 lives in 2022 to 371.7 in 2024. This is the concentration of mental health concerns within this income band. The lowest prevalence was consistently among the 13+ salary level, where the rate increased slightly from 89.6 in 2022 to 96.8 in 2024. Despite the increase, this group remains the least affected in terms of per capita mental health issues.

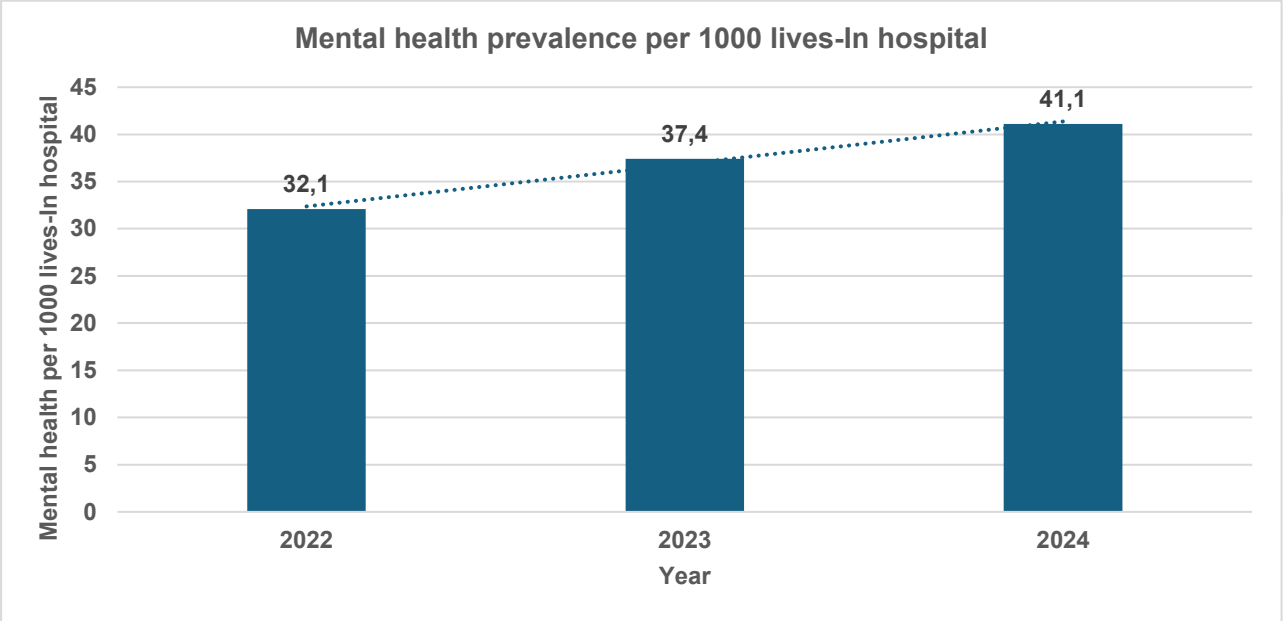
Graph 15: Mental Health Claims Statistics by Salary Level – In Hospital



Graph 15 shows the number of mental health claims by salary level in hospitals from 2022 to 2024. The graph demonstrates a steady upward trend in mental health claims across salary levels in hospitals over these three years. The increasing number of claims suggests that mental health issues are becoming more prevalent or better reported in hospital settings, with a consistent rise each year. In 2022 there were 25 293 claims which increased to 30 795, showing a rise of 5 502 claims compared to 2022. Moreover, in 2024 the claims further increased to 35 409, indicating a rise of 4 614 claims from 2023.

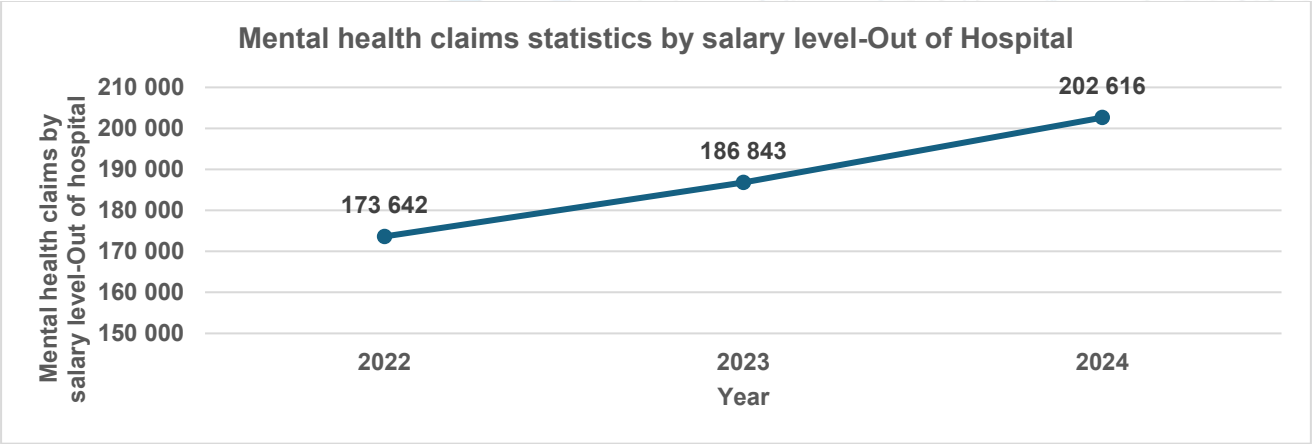
In-hospital mental health claims were highest among individuals in the 6–12 salary level, rising significantly from 15,008 in 2022 to 20,429 in 2024. This group consistently accounted for the largest number of in-hospital mental health cases over the three-year period. The 13+ salary level had the fewest claims, although the number more than doubled from 85 in 2022 to 168 in 2024, it remained the lowest across all income bands.

Graph 16: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives- In Hospital



Graph 16 shows the trend of mental health prevalence per 1000 lives in hospitals from 2022 to 2024. The graph demonstrates a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence per 1000 lives in hospitals over these three years. The increasing prevalence suggests that mental health issues are becoming more common or better identified in hospital settings, with the trend steadily rising each year. The prevalence was 32.1 per 1000 lives in 2022 which increased to 37.4 in 2023, indicating a rise of 5.3 from 2022. The prevalence further increased to 41.1 in 2024 showing an increase of 3.7 from 2023. The highest prevalence per 1000 lives for in-hospital mental health issues was again seen in the 6–12 salary band, increasing steadily from 40.5 in 2022 to 51.8 in 2024. Conversely, the 13+ salary group recorded the lowest prevalence, despite a modest rise from 8.6 in 2022 to 11.9 in 2024.

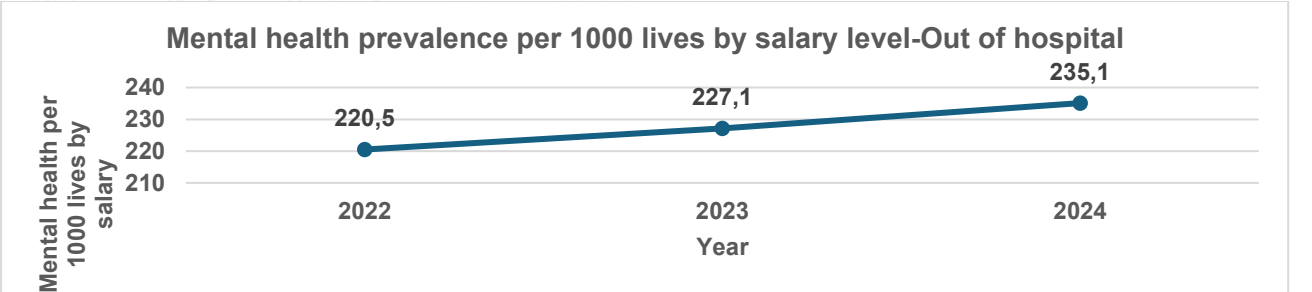
Graph 17: Mental Health Claims Statistics by Salary Level – Out Hospital



Graph 17 illustrates the number of mental health claims by salary level out of from 2022 to 2024. The data from the graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health claims by salary level out of hospitals over these three years. The increasing numbers suggest that mental health issues are becoming more prevalent or more frequently reported in hospital settings, with a consistent rise each year. In 2022 the number of claims was 173 642. The claims increased to 186 843 in 2023, showing an increase of 13 201 claims compared to 2022.

The claims further increased to 202 616 in 2024, indicating an increase of 15 773 claims from 2023. Out-of-hospital mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 6–12 salary level, increasing steadily from 109,988 in 2022 to 126,171 in 2024. This group consistently showed the highest number of claims, indicating a substantial reliance on outpatient mental health services. The 13+ salary level recorded the fewest claims, rising from 803 in 2022 to 1,197 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all salary levels.

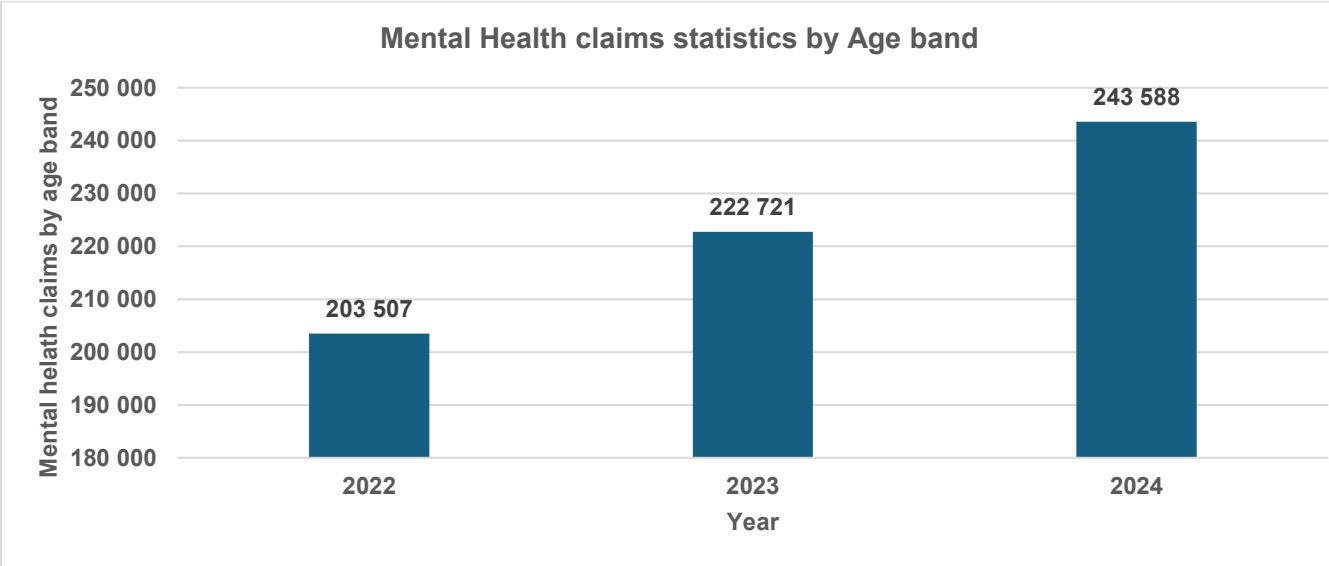
Graph 18: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives by Salary Level – Out of Hospital



Graph 18 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by salary level for out-of-hospital cases from 2022 to 2024. The data shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence across these years, indicating that mental health issues are becoming more common or more frequently reported outside of hospital settings. In 2022, the prevalence was 220.5 cases per 1000 lives. This figure increased to 227.1 cases in 2023, reflecting a rise of 6.6 cases per 1000 compared to the previous year.

The upward trend continued in 2024, reaching 235.1 cases per 1000 lives, which marks an increase of 8 cases per 1000 lives from 2023. The highest prevalence of outpatient mental health conditions was found in the 6–12 salary band, increasing from 297.1 in 2022 to 319.9 in 2024. On the other end, the lowest prevalence was again seen in the 13+ salary group, with a minimal increase from 81.0 to 84.9 over the same period.

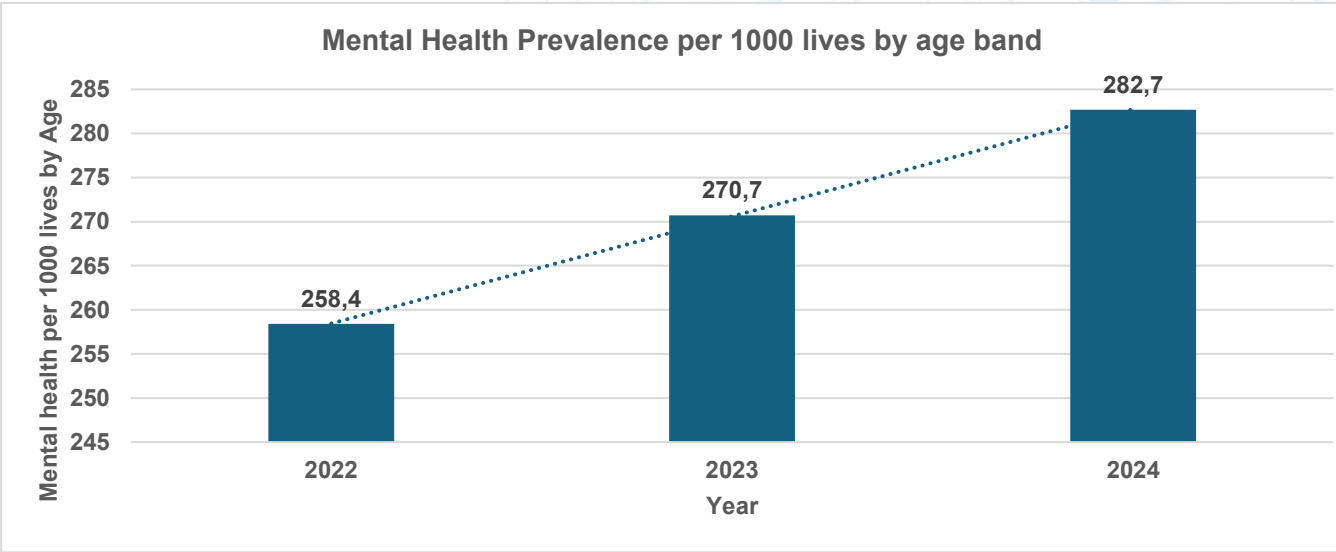
Graph 19: Mental Health Claims Statistics by Age Band



Graph 19 illustrates the number of mental health claims by age band from 2022 to 2024. The graph reveals a consistent upward trend in mental health claims across all three years, suggesting that mental health issues are becoming increasingly prevalent or more frequently reported across various age groups. In 2022, the number of claims stood at 203,507. This increased to 222 721 in 2023, representing a rise of 19 214 claims compared to 2022. The upward trend continued into 2024, with claims reaching 243 588, showing a further increase of 20 867 claims from 2023. Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 50-60 Age band, increasing steadily from 54397 in 2022

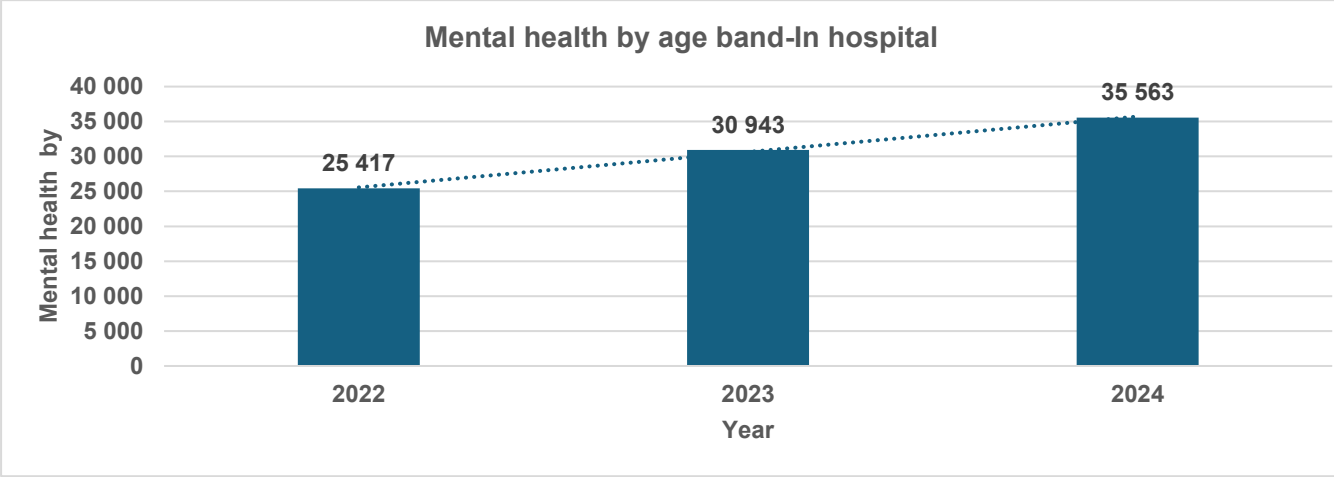
to 65300 in 2024. The 80+ recorded the fewest claims, increasing from 6308 in 2022 to 7206 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all age group.

Graph 20: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives by Age Band



Graph 20 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by age band from 2022 to 2024. The data shows a steady increase in mental health prevalence across the three-year period, indicating that mental health conditions are becoming more common or more frequently identified across various age groups. In 2022, the prevalence was 258.4 cases per 1000 lives. This number rose to 270.7 cases in 2023, reflecting an increase of 12.3 cases per 1000 compared to 2022. The trend continued in 2024, reaching 282.7 cases per 1000 lives, which represents a further increase of 12 cases per 1000 from the previous year. Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 80+ Age band, increasing steadily from 487.2 in 2022 to 518.9 in 2024. The 60-80 recorded the fewest claims, increasing from 241.7 in 2022 to 248 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all age group.

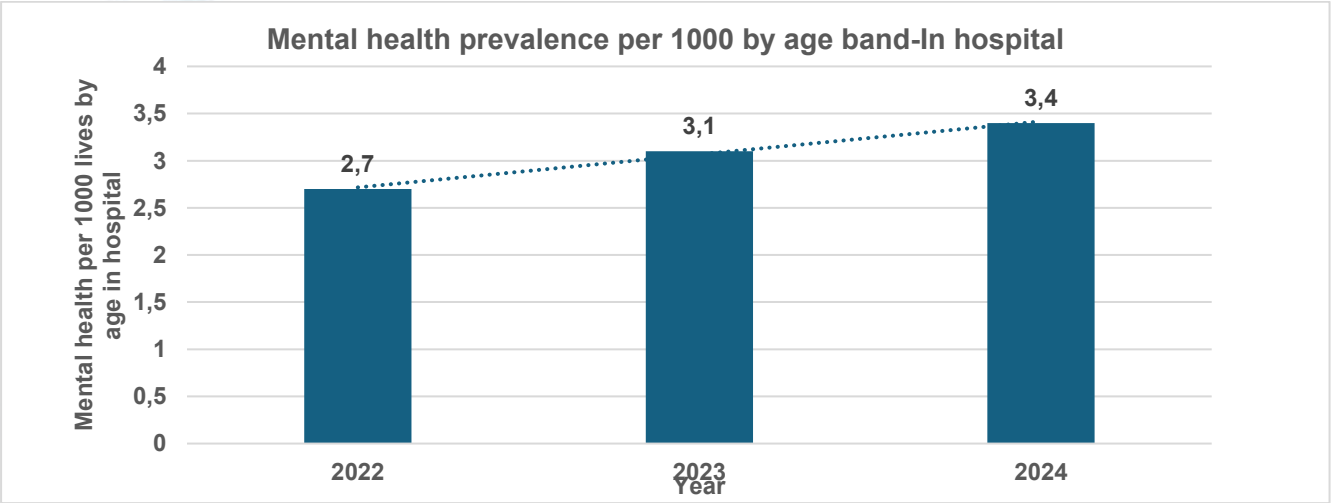
Graph 21: Mental Health by Age Band-In Hospital



Graph 21 illustrates the mental health prevalence by age band in hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence across different age bands over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 25 417 which increased to 30 943 in 2023, showing a rise of 5 526 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 35 563, indicating an increase of 4 620 from the previous year.

In hospital Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 40-50 Age band, increasing steadily from 6988 in 2022 to 9728 in 2024. The 80+ recorded the fewest claims, increasing from 713 in 2022 to 854 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all age group

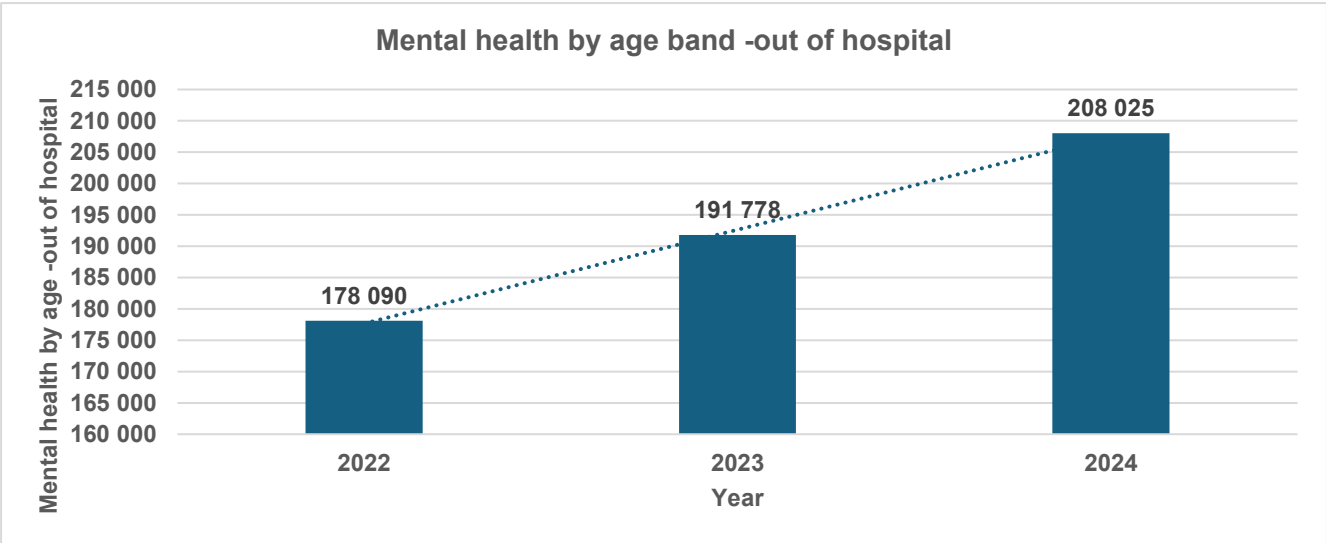
Graph 22: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 by Age Band-In Hospital



Graph 22 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by age in hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence among hospitalised individuals over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 2.7 per 1000 lives, this then increased to 3.1 in 2023, showing a rise of 0.4 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 3.4 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 0.3 from the previous year.

In hospital Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 80+ Age band, increasing steadily from 4.6 in 2022 to 5.1 in 2024. The 60-70 recorded the fewest claims, increasing from 1.9 in 2022 to 2.4 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all age group.

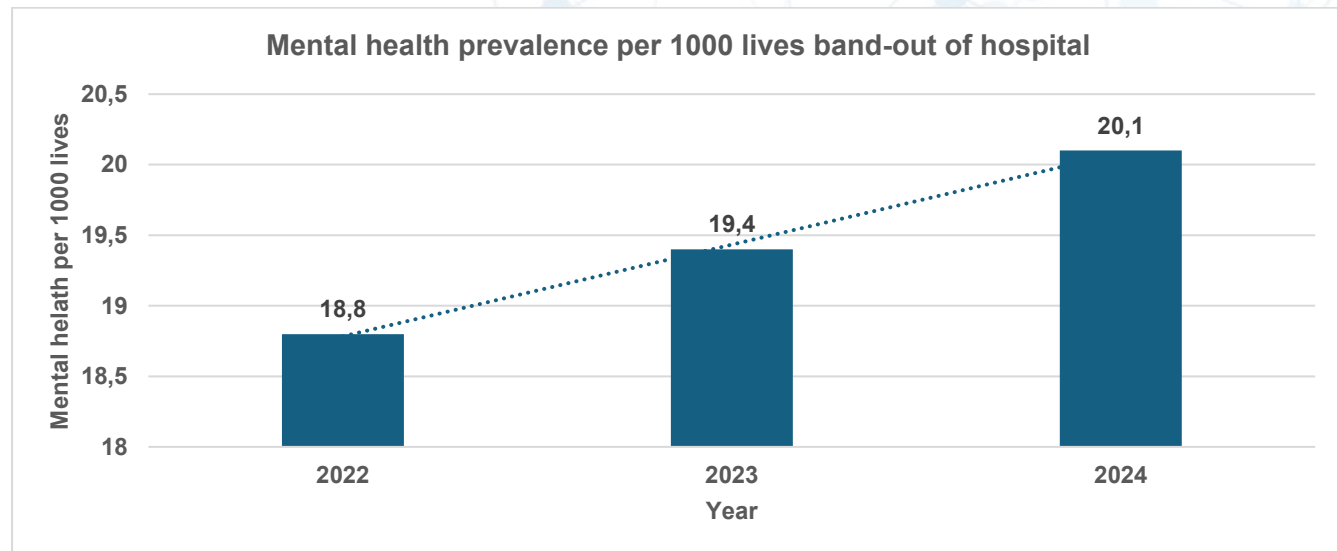
Graph 23: Mental Health by Age Band-Out of Hospital



Graph 23 illustrates the mental health prevalence by age band out of hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health cases managed outside of hospital settings over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 178 090, which increased to 191 778 in 2023, showing a rise of 13 688 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 208 025, indicating a rise of 16 247 from the previous year.

Out hospital Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 50-60 Age band, increasing steadily from 47 629 in 2022 to 55 759 in 2024. The 80+ recorded the fewest claims, increasing from 5 595 in 2022 to 6 352 in 2024, remaining the lowest among all age group.

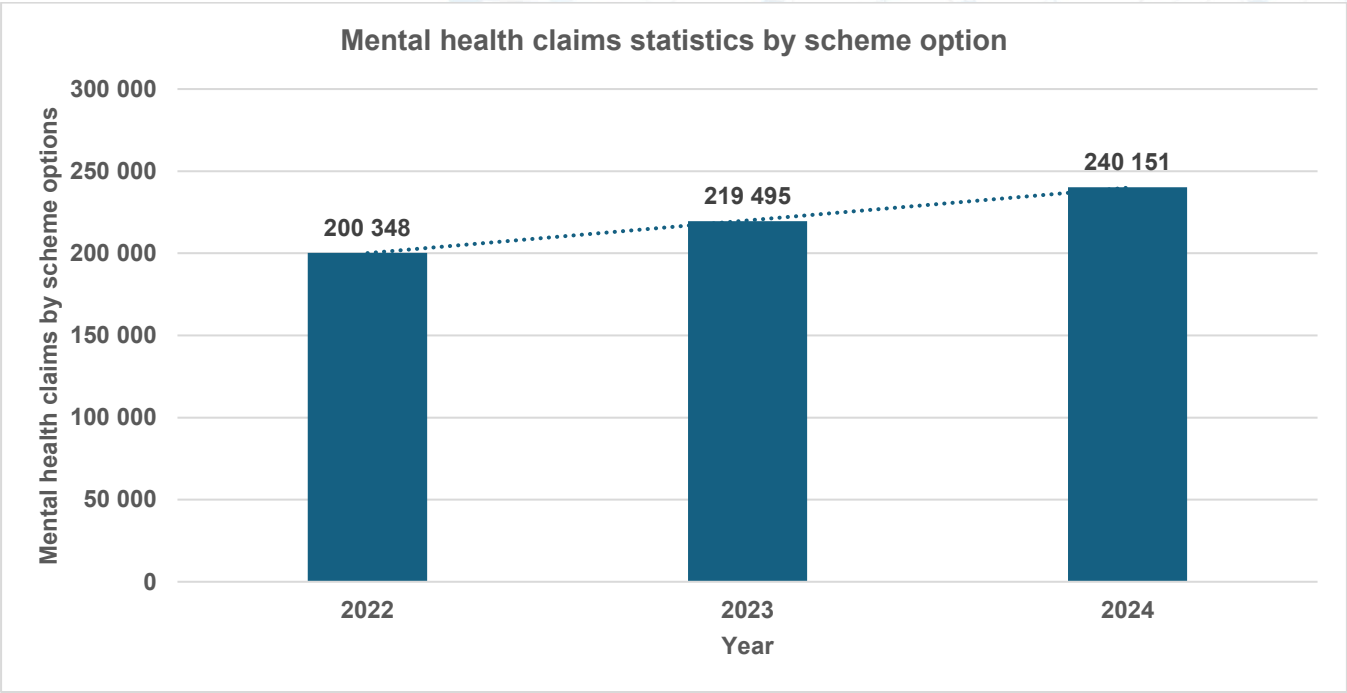
Graph 24: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives by Age Band-Out of Hospital



Graph 24 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by age band out of hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence outside of hospital settings over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 18.8 per 1000 lives which increased to 19.4 in 2023, showing a rise of 0.6 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 20.1 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 0.7 from the previous year.

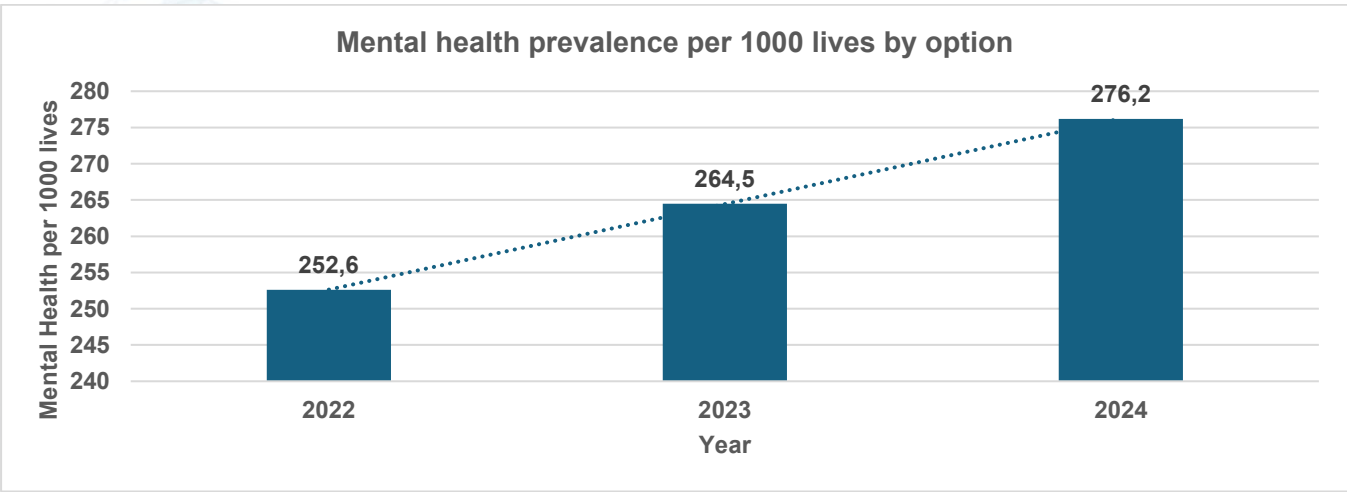
Out hospital Mental health claims were most common among individuals in the 80+ Age band, increasing steadily from 36 in 2022 to 38.1 in 2024. On the other hand, 40-50 and 50-60 recorded the fewest claims at 18.0 for both age group in 2022 which increased to 18.9 and 18.3 in 2024 for 40-50 and 50-60 respectively.

Graph 25: Mental Health Claims Statistics by Scheme Option



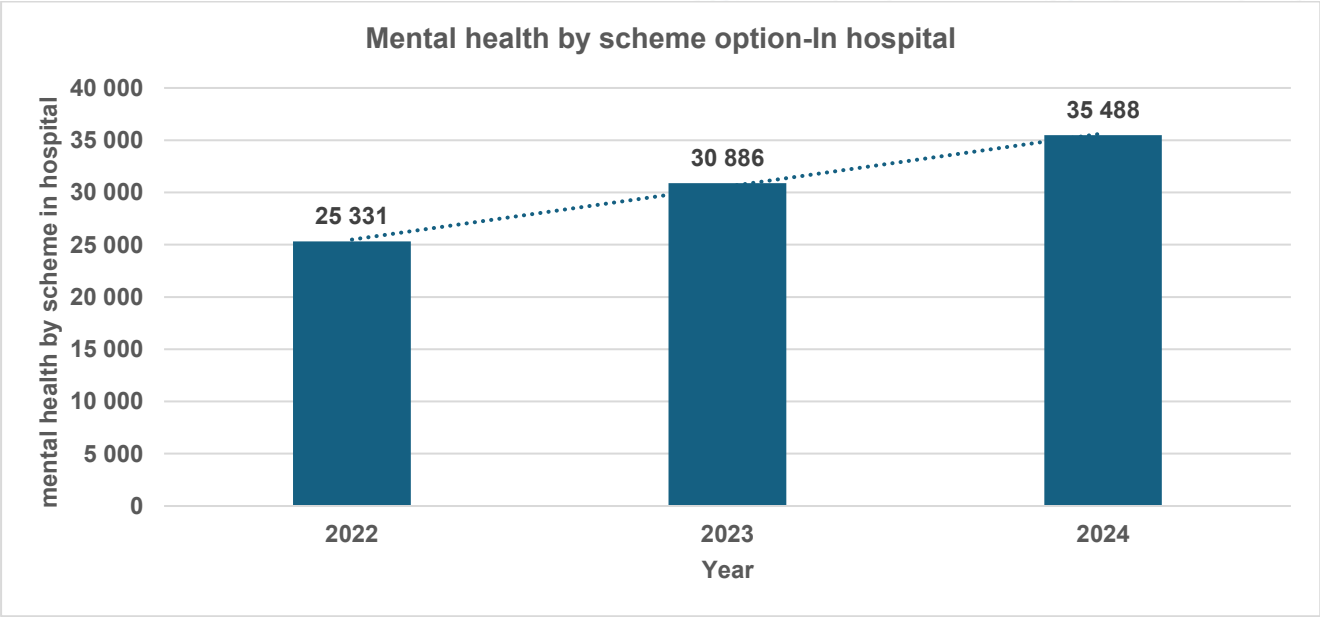
Graph 25 illustrates the number of mental health claims by scheme option from 2022 to 2024. The data from the graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health-related claims across scheme options over the three-year period. In 2022, the number of claims was 200 348. This increased to 219 495 in 2023, showing a rise of 19 147 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with claims reaching 240 151, indicating an increase of 20 656 from the previous year. EMERALD reported the highest mental health cases, decreasing from 105,991 in 2022 to 104,515 in 2024. In contrast, ONYX had the lowest, declining from 11,554 to 10,258 over the same period.

Graph 26: Mental Health Prevalence per 1000 lives by Scheme option



Graph 26 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by employer from 2022 to 2024. The data from the graph shows a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence across scheme options over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 252.6 per 1000 lives which increased to 264.5 in 2023, showing a rise of 11.9 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 276.2 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 11.7 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the steady growth in mental health prevalence. ONYX recorded the highest rate, rising from 539.4 per 1,000 lives in 2022 to 574.5 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, TANZANITE ONE had the lowest prevalence, though it increased from 129.1 to 180.3 per 1,000 lives during the same period.

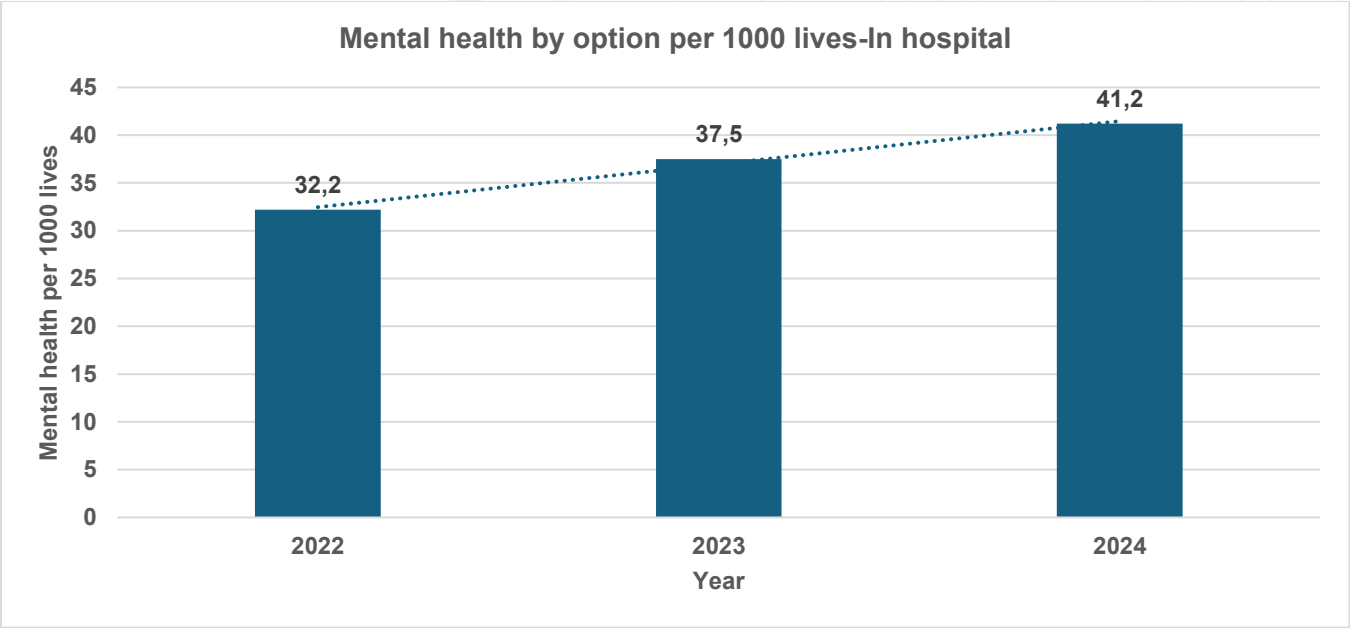
Graph 27: Mental Health by Scheme Option-In Hospital



Graph 27 illustrates the number of mental health cases by scheme option in hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in hospital-based mental health cases under scheme options over the three-year period.

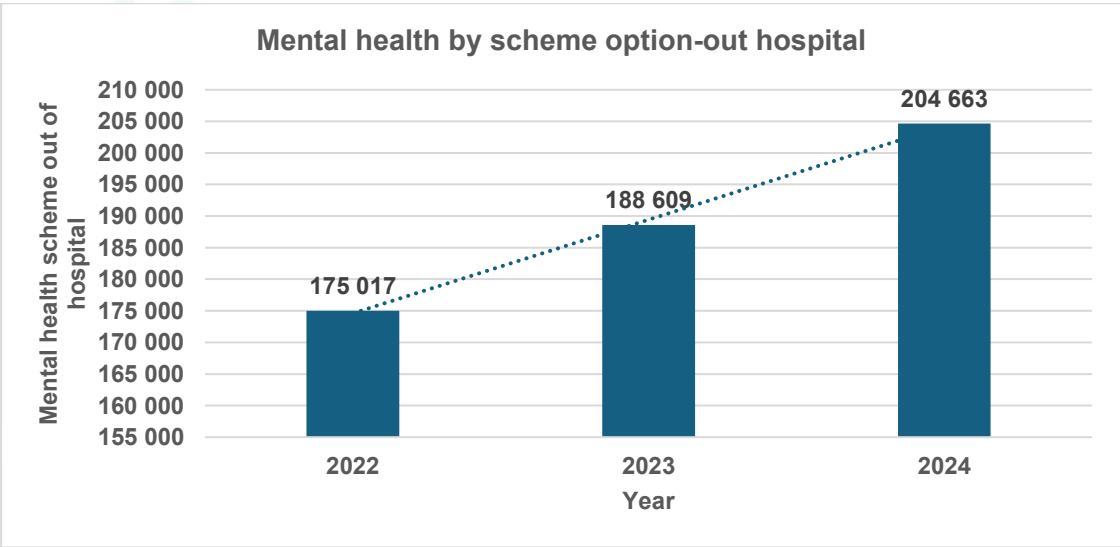
In 2022, the number of cases was 25 331 which increased to 30,886 in 2023, showing a rise of 5 555 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with cases reaching 35 488, indicating an increase of 4 602 from the previous year. EMERALD reported the highest number of mental health hospital claims, increasing from 13,507 in 2022 to 14,514 in 2024. In contrast, ONYX had the lowest, declining from 1,214 to 1,158 over the same period.

Graph 28: Mental Health by option per 1000 lives-In Hospital



Graph 28 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by option in hospital from 2022 to 2024. The data from the graph shows a steady upward trend in hospital-based mental health prevalence across scheme options over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 32.2 per 1000 lives, this increased to 37.5 in 2023, showing a rise of 5.3 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 41.2 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 3.7 from the previous year. For In-hospital prevalence, ONYX recorded the highest rate, increasing from 56.7 per 1,000 lives in 2022 to 64.9 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, TANZANITE ONE had the lowest prevalence, although it rose from 17.4 to 32.8 per 1000 lives during the same period.

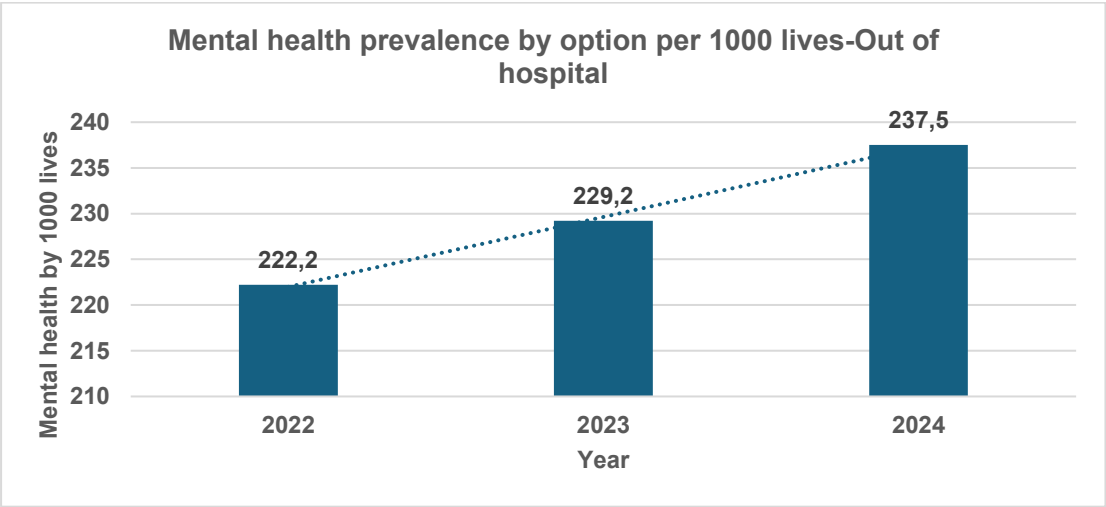
Graph 29: Mental Health by Scheme Option-Out Hospital



Graph 29 illustrates the number of individuals participating in mental health schemes out of hospital for the years 2022, 2023, and 2024. The data from the graph shows a steady upward trend in out-of-hospital mental health engagement under scheme options over the three-year period.

In 2022, the number of individuals was 175 017. This increased to 188,609 in 2023, showing a rise of 13 592 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with participation reaching 204 663, indicating an increase of 16 054 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the consistent growth in out-of-hospital mental health scheme utilisation. EMERALD reported the highest number of out-hospital mental health cases, decreasing from 92,484 in 2022 to 90,001 in 2024. In contrast, ONYX had the lowest, declining from 10,340 to 9,100 over the same period.

Graph 30: Mental Health Prevalence by option per 1000 lives-Out of Hospital

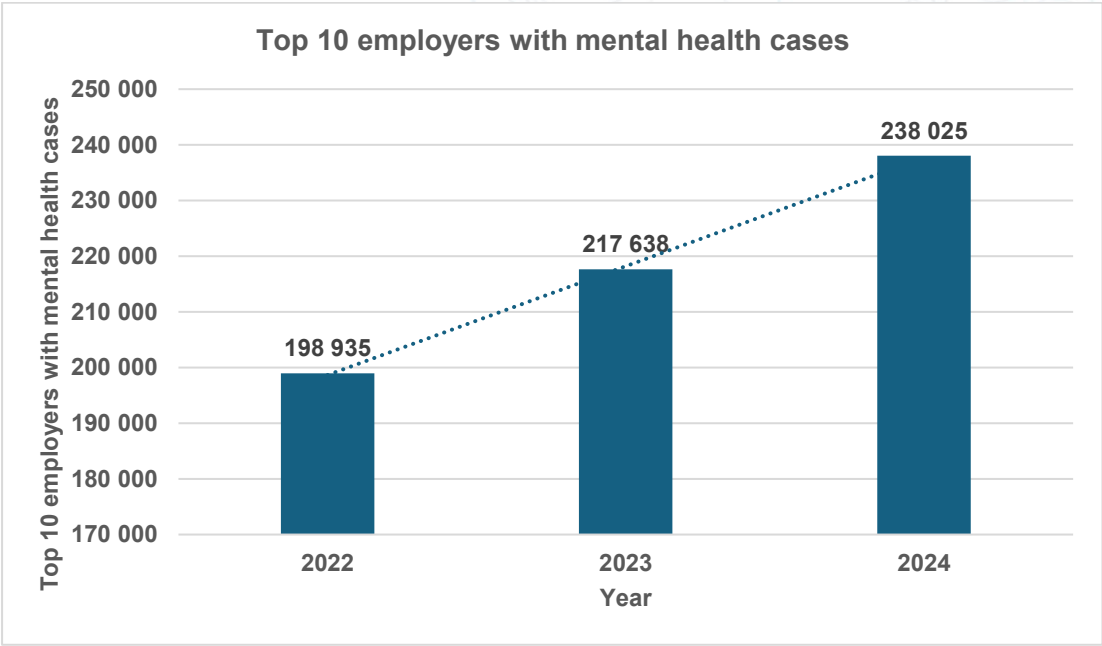


Graph 30 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives by option out of hospital from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a consistent upward trend in mental health prevalence outside of hospital settings over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 222.2 per 1000 lives. This increased to 229.2 in 2023, showing a rise of 7.0 compared to 2022.

The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 237.5 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 8.3 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars reinforces the steady growth in mental health prevalence out of hospital. For out of hospital prevalence, ONYX recorded the highest rate, moving from 482.8 per 1,000 lives in 2022

to 509.7 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, TANZANITE ONE had the lowest prevalence, though it increased from 111.7 to 147.5 per 1,000 lives during the same period.

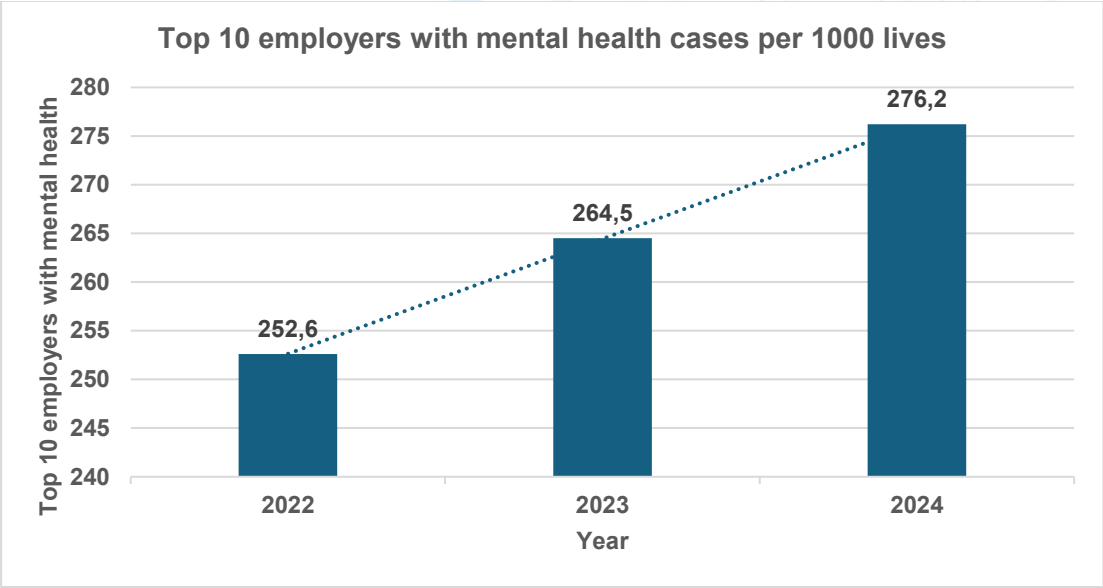
Graph 31: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases by Employer



Graph 31 illustrates the number of mental health cases reported by the top 10 employers for the years 2022, 2023, and 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in workplace-related mental health cases over the three-year period. In 2022, the number of cases was 198 935. This increased to 217 638 in 2023, showing a rise of 18 703 compared to 2022.

The upward trend continued in 2024, with cases reaching 238 025, indicating an increase of 20 387 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the consistent growth in mental health cases among major employers. In 2022, Education had the highest number of mental health cases at 78379 which increased to 98013 in 2024 while NPA had the lowest at 2523 in 2022 which increased to 2901.

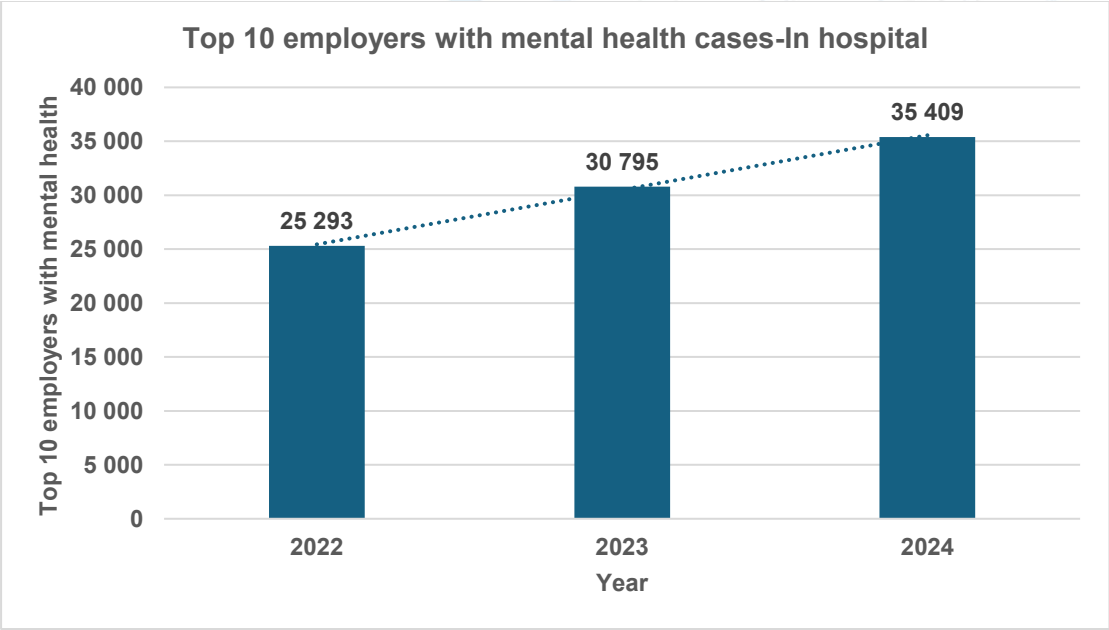
Graph 32: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases per 1000 lives by Employer



Graph 32 illustrates the mental health prevalence per 1000 lives among employees of the top 10 employers from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence in the workforce over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 252.6 per 1000 lives. This increased to 264.5 in 2023, showing a rise of 11.9 compared to 2022.

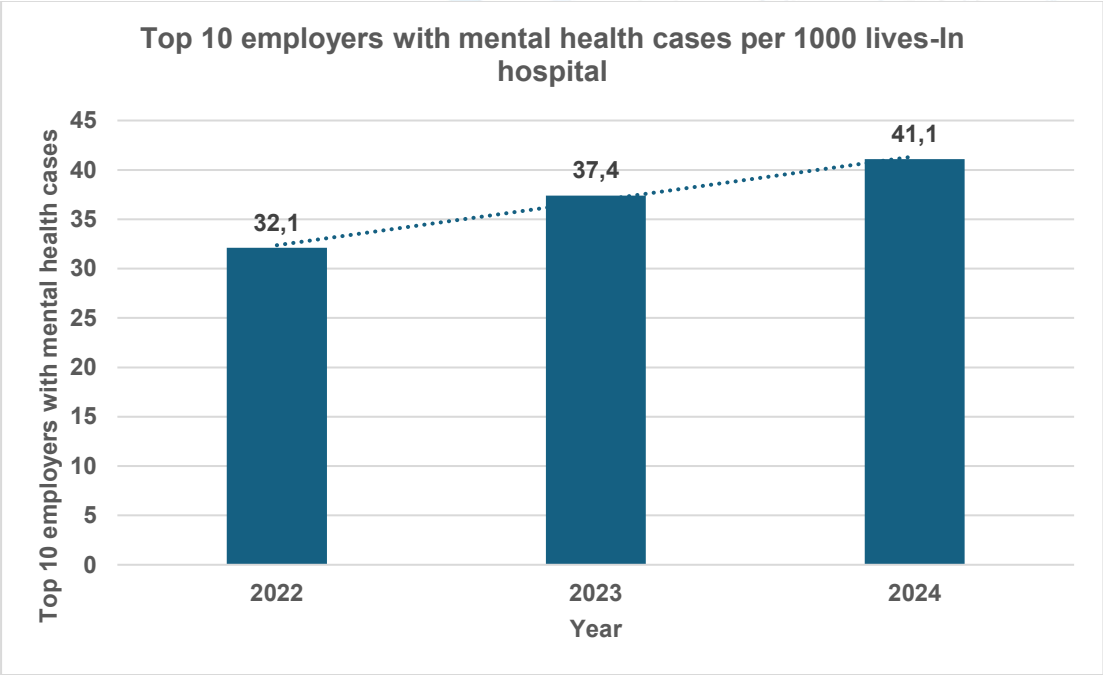
The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 276.2 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 11.7 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the consistent growth in mental health prevalence among top employers' staff. Public Admin recorded the highest rate, rising from 698.2 per 1,000 lives in 2022 to 774.6 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, Pensioners had the lowest prevalence, though it increased from 168.7 to 153.4 per 1,000 lives during the same period.

Graph 33: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases-In Hospital



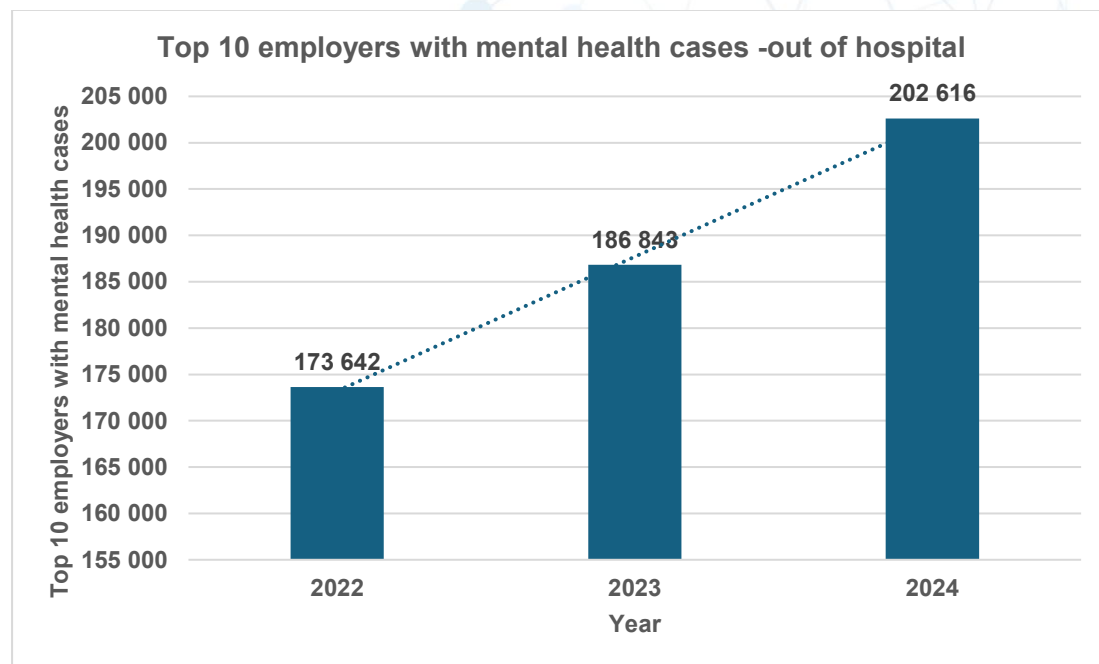
Graph 33 illustrates the number of in-hospital mental health cases reported by the top 10 employers from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a consistent upward trend in hospital-based mental health cases among employees over the three-year period. In 2022, the number of cases was 25 293, this increased to 30 795 in 2023, showing a rise of 5 502 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with cases reaching 35 409, indicating an increase of 4 614 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars reinforces the steady growth in mental health-related hospitalisations among employees of major employers. Education recorded the highest rate, rising from 9888 in 2022 to 14379 in 2024. Meanwhile, Transport had the lowest rate though it increased from 352 to 501 during the same period.

Graph 34: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases per 1000 lives-In Hospital



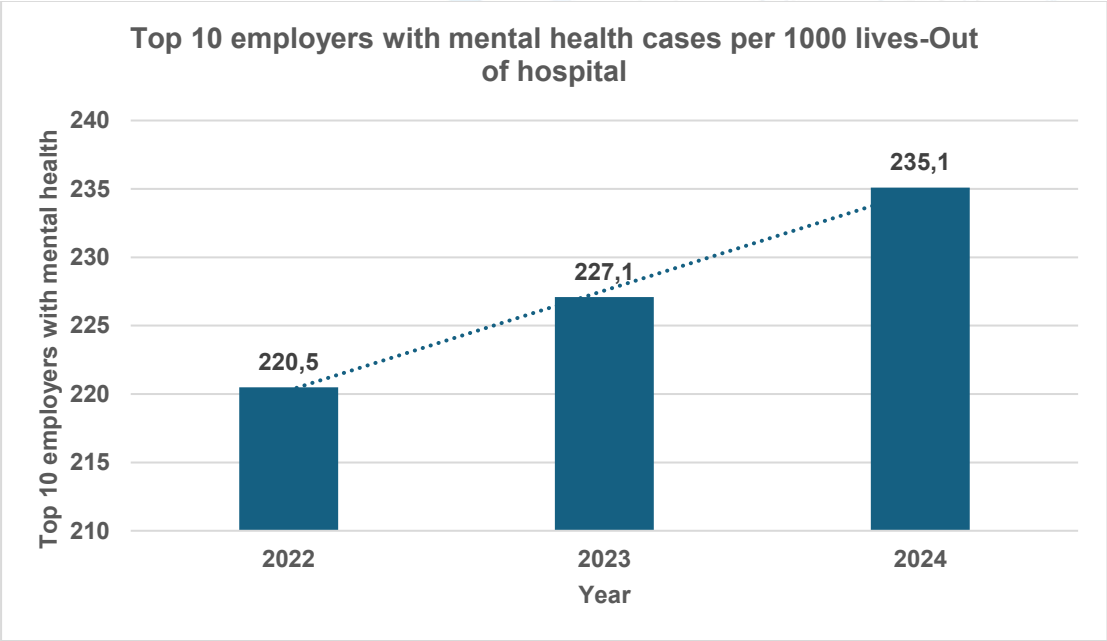
Graph 34 illustrates the number of in-hospital mental health cases per 1000 lives among employees of the top 10 employers from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence in hospital settings over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 32.1 per 1000 lives. This increased to 37.4 in 2023, showing a rise of 5.3 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 41.1 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 3.7 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the consistent growth in hospital-based mental health cases among employees. Public Admin recorded the highest rate, rising from 80.9 per 1,000 lives in 2022 to 121.5 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, Pensioners had the lowest prevalence, though it increased from 19.1 to 17.7 per 1,000 lives during the same period.

Graph 35: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases-Out Hospital



Graph 35 illustrates the number of out-of-hospital mental health cases reported by the top 10 employers for the years 2022, 2023, and 2024. The graph shows a consistent upward trend in community-based mental health cases among employees over the three-year period. In 2022, the number of cases was 173 642. This increased to 186 843 in 2023, showing a rise of 13 201 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with cases reaching 202 616, indicating an increase of 15 773 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars highlights the steady growth in out-of-hospital mental health cases among employees. Education recorded the highest rate, rising from 68493 in 2022 to 83634 in 2024. Meanwhile, NPA had the lowest rate though it increased from 2165 to 2469 during the same period.

Graph 36: Top 10 Employers with Mental Health cases per 1000 lives-Out of Hospital

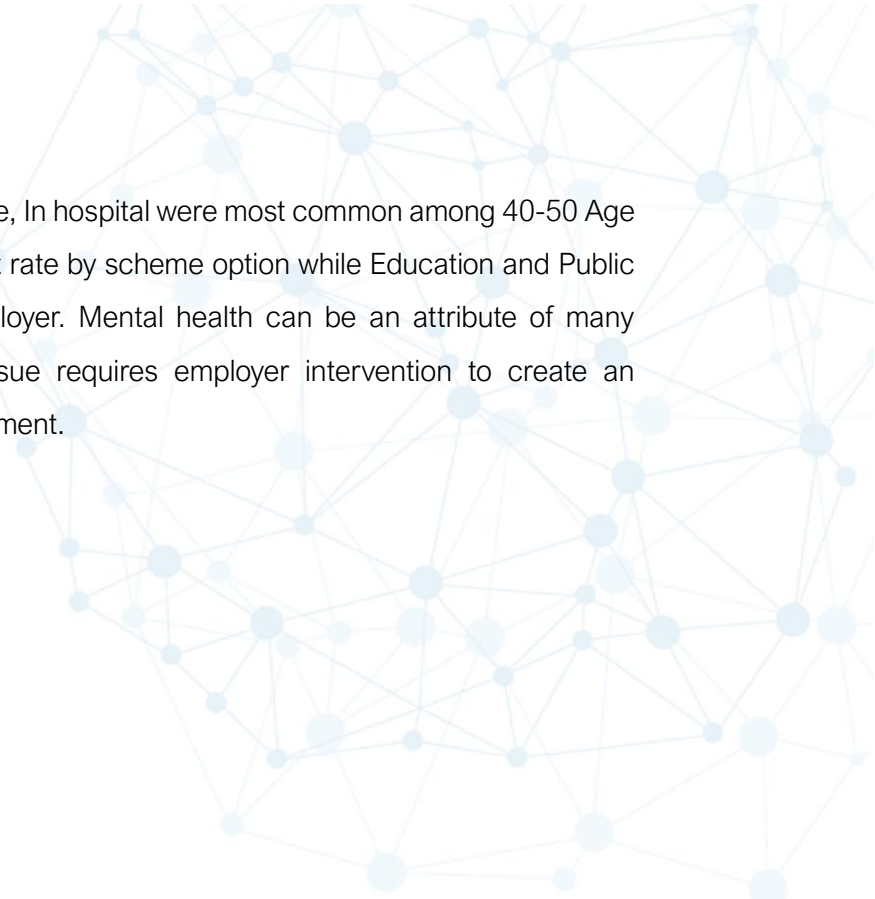


Graph 36 illustrates the number of out-of-hospital mental health cases per 1000 lives among employees of the top 10 employers from 2022 to 2024. The graph shows a steady upward trend in mental health prevalence outside of hospital settings over the three-year period. In 2022, the prevalence was 220.5 per 1000 lives. This increased to 227.1 in 2023, showing a rise of 6.6 compared to 2022. The upward trend continued in 2024, with prevalence reaching 235.1 per 1000 lives, indicating an increase of 8.0 from the previous year. The dotted trend line above the bars reinforces the consistent growth in out-of-hospital mental health prevalence among employees. Public Admin recorded the highest rate, rising from 604.8 per 1,000 lives in 2022 to 674.9 per 1,000 lives in 2024. Meanwhile, Pensioners had the lowest prevalence and decreased from 149.6 to 133.8 per 1,000 lives during the same period.

CONCLUSION

Mental health remains a significant health concern among public servants who are members of GEMS. Both in-hospital and out-of-hospital claims have risen over the past three years. Depression and anxiety were the most prevalent mental health conditions among public servants. Schizophrenia and psychosis remained relatively rare within the public sector population.

Female public servants recorded significantly higher mental health claims compared to their male counterparts. Mental health claims were most common among 6-12 salary levels and 50-60 Age band. Out hospital Mental health claims were most common among

A decorative graphic in the top right corner consisting of a network of light blue dots connected by thin, light blue lines, forming a complex, interconnected web.

individuals in the 50-60 Age band while, In hospital were most common among 40-50 Age band. EMERALD reported the highest rate by scheme option while Education and Public Admin reported highest rate by employer. Mental health can be an attribute of many factors; however, addressing this issue requires employer intervention to create an enabling and supportive work environment.



MENTAL HEALTH CRISIS



6. MENTAL HEALTH CRISIS AMONG SOUTH AFRICAN POLICE: A CALL FOR URGENT SUPPORT

Overview

The mental health crisis among South Africa's first responders, particularly the police, has reached alarming levels. On average, one member of the South African Police Service (SAPS) dies by suicide every week. In the 2024/25 period alone, 54 police officers took their own lives, adding to a total of 300 suicides over the past seven years. The ongoing psychological strain and lack of adequate support systems are taking a devastating toll on those tasked with ensuring public safety.

Studies show that 47.3% of police and paramedics could be diagnosed with depression, 37.8% with generalised anxiety disorder, and 48.5% are at risk for PTSD, far above national averages of 9.8% and 15.8%, respectively. The South African Society of Psychiatrists (SASOP) warns that constant exposure to crime, domestic violence, and large-scale disasters significantly impacts the mental health of first responders. Dr. Alicia Porter from SASOP emphasised that untreated conditions affect the performance of police officers, their relationships and quality of life.

South Africa's broader mental health system is also failing. Between 75% and 90% of individuals in need do not receive support, largely due to resource shortages and the stigma surrounding mental illness. Within SAPS, only 621 health professionals serve over 187,000 employees, an enormous disparity. The stigma is particularly severe among uniformed personnel, who often avoid seeking help for fear of appearing weak.

Experts call for independent, confidential, and easily accessible support systems. Dr. Porter recommends trauma clinicians who operate outside management structures, regular mental health screenings after traumatic incidents, and training programs to promote awareness and peer support. She further highlights the need for "rostering hygiene", balanced scheduling and rotation between high- and low-trauma duties, to reduce burnout. Without reform, South Africa risks losing frontline talent and weakening its emergency response capacity.

Overwhelming Workload and Mental Health Strain on Police Officers by Gcwalisile Khanyile

Police officers in South Africa are under immense pressure, with one officer serving an estimated 400,000 citizens, almost double the UN's recommended ratio of 1:220. Of more

than 180,000 SAPS employees, about 30,000 are administrative staff, leaving only 150,000 trained officers actively fighting crime.

Lesiba Thobakgale from the South African Policing Union (SAPU) said the SAPS is severely under-resourced, both physically and in manpower. He called for improved safety guidelines, better pay, and modern equipment such as body cameras to enhance accountability and reduce police killings. Thobakgale also emphasised that mental health professionals must be adequately equipped to debrief officers after traumatic incidents.

Independent policing expert Dr. Johan Burger noted that police numbers dropped from 154,748 in 2010/11 to 139,901 in 2020/21, while the population grew from 50 to 60 million. Although numbers recovered slightly to 150,388 by 2023/24, the ratio remains far from optimal. Rising violent crime, including murders and aggravated robberies, mirrors the strain on policing capacity. Burger stressed that socio-economic factors such as poverty, unemployment, and substance abuse, further drive crime, making policing even more challenging.

Burger also criticised the slow implementation of the National Integrated Crime and Violence Prevention Strategy (ICVPS) adopted in 2022, urging stronger collaboration across government departments and annual progress updates from the President or Cabinet.

Detectives are particularly burdened, with the current workforce of 22,400 falling 8,600 short of the 31,000 required. This shortage leads to backlogs, incomplete investigations, and falling morale. In 2024, 111 police officers were killed, 40% while on duty, adding further emotional strain. Many officers are reluctant to attend trauma support programs due to stigma and fear of being declared unfit for duty.

Counselling psychologist Tholinhlanhla Dlamini-Ngcoya explained that depression, PTSD, and anxiety are widespread among law enforcement officers. Long hours, lack of rest, and high exposure to violence lead to burnout, fatigue, insomnia, and emotional instability, sometimes resulting in suicidal thoughts or violent outbursts. Fear of stigma and job loss prevents many from seeking help. Dlamini-Ngcoya urged that mental health assessments become compulsory and viewed as a sign of strength, not weakness.

Despite these challenges, SAPS spokesperson Brigadier Athlenda Mathe said initiatives like Project 10 000, which recruits and trains new officers annually, aim to reduce the workload. SAPS also runs an Employee Health and Wellness Unit with psychologists,



social workers, and chaplains providing 24/7 support and mandatory debriefings within 72 hours of traumatic incidents. Mathe emphasised the department's commitment to continuous resourcing, training, and promoting ethical conduct and well-being among members.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of interlocking triangles in shades of grey and white. Overlaid on this are two network diagrams, each consisting of a cluster of blue dots connected by thin lines. A solid green shape is in the top-left corner, and a green semi-circle is in the bottom-right corner. A horizontal band with a repeating geometric pattern in light purple and white contains the title text.

**LONGITUDINAL STUDY: PSETA
PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION
LEADERSHIP TRAINING
PROGRAMME SURVEY**



7. LONGITUDINAL STUDY: PSETA PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION LEADERSHIP TRAINING PROGRAMME SURVEY (ROUND 2)

Overview

The Public Service Education and Training Authority (PSETA), in collaboration with the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC) and the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC), implemented a training program aimed at enhancing the skills and competencies of public service officials. This initiative led to the successful completion of the National Certificate in Public Administration Leadership by 51 participants, representing various government entities, trade unions, and councils. To evaluate whether the trained employees are using the skills gained based on the program's impact, a longitudinal survey was conducted electronically in two rounds: the first in September 2023 and the second in September 2024. The survey aimed to assess the application of skills acquired during the training and the overall effectiveness of the program.

The survey results over the two intervals (2023 and 2024) revealed valuable insights into the participants' experiences and the program's impact. The first round saw a 64.7% response rate, which decreased to 54.9% in the second round, largely due to challenges in reaching participants with inactive email addresses and some who might have moved on from the public service. Despite the decline in participation (33 in 2023 and 28 in 2024), the survey provided a comprehensive understanding of the training's effectiveness across a diverse sample, including respondents from various roles within the public service. The data highlighted a strong application of skills in areas such as team building, knowledge management, and diversity management, indicating that the training was relevant and practical for many participants. There was an increase on those using the skills from 2023 to 2024. However, a slight decline was observed in the sustained application of certain skills.

Participants reported a significant positive impact on their job performance, with 88.9% indicating that the training had enhanced their capabilities. This positive outcome suggests that the program was well-designed and aligned with the needs of the public service workforce. 85.71% (2023) and 85.14% in 2024 stated that they have applied the skills. The percentage of respondents who indicated that their current role limits the application of these skills increased from 7.14% in 2023 to 10.71% in 2024, which is a 3.57% increase. The data indicates a substantial positive improvement in the application

of the relevant skill of building teams to meet set goals and objectives. Thus, 67.87% in 2023 and 82.14% in 2024. In 2023, 85.71% of respondents reported that they had started applying the skills learned from the training of managing data service improvements while 2024 saw a decline to 85.18%. There was an increase from 82.14% in 2023 to 89.29% in 2024 of respondents who applied the skills Interpreting and managing conflicts. In terms of the skills of interpreting and managing conflicts there was 82.14% in 2023 and an increase to 89.29% in 2024. From 2023 to 2024, there was a significant increase in the percentage of respondents who reported applying the skills of knowledge management principles, increased from 67.86% to 89.29%. There has been a positive shift in the utilisation of the skill of self-management and development (85.71% in 2023 to 96.43% in 2024). There has been a notable decline in the number of people who initially reported using the skill of analyse, interpret and communicate information, with the figure dropping from 96.43% in 2023 to 89.29% in 2024. There has been an increase in the number of people who are not using the skill of Knowledge of Ethical Principles, Standards & Professional Conduct (96.30% in 2023 and 89.29% in 2024). There has been an increase in percentage in respondents who applied the principles of risk management skills (55.56% in 2023 and 57.14% in 2024). The data indicates an improvement in the utilisation of the learned skill, with application increasing from 71.43% in 2023 to 78.5% in 2024. There was an increase on the utilisation of the formulation & Evaluation of Policies & Regulations skill, increasing from 42.86% in 2023 to 60.71% in 2024. The longitudinal data revealed a positive trend in application of creating opportunities for innovation and lead Projects to meet innovative ideas skill application among the participants (48.15% in 2023 and 55.56% in 2024). In applying the skill of analysing the role of emotional intelligence in leadership there was an increase from (71.43% in 2023 to 85.71% in 2024). There has been an overall positive trend in the application of visionary leadership skills, (74.07% in 2023 to 82.14% in 2024). The vast majority of respondents (88.9%) reported a positive impact from the training on their job performance. However, the survey also identified areas for improvement, including the need for a stronger focus on conflict management, revisions to the assessment process, and better alignment of training content with participants' roles. The recommendations for improvement emphasize the importance of tailoring training to individual needs, incorporating practical assessments, and supporting continuous professional development. These findings highlight the importance of ongoing efforts to refine and optimise training programs to ensure their continued relevance and effectiveness in the public service and professionalisation.

The study concludes that; A significant majority of respondents reported that they had begun applying the skills acquired during the training, particularly in areas such as, knowledge management, and diversity management. This suggests that these sessions of the training were relevant and practical for many participants.

Some participants experienced difficulty in applying certain skills due to their job roles or responsibilities, particularly in areas like risk management and the promotion of innovation. This highlights the importance of aligning training content with participants' current or anticipated roles to ensure the skills can be fully utilised.

The vast majority of respondents reported a positive impact on their job performance as a result of the training, indicating that the program successfully met its objectives of enhancing leadership and administrative capabilities.

Introduction

The Public Service Education and Training Authority (PSETA) embarked on a collaborative initiative with the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC) and the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) to enhance the skills and competencies of public sector officials. This initiative involved a comprehensive training program aimed at employed officials within both government departments and trade unions operating in the public sector. The program, which was a National Certificate in Public Administration Leadership, saw active participation from 60 officials representing a broad spectrum of government entities, trade unions, and councils. Out of these, 51 participants successfully completed the program, reflecting a high level of commitment and engagement.

To evaluate the impact of this training, a longitudinal survey was conducted in two rounds: the first in September 2023 and the second in September 2024. The surveys, administered electronically, aimed to assess the participants' application of the skills acquired during the training and the overall effectiveness of the program. The following sections provide a detailed analysis of the survey distribution, participation rates, sample diversity, and data insights, highlighting key trends and outcomes observed over the course of the study.

Survey Distribution and Participation

The survey distribution and participation rates provide insights into the effectiveness of the training program's longitudinal study. The training, which included 51 participants, saw 33 participants responding to the first round of the survey in September 2023 and 28 participants responding to the second round in September 2024. This represents a response rate of approximately 64.7% in the first round and 54.9% in the second round, indicating a slight decrease in participation over time.

One significant challenge observed was the drop in responses between the first and second rounds, with a 15.2% decrease in participation. This reduction is likely due to the fact that many participants became unreachable as their provided email addresses became inactive. This issue is common in longitudinal studies, where maintaining contact with participants over time can be difficult, especially when participants change jobs, retire, or lose access to the contact information initially provided.

The electronic distribution of the surveys, conducted via an online questionnaire, was effective in facilitating easy access and quick responses.

Sample analysis

Diversity of Roles: The survey captures a wide range of occupations within the public service, from support staff to senior management.

Administrative Predominance: Half of the respondents are in administrative roles, suggesting a strong focus on public administration in the training.

Management Representation: Over a quarter of respondents are in management positions, indicating the training's relevance to leadership roles.

Inclusion of Specialised Roles: The presence of teachers, a radiographer, and union representatives suggests the training's broad applicability across different public sector domains.

Hierarchical Spread: The data includes entries from various levels of the organisational hierarchy, from cleaners to senior managers and heads of departments.

Leadership Focus: The significant proportion of management roles aligns with the "Leadership" component of the certificate.

STUDY FINDINGS

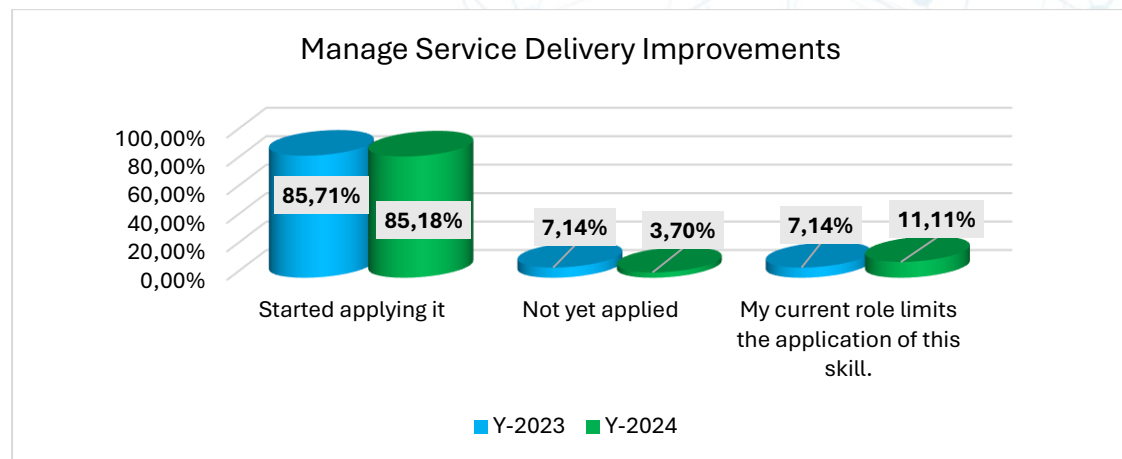


Figure 1: Manage Data Service Improvements

In 2023, 85.71% of respondents reported that they had started applying the skills learned from the training of managing service delivery improvements. However, this percentage decreased to 85.18% in 2024.. This decline might suggest that while some employees who had initially begun applying the skills were unable to sustain their usage over time, potentially due to changing job roles or responsibilities. The percentage of respondents who indicated that their current role limits the application of this skill increased from 7.14% in 2023 to 11.11% in 2024, which is a 3.97% increase. This increase aligns with the observed decrease in the number of employees who reported applying the skills. It suggests that changes in job roles, possibly due to promotions, restructuring, or shifts in responsibilities, might have restricted the opportunity to use these specific skills.

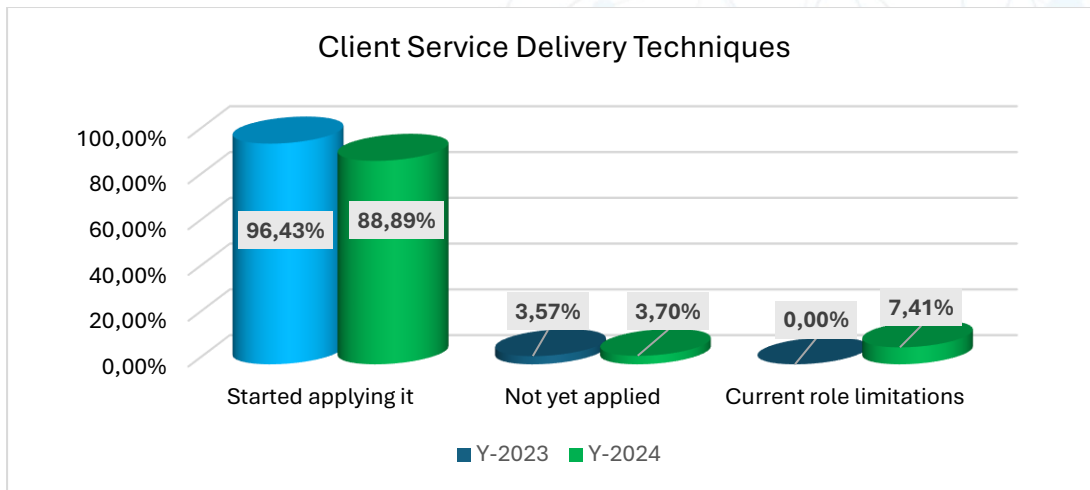


Figure 2: Client Service Delivery Techniques

The data reveals a significant change among employees who initially reported that they had started using the skills acquired during training in 2023. The decrease in the percentage of those applying this skill from 96.43% in 2023 to 88.89% in 2024 (Figure 2), , suggests that some employees have experienced changes in their roles, which now limit their ability to apply the skill. This is further supported by the noticeable increase in the number of respondents who reported that their current role restricted the application of the skills, rising to 7.41% in 2024 from 0% in 2023.

Moreover, another concerning trend is the rise in the percentage of employees who initially reported that they had not yet applied the skills. This figure jumped from 2.57% in 2023 to 7.17% in 2024, indicating that some employees either find the skill less relevant to their current roles or have encountered barriers preventing them from implementing the training in their work environment.

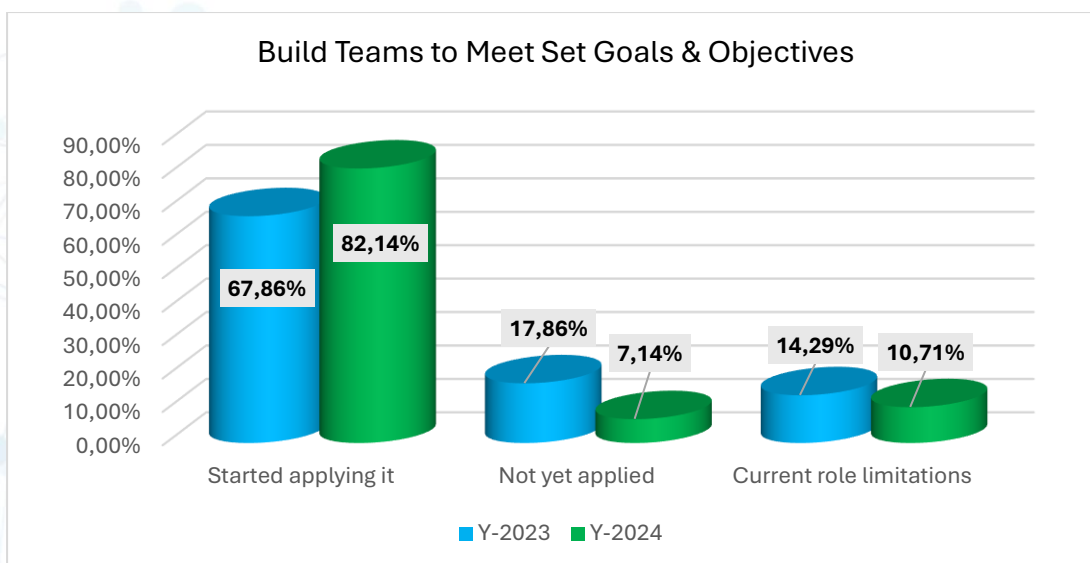


Figure 3: Building teams to meet set goals and objectives.

The data indicates a substantial positive improvement in the application of the relevant skill of building teams to meet set goals and objectives. Thus, 67.87% in 2023 and 82,14% in 2024 (Figure 3) of respondents reported that they had started using the skill. This number has now increased significantly to 82.14 percent - a 14.27 percentage point increase.

This surge in the adoption of the skill is also reflected in the decreased numbers of those who previously had not started using it. Additionally, there has been a decline in the proportion of respondents who initially indicated that their current role limited their ability to apply the skill. The data clearly demonstrates a marked uplift in the utilisation of this skill across the sample population. The substantial shift in these metrics points to meaningful progress in the broader application and integration of this capability.

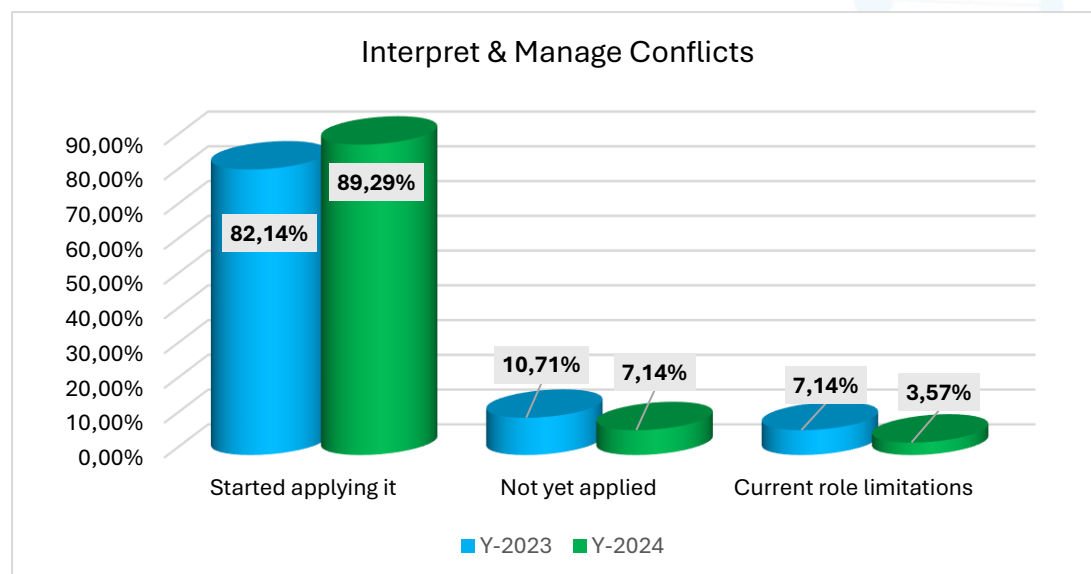


Figure 4: Interpret and manage conflicts

In terms of the skills of interpreting and managing conflicts there was 82.14% in 2023 and an increase to 89.29% in 2024 (Figure 4). The data indicates a positive shift in the application of the skill. There has been a noticeable decrease in the number of respondents who initially reported that they have not yet applied the skill, as well as a decline in those who previously felt that their current role limits their ability to use the skill. This suggests that more employees are now finding ways to integrate the skill into their work, reflecting an overall improvement in its practical application.

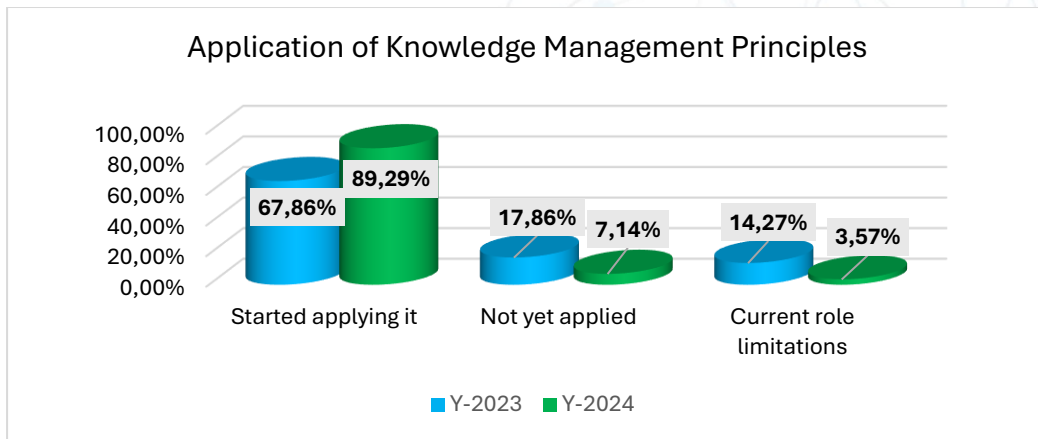


Figure 5: Application of knowledge management principles.

The data reveals a strong positive correlation between the increased application of Knowledge Management Principles and the corresponding decline in respondents who have not yet applied the skill or face role limitations.

From 2023 to 2024, there was a significant rise in the percentage of respondents who reported applying the skills of applying of knowledge management principles, increased from 67.86% to 89.29%, which represents a 21.43% improvement. This indicates that the training is becoming increasingly effective in helping employees integrate these principles into their daily work routines.

Conversely, there was a marked decrease in the number of respondents who had not yet applied the skills, dropping from 17.86% in 2023 to just 7.14% in 2024, a reduction of 10.72%. This suggests that more employees are finding opportunities to utilise the training, possibly due to increased support, better understanding of the principles, or evolving job roles that allow for application.

Additionally, the percentage of employees who felt their current roles limited their ability to apply the skills fell sharply from 14.27% in 2023 to 3.57% in 2024, a decrease of 10.7%. This further underlines the training's success, as it appears that either employees' roles have evolved to better accommodate these skills, or they have found ways to overcome these limitations.

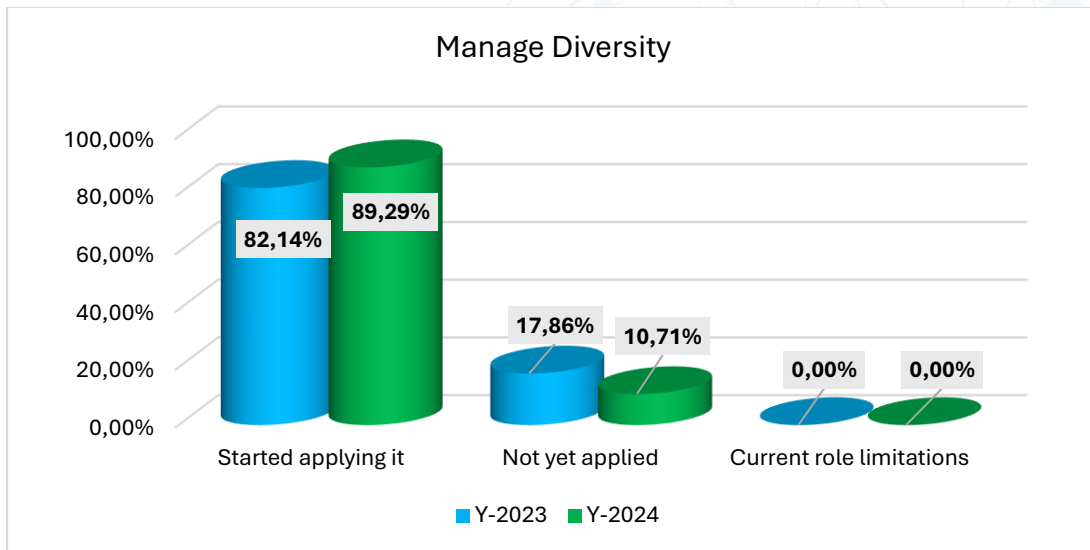


Figure 6: Managing diversity

The data shows a positive trend in the application of diversity management, with an increase from 82.14% in 2023 to 89.29% in 2024 (Figure, 6). This 7.15% increase indicates that more employees are effectively integrating diversity management principles into their work environments.

Correspondingly, there has been a decrease in the percentage of respondents who reported that they have not yet applied the skill, dropping from 17.86% in 2023 to 10.71% in 2024. This 7.15% reduction suggests that the training is becoming more effective in helping employees find opportunities to use these skills, leading to greater overall application.

Furthermore, there is consistency in the data regarding role limitations, with no respondents reporting any role-based barriers to applying diversity management skills in both 2023 and 2024. This suggests that this module was well-aligned with the roles of employees.

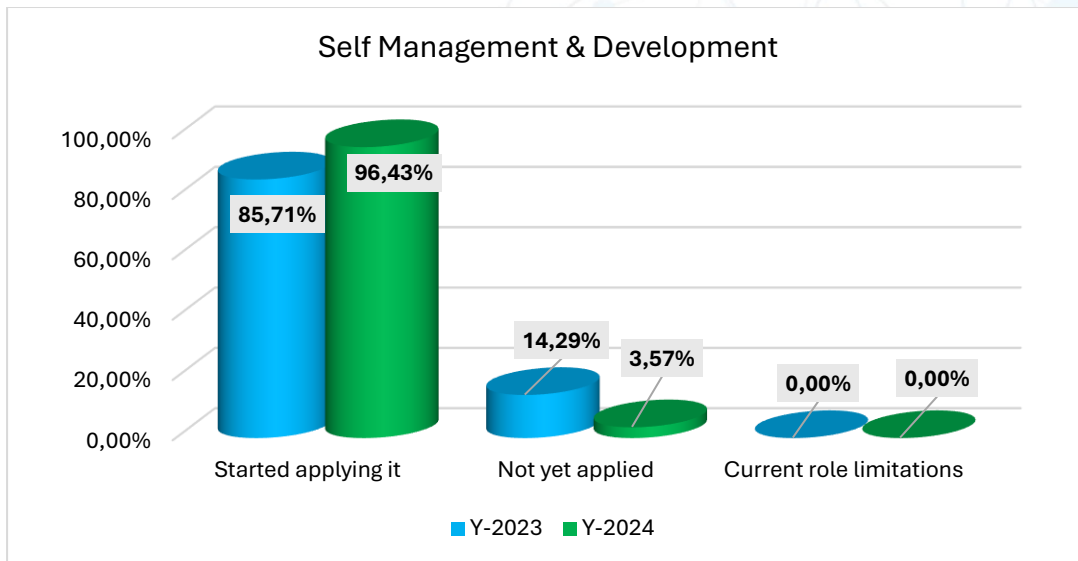


Figure 7: Manage and develop oneself in work environment.

There has been a positive shift in the utilisation of the skill of self-management and development (85.71% in 2023 to 96.43% in 2024). The data shows that only 3.57% of respondents reported that they have not yet applied the skill in their work environment. This indicates a significant improvement in the adoption and practical use of self-management and development skills, demonstrating that the majority of employees are now effectively integrating this skill into their work routines.

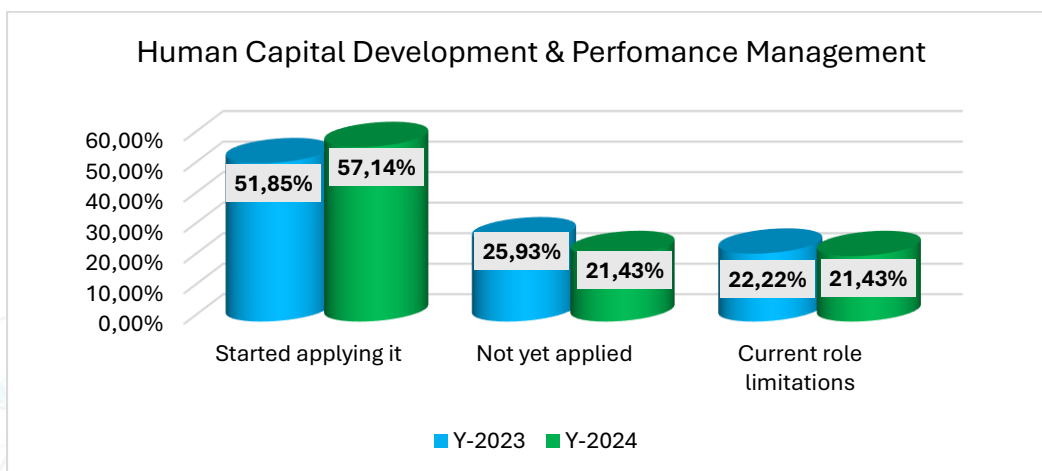


Figure 8: Managing the development and performance of human capital.

Despite a 5.29% increase in the number of respondents who have started applying this skill, there remains a significant 42.86% who have not yet utilised it. The substantial non-application of the skill can be attributed to a large portion of the participants not being in supervisory or management roles, which limits their ability to apply the training effectively.

While there has been a decrease in role limitations, it remains a significant barrier to the full implementation of the skill.

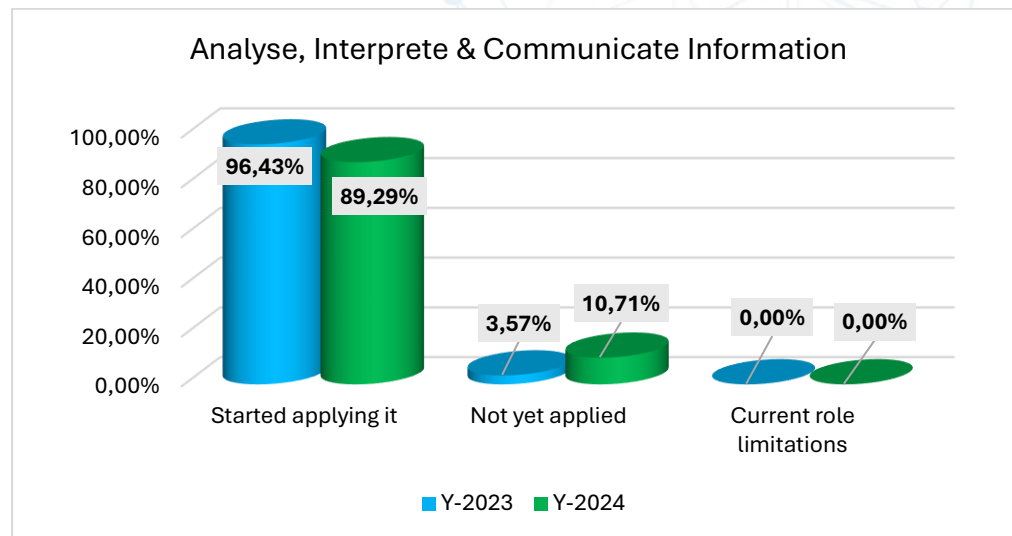


Figure 9: Analyse, interpret and communicate information.

There has been a notable decline in the number of people who initially reported using the skill of analyse, interpret and communicate information, with the figure dropping from 96.43% in 2023 to 89.29% in 2024 (Figure 9). This decrease has led to an increase in the number of individuals who have yet to apply the skill. This shift may be attributed to changes in job roles or responsibilities among some employees who participated in the training. Despite this negative trend, there is still optimism for increased application of the skill, as no respondents reported any role limitations, indicating that the potential for broader adoption remains strong.

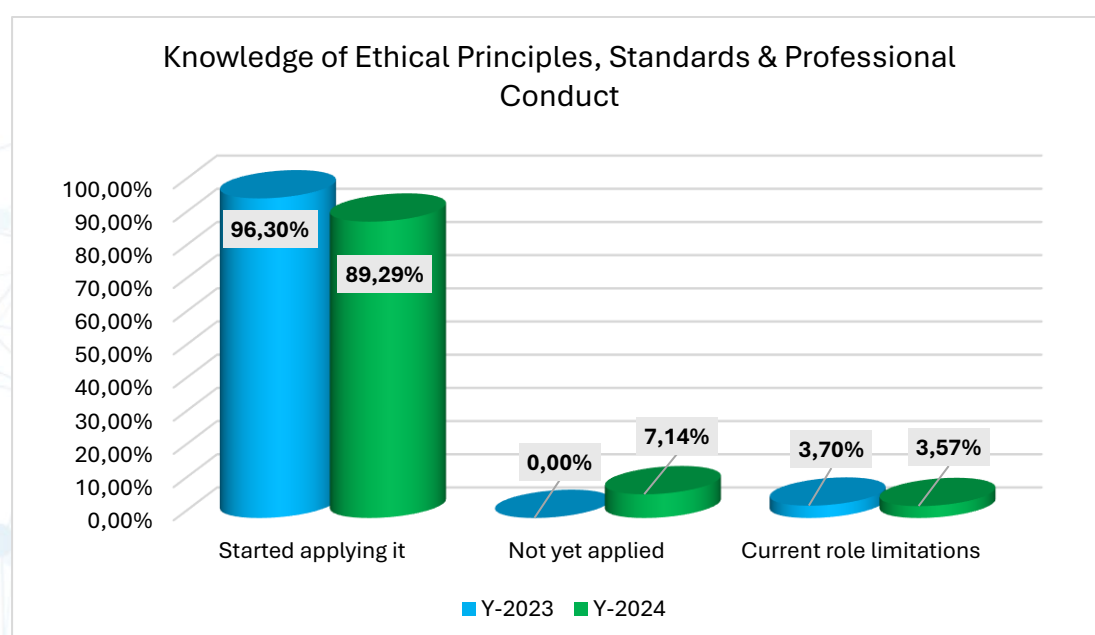


Figure 10: Knowledge of ethical principles, standards and professional conduct.

There has been an increase in the number of people who are not using the skill of Knowledge of Ethical Principles, Standards & Professional Conduct (96.30% in 2023 and 89.29% in 2024, accompanied by a decrease in those who are applying it (Figure 10). This trend may be attributed to individuals who have changed jobs between the two reporting periods, impacting on the utilisation of the skill in their new roles.

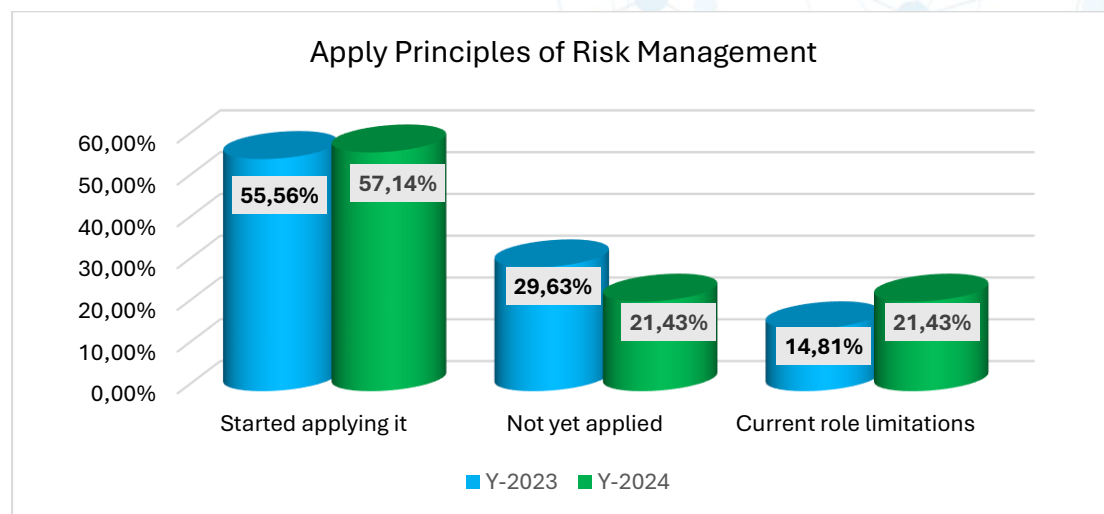


Figure 11: Principles of risk management.

There has been an increase in percentage in respondents who applied the principles of risk management skills (55.56% in 2023 and 57.14% in 2024). The data shows that the current role limitations have increased from 14.81% in 2023 to 21.43% in 2024. This increase may be due to changes in employees' job roles or responsibilities, which have affected their ability to apply the skill. Although there has been a decrease in the number of respondents who reported not yet applying the skill, this reduction does not reflect a genuine increase in skill application. Instead, it is largely attributable to role changes rather than an actual improvement in the application of the skill.

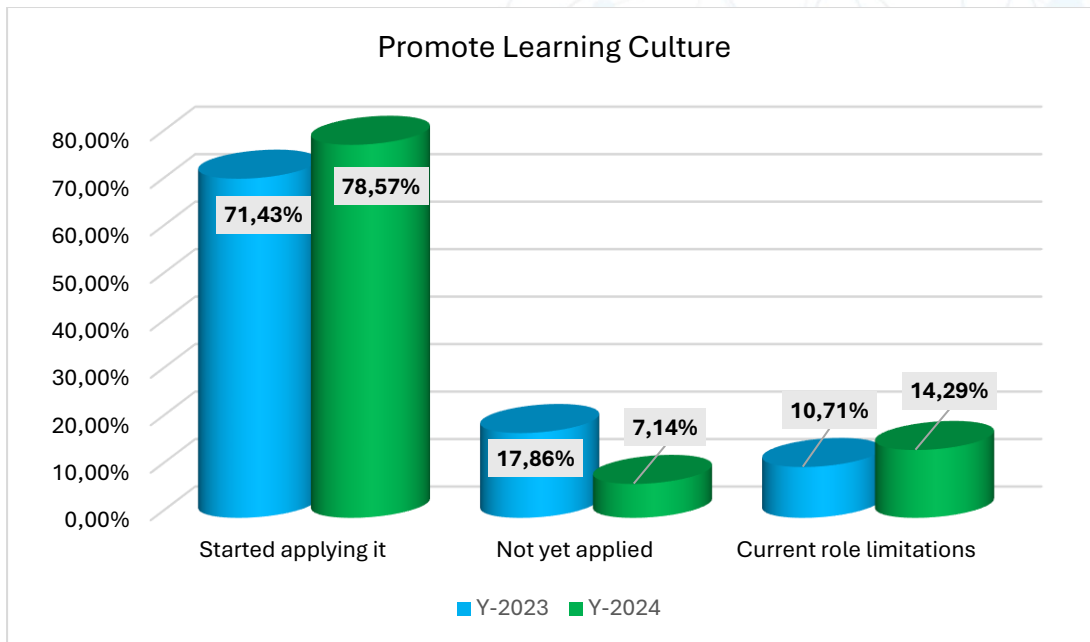


Figure 12: Promoting learning culture

The data indicates an improvement in the utilisation of the learned skill, with application increasing from 71.43% in 2023 to 78.5% in 2024 (Figure 12). This positive change correlates with a decrease in the number of respondents who initially reported "not yet using the skill." However, despite this overall improvement in skill application, there has been an increase in the percentage of respondents reporting role limitations, which may still hinder full utilisation of the skill.

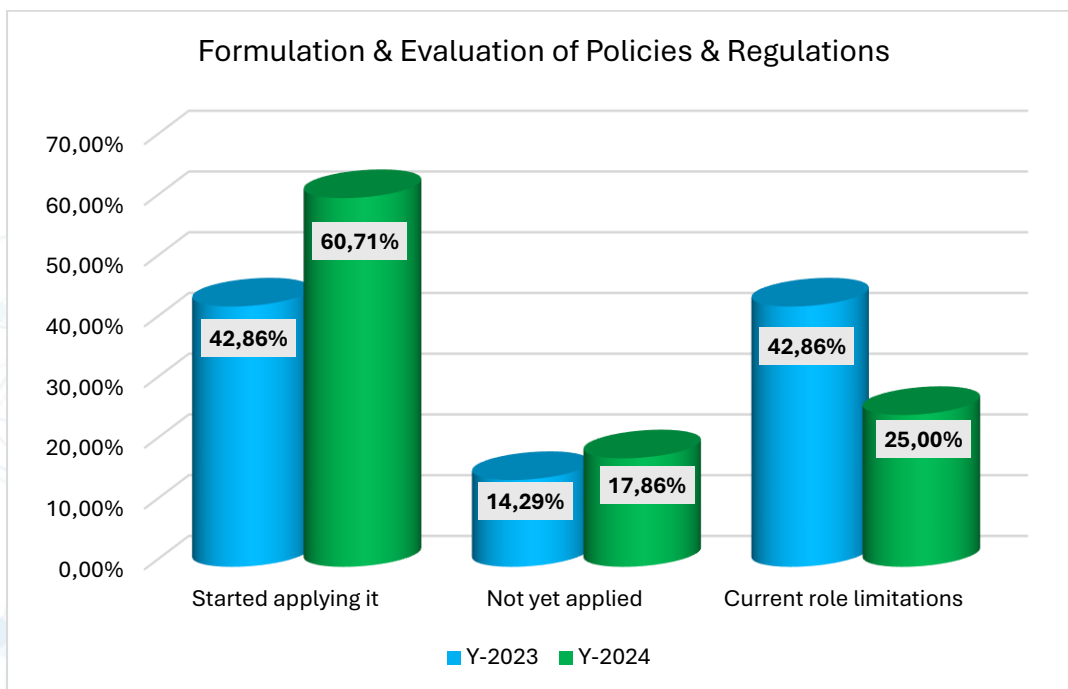


Figure 13: Formulation and evaluation of policies and regulations.

The data shows a significant improvement in the utilisation of skills related to the "Formulation & Evaluation of Policies & Regulations," with the percentage of respondents applying the skill increasing from 42.86% in 2023 to 60.71% in 2024 (Figure 13). This represents an 18.85% increase, indicating a positive trend in the application of this skill within the work environment.

Additionally, the proportion of respondents reporting role limitations has decreased significantly from 42.86% in 2023 to 25.00% in 2024, a reduction of 17.86%. This decrease suggests that fewer employees feel restricted by their current roles in applying the skills, which aligns with the overall improvement in skill utilisation.

Despite these positive changes, it is important to consider that many respondents are likely at lower levels within the organizational hierarchy, which may still limit their ability to implement the skills learned. This hierarchical constraint may explain why, despite improvements, some respondents continue to face challenges in applying the skills.

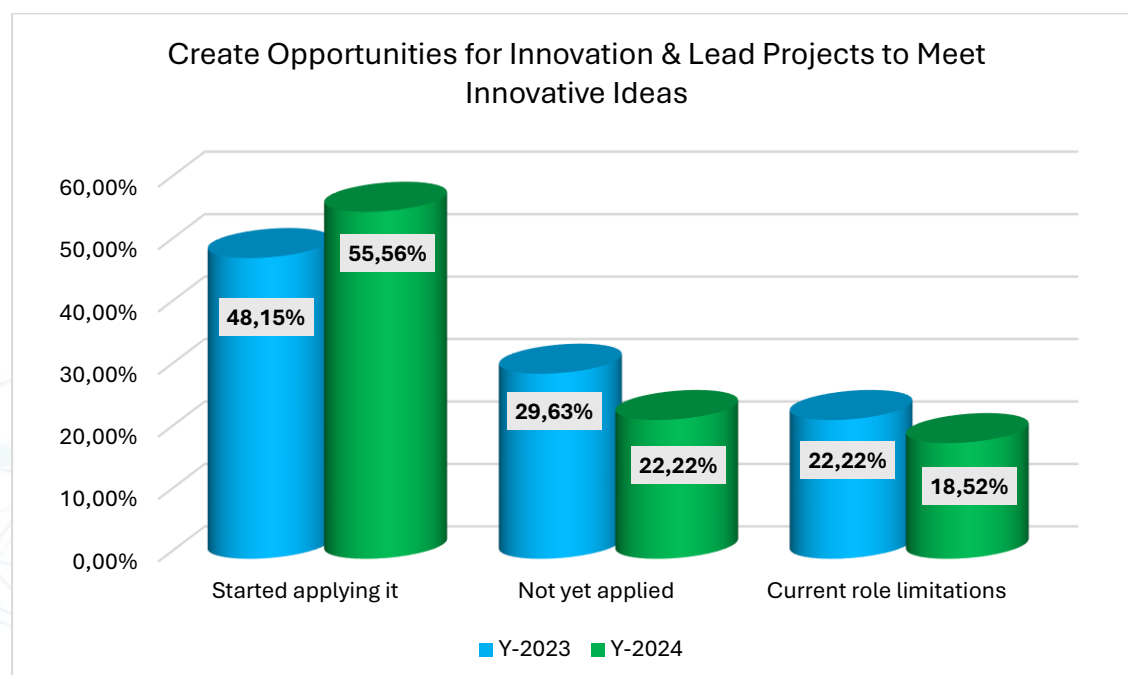


Figure 14: Creating opportunities for innovation and leading projects to meet innovative ideas.

The data presented in the table reflects the participants' progress in applying skills related to "Creating Opportunities for Innovation & Leading Projects to Meet Innovative Ideas".

Overall, the longitudinal data reveals a positive trend in application of creating opportunities for Innovation & Lead Projects to Meet Innovative Ideas skill application among the participants (48.15% in 2023 and 55.56% in 2024), (Figure 14) highlighting the effectiveness of the PSETA Public Administration Leadership Training Programme in fostering innovation and leadership capabilities.

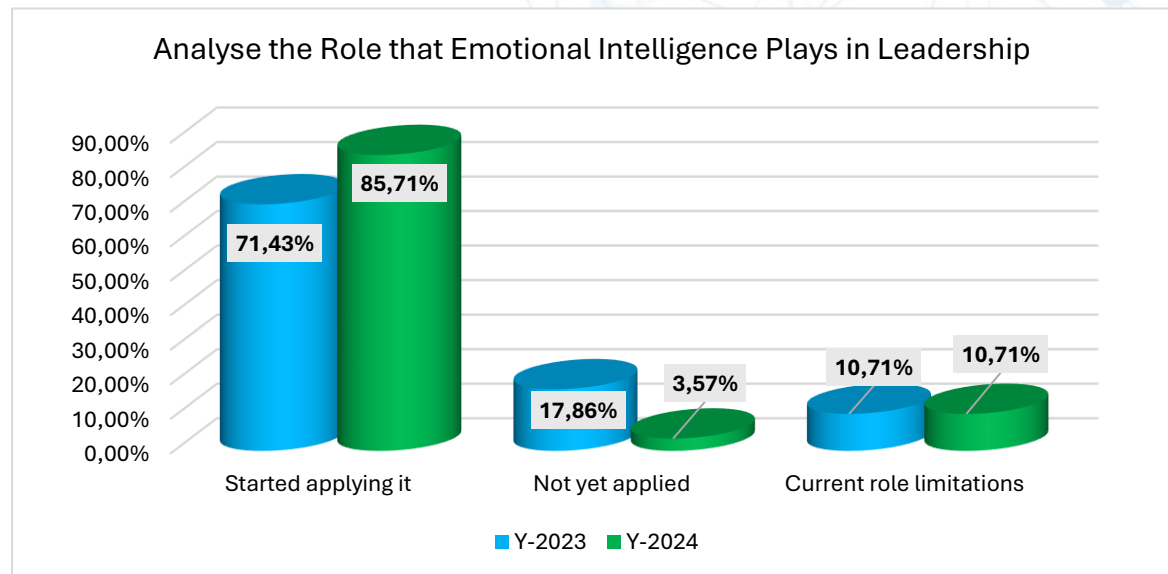


Figure 15: Analysing the role of emotional intelligence in leadership.

Although there has been no change in the reported role limitations for applying the learned skill, there is a decrease in the number of respondents who previously reported not yet applying the skill in their work environments. This shift has resulted in an increase in the percentage of those who are now using the skill (applying the skill of analysing the role of emotional intelligence in leadership (71.43% in 2023 and 85.71% in 2024) (Figure 15).

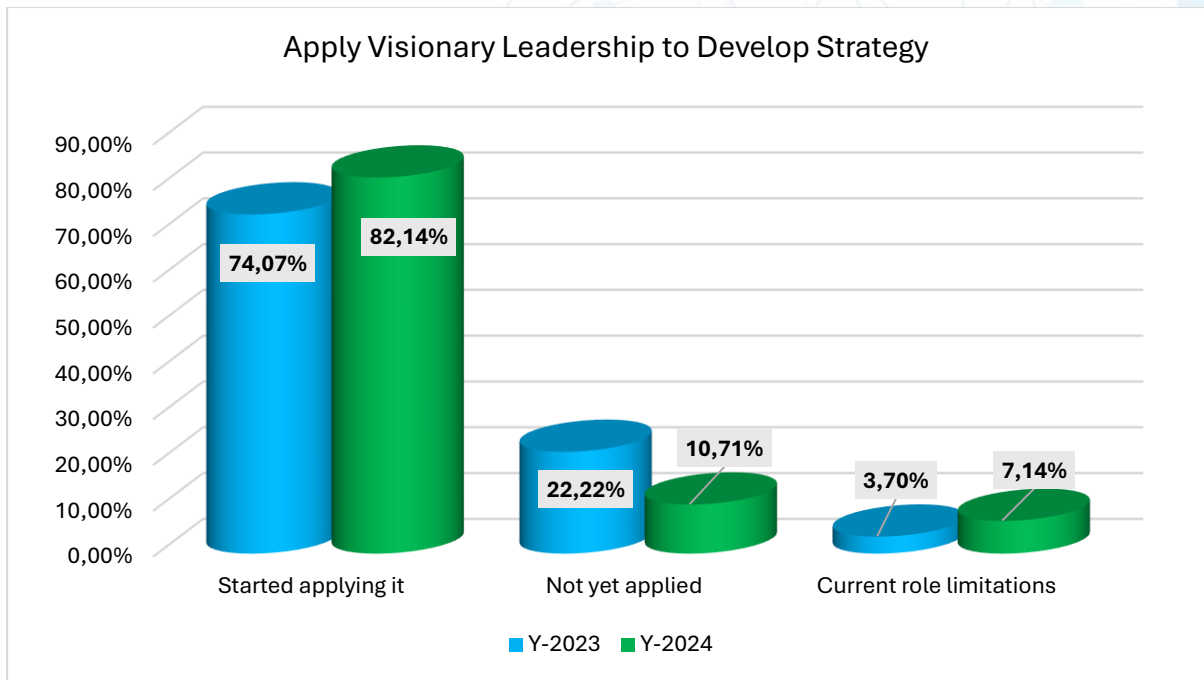


Figure 16: Visionary leadership to develop strategy

The data points to an overall positive trend in the application of visionary leadership skills, (74.07% in 2023 to 82.14% in 2024) as evidenced by the increased percentage of respondents who have started applying the skill (Figure 16). However, the growing number of respondents who feel limited by their current roles suggests that while individual capability is improving, structural or organizational barriers might be preventing full utilisation of the skill.

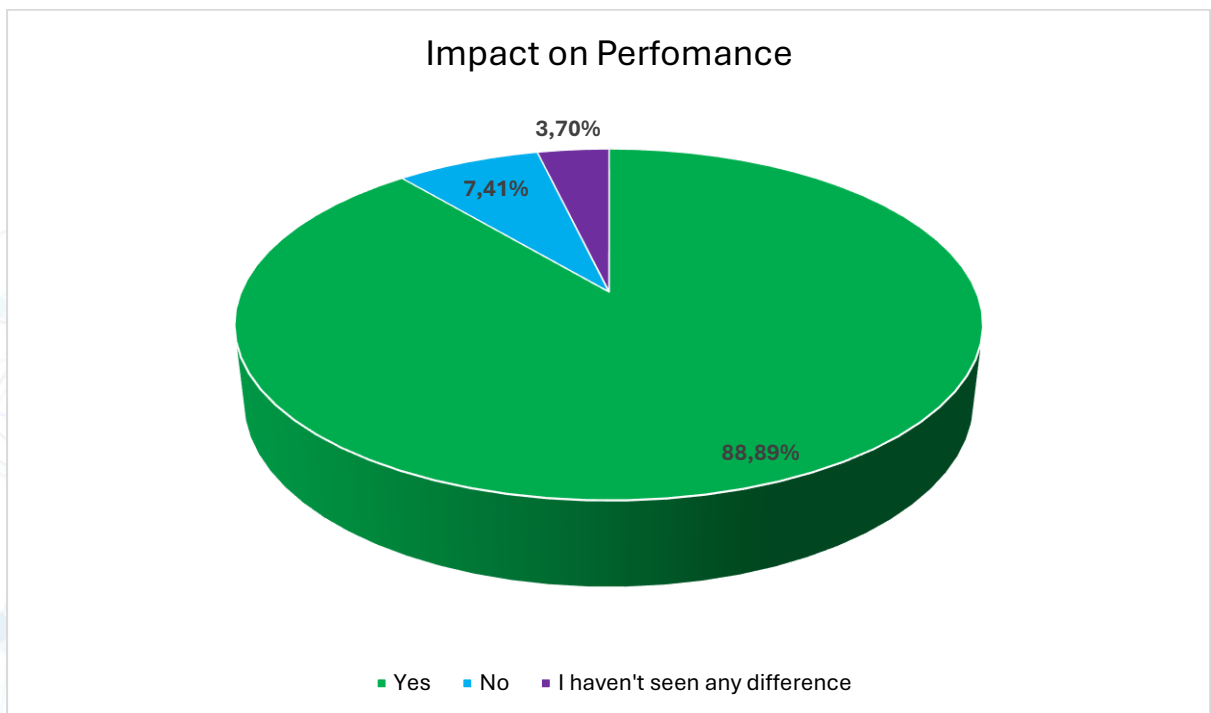


Figure 17: The Training's Impact on Performance

The vast majority of respondents (88.9%) (Figure 17) reported a positive impact from the training on their job performance. This suggests that the curriculum and delivery were effective in equipping participants with the necessary skills. Only 11.1% of respondents reported either no difference or a negative impact. This low percentage indicates that the training was generally well-received and most respondents finding some aspects of it relevant to their roles.

The positive feedback suggests that the training program was well-designed and aligned with the needs of the participants. The curriculum likely covered essential topics and provided practical skills that are directly applicable to the workplace. The improved performance of participants is likely to have a positive impact on their organisations they work for. By developing their leadership and administrative skills, participants are better equipped to contribute to organisational goals and improve efficiency.

Recommendations

The feedback gathered from the survey on program improvement has yielded valuable insights that can significantly enhance the program's effectiveness and better cater to the needs of its participants.

Enhance Focus on Conflict Management: Integrate a module of the conflict management. Some of the respondents felt that the training will be more beneficial if it included training in conflict management.

Review Assessment Process: Consider revising the assessment process by expanding beyond the exclusive use of the Portfolio of Evidence (POE). Explore alternative assessment methods to ensure a more comprehensive evaluation. There was a general complaint on the POE assessment that demands a lot of time from people who have work and family responsibilities.

Covering Comprehensive Content: Respondents acknowledge the excellent coverage of the program but emphasised the need for continuous improvement in content delivery, particularly in areas such as conflict management, leadership training, anti-corruption management, and policy monitoring.

Continuous Professional Development: Implement a continual program structure, ensuring seamless progression to the next National Qualifications Framework (NQF) level, thereby fostering ongoing professional development.

Enhance Assessment Relevance: Modify assessments to include work-based evaluations, ensuring the content's precision and relevance. This shift would move beyond theoretical assessments and provide a more accurate reflection of learners' practical skills.

Incorporate Legislation Analysis: Integrate sessions dedicated to legislation analysis to deepen participants' understanding of the legal frameworks relevant to the program's subject matter.

Time Management: Address concerns about time allocation during sessions. Recognise the workload involved in the course and consider extending session durations to adequately cover the material without compromising depth.

Conclusion

High Engagement and Skill Application: A significant majority of respondents reported that they had begun applying the skills acquired during the training, particularly in areas such as, knowledge management, and diversity management. This suggests that these sessions of the training were relevant and practical for many participants.

Challenges with Role Limitations: Some participants experienced difficulty in applying certain skills due to their job roles or responsibilities, particularly in areas like risk management and the promotion of innovation. This highlights the importance of aligning training content with participants' current or anticipated roles to ensure the skills can be fully utilised.

Positive Impact on Performance: The vast majority of respondents reported a positive impact on their job performance as a result of the training, indicating that the program successfully met its objectives of enhancing leadership and administrative capabilities.

Recommendations

Enhance Alignment of Training Content with Participant Roles

Conduct Pre-Training Needs Assessments: Assess participants' current roles, responsibilities, and career aspirations before designing or updating training modules.

Rationale: Tailoring content to match participants' specific job functions ensures greater relevance and facilitates the practical application of skills learned.

Facilitate Flexible Learning Paths: Allow participants to choose elective modules that best fit their professional needs and interests.

Rationale: Flexibility empowers participants to focus on areas most relevant to their work, increasing engagement and the likelihood of skill application.

Diversify and Enhance Assessment Methods

Incorporate Practical, Work-Based Assessments: Integrate assessments that require participants to apply skills directly within their work environments, such as projects, case studies, and real-life problem-solving tasks.

Rationale: Practical assessments provide a more accurate measure of competency and reinforce the transfer of learning to the workplace.

Support Continuous Professional Development

Establish Progressive Learning Pathways: Create structured pathways that allow participants to progress to higher National Qualifications Framework (NQF) levels upon completion of the program.

Rationale: Ongoing learning opportunities encourage lifelong learning, career advancement, and sustained application of skills.

Optimize Training Delivery and Time Management

Review and Adjust Session Durations: Evaluate and, if necessary, extend the duration of training sessions to ensure comprehensive coverage of material without overwhelming participants.

Rationale: Adequate time allocation allows for in-depth exploration of topics, interactive learning, and better assimilation of knowledge.

Balance Workload and Learning Pace: Distribute the training content evenly over the program duration and incorporate regular breaks and reflection periods.

**PSETA PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION
PROCUREMENT PROGRAM
LEARNER'S WITHDRAWAL
REPORT 2024**



gathered feedback from 11 out of 18 participants who withdrew, aiming to identify strategies for program improvement and to prevent similar situations in the future. The survey findings revealed that participants came from various departments within the public service, with diverse educational backgrounds and motivations for enrolling in the program. The main reasons for program withdrawal included lack of time for coursework, conflict with work projects and deadlines, program structure not being suitable, insufficient support from managers, and illness/personal emergency. The feedback highlighted the struggle to balance program demands with work schedules, indicating the need for flexible learning options, stronger communication, and program design improvements to enhance participant retention.

The participants recommended flexible learning options such as weekend or evening classes, reduced class time, extended deadlines, clear program information, managerial involvement, reduced class frequency, and fewer or consolidated assignments. Implementing these recommendations could create a more accessible and accommodating program for working professionals, ultimately leading to a higher program completion rate and a more skilled public procurement workforce. The key takeaway from the survey is the necessity for a program that caters to individuals with busy schedules, which could be achieved through increased flexibility, reduced workload, and improved communication and transparency.

Introduction

The Public Service Sector Education and Training Authority (PSETA), in collaboration with the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) and the General Public Service Sector Bargaining Council (GPSSBC) offered a public administration procurement program designed to equip public administration employees across South Africa with the necessary skills for effective procurement processes. A total of 193 employees enrolled in the program. However, 18 participants dropped out before or during the program's commencement, resulting in a dropout rate of approximately 9.3%. Recognising the importance of participant retention, the PSCBC conducted a survey to understand the reasons behind these dropouts. While only 11 participants responded, their feedback provides valuable insights.

The Public Administration Procurement Training Programme, launched in July 2023 aimed to build procurement capabilities among public sector employees. However, the program

has faced a concerning dropout rate, with 18 enrolled learners withdrawing before completing the 12-month training.

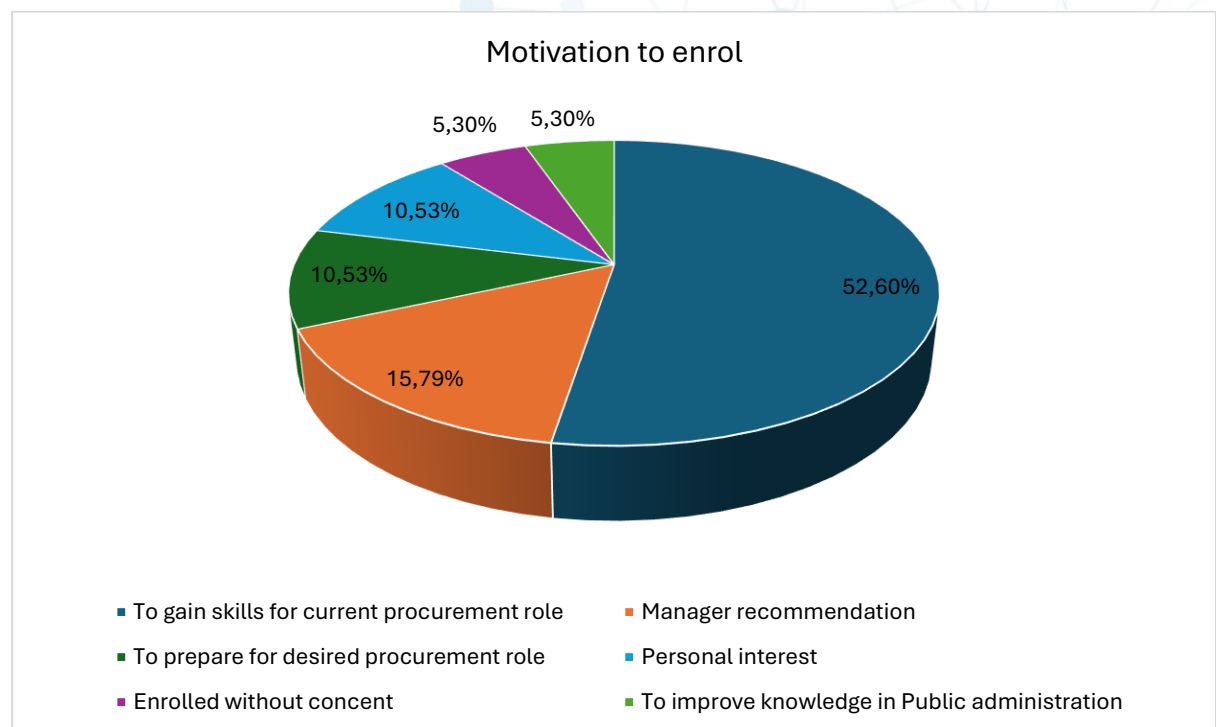
To understand the reasons behind this high attrition and identify areas for improvement, the PSCBC conducted a survey of the 18 learners who had dropped out of the program. The insights gathered from this survey are critical to enhancing participant retention and ensuring the successful completion of the program, which is essential for developing the intended procurement competencies within the public service.

This report presents the findings of the survey, shedding light on the motivations that initially led participants to enrol and their recommendations for improving the structure and delivery of future iterations of the Public Administration Procurement Training Programme. By addressing the key factors contributing to the withdrawal rate, the PSCBC and GPSSBC can implement targeted interventions to increase completion rates and better achieve the program's skill development objectives.

Current qualifications obtained by the respondents.

All participants who withdrawn from the programme possess qualifications ranging from diplomas to master's degrees, all of which are above NQF level 5 of the programme. This suggests that the participants were already highly qualified, and the programme content may have been below their level of expertise or not challenging enough to keep them engaged. Enrolling in a training programme at a lower level than their existing qualifications could have led to a lack of motivation and a decision to withdraw. The participants may have felt that the programme content was not relevant or challenging enough to justify the time and effort required to complete it. The participants come from diverse educational backgrounds, including public management, business management, finance, human resources, and supply chain management. This diverse set of qualifications indicates that the participants may have had different training needs and expectations from the programme.

Motivation for Participants to Enrol in the programme.



Based on the above graph, gaining skills for their current procurement role was the primary motivation for the majority of respondents (52.60%). This indicates that the majority of those who dropped out of the training program were already working in a procurement role and were seeking to develop their skills further.

Manager recommendation was the second highest motivation, accounting for 15.79% of the respondents. This suggests that a significant portion of the participants were encouraged or directed by their managers to enrol in the program.

Preparing for a desired procurement role and personal interest were tied as the third most common motivations, each accounting for 10.53% of the respondents. This indicates that a smaller, but still significant, proportion of the participants were seeking to either advance their careers in procurement or were simply personally interested in the subject matter.

A small percentage of respondents (5.30%) were enrolled without consent, implying that they may have been required to participate in the program rather than doing so voluntarily.

Another 5.30% of respondents were motivated to improve their knowledge in public administration, which suggests the lack of interest once they realised that the programme focus was on procurement rather than general public administration.

Respondent's Expectations from the programme

Changes in the process: Some respondents were interested in the program as they wanted to learn more about the future prospects and changes in the procurement process.

Gaining insights: Several respondents were looking to gain more insights into procurement issues and processes, as well as the overall procurement function, to enhance their knowledge and skills.

Alignment with current qualifications and experience: Respondents mentioned that the program was aligned with their current qualifications and would help boost their knowledge and skills, as they were already working in procurement.

Insufficient support from manager: Respondents cited a lack of support from their manager as a reason for their expectations not being met.

Upskilling and career growth: Respondents expressed that they were expecting the program to improve their knowledge and skills, as well as provide them with a broader understanding of supply chain management, which could potentially assist in their career growth and opportunities.

Professional qualification: A few respondents were specifically looking to be trained on a diploma in procurement, indicating their desire for a more formal and recognized qualification.

Respondent's reasons for withdrawal

Conflict with work projects and deadlines: This was the most commonly cited reason, mentioned by several respondents. It suggests that the programme's demands conflicted with the respondents' job responsibilities, making it difficult for them to balance the workload and meet deadlines. The requirement to attend classes for 5 days every month was not feasible for those with project-based jobs and tight deadlines.

Lack of time for coursework: Another frequently mentioned reason was a lack of time to dedicate to the programme's coursework. This could be due to the respondents' other commitments, such as work, personal responsibilities, or other priorities. The program's workload and deadlines were too demanding, making it difficult to balance their studies with their existing work and personal responsibilities. This was especially challenging for those already enrolled in other academic programs.

Programme structure was not suitable: Some respondents indicated that the programme's structure was not suitable for their needs or circumstances. This could imply that the programme's delivery method, schedule, or content did not align well with the respondents' learning preferences or lifestyle.

Illness/personal emergency: Respondents mentioned a personal emergency or illness as the reason for withdrawing, which suggests that unexpected life events can also lead to program withdrawal.

Concerns about impact on work performance: Respondents mentioned that their managers advised them against participating in the program, as it would not be possible to support their daily work functions if they were to continue with the program.

The responses also provide some additional context:

One respondent is currently studying with MANCOSA, which could indicate that they are pursuing a different educational path.

Another respondent already has an NQF Level 5 in Supply Chain Management, and is interested in pursuing a different qualification, such as a Diploma in Procurement, instead of the program they had initially enrolled in.

Recommendations by respondents

Flexible Learning Options: Participants emphasised the importance of accommodating diverse schedules by offering weekend or evening classes. This would cater to individuals with busy work commitments during weekdays. Additionally, implementing reduced class times could alleviate the time constraints faced by participants, making it more feasible for them to balance their work and study responsibilities. Extending deadlines for assignments emerged as another crucial suggestion, providing participants with more time to effectively manage their workload and ensure quality submissions.

Communication and Transparency: Participants stressed the necessity of clear and comprehensive program information upfront. Ensuring that individuals fully understand the program's content, requirements, and expectations before enrolment can prevent instances of unwitting participation. Moreover, involving managers in discussions about

program participation beforehand can foster their support and understanding, thus facilitating smoother integration of work and study commitments.

Program Design: Recommendations for program design improvements included reducing the frequency of classes from the current five days every month, which could be overwhelming for participants juggling professional and academic responsibilities. Adopting a less frequent class schedule would promote better time management and reduce participant stress levels. Similarly, streamlining assignments by either reducing their number or consolidating them with extended deadlines would help alleviate workload pressure and enhance participants' ability to focus on learning.

Conclusion

The survey revealed that all the participants who withdrew from the programme already possessed qualifications ranging from diplomas to master's degrees, which were above the NQF level 5 of the programme. This suggests the programme content may have been perceived as too basic or not challenging enough to keep these highly qualified individuals engaged.

The most commonly cited reasons for withdrawal were conflicts with work projects/deadlines and lack of time to dedicate to the programme's coursework. This indicates the programme's demands were difficult for participants to balance alongside their existing professional and personal responsibilities.

Some participants found the programme structure, schedule, and delivery methods unsuitable for their needs and circumstances. This implies the programme design may not have been optimally aligned with the learning preferences and lifestyles of the target audience.

Lack of support from managers was cited as one of the reasons for withdrawal suggesting organisational buy-in and encouragement could be an important factor for participant retention. A few participants were interested in pursuing a formal diploma in procurement rather than the current programme, indicating a need to offer more specialised and credential-bearing training options.

A network diagram in the top-left corner featuring a cluster of blue nodes connected by thin, light-blue lines, set against a background of white and light-gray geometric shapes.

CSR IMPACT ASSESSMENT REPORT

A 3D-style graphic of a spiral made of dark blue and white segments, positioned to the right of the title.A network diagram in the bottom-right corner, similar to the one in the top-left, with blue nodes and light-blue connecting lines, set against a background of white and light-gray geometric shapes.

9. CSR IMPACT ASSESSMENT REPORT

Overview

In South Africa, Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is primarily encouraged through the Companies Act of 2008 and the Broad-Based Black Economic Empowerment (B-BBEE) Act. While not a direct legal obligation, the Companies Act requires certain companies to establish social and ethics committees, which monitor and report on CSR-related matters. The B-BBEE Act, along with its Codes of Good Practice, focuses on economic empowerment of historically disadvantaged individuals, effectively integrating social responsibility into business practices.

This impact assessment evaluates the effectiveness and outcomes of PSCBC's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives across four key beneficiary organisations (Gatang High School (2021-2022), Olievenhoutbosch Clinic (2021), Louis Botha Children's Home (2021-2022), and 10th CCC Rehabilitation Centre (2020-2021)).

From 2020-2022 PSCBC's CSR initiatives have successfully addressed genuine community needs through a consultative approach that prioritised stakeholder input over external assumptions, resulting in meaningful improvements in service delivery and beneficiary welfare. The strategic impact spans multiple sectors, with each intervention demonstrating thoughtful alignment between corporate social responsibility objectives and actual community development priorities.

At Gatang High School, the sanitary towels and school shoes initiatives addressed critical barriers to educational participation for high school learners from informal settlements. The intervention served a school population of 2,151 learners from households primarily dependent on social grants, where families consistently prioritised food security over educational and health-related products. The assessment revealed a direct correlation between sanitary towels availability and school attendance, with girl learners frequently missing school during menstruation, the provision of sanitary towels increased attendance and confidence in learners. The school developed a systematic distribution framework to maintain confidentiality and reduce stigma while enhancing learner dignity and confidence through provision of essential hygiene products and appropriate school footwear.

However, current depletion of resources highlights ongoing sustainability challenges and emphasises the cyclical nature of these needs, requiring consideration of long-term support mechanisms rather than one-time interventions.

The Olievenhoutbosch Clinic, serving approximately 400 patients daily, experienced significant operational improvements through medical equipment and supply donations made by the PSCBC. Enhanced operational efficiency resulted from blood pressure machines donated that addressed critical equipment shortages, while health crisis response capability was demonstrated through timely Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) provision during COVID-19, supporting healthcare service continuity when public healthcare systems faced unprecedented strain. Healthcare professional support was strengthened through the provision of stethoscopes donations that addressed fundamental clinical practice needs for 16 nurses and 3 doctors who had previously been sharing limited equipment. This improved access to primary health care and timely referrals. However, the intervention revealed ongoing equipment needs with clear specifications for sustainable support.

Louis Botha Children's Home, serving 90-95 vulnerable children with only 40% government funding coverage, benefited from comprehensive renovation of House No. 8 that addressed critical infrastructure needs. Structural improvements including roof repairs, gutter installation, window replacement, and exterior repainting enhanced living conditions for children removed from homes due to abuse, neglect, or parental absence. However, assessment limitations due to documentation gaps and personnel accessibility highlighted the need for improved evaluation mechanisms in future CSR initiatives. The evaluation identified ongoing challenges in exterior maintenance, representing the facility's most persistent infrastructure needs and suggesting opportunities for continued partnership focused on areas where the organization can make the most significant long-term impact.

The 10th CCC Rehabilitation Centre demonstrated the sustainability and lasting impact of infrastructure investments three years post-implementation. Transformative facility upgrades including warm water shower systems, mattresses, blankets, and tile installation created an enhanced rehabilitation environment that contributed to dignified living conditions and improved recovery outcomes for the beneficiaries. The skills development partnership enabled expanded training programs and job placement support, reflecting a comprehensive approach that addresses immediate needs while building long-term

capacity for both individual success and institutional sustainability. The continued benefit to new resident cohorts validates the wisdom of infrastructure investment over consumable resources, demonstrating how strategic CSR interventions can create lasting foundations for community development.

The assessment validates PSCBC's strategic approach to community engagement through needs-responsive methodology that ensures maximum effectiveness and sustainability. Key sustainability insights reveal the cyclical nature of needs requiring ongoing support rather than one-time interventions, particularly for consumable items, while infrastructure investments provide lasting benefits that serve multiple beneficiary cohorts over extended periods.

Future CSR strategy should maintain the consultative approach to needs assessment, ensuring interventions address actual needs rather than assumed community requirements. Infrastructure development should be prioritised based on demonstrated sustained impact. While sustainability frameworks address the cyclical nature of immediate needs, they should be based on building long-term change. The comprehensive nature of positive outcomes documented across all beneficiaries, positions PSCBC for a continued meaningful community engagement and expanded social impact through strategic CSR initiatives that address both immediate needs and contribute to sustainable community development.

Introduction

The Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) serves as a cornerstone of South Africa's public service labour relations, facilitating negotiations between government as an employer and public service unions. While its primary mandate centres on facilitating negotiations and promoting workplace harmony, the PSCBC has embraced a broader social responsibility through meaningful Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives that extend far beyond its traditional role.

These CSR programs represent the PSCBC's deep commitment to addressing South Africa's most pressing social challenges, particularly those affecting vulnerable and marginalised communities. The organisation has developed targeted interventions that tackle a wide spectrum of issues, from educational barriers and healthcare access to substance abuse recovery and social welfare support. This comprehensive approach

demonstrates the PSCBC's understanding that sustainable community development requires addressing multiple interconnected challenges simultaneously, rather than focusing on isolated problems.

The scope of PSCBC's social investment encompasses several critical areas of need. In the educational sphere, the organisation has recognised that seemingly, basic needs can create significant barriers to learning. Their donations of sanitary towels addressed the menstrual hygiene challenges that often force disadvantaged girl learners to miss school, while the provision of school shoes supported consistent attendance and performance in under-resourced educational institutions. These institutions acknowledged that dignity and basic necessities are fundamental prerequisites for educational success.

In healthcare support and social welfare, the PSCBC has strengthened community infrastructure through strategic donations of medical equipment and supplies to a local clinic, recognising that accessible healthcare forms the foundation of thriving communities. Their commitment to the most vulnerable is further demonstrated through orphanage refurbishment projects that improve living conditions for children who have lost their primary support systems. Additionally, the organisation has invested in infrastructure upgrades and skills development programs at drug rehabilitation facilities, understanding that successful recovery requires both immediate support and long-term reintegration opportunities.

This impact evaluation examines the tangible outcomes of these initiatives across four key beneficiary institutions that exemplify the breadth and effectiveness of PSCBC's community engagement. Gatang High School in Mamelodi, with its 2,091 learners, serves as a testament to the educational impact of these programs. The school's 1,056 female learners have directly benefited from sanitary towels donations, while the broader student population has gained improved access to education through school shoes donations that removed practical barriers to consistent attendance.

The healthcare support of PSCBC's was recognised at Olievenhoutbosch Community Clinic, a critical healthcare access point that serves approximately 400 patients daily. Through equipment and healthcare supplies donations, the PSCBC has enhanced the clinic's capacity to deliver quality healthcare to an underserved community, demonstrating how strategic investments can amplify the reach and effectiveness of existing healthcare infrastructure.

The organisation's commitment to children's welfare is exemplified through its support of Louis Botha Children's Home, which provides care and stability for 92 to 95 orphaned children during their most formative years. The PSCBC's refurbishment initiatives have created a more nurturing environment for these vulnerable young people.

Finally, the 10th Commandment Community Care Centre in Tembisa represents the PSCBC's engagement with substance abuse recovery, one of South Africa's most complex social challenges. This rehabilitation facility focuses on helping young men overcome dependency, and during the evaluation period, it was supporting 32 males aged 18-35 in their recovery journey. The PSCBC's infrastructure improvements and skills development support initiative has enhanced the facility's capacity to provide not just rehabilitation services, but also the practical skills necessary for successful reintegration into the society.

Through these diverse initiatives, the PSCBC has demonstrated that effective corporate social responsibility transcends traditional charitable giving. Instead, the approach created sustainable, community-driven solutions that address root causes of social challenges while building local capacity for long-term development. This evaluation seeks to measure not just the immediate impacts of these interventions, but their potential for creating lasting positive change in the communities they serve.

Objectives of the Evaluation

The primary objectives of this impact evaluation are as follows:

1. **Assess the Impact:** To determine the extent to which PSCBC's CSR projects have achieved their intended outcomes in terms of community development, empowerment, and improved standards of living.
2. **Evaluate Sustainability:** To understand the sustainability of the impacts, particularly focusing on infrastructure, resources, and skills enhancement provided by PSCBC.
3. **Gather Stakeholder Feedback:** To capture the experiences and feedback from stakeholders, including beneficiaries, school and clinic management, and rehabilitation centre staff.
4. **Identify Areas for Improvement:** To provide actionable insights to enhance the design, implementation, and reach of future PSCBC CSR initiatives.

Methodology

The evaluation employed a qualitative research approach utilizing in-depth interviews with key informants. Key informants comprised management personnel from the facilities under review. This methodology was selected to gather comprehensive insights and detailed perspectives from individuals with direct operational knowledge and decision-making authority within the evaluated facilities.

Evaluation Technique

Interview Arrangements: Appointments were scheduled with targeted respondents at locations of their preference. This approach was adopted to ensure participants felt comfortable and relaxed in familiar environments, thereby encouraging openness and willingness to engage with comprehensive questioning.

Interview Setting: By conducting interviews at respondent-selected venues, we aimed to create an atmosphere conducive to honest and detailed responses, recognising that environmental comfort significantly impacts the quality of data collected.

Language Accommodation: Participants were encouraged to respond in their preferred language to ensure precise communication and enable authentic self-expression. This multilingual approach was implemented to eliminate potential language barriers that could compromise response accuracy or participant comfort.

This approach was designed to maximize data quality by prioritising respondent comfort, accessibility, and authentic communication, thereby facilitating comprehensive exploration of the research objectives.

Limitations and Challenges

This impact assessment faced several methodological and logistical constraints that affected the comprehensiveness and efficiency of the evaluation process. While the research team successfully engaged with key stakeholders through semi-structured interviews across four sites, the data collection process was significantly hampered by challenges in securing appropriate interview schedules with key informant stakeholders. This scheduling difficulty had a cascading effect on the overall timeline of the study, requiring substantially more time than initially anticipated to coordinate meetings and resulting in frequent postponements that disrupted the planned research schedule.

The variability in stakeholder cooperation presented additional methodological challenges, particularly regarding the recording of interview sessions. Although three of the four site managers consented to audio recording of their interviews, which facilitated accurate transcription and comprehensive data analysis, one manager declined to be recorded, necessitating reliance solely on handwritten notes during the interview process..

Furthermore, the evaluation was constrained by insufficient preliminary information regarding the specific CSR initiatives implemented at each site. This knowledge gap posed significant challenges for the research evaluators, who required more detailed insights into the programs under assessment to develop more targeted evaluation frameworks and strengthen the overall data collection process. The lack of comprehensive background information about the initiatives limited the evaluators' ability to formulate more precise questions. Despite these limitations, the site visitations did facilitate valuable observational opportunities and helped establish rapport and trust with managers within their operational environments, which partially mitigated some of the information constraints encountered during the study.

Evaluation Findings

Gatang High School CSR Interventions

Background and Context

PSCBC has demonstrated its commitment to expanding contributions through impactful Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives designed to support vulnerable and marginalised communities. The organisation's strategic focus encompasses addressing critical social issues while contributing to sustainable community development, with particular attention to youth, young women, the elderly, and orphans. This mission reflects a comprehensive understanding of the interconnected nature of social challenges and the need for targeted interventions that address both immediate needs and long-term development objectives.

Gatang High School serves as a critical educational institution within a predominantly disadvantaged community in Mamelodi, catering to learners from informal settlements that represent one of South Africa's most vulnerable demographic segments. Most of the parents who are the residents of the informal settlement are unemployed and also the majority are involved in informal businesses or rely on social grants. The institution

operates within the constraints of limited resources while striving to provide quality education to learners from poverty-stricken backgrounds. The school's position within this community context makes it an ideal partner for CSR initiatives aimed at addressing systemic challenges that affect educational outcomes and learner development.

PSCBC implemented targeted donations to Gatang High School, specifically providing sanitary towels and school shoes to **2,096** learners . This intervention was designed to address immediate needs while supporting educational continuity and learner dignity within the school environment. The strategic nature of these donations reflects an understanding of the specific challenges faced by learners from disadvantaged backgrounds, particularly the intersection of poverty and gender-specific needs that can significantly impact educational access and outcomes.

Community Profile and Socioeconomic Context

The survey revealed a complex socioeconomic landscape that significantly influences educational outcomes and learner development within the Gatang High School community. The majority of learners originate from informal settlements, representing communities characterised by limited access to basic services, inadequate infrastructure, and persistent poverty that affects all aspects of daily life. This demographic profile creates specific challenges that extend beyond the school environment.

Most households rely on social grants as their primary income source, creating a financial environment where every expenditure requires careful consideration and prioritisation. Families consistently prioritise food security over other necessities such as educational supplies, clothing, or health-related products, making it difficult to resources allocation. This economic reality creates a situation where learners may lack basic educational and health necessities that are taken for granted in more affluent communities, directly impacting their ability to fully participate in educational activities.

Sanitary Towel Initiative

The sanitary towel initiative represents one of the most critical components of PSCBC's intervention at Gatang High School. The evaluation confirmed that sanitary towels was a relevant initiative that constituted a fundamental necessity within the school, with their availability directly correlating with educational access and learner dignity. The PSCBC initiative for supporting with sanitary towels to 1,056 girl learners was aligned with the needs of the school for the learners' educational development outcome. The intersection

of poverty and gender-specific needs creates a complex challenge that extends beyond simple product provision to encompass broader issues of educational equity and learner development.

The administration of sanitary towels within the school environment demonstrates a thoughtful approach to addressing sensitive needs while maintaining learner dignity. The school has developed a systematic storage and distribution system that allows learners to request products as needed while ensuring confidentiality and reducing stigma associated with menstruation. This administrative framework reflects the school's understanding of the importance of these products for maintaining educational continuity and learner comfort.

The educational impact of sanitary towels availability extends far beyond simple product provision. The evaluation documented significant correlations between product availability and school attendance, with learners frequently requesting early release or missing school entirely during menstruation when products were unavailable. This pattern created cumulative educational disadvantage, as irregular attendance directly impacted academic progress and achievement. The psychological and social effects were equally significant, with learners experiencing reduced confidence and self-esteem during menstruation, affecting their classroom participation and overall educational experience.

Teachers within the school have recognised the critical nature of this need and have responded by providing personal financial support during shortages. This demonstrates the severity of the need to supporting learner welfare. However, it also highlights the unsustainable nature of relying on individual teacher contributions to address systemic community needs.

The current status assessment reveals a concerning depletion of sanitary towels resources, with the school having no stock available at the time of the evaluation. This situation has necessitated a return to the challenging conditions that existed before the PSCBC intervention, with learners once again facing barriers to educational participation during menstruation. The depletion of resources highlights the ongoing nature of this need and the importance of considering sustainability in CSR intervention design.

School Shoe Initiative Assessment

The school shoe initiative addresses another critical need within the learner community, though the nature of this challenge differs from the sanitary towel situation. Despite the

previous donation, the school shoes challenge remains persistent due to the natural wear and tear cycle of footwear. The evaluation revealed that shoes naturally deteriorated over time, creating ongoing replacement needs that extend beyond the initial donation period.

Parental inability to purchase replacement shoes creates a continuous challenge for the school community. The evaluation documented frequent requests from parents for permission to allow learners to wear non-prescribed shoes, reflecting the financial constraints that prevent families from purchasing appropriate school footwear. This situation requires ongoing negotiation between maintaining school standards and accommodating family economic realities.

The school's response to shoes' needs demonstrates a thoughtful approach to resource allocation based on individual learner circumstances. The needs-based distribution system allows for priority allocation to learners with the greatest need while considering family financial capacity. This approach maximizes the impact of available resources while ensuring that the most vulnerable learners receive appropriate support.

Teachers continue to provide personal financial contributions to address shoe needs, similar to their response to sanitary towel shortages. This pattern reflects the deep commitment of educational professionals to learner welfare while highlighting the ongoing nature of poverty-related challenges within the school community. The persistence of this need despite previous donations underscores the importance of considering replacement cycles and sustainability in intervention design.

Infrastructure and Environmental Challenges

The evaluation identified significant infrastructure challenges that compound the educational difficulties faced by learners at Gatang High School. The sanitation infrastructure represents a critical concern, with only two functional toilets serving the entire school population of **2151**. This limitation created practical challenges for learners while also affecting educational time through queue formation and facility access difficulties.

The impact of inadequate sanitation facilities extends beyond simple inconvenience to affect learner dignity, comfort, and educational engagement. The formation of queues during class time results in lost learning opportunities and can create additional stress for learners who must balance biological needs with educational participation. This

infrastructure challenge particularly affects female learners, who may require additional privacy and time for personal care.

Transportation barriers represent another significant challenge affecting educational access within the Gatang High School community. Many learners reside in considerable far distances from the school, with limited public transportation options available. The Department of Basic Education faces capacity constraints that limit their ability to provide school transportation services, despite the high number of learners requiring such support. This situation creates daily challenges for learners and families, potentially affecting attendance and educational continuity.

The combination of infrastructure limitations and geographic barriers creates a cumulative effect that can significantly impact educational outcomes. Learners must navigate multiple challenges daily to access education, from transportation difficulties to inadequate facilities once they arrive at school. These environmental factors interact with poverty-related challenges to create complex barriers to educational success.

Stakeholder Perspectives and Response

School administration perspectives provide valuable insights into the intervention's impact and the broader community context. School representative demonstrated clear recognition of PSCBC's meaningful contribution to addressing critical community needs. Their acknowledgment of the intervention's alignment with priority needs validated the strategic approach taken by PSCBC in identifying and addressing specific challenges within the school community.

The professional insights provided by school administrators reveal an understanding of community requirements and intervention sustainability. Their identification of ongoing challenges reflects realistic assessment of the intervention's long-term effectiveness while maintaining appreciation for the initial support provided. This balanced perspective provides valuable guidance for future intervention design and implementation.

The school principal's perspectives offer ground-level insights into the daily impact of the intervention on learner welfare and educational outcomes. Educators consistently demonstrated personal investment in addressing learner needs, providing financial contributions from their own resources to supplement organisational donations. This response reflects both professional commitment and recognition of the intervention's importance for learners' development.

Strategic Implications and Future Considerations

The evaluation findings present significant strategic implications for PSCBC's ongoing CSR initiatives and community engagement approach. The validation of intervention effectiveness provides strong support for continued investment in similar communities while highlighting opportunities for enhanced sustainability and expanded impact.

Conclusion

The comprehensive impact assessment of PSCBC's CSR initiative at Gatang High School demonstrates significant positive outcomes while highlighting opportunities for enhanced sustainability and expanded impact. The intervention successfully addressed genuine community needs, created meaningful improvements in learner welfare and educational outcomes, and established foundations for ongoing community engagement. The validation of intervention effectiveness provides strong support for continued investment in similar communities while informing strategic enhancements for future initiatives.

The strategic opportunities identified through the evaluation present compelling possibilities for PSCBC's continued community engagement. The development of sustainable support mechanisms, strategic partnerships for resource sharing, and comprehensive community development approaches could significantly enhance the long-term impact of CSR initiatives. The potential for intervention model replication and scaling represents significant opportunities for expanding positive impact across multiple communities.

The organisational alignment between evaluation findings and PSCBC's CSR mission validates the strategic approach taken in engagement while highlighting opportunities for continued innovation and development. The analysis confirms that the initial intervention created significant positive change while establishing foundations for sustained community partnership and development.

Olievenhoutbosch Clinic CSR Initiatives

Contextual Framework and Community Impact

The Olievenhoutbosch Clinic serves as a vital healthcare hub for a substantial community, providing medical services to approximately 400 patients daily. This high patient volume underscores the clinic's critical role in the local healthcare. The PSCBC's CSR initiatives

must therefore be evaluated not merely as isolated donations, but as interventions that extends through the entire community, affecting hundreds of individuals daily who depend on the clinic's services.

The clinic's management emphasised that Olievenhoutbosch represents a large community with substantial healthcare needs, making any enhancement to the facility's capabilities particularly impactful. This context is crucial for understanding why seemingly modest donations have generated disproportionately positive outcomes. In resource-constrained healthcare environments, strategic investments in basic equipment and supplies can dramatically improve service delivery efficiency and patient care quality.

Medical Equipment Impact and Operational Efficiency

The donation of blood pressure machines has emerged as perhaps the most transformative aspect of the PSCBC's intervention. The clinic's management specifically noted that the automatic blood pressure machines provided significant relief during periods of equipment shortage, directly addressing a critical operational bottleneck. With 13 consultation rooms and a daily patient load of 400 individuals, the availability of sufficient blood pressure monitoring equipment directly linked with reduced waiting times and improved patient flow.

The impact extends beyond mere convenience to fundamental healthcare delivery quality. When healthcare professionals must share limited equipment across multiple consultation rooms, it creates inefficiencies throughout the day, leading to extended waiting periods and potentially compromised patient care. The PSCBC's donation of automatic blood pressure machines addressed this challenge by enabling more consultation rooms to operate independently, thereby improving the clinic's overall capacity.

However, the assessment also reveals the ongoing nature of healthcare infrastructure needs. While the donated blood pressure machines provided temporary relief, the clinic management indicated that these machines have since reached the end of their operational life, highlighting the cyclical nature of equipment needs in healthcare facilities.

Personal Protective Equipment and Crisis Response

The timing of the PSCBC's Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) donations coincided with the COVID-19 pandemic, demonstrating the organisation's responsiveness to emerging community needs. The clinic management explicitly acknowledged that the face masks and sanitizers were "very useful" during the COVID-19 period, when there were frequent

shortages of such materials. This intervention illustrates how strategic CSR initiatives can provide critical support during crisis periods when public healthcare systems face unprecedented strain.

The PPE donations represent more than material support; they reflect the PSCBC's understanding of healthcare workers' protection needs during a global health emergency. By ensuring that healthcare professionals had adequate protective equipment, the CSR initiative contributed to maintaining healthcare service continuity during a period when many healthcare facilities faced staffing challenges due to COVID-19 exposure risks.

Healthcare Professional Support

The donation of shoes, jackets, and stethoscopes addresses often-overlooked aspects of healthcare worker support. The clinic management stated that *"there is nothing we can say they did not make any difference, or not important, especially the jackets in winter are useful"* revealing the meaningful impact of these seemingly basic items on healthcare worker comfort and professional dignity.

The stethoscope donation addresses a critical shortage that affects fundamental clinical practice. With 16 professional nurses and 3 doctors sharing limited stethoscopes, the clinic faced a situation where healthcare professionals could not operate with the basic tools necessary for patient assessment. The PSCBC's stethoscope donation provided partial relief, though the clinic management indicated that ideally, each healthcare professional should have their own stethoscope to ensure optimal patient care and equipment longevity.

This aspect of the CSR initiative demonstrates understanding that healthcare quality depends not only on facility infrastructure but also on ensuring that healthcare professionals have the personal equipment necessary to perform their duties effectively. The sharing of stethoscopes, while necessary due to resource constraints, can compromise both hygiene standards and equipment durability.

Maternal and Child Health Infrastructure

The donation of baby changing stations represents targeted investment in maternal and child health infrastructure. While the assessment interview did not elaborate extensively on these items, their inclusion in the donation package demonstrates the PSCBC's recognition of the clinic's diverse patient population and specialised care needs. These

facilities contribute to creating a more family-friendly healthcare environment and ensure that the clinic can adequately serve mothers and infants.

The baby changing stations provide essential hygiene facilities for families accessing healthcare services. These seemingly modest improvements contribute to the overall patient experience and reflect attention to the practical needs of healthcare service delivery.

Systemic Challenges and Ongoing Needs

The impact assessment reveals that while the PSCBC's CSR initiatives have generated positive outcomes, they have also highlighted the depth of ongoing needs within the healthcare system. The clinic management's identification of requirements for glucometers, testing strips, and scales indicates that the initial donations have addressed some needs while revealing others.

The clinic's request for additional blood pressure machines, glucometers, and scales reflects the ongoing nature of healthcare infrastructure needs. The management's specification that 13 blood pressure machines would be ideal (one per consultation room) provides a clear metric for understanding the scale of need relative to current capacity.

Community Health System Strengthening

The PSCBC's CSR initiatives have contributed to strengthening the local health system's capacity to serve a large and underserved population. By addressing equipment shortages and providing essential supplies, the donations have enabled the clinic to operate more efficiently and provide better quality care to its patients.

The improvement in consultation room efficiency, reduction in waiting times, and enhanced healthcare worker capacity represent systemic improvements that benefit the entire community. These outcomes demonstrate how targeted CSR investments can generate benefits that extend far beyond the immediate value of donated items.

Future Considerations

Based on the impact assessment findings, several considerations emerge for future CSR initiatives. The ongoing need for blood pressure machines, glucometers, and scales suggests opportunities for continued partnership with the clinic. The specification of equipment quantities (13 blood pressure machines, individual stethoscopes for 19 healthcare professionals) provides clear targets for future interventions.

Conclusion

The PSCBC's CSR initiatives at Olievenhoutbosch Clinic have demonstrated measurable positive impact across multiple dimensions of healthcare delivery. From improving operational efficiency through blood pressure machine donations to supporting healthcare worker dignity through professional supplies, the interventions have addressed real needs and generated tangible benefits for both healthcare workers and patients.

The clinic's high patient volume and resource constraints mean that even modest improvements can generate significant positive outcomes. The positive outcomes documented in this assessment demonstrate that the PSCBC's CSR initiatives have successfully contributed to strengthening healthcare delivery in an underserved community. The interventions have not only addressed immediate needs but have also provided insights into ongoing challenges and opportunities for continued community support. This foundation of positive impact positions the PSCBC well for potential future CSR initiatives that could further enhance healthcare access and quality in the Olievenhoutbosch community.

Louis Botha Children's Home CSR Initiatives

Overview and Operations

Louis Botha Children's Home is a residential care facility serving 90-95 vulnerable children in the Queenwood community. Located in a suburban area, the facility comprises nine residential units designed as standard households with wooden flooring, each accommodating 10-12 children under the supervision of two-house guardians. The facility is staffed by a professional team that includes social workers, wellness officers, and additional support personnel who ensure comprehensive care for children removed from their homes due to abuse, neglect, or parental absence.

The orphanage operates under significant financial constraints, receiving only 40% of its operational costs from government funding while being responsible for self-funding the remaining 60% of the children's needs. This funding gap creates ongoing challenges in meeting basic requirements such as school uniforms, footwear, and household equipment that can withstand the high-capacity usage. The facility has developed a strategic approach to resource acquisition through community donations and corporate partnerships, utilising their marketing department to solicit support via their website and community outreach initiatives.

Despite these financial limitations, the facility maintains comprehensive programs designed to support the children's physical, emotional, and social development. These programs include supervised cycling activities that promote fitness and socialisation among the children, quality clothing provision to boost self-esteem and confidence, and weekly educational excursions during school holidays. Management maintains strict quality standards for all donations, ensuring that items provided to children meet standards they would personally accept for their own use.

PSCBC's CSR Initiative and Community Support

PSCBC implemented a comprehensive renovation project targeting House No. 8. The scope of work addressed critical infrastructure needs including fixing the leaking roof system, complete gutter system installation, replacement of broken windowpanes, repair of wall cracks throughout the unit, and complete exterior repainting. This renovation was part of PSCBC's broader corporate social responsibility initiative to support vulnerable communities and address immediate housing needs while contributing to long-term sustainability goals.

The orphanage has developed strong community relationships that are essential to its continued operation. Through active outreach using their organisational website and marketing department, they successfully solicit donations of food, clothing, bicycles, and other essential items from community members and corporate partners. The facility maintains relationships with various organisations and community groups that supplement government funding and contribute to sustainable operations, creating a network of support that extends beyond traditional funding mechanisms.

Challenges

The facility faces significant infrastructure challenges primarily related to the high-capacity accommodation model. With 10-12 children living in each household designed for standard family use, the accelerated wear and tear creates ongoing maintenance demands that strain the facility's limited resources. The household equipment and utensils, which are not industrial expected standard, require frequent replacement due to heavy usage, adding to operational costs. Additionally, the aging community infrastructure contributes to frequent power failures and water disruptions that further complicate daily operations. When renovations are necessary, children must be temporarily relocated to

other houses, which limits the facility's capacity to undertake multiple renovation projects simultaneously and creates logistical complications for staff and residents alike.

Assessment Limitations

The assessment of PSCBC's CSR initiative faced several significant limitations that prevented a comprehensive evaluation of the project's impact. Insufficient documentation of completed renovations, the inability to locate facility management personnel who were responsible for the original project, and limited access to specific impact measurements for House No. 8 all contributed to gaps in the evaluation process. The interview process consequently shifted focus from specific project assessment to understanding the orphanage's daily operations and broader support network. These limitations highlight the critical need for improved documentation systems and clearer communication protocols for future CSR initiatives. Despite these constraints, the available information suggests that the facility can manage interior maintenance reasonably well with current resources, but exterior maintenance consistently presents the most significant ongoing challenge.

Conclusion and Future Recommendations

While the comprehensive impact assessment of PSCBC's CSR initiative at Louis Botha Children's Home could not be fully completed due to documentation gaps and personnel accessibility issues, the available evidence suggests that the renovation of House No. 8 addressed critical infrastructure needs that directly impact the children's living conditions. The facility's management indicated that while they can adequately maintain most interior aspects of the households with current resources, exterior maintenance consistently presents the greatest ongoing challenge due to cost and complexity, particularly regarding fence repairs and exterior painting projects.

The orphanage's demonstrated commitment to quality care, evidenced through their strict donation standards and comprehensive child development programs, combined with strong community engagement and strategic resource management, provides a solid foundation for continued partnership opportunities. The facility's approach to maintaining dignity for the children through quality standards, ensuring that donated items meet personal use criteria, reflects a holistic understanding of child welfare that extends beyond basic shelter and food provision.

For PSCBC, future CSR initiatives should focus on exterior maintenance projects, which represent the facility's most persistent infrastructure challenges and where the organization can make the most significant long-term impact. The findings suggest that PSCBC's continued involvement could significantly contribute to the long-term sustainability of Louis Botha Children's Home, particularly through addressing exterior infrastructure needs that the facility cannot manage independently due to resource constraints.

The experience at Louis Botha Children's Home demonstrates both the critical need for such partnerships and the importance of establishing proper evaluation mechanisms to maximize the benefit of CSR initiatives in supporting vulnerable children and strengthening community care systems.

10th CCC Rehabilitation Centre CSR Initiative

Overview of the CSR Initiative

The PSCBC's corporate social responsibility initiative represented a strategic investment in community development through infrastructure enhancement at the rehabilitation centre. The renovation program included essential improvements such as painting, toilet repairs, shower system upgrades, provision of mattresses and blankets, and tile installation throughout the facility. These interventions directly addressed critical infrastructure deficiencies that were hampering the centre's operational effectiveness and resident comfort.

The impact of these renovations was immediately apparent and deeply appreciated by both management and residents. The shower system renovation proved particularly transformative, as the facility had previously only provided cold water bathing facilities. The upgraded system now delivers warm water, providing basic comfort. This improvement significantly enhanced the rehabilitation environment, contributing to both physical well-being and psychological comfort during the recovery process.

The provision of blankets addressed fundamental comfort needs while demonstrating care for resident dignity and well-being. Management explicitly acknowledged how these seemingly simple additions substantially improved living conditions and contributed to a more conducive healing environment. The renovations created a ripple effect of

improvements that enhanced the facility's overall operational capacity and its ability to provide quality care.

The PSCBC initiative demonstrated strategic alignment with the centre's actual needs rather than imposing external priorities. This needs-responsive approach ensured maximum effectiveness and sustainability of the interventions. The infrastructure improvements not only benefited current residents but established a foundation for improved service delivery that continues to serve new cohorts of individuals seeking recovery. The initiative's success lies in its recognition that environmental conditions significantly impact rehabilitation outcomes and that dignified living conditions are essential components of effective addiction treatment.

Skills Development Programs

The PSCBC's strategic sponsorship of skills development initiatives represents a transformative partnership that has significantly enhanced the centre's comprehensive approach to resident rehabilitation and community reintegration. Through this collaborative effort, the PSCBC has enabled the centre to expand and refine its skills development methodology, creating a more robust framework that addresses the complex challenges faced by individuals in recovery while building sustainable pathways to economic independence.

The centre's approach to skills development, now strengthened by PSCBC support, reflects a profound understanding of the complex interaction between addiction recovery, skills acquisition, and successful community reintegration. This partnership ensures that development programs build upon existing capabilities while systematically addressing skill gaps that may have contributed to addiction or unemployment.

Beyond skills training, the centre maintains an active job placement program that assists the recovered in finding employment opportunities. This holistic approach recognises that successful reintegration requires not only skills development but also practical support in navigating the job market. The centre's commitment to post-program support demonstrates understanding that recovery is an ongoing process requiring sustained community support.

The effectiveness of these programs is evidenced by the continued success of program graduates who utilise their acquired skills in their post-rehabilitation lives. Many graduates

maintain connections with the centre, providing mentorship and motivation for current residents while contributing to program sustainability through their ongoing involvement. This creates a positive cycle of recovery, skill development, and community contribution that extends the centre's impact far beyond its physical boundaries.

Stakeholder Perspective and Response

The warm reception given to the researchers at the facility demonstrates that the centre views the PSCBC as a highly valued partner. The appreciation demonstrated by the centre's leadership provides tangible evidence of the significant positive impact that the PSCBC's corporate social responsibility initiatives have had on the organization.

Community recognition of the PSCBC's contributions validates the strategic approach taken in addressing infrastructure challenges while contributing to sustainable community development. The alignment between corporate social responsibility initiatives and actual community needs demonstrates the value of consultative approaches that prioritize stakeholder input over external assumptions about community requirements.

Strategic Implications and Future Considerations

The gap between the PSCBC initiative implementation during 2020-2021 and the evaluation conducted in May 2025 provides valuable insights into the sustainability and ongoing relevance of corporate social responsibility interventions. Despite this three-year interval, during which the original beneficiary cohort had completed their programs and moved on, the infrastructure improvements continue to benefit new residents and support ongoing operations. This longevity demonstrates the wisdom of investing in infrastructure improvements rather than consumable resources.

Current needs assessment reveals evolving priorities that reflect both the success of previous interventions and emerging challenges. The management has identified clothing as a critical need, as many residents arrive with minimal possessions, having often sold personal items to support their addiction. The need for storage solutions such as shelves and wardrobes are amongst the new priorities of the centre. Additionally, ceiling repairs have been identified as necessary infrastructure improvements that would enhance living conditions and facility maintenance.

Future intervention opportunities include expanded skills training programs, particularly in beading, which aligns with both therapeutic activities and marketable skills development. The combination of practical infrastructure improvements with skills development represents a comprehensive approach that addresses immediate needs while building long-term capacity for both individual success and institutional sustainability.

Conclusion

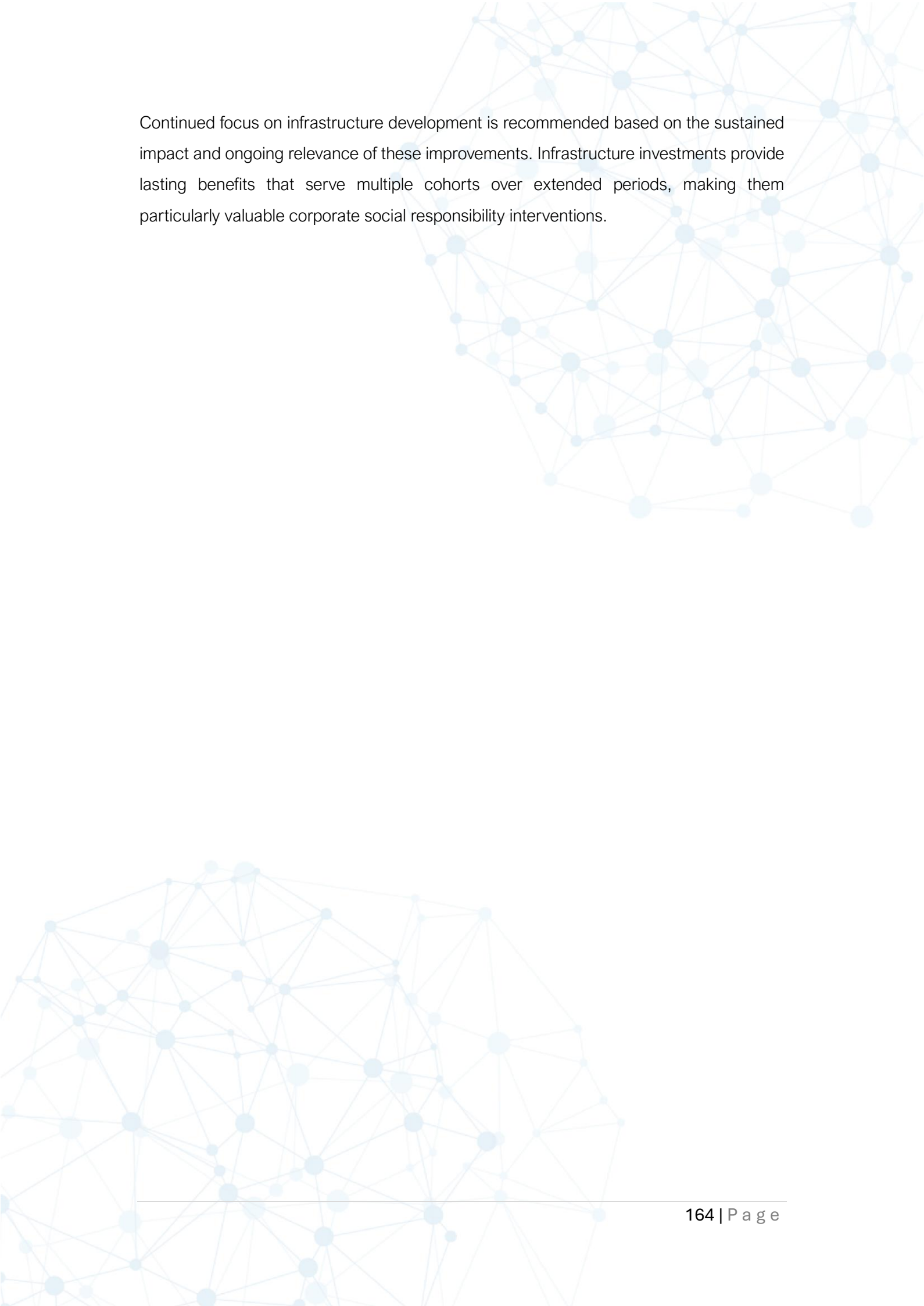
The PSCBC corporate social responsibility initiative at the 10th CCC has demonstrated significant positive impact through strategic infrastructure improvements that enhanced living conditions, operational effectiveness, and quality of care delivery. The initiative's success stems from its responsive approach to actual needs rather than imposed external priorities, resulting in improvements that continue to benefit new cohorts of residents years after implementation.

The comprehensive nature of the renovations, from basic amenities like warm water and comfortable bedding to structural improvements like flooring and facility maintenance, created an environment more conducive to successful rehabilitation outcomes. These improvements supported the centre's broader mission of restoring dignity to individuals in recovery while enhancing its capacity to serve the community effectively.

The sustainability of the initiative's impact, evidenced by continued utilisation and appreciation three years post-implementation, validates the strategic focus on infrastructure development as a foundation for ongoing service delivery. The positive feedback from management demonstrates successful alignment between corporate social responsibility objectives and community development needs.

Recommendations

The PSCBC's consultative approach to needs assessment should be maintained and expanded in future corporate social responsibility initiatives. This methodology ensures relevant and effective implementation while maximising cost-effectiveness through targeted interventions that address actual rather than assumed needs. The success of this approach at the 10th CCC provides a model for engagement with other community organisations and initiatives.



Continued focus on infrastructure development is recommended based on the sustained impact and ongoing relevance of these improvements. Infrastructure investments provide lasting benefits that serve multiple cohorts over extended periods, making them particularly valuable corporate social responsibility interventions.

**REPORT ON
COLLABORATOR
USAGE REPORT**

10. REPORT ON THE COLLABORATOR SOFTWARE SYSTEM UTILISED BY THE PSCBC

OVERVIEW

The Collaborator software system is a key digital platform utilised by the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC) to manage operational workflows, case tracking, and task administration across internal and stakeholder-facing processes. The system supports both premise-based tasks (internal operational activities) and portal-based tasks (external or stakeholder interactions), contributing significantly to institutional efficiency, record-keeping, and service delivery.

Usage statistics over recent years indicate sustained and growing reliance on the system, particularly for premise tasks, demonstrating its strategic value in supporting organisational coordination, governance, and operational oversight.

BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

In line with the PSCBC's ICT Operational Plan and digital governance objectives, the Collaborator system has been implemented as an integrated workflow and case management tool. The platform enables structured documentation, tracking of tasks, and monitoring of case-related activities within the Council's operational environment.

The system aligns with:

- Digital transformation initiatives
- Improved institutional record management
- Efficient coordination between internal units and external stakeholders
- Strengthened governance and accountability mechanisms

OVERVIEW OF THE COLLABORATOR SOFTWARE SYSTEM

SYSTEM DESCRIPTION

Collaborator is a system that was introduced to streamline internal and external processes to reduce paper-based dependencies, improve turnaround times and create a transparent audit trail for records, supply chain activities, and case referrals.

It serves as a structured digital environment where tasks can be routed systematically, monitored efficiently, and completed in accordance with approved workflows. Prior to its adoption, many processes relied heavily on manual documentation, email-based approvals, Prior to the introduction of collaborator many council processes relied heavily on manual documentation, email-based approvals, which made monitoring, reporting, and accountability a little bit difficult.

From a security perspective, Collaborator includes authentication controls and permission-based access rights, limiting users to functions aligned with their roles.

KEY FUNCTIONAL MODULES

The PSCBC utilizes Collaborator system as a centralized platform that integrates several core business functions.

In terms of records and document management, the system allows for the electronic creation, storage, classification, and retrieval of official documents. It maintains control and provides an audit trail reflecting user activity, approvals, and document updates. This has significantly reduced reliance on physical filing systems while improving accessibility and traceability.

Within supply chain management processes, the system facilitates requisition submissions, approval routing, procurement documentation, and supplier registrations. Workflows are pre-configured to ensure that transactions move sequentially through required approval levels. This structure strengthens compliance with internal financial controls and procurement regulations.

The case management component enables the registration, referral, escalation, and resolution tracking of cases. Each case progresses through a defined lifecycle, allowing managers to monitor status, response times, and service level adherence. This structured approach improves visibility and helps ensure that cases are not overlooked or delayed unnecessarily.

An important additional functionality of the Collaborator system is the monitoring of employee attendance. The system enables structured recording of staff attendance, leave applications, and related approvals.

The PSCBC currently utilises the following core components:

- Premise Task Management (internal workflow tasks)
- Portal Task Management (external or stakeholder-related submissions)
- Portal Case Tracking (case registration and monitoring)
- Usage Dashboard and Reporting

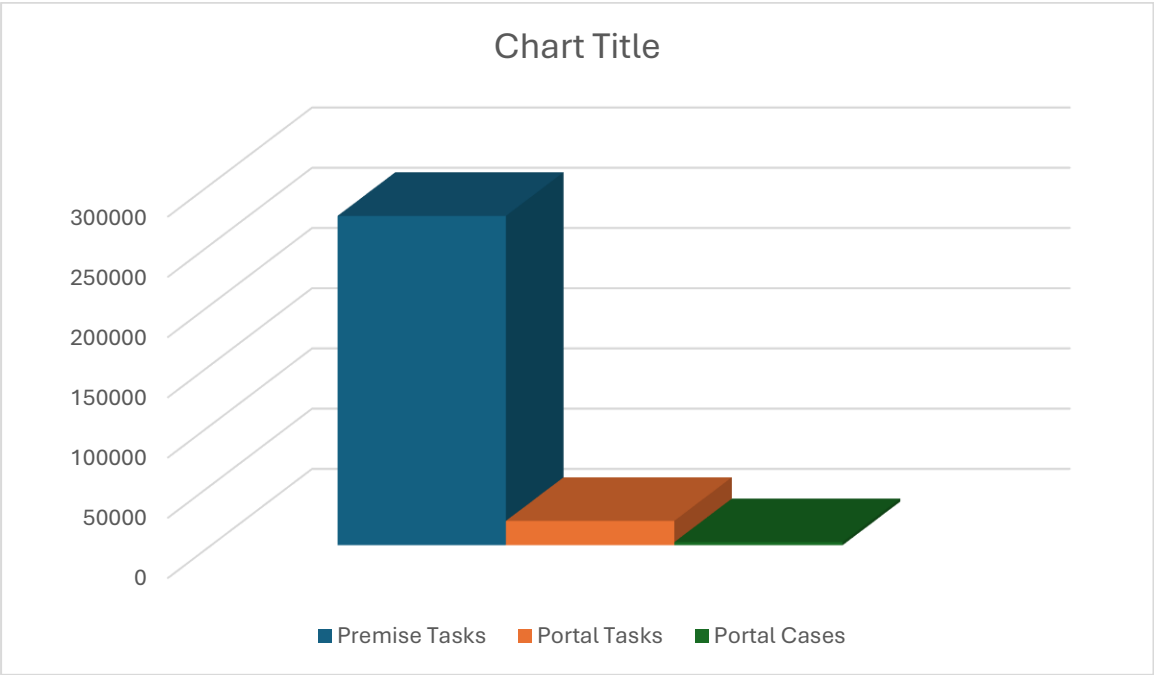
SYSTEM USAGE ANALYSIS (BASED ON PROVIDED STATISTICS)

USAGE SUMMARY (2022–2026)

Collaborator has contributed significantly to the organization’s operational efficiency.

For the selected reporting period (2022–2026), the system recorded:

- **Total Portal Tasks:** 20,151
- **Total Premise Tasks:** 273,324
- **Total Portal Cases:** 2 491



This indicates that the system is heavily used for internal operational processes while also supporting a significant number of portal-based engagements. The use of the system for case referrals continues to lag behind.

YEARLY USAGE TRENDS

Year	Portal Tasks	Premise Tasks	Portal Cases
2022	5,107	51,887	826
2023	5,971	53,697	631
2024	5,112	64,896	478
2025	3,679	91,870	498
2026*	282	10,974	58

*2026 reflects partial-year data.

KEY OBSERVATIONS

- A significant increase in **premise task usage**, peaking in 2025 with 91,870 tasks.
- Consistent utilisation of portal tasks, indicating ongoing stakeholder interaction.
- Gradual decline in portal cases after 2022, suggesting improved resolution efficiency or process optimisation.
- Strong institutional dependence on the system for internal workflow management.

STRATEGIC VALUE TO THE PSCBC

OPERATIONAL EFFICIENCY

The Collaborator system enhances:

- Task tracking and accountability
- Workflow automation
- Centralised information management
- Reduced administrative delays

GOVERNANCE AND COMPLIANCE

The Collaborator system plays an important role in supporting good governance by ensuring that processes are standardized and traceable. Through role-based access controls, audit logs, and approval trails, the system enhances accountability and transparency.

All actions taken within the system are recorded, creating a reliable audit trail that can be referenced.

The system supports good governance through:

- Audit trails and traceability
- Structured documentation
- Transparent case management
- Alignment with public sector accountability standards

SERVICE DELIVERY IMPROVEMENT

By enabling structured case and portal management, the system contributes to:

- Faster response times
- Improved stakeholder engagement
- Enhanced dispute and case monitoring
- Data-driven decision-making

ICT OVERSIGHT AND SYSTEM MANAGEMENT

From an ICT governance perspective, the Collaborator system falls under:

- ICT operational oversight
- Monitoring and performance reporting
- System coordination and approvals
- Data integrity and security management

The dashboard functionality provides management with real-time insights into system utilisation and performance indicators.

CHALLENGES AND RISKS

Despite its effectiveness, the following risks should be considered:

- Increasing system dependency without continuous upgrades
- Potential data overload due to high task volumes
- Need for ongoing user training and change management
- Integration limitations with other ICT systems (if not fully interoperable)

RECOMMENDATIONS

Strengthening enforcement of system usage to ensure that all case referrals, procurement workflows and document filing are processed exclusively within Collaborator to ensure full visibility and traceability. Ongoing training and refresher sessions are recommended to reinforce proper system usage and workflow discipline.

To optimise the utilisation of the Collaborator system, the following are recommended:

Continuous System Enhancement

Regular upgrades to ensure scalability and improved functionality.

User Capacity Building

Ongoing training for PSCBC staff and stakeholders to maximise system efficiency.

Data Analytics Integration

Advanced reporting tools for strategic planning and performance monitoring.

System Integration

Integration with other PSCBC ICT systems for seamless digital governance.

Periodic Usage Audits

Annual reviews of system usage trends to inform ICT strategic planning.

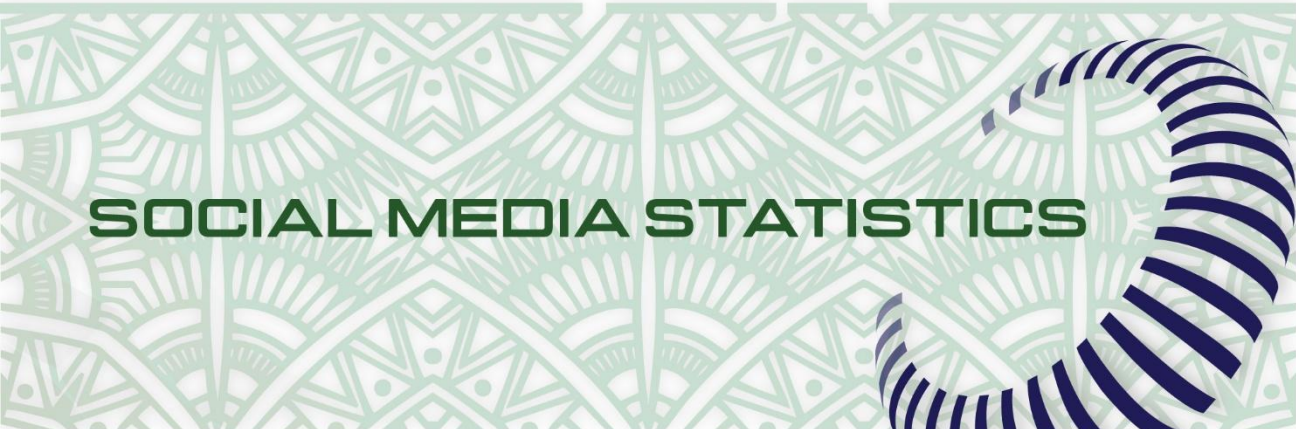
CONCLUSION

The Collaborator software system is a critical ICT asset within the PSCBC's digital ecosystem. The high volume of premise and portal tasks over recent years demonstrates its central role in operational coordination, governance, and service delivery.

Its continued use supports institutional efficiency, transparency, and data-driven management. With sustained ICT oversight and strategic enhancements, the system will remain instrumental in strengthening the PSCBC's operational effectiveness and digital transformation agenda.



SOCIAL MEDIA STATISTICS



11. PSCBC SOCIAL MEDIA STATISTICS PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR 2025

Background

The Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council plays a crucial role in disseminating and imparting knowledge on labour relation, as well as communicating information on PSCBC events, trade union conferences, Corporate Social Responsibility projects, and emerging issues that affects public servants, such as salary negotiations, changes in employment conditions, medical aid matters, and other labour related issues. This is achieved through various communication channels, including social media platforms, to ensure that accurate and relevant information is shared to a wide range of public servants.

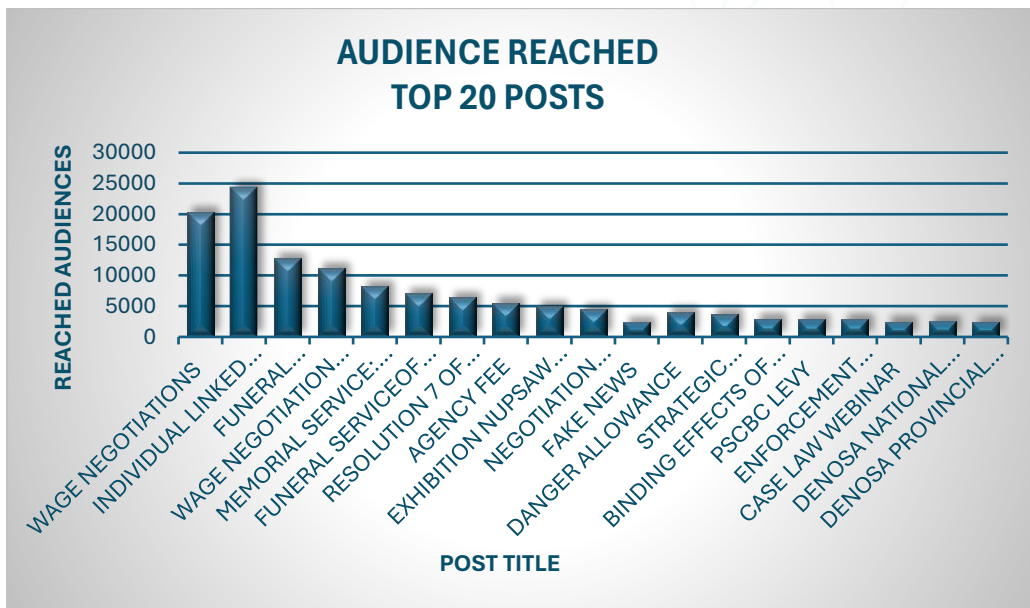
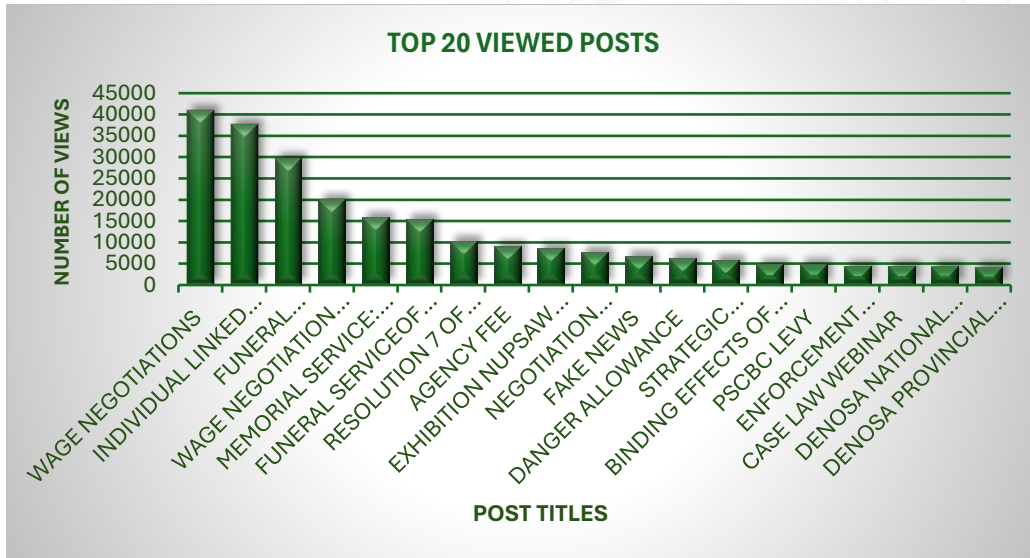
Purpose

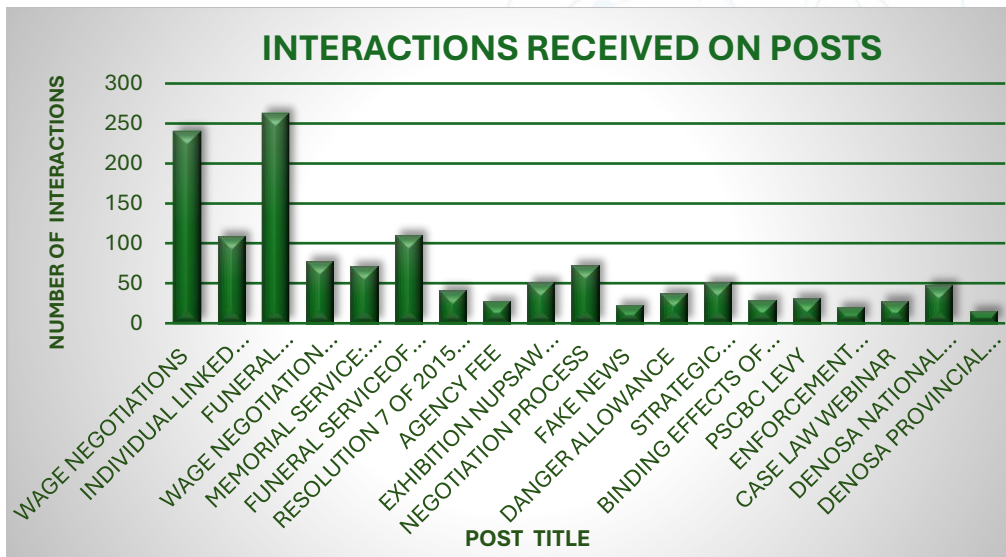
The primary purpose of this report is to evaluate performance of content posted by the Public Service Coordinating Bargaining Council for the year 2025. The report aims at analysing the views, reach, engagement, shares and the overall effectiveness of the content shared/ posted across social media platforms. The report also includes reviewing Mental Health Posts and the video content shared across the platforms. The report specifically evaluate the performance of content shared on Facebook, as it is the platform mostly used by public servants.

Quarterly Performance on Content Posted on Facebook

Quarter One

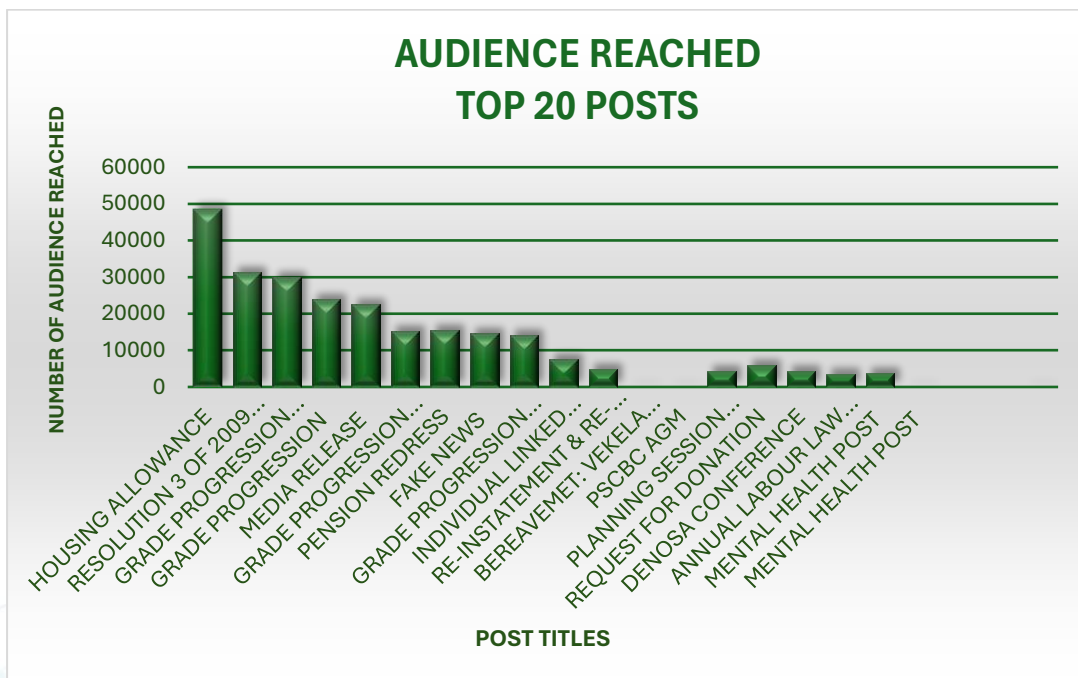
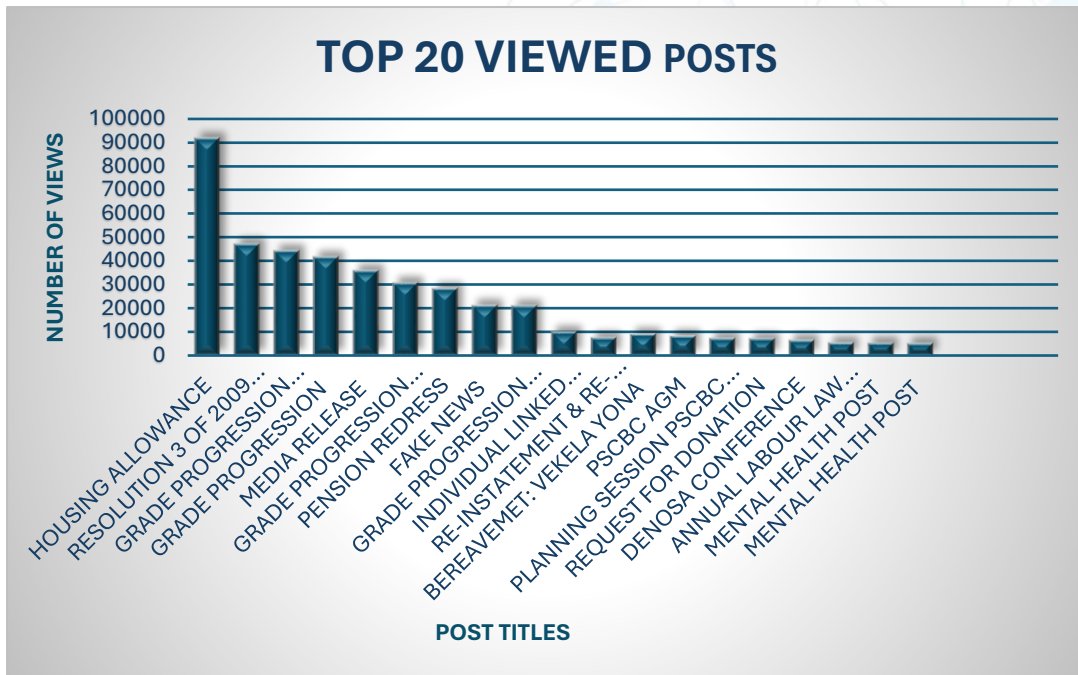
The below graphs represent the first quarter performance of content shared on Facebook between January 2025 and March 2025. The data highlights the top 20 performing post by Views, Audience Reached, Interactions and Shares. These top performing posts were selected from content published on a daily basis throughout quarter one.

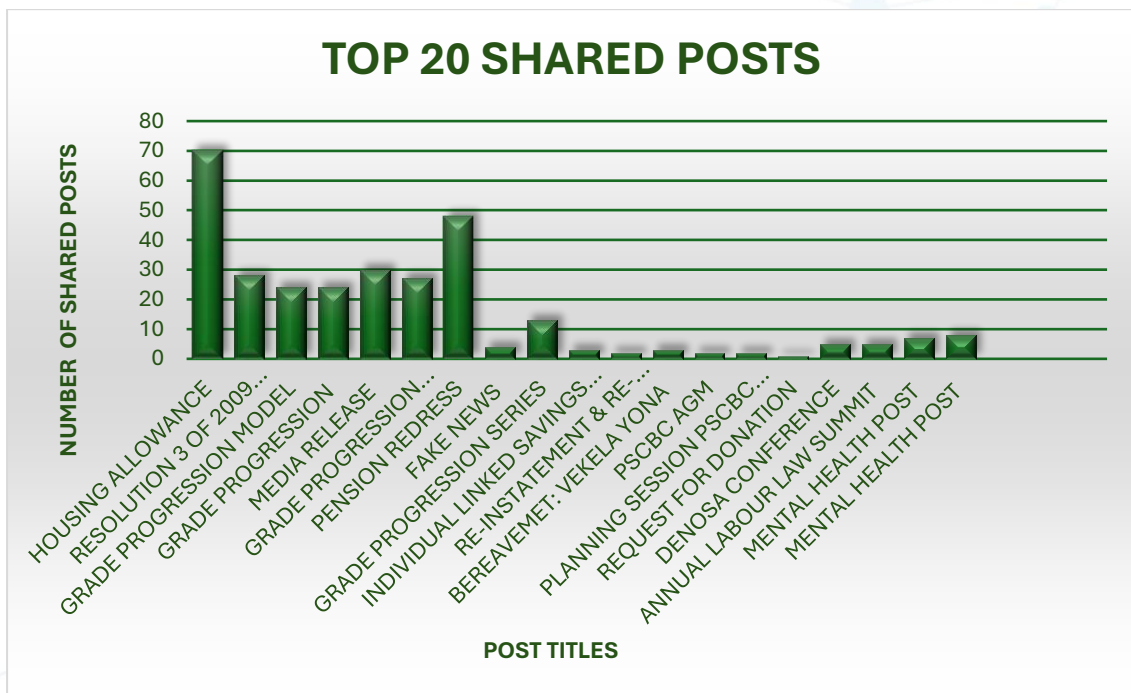
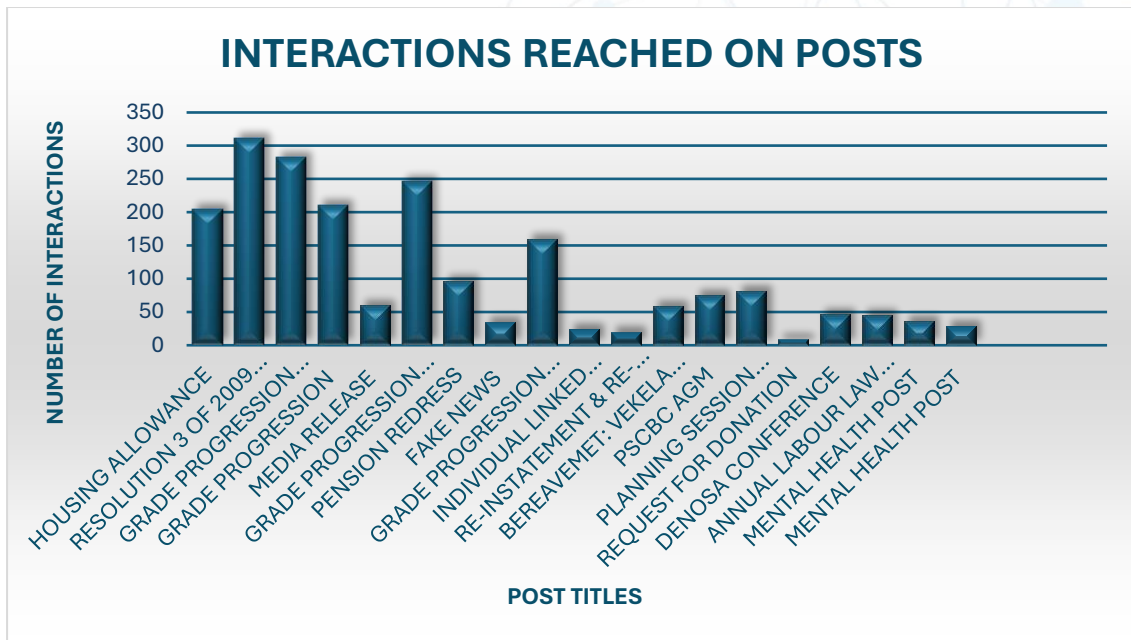




Quarter Two

The below graphs represent the second quarter performance of content shared on Facebook between April 2025 and June 2025. The data highlights the top 20 performing post by Views, Audience Reached, Interactions and Shares. These top performing posts were selected from content published on a daily basis throughout quarter two.

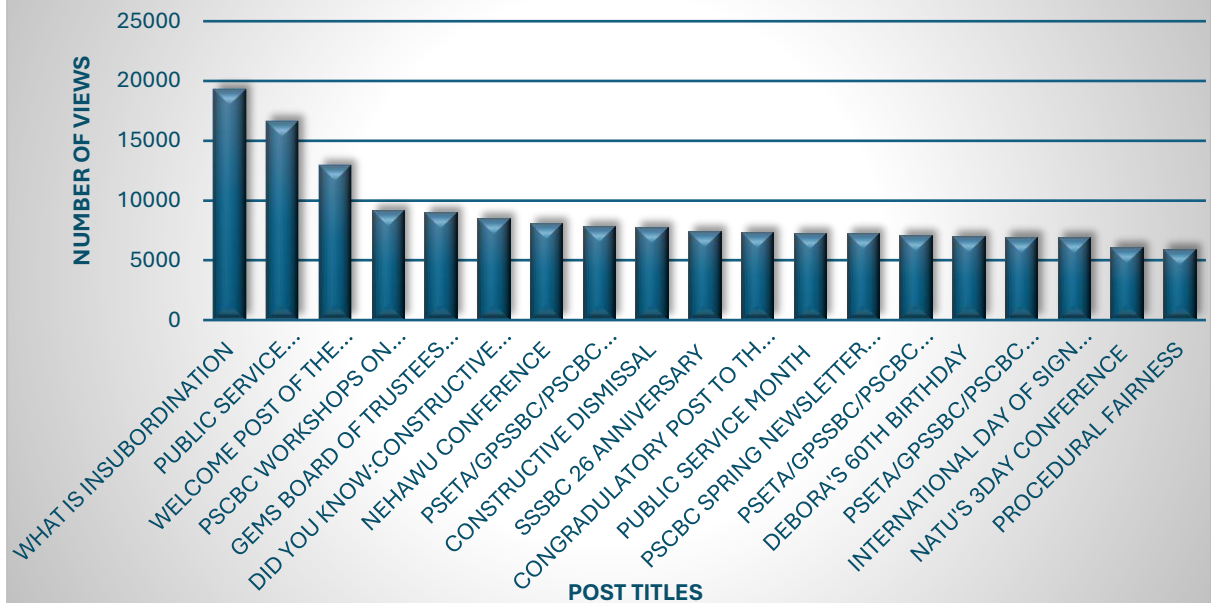




Third Quarter

The below graphs represent the third quarter performance of content shared on Facebook between July and September 2025. The data highlights the top 20 performing post by Views, Audience Reached, Interactions and Shares. These top performing posts were selected from content published on a daily basis throughout quarter two.

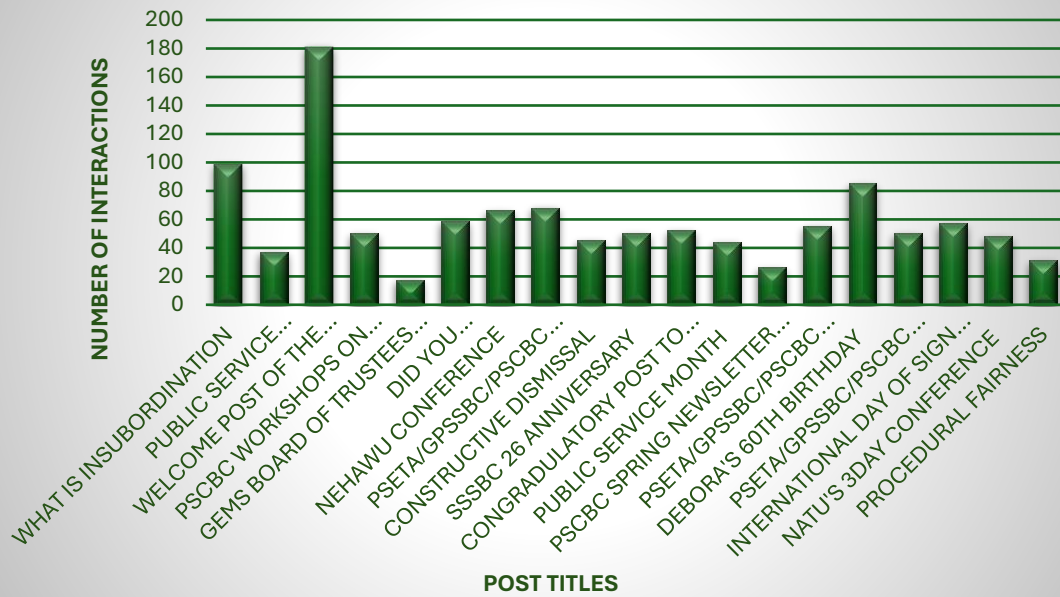
TOP 20 VIEWED POSTS



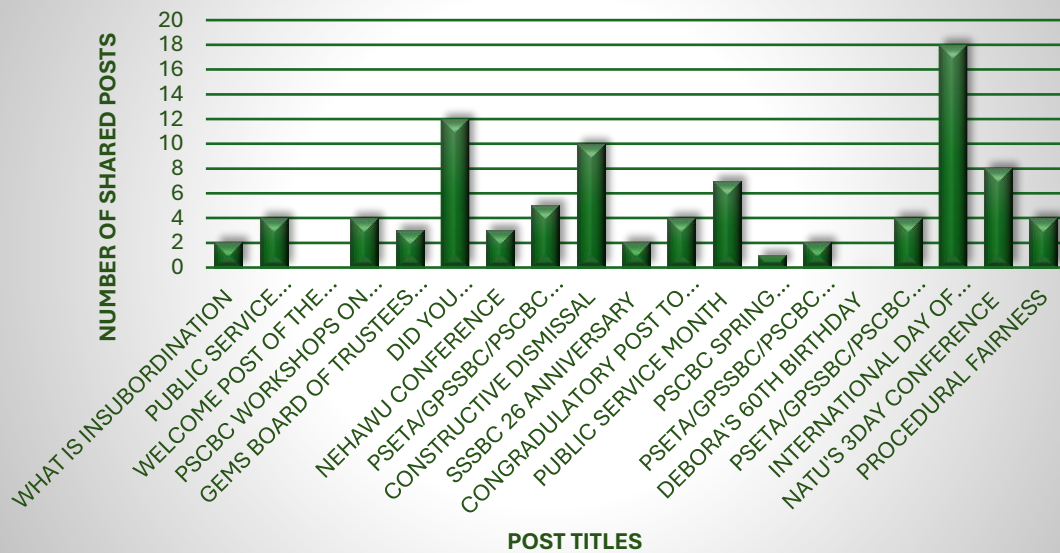
AUDIENCE REACHED TOP 20 POSTS



TOP 20 POSTS BY INTERACTIONS

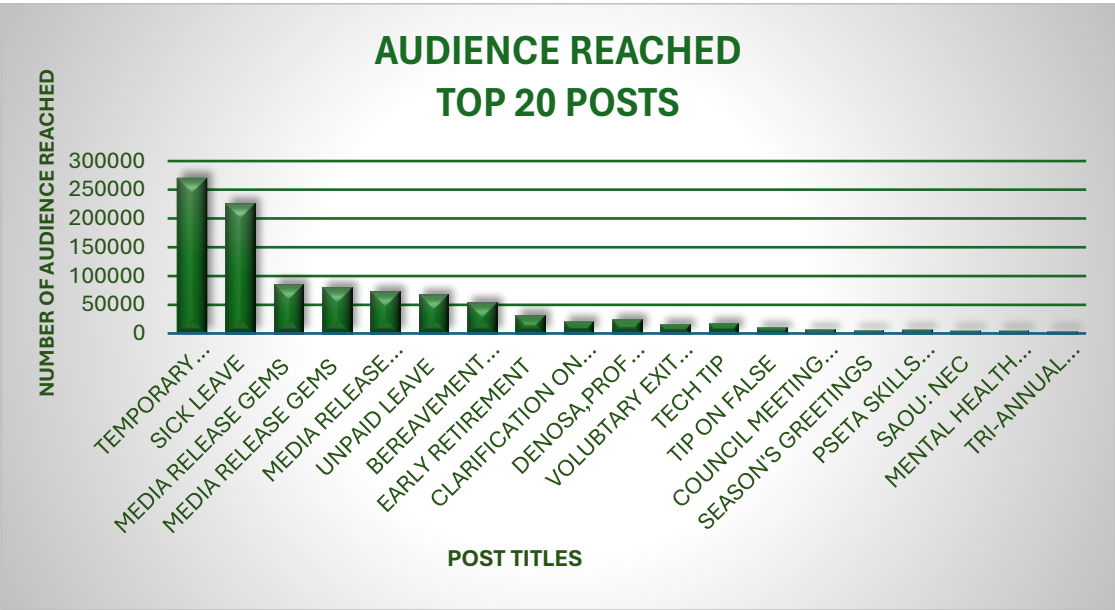
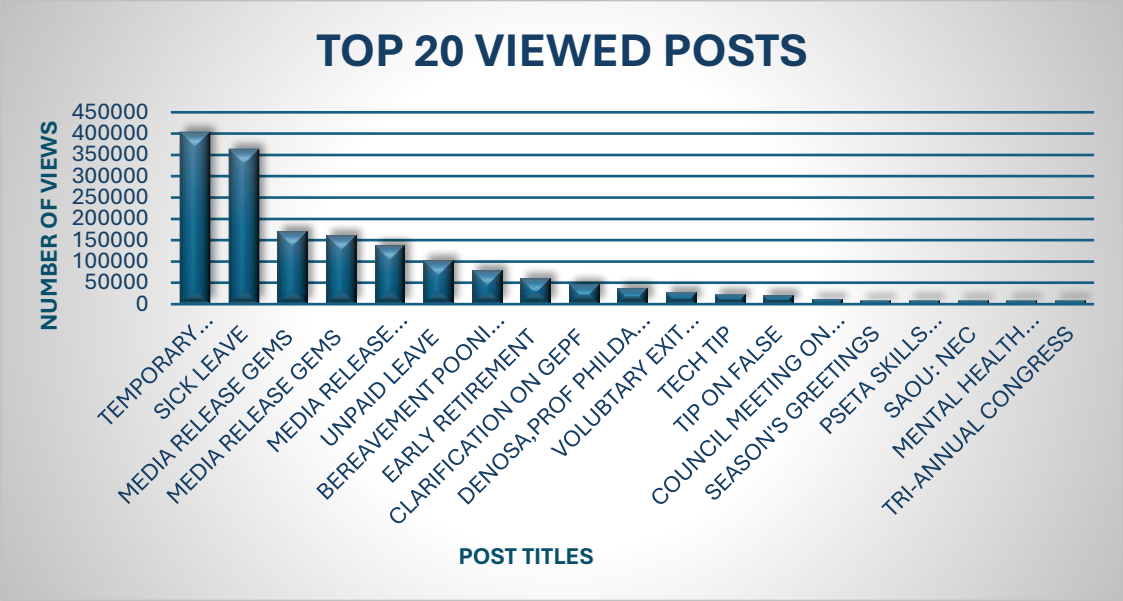


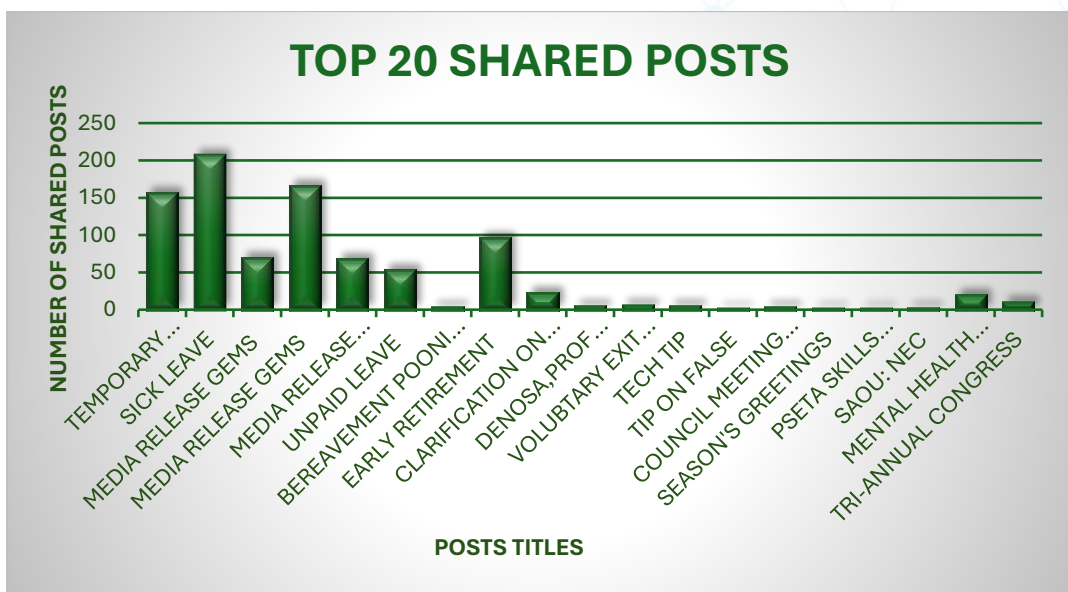
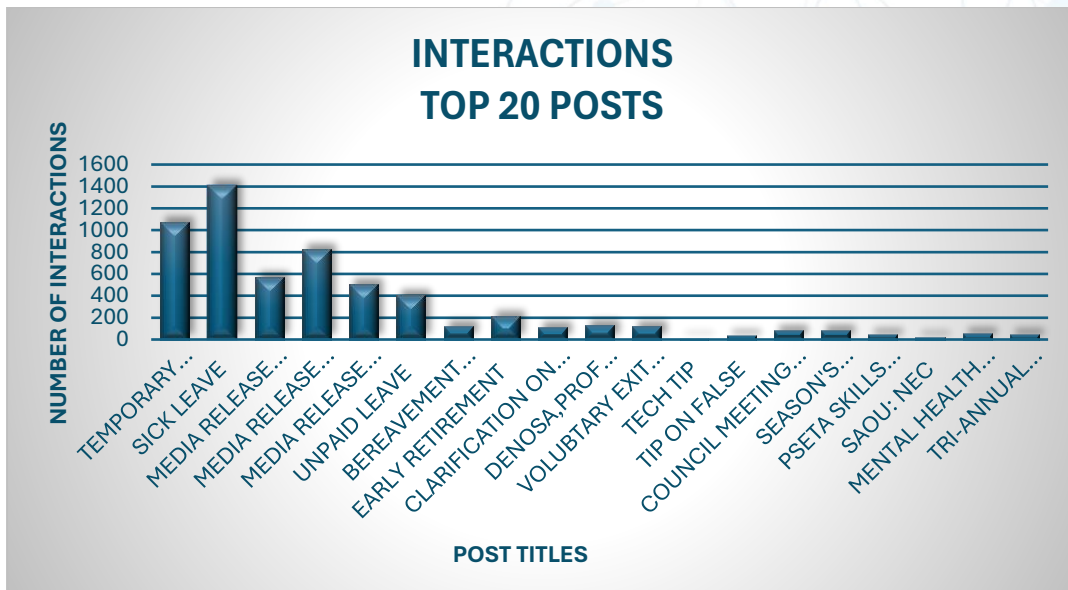
TOP 20 SHARED POSTS



Quarter Four

The below graphs represent the fourth quarter performance of content shared on Facebook between October and December 2025. The data highlights the top 20 performing post by Views, Audience Reached, Interactions and Shares. These top performing posts were selected from content published on a daily basis throughout quarter fourth.



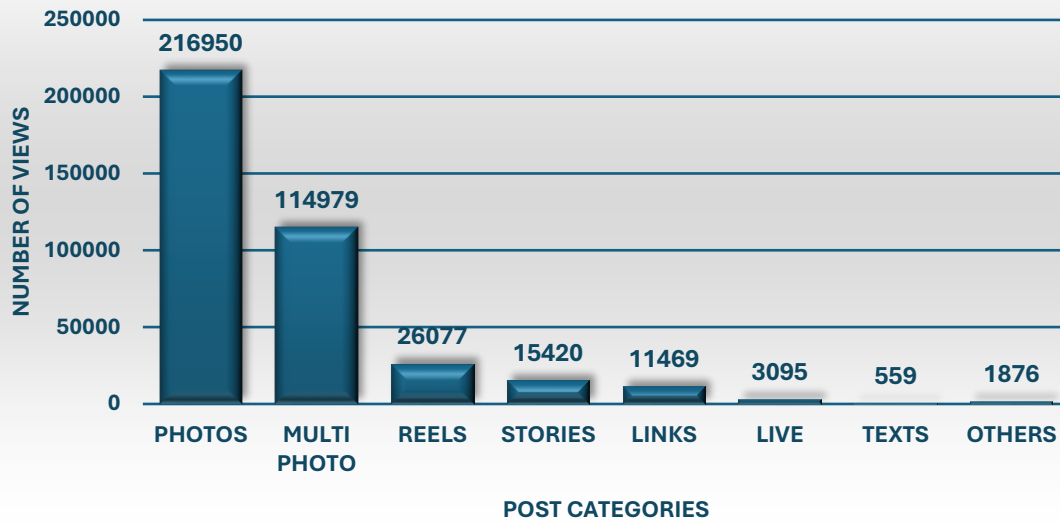


Performance by Category

The graphs below provide a detailed analysis of the quarterly performance of content posted on Facebook in 2025. The graphs illustrate the total number of views, reached across various content categories which includes, photos, multi photos, reels, links, stories, live, texts and other posted content. In comparing the performance of all the four quarters, the graphs shows that quarter four has the highest performance reaching a total number of 2 192 486 views.

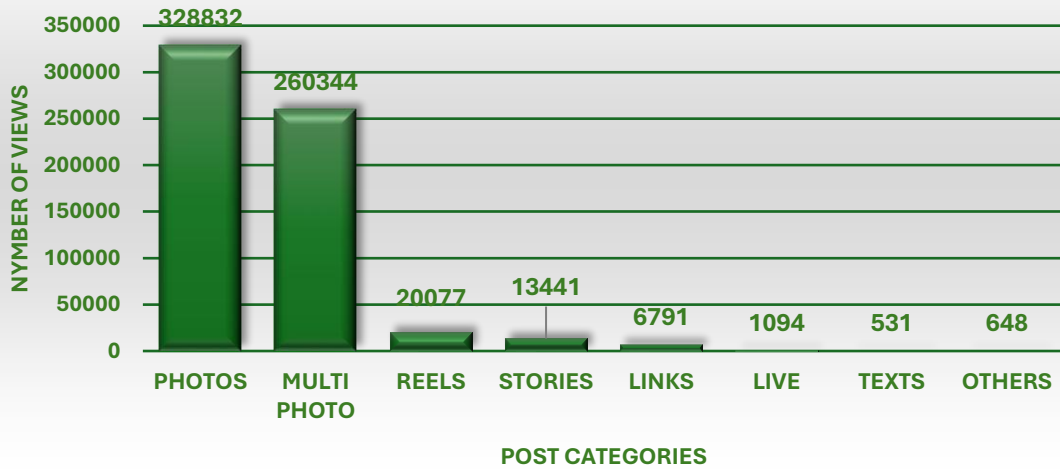
POST PERFORMANCE BY CATEGORIES

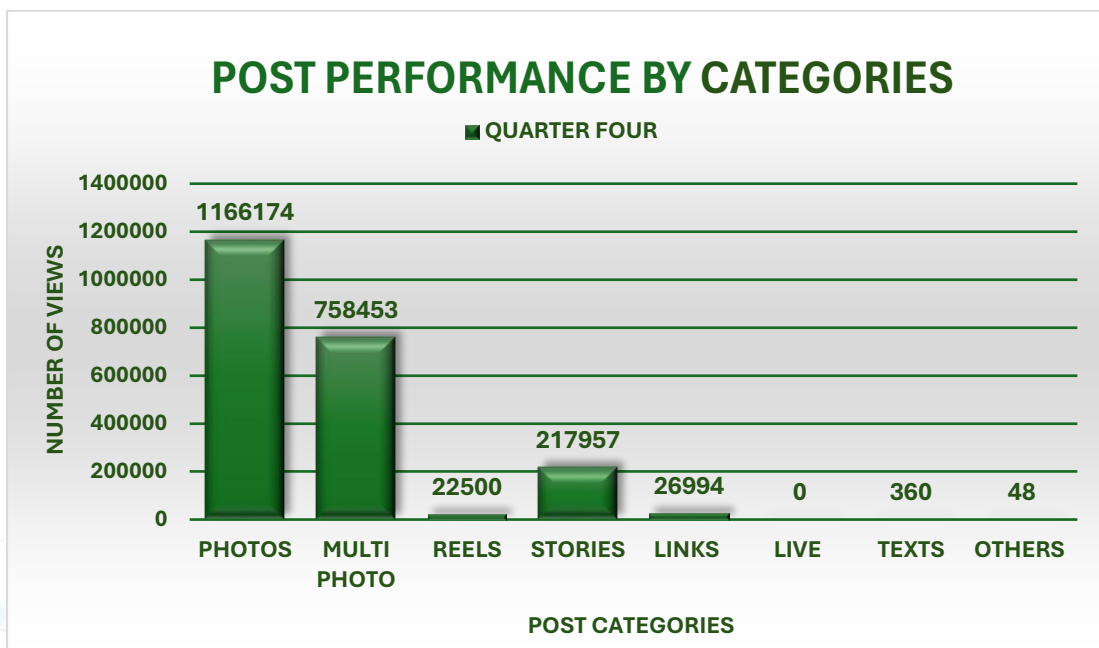
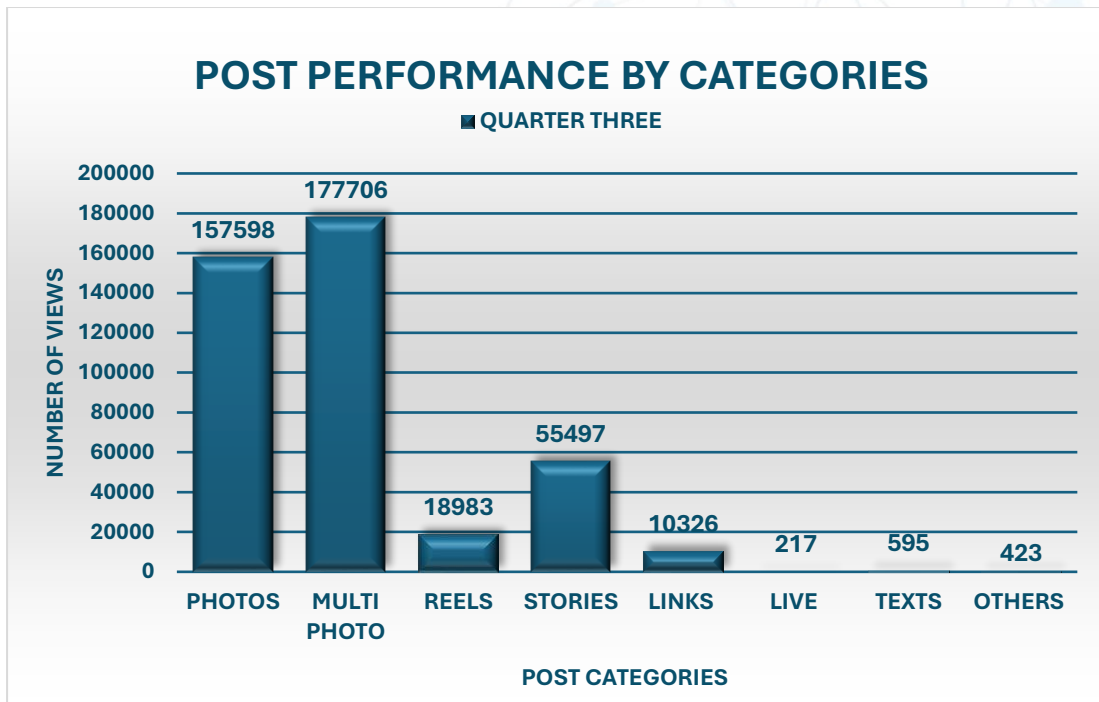
■ QUARTER ONE



POST PERFORMANCE BY CATEGORIES

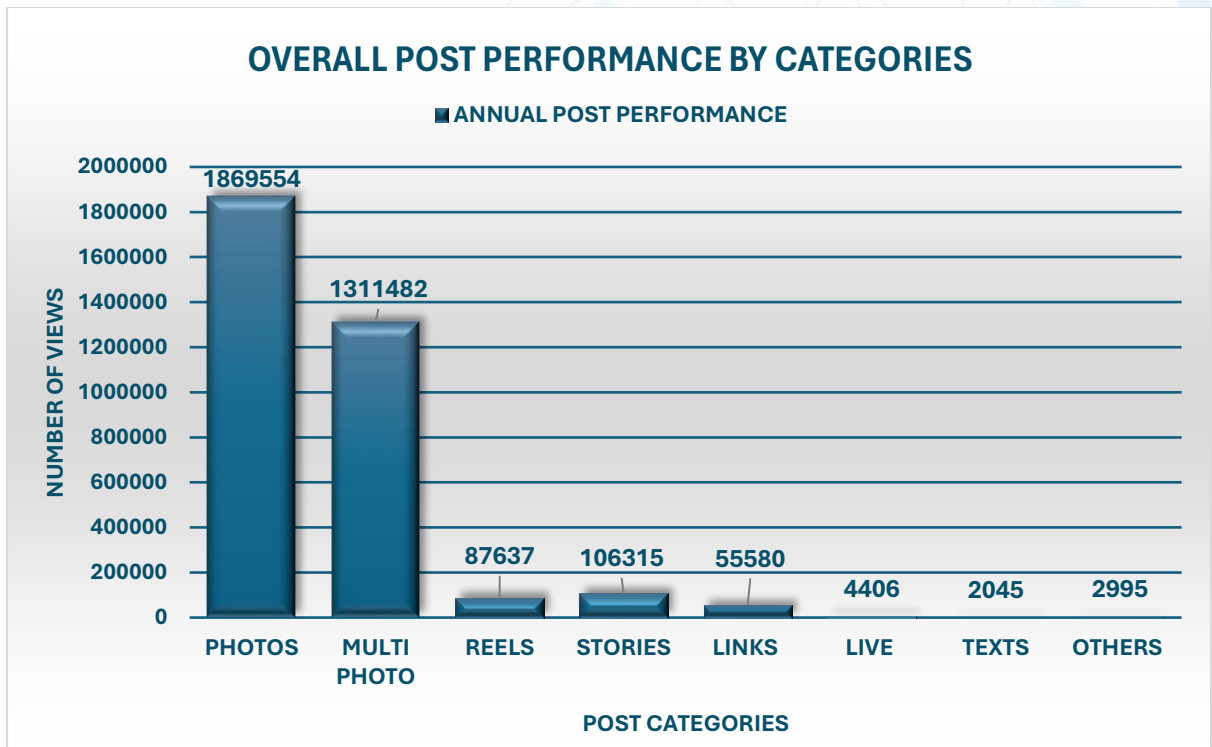
■ QUARTER TWO





Overall Performance

Throughout the year 2025, the content posted on Facebook has reached a total 3 440 014 views. The graph below shows a total number of views per post category for the year.

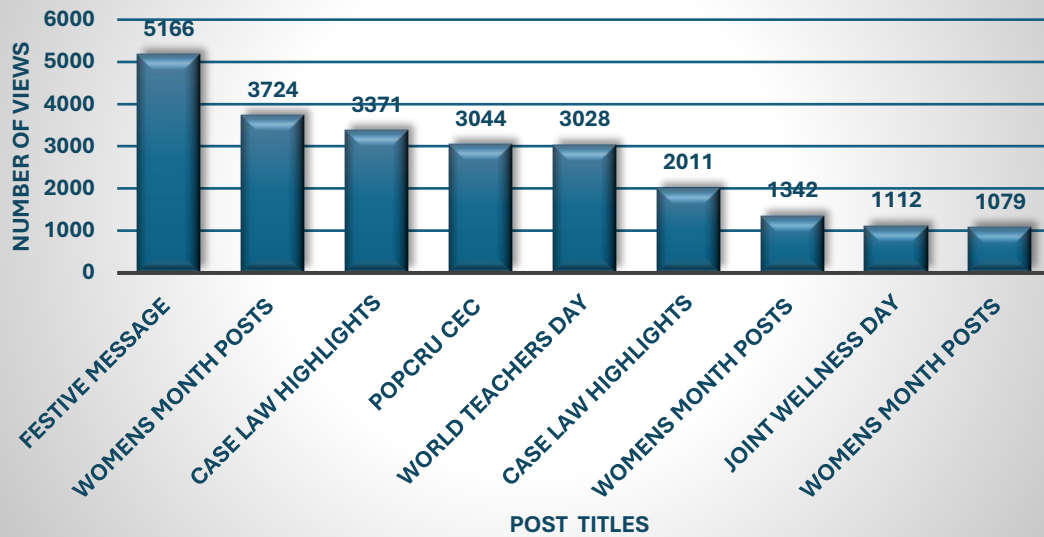


Video Posts Performance

The graph below shows the top 10 performing video posts from all the reels that were posted in 2025. The videos were selected based on the number of views, audience reached, engagement and shares they received. Among the top 10 the highest performing video featured a festive message by the General Secretary of the PSCBC which received 5 166 views, reached 5466 people 98 interactions and 4 Shares.

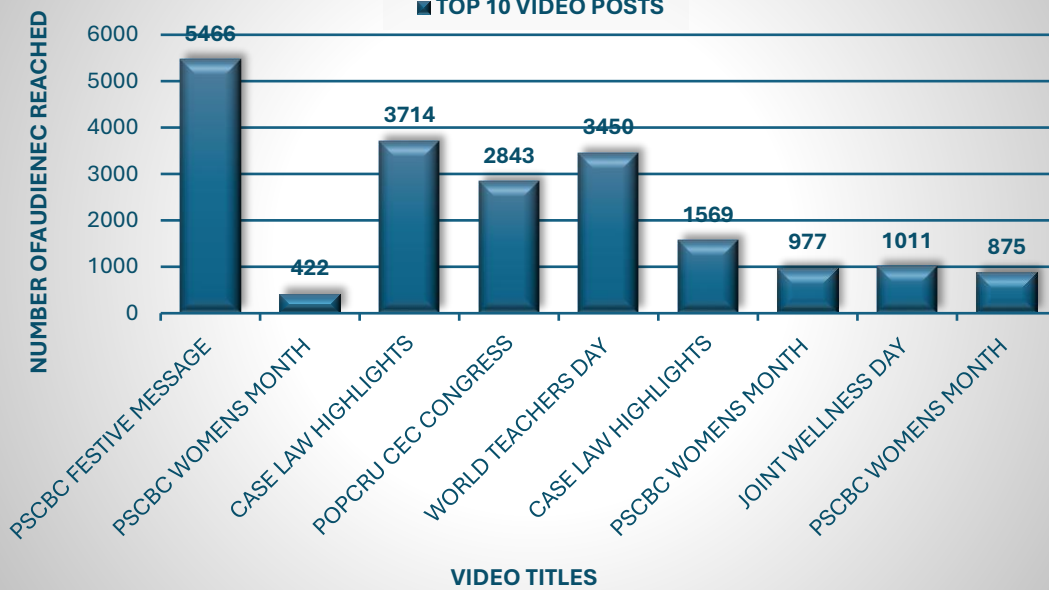
VIDEO POST BY VIEWS

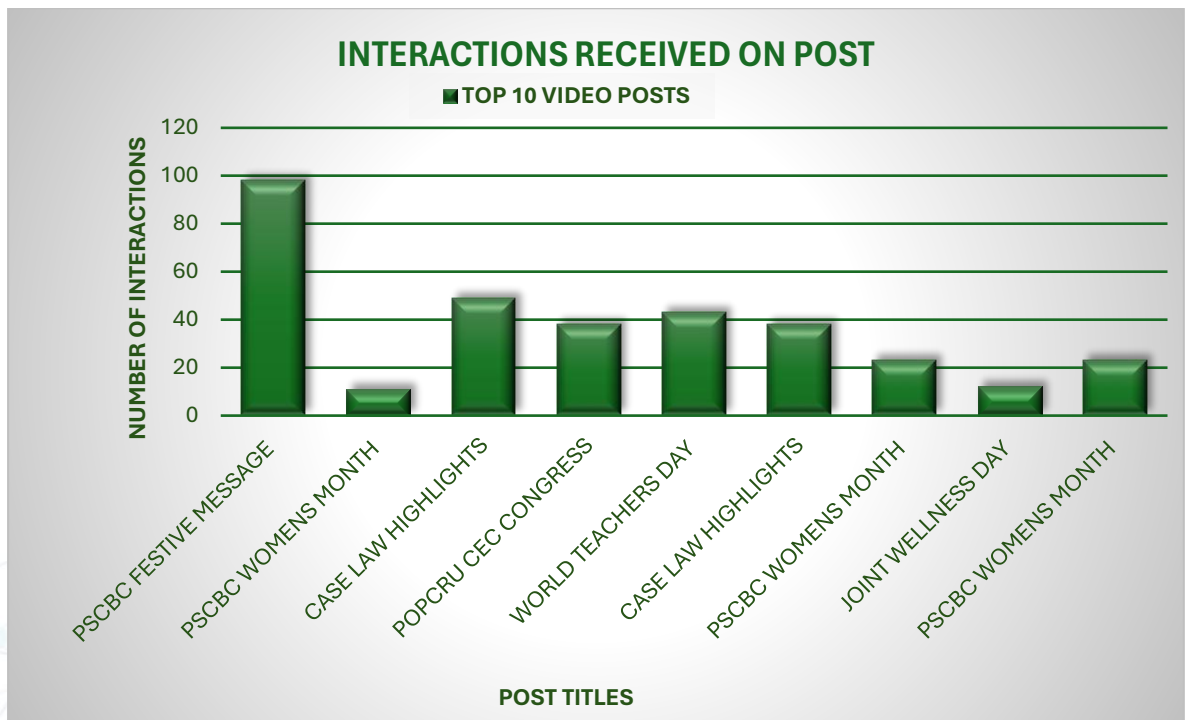
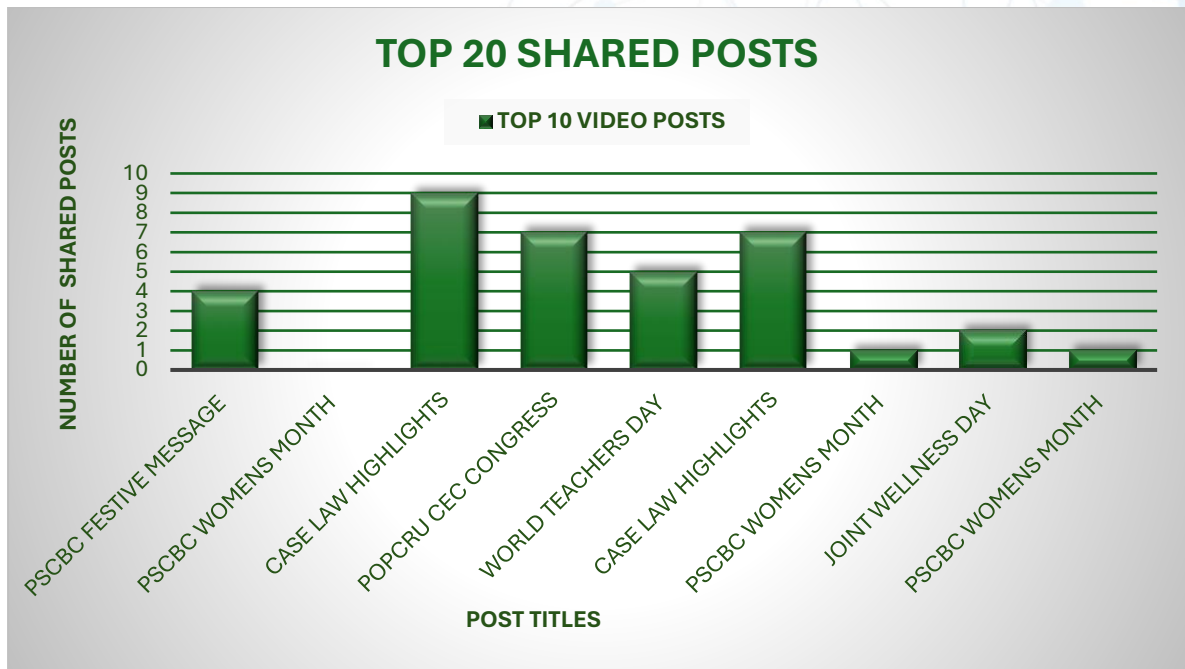
■ TOP 10 VIDEO POSTS



VIDEOS REACHED BY AUDIENCE

■ TOP 10 VIDEO POSTS

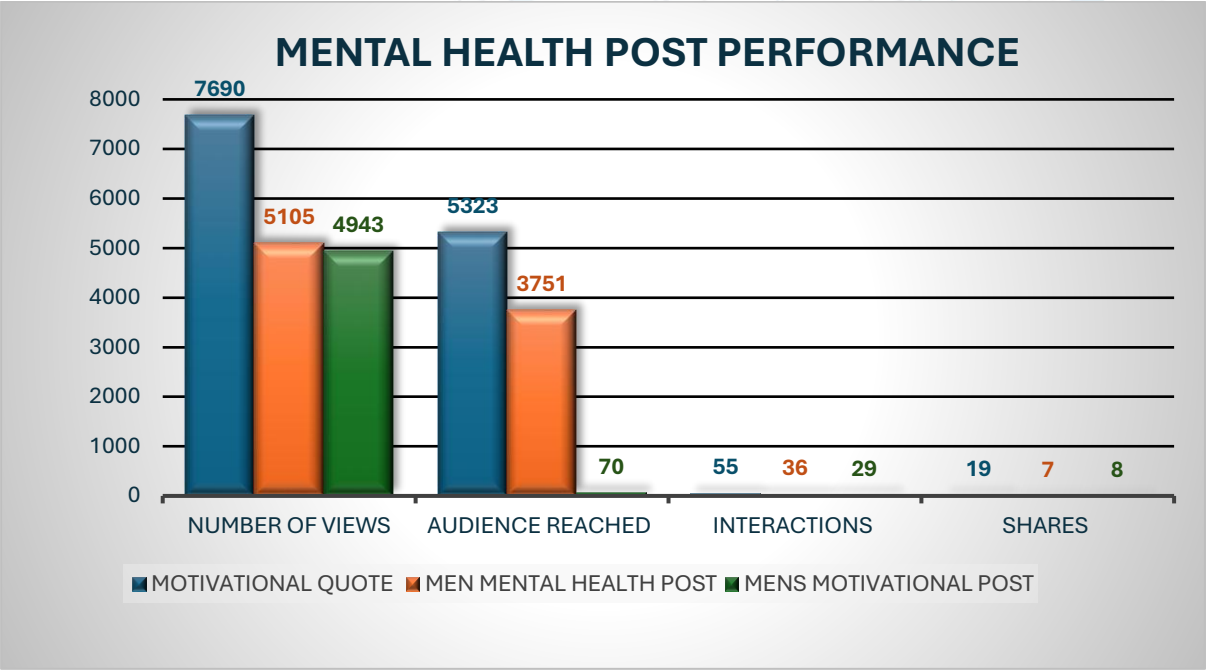




Mental Health Post Performance

The graph below represents the top three performing Mental Health posts selected from the top 20 across all four quarter of 2025 based on views,audience reached, engagement and shares. The highest performing posted achieved 7690 views,reached 5323 audience,

55 interactions and 19 shares. The post spoke on the importance of helping others and being compassionate.



Conclusion

In conclusion, content posted on Facebook in 2025 achieved a strong engagement across all post categories with an accumulative of 3 million views across the platform for the year. The results also indicates that audience engagement on Facebook is higher than on any other social media platforms. Facebook in 2025 generated strong engagement across all post categories. The results indicates that audience engagement on Facebook is higher than on any other social media platforms, this suggest that continued priority and strategic content development for Facebook is essential in maintaining audience engagement and reaching a wide range of public servants.

The background features a complex geometric pattern of interlocking triangles in shades of green and white. Overlaid on this are two network diagrams, each consisting of blue dots connected by thin lines, forming a web-like structure. A large, stylized, curved shape with dark blue and white horizontal stripes is positioned on the right side of the central text area. The text "RISK ASSESSMENT" is written in a bold, dark green, sans-serif font, centered horizontally within the green patterned band.

RISK ASSESSMENT

12. RISK ASSESSMENT REPORT

Introduction

Namusi Chartered Accountants was engaged to facilitate a risk assessment workshop for the Public Service Co-ordinating Bargaining Council (PSCBC). The risk assessment workshop was attended by members of the Management Committee (MANCO), and was held on 04 December 2025.

We have pleasure in presenting the outcomes of this workshop below.

Objectives

The principal objectives of the Risk Assessment workshop were to:

- Identify the key risks that may have an impact on PSCBC meeting its strategic objectives;
- Assess the likelihood of these risks occurring in the ordinary course of business;
- Assess the impact of these risks on PSCBC's operations (likelihood and magnitude);
- Identify the current controls implemented by PSCBC to mitigate these risks;
- Propose strategies to mitigate these risks for consideration by Council; and
- Identify risk owners.

Approach

The workshop was intentionally designed to be interactive, thus encouraging open dialogue, collaborative problem-solving, and consensus-building to ensure that risks were accurately identified and understood from the perspectives of multiple stakeholders of PSCBC.

This approach ensured that there was full participation, and a common understanding of key risks and opportunities across the organization, and fostered common understanding about risks identified and their respective controls.

Risk Assessment process

Namusi facilitated PSCBC's risk assessment process which involved systematically

evaluating each identified risk by assessing its potential impact and likelihood using defined quantitative scales ranging from 1 to 10.

Impact was assessed in terms of the severity of consequences on the PSCBC's objectives, mandate, and operational continuity, while likelihood measured the probability of occurrence under existing conditions.

These two dimensions were combined to determine the inherent risk score, expressed on a 100-point basis, representing the level of exposure before the application of any controls or mitigation measures.

The inherent risk rating was then used to classify risks according to their materiality and to guide the level of management and council oversight required.

Finally, appropriate risk mitigation strategies were identified, detailing the actions to be implemented by management or council to reduce the likelihood and/or impact of each risk to an acceptable level within the PSCBC's risk appetite, together with mechanisms for ongoing monitoring and review.

This process is further detailed in [Section I](#).

Recommendations

It is recommended that:

- The identified risks be integrated into the strategic session/workshop and other strategy discussions, to ensure these are considered together with the strategic objectives of the entity.
- Risk tolerance be discussed and approved by Council.
- Seek Council approval of the risks, risk ratings and mitigation strategies.
- Reconsider the strategic alignment of the risk register with the newly approved strategy (strategic objectives).
- Risk owners to ensure that the risk information remains relevant and respond to changing environment.
- The risk mitigation plans/strategies should be monitored until completion and then the risk should be reassessed to determine if the actions have reduced the risk exposure to within the risk tolerance levels.

Section I – Risk Assessment Process

An effective risk assessment process is fundamental to the PSCBC's ability to fulfil its mandate, safeguard institutional integrity, and deliver sustainable outcomes in a complex and evolving operating environment. By systematically identifying, evaluating, and prioritising strategic, operational, financial, and compliance risks, the PSCBC is better positioned to anticipate potential threats and opportunities, make informed decisions, and allocate resources efficiently. A robust risk assessment process strengthens governance and accountability, supports regulatory compliance, and enhances management's capacity to proactively manage uncertainty, thereby contributing to organisational resilience, service delivery continuity, and the long-term achievement of the PSCBC's strategic objectives.

Namusi followed the following steps in the Risk Assessment process:

Impact

A consequence is an outcome of an event affecting the PSCBC's objectives. This can be a certain or uncertain outcome with a positive or negative effect on the PSCBC's objectives. We used a scale of 1 to 10 to represent the impact quantitatively.

Risk Impact scale:

Score	Impact Level	Description
10	Critical/ Catastrophic	Threatens the PSCBC's survival or mandate
9	Severe	Major disruption with long term consequences
8	Very high	Core operations significantly affected
7	High	Serious impact requiring council intervention
6	Moderate – High	Noticeable impact requiring

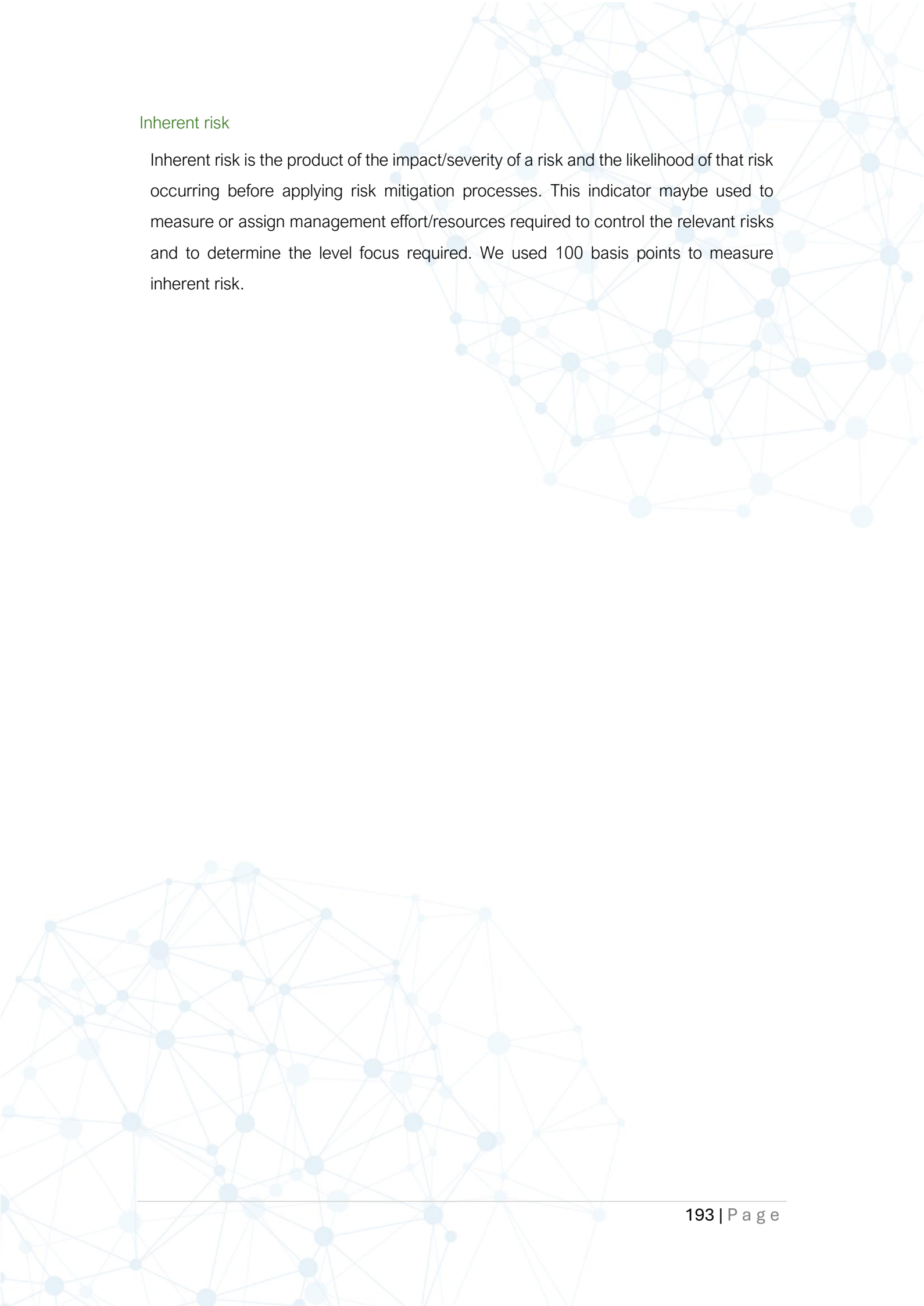
		senior management action
5	Moderate	Manageable disruption with financial or operational effect
4	Low – Moderate	Limited disruption
3	Low	Minimal operational or financial impact
2	Very Low	Negligible impact
1	Insignificant	No meaningful impact.

Likelihood

Likelihood is the chance of something happening. This is the chance of something happening, whether defined, measured or determined objectively or subjectively, qualitatively or quantitatively and described using general terms or mathematically. We used a scale of 1 to 10 to represent likelihood quantitatively.

Risk Likelihood scale:

Score	Likelihood level	Description
10	Almost certain	Expected to occur in most circumstances
9	Very Likely	Will Probably occur
8	Likely	More likely than not
7	Moderately high	Could easily occur
6	Possible – high	Reasonable chance of occurring
5	Possible	Might occur at some point
4	Unlikely – Possible	Could occur but not expected
3	Unlikely	Not expected but conceivable
2	Rare	Highly unlikely
1	Remote	Remote, almost practically impossible.

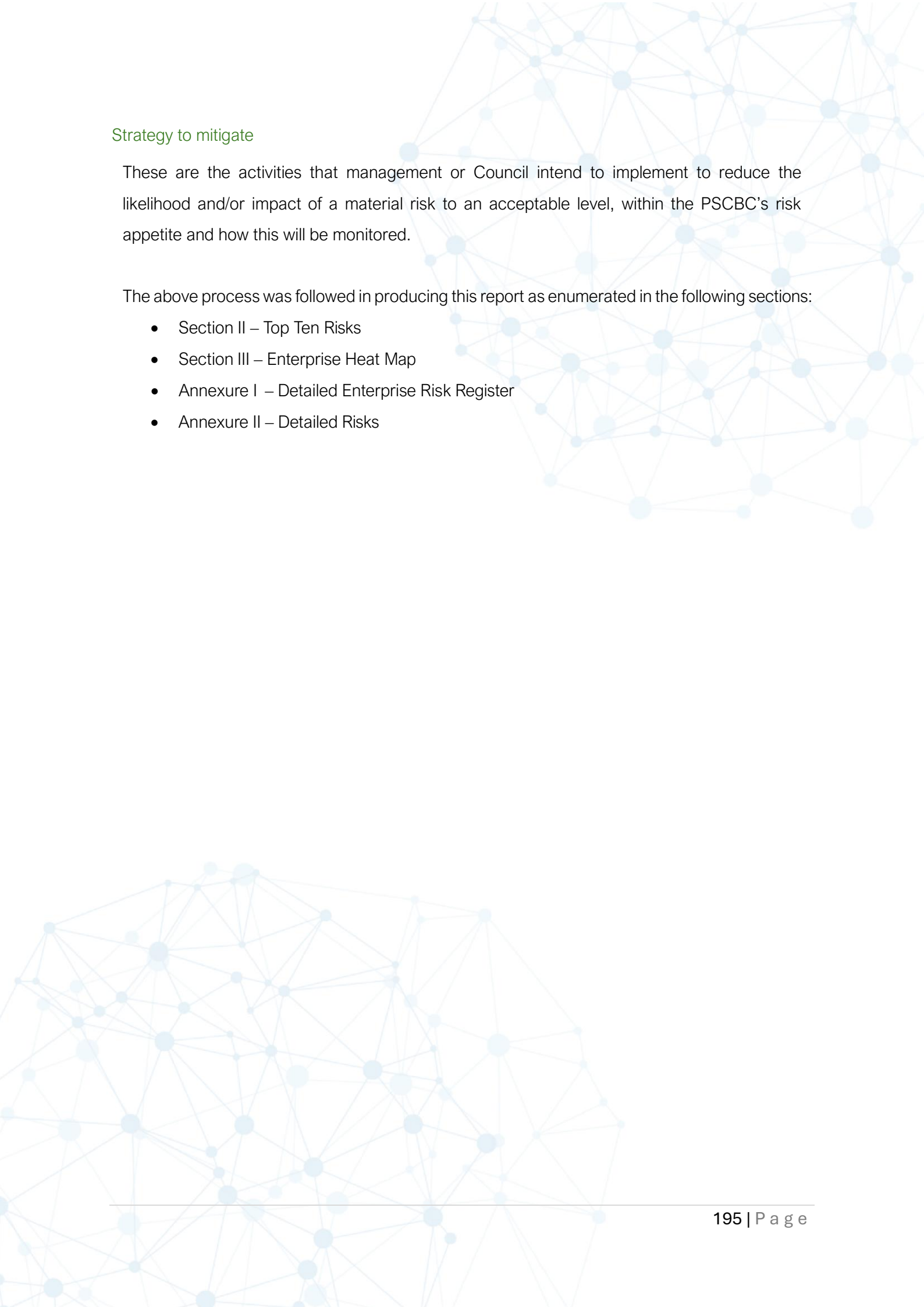


Inherent risk

Inherent risk is the product of the impact/severity of a risk and the likelihood of that risk occurring before applying risk mitigation processes. This indicator maybe used to measure or assign management effort/resources required to control the relevant risks and to determine the level focus required. We used 100 basis points to measure inherent risk.

Inherent risk scoring

Score Range	Risk Rating	Description
90 – 100	Extreme / Critical	Immediate threat to organisational survival or mandate requiring urgent council/ attention.
80 – 89	Very High	Severe exposure with unacceptable risk profile. Needs urgent mitigation with council oversight and frequent reporting.
70 – 79	High	Major risk that could materially affect objectives.
60 – 69	Moderate High	Significant risk requiring structured mitigation
50 – 59	Moderate	Noticeable risk within tolerance if controlled.
40 – 49	Low – Moderate	Manageable risk with limited disruption.
30 – 39	Low	Minor risk with limited impact
20 – 29	Very Low	Minimal exposure
10 – 19	Insignificant	Negligible
1 – 9	Trivial	Theoretical or remote risk



Strategy to mitigate

These are the activities that management or Council intend to implement to reduce the likelihood and/or impact of a material risk to an acceptable level, within the PSCBC's risk appetite and how this will be monitored.

The above process was followed in producing this report as enumerated in the following sections:

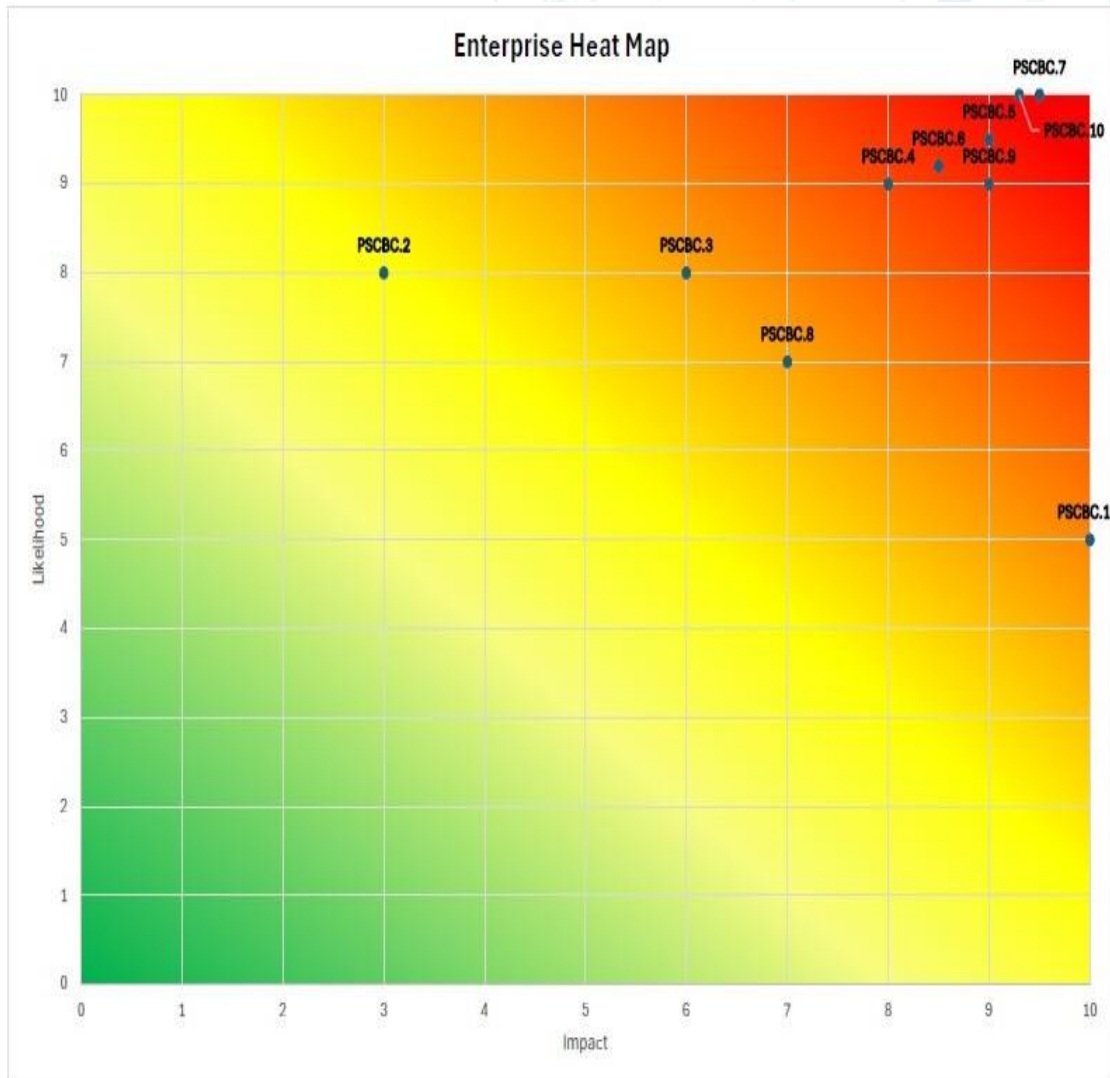
- Section II – Top Ten Risks
- Section III – Enterprise Heat Map
- Annexure I – Detailed Enterprise Risk Register
- Annexure II – Detailed Risks

Enterprise Risk Matrix

Risk Identifier #	Risk Category	Risk Description	Impact	Likelihood	Inherent Risk Level	Strategy to Mitigate	Residual Risk Level	Strategy Importance	Root Cause	Existing Controls	Risk Owner
PSCBC.1	Strategic	Insufficient Levy income risk based on the funding model.	10	5	50	Review funding model as to secure future sustainability	20	50	Fiscus pressure, as well a review of the funding model.	Monitoring monthly levy income	Council
PSCBC.2	Strategic	Proliferation of trade unions and the non-review of criteria for admission	3	8	24	Enforcement of collective agreement regulating organisational rights and the review of the constitution regulating the criteria for admission.	10	24	Intra unions conflicts and membership service, Pressure of unions to deliver	Organisational Right and Collective agreements in place	General Secretary
PSCBC.3	Financial	Budgeting funding is not aligned to the strategic goals	6	8	48	Resolution to amend the levy income	20	48	Insufficient funds	Oversight by FINCOM in budget Management.	General Secretary
PSCBC.4	Strategic	Management of strategic partnership	8	9	72	Develop a strategic objective on relationship management.	40	72	Lack of proactive mechanism to manage strategic relationships	None	Council
PSCBC.5	Strategic	Integrity of membership determination process and reliability of membership	9	9	81	Constitutional amendment and implementation of the verification management process.	30	81	Inconsistencies in reported membership.	Constitutional limitations on verification process.	Council

	Risk Category	Risk Description	Impact	Likelihood	Inherent Risk Level	Strategy to Mitigate	Residual Risk Level	Strategy Importance	Root Cause	Existing Controls	Risk Owner
PSCBC.6	Strategic	EXCO members term of office (not aligned to strategic cycle) and the role clarification between the Council and Governance structures.	9	9	81	Constitutional amendments	20	81	Constitutional provisions.	Policies and Delegation of authority.	Council
PSCBC.7	Operational	Reputation risk through Brand Management (Social Media, Artificial Intelligence)	9	10	90	Finalisation of the Artificial Intelligence policy, social media policy and implementation, monitoring reputational risk methodology.	49	90	Limited implementation of the media policy	None	General Secretary
PSCBC.8	Strategic	Generational risk	7	7	49	Develop a strategy to appeal to the upcoming generation.	20	49	Changes in Societal norms.	None	Council
PSCBC.9	Operational	Lack of monitoring Compliance(non-implementation of Collective agreements, Legislations, Non-compliance with Case law).	9	9	81	Strengthening the monitoring processes.	20	81	Insufficient Controls/policies	Monitoring and Evaluation and enforcement of collective agreement	General Secretary
PSCBC.10	Operational	IT Risk (Cyber security, hardware failure, natural disaster, password risk, human error.	9	10	90	Update the Disaster Recovery plan and Staff awareness programmes.	55	90	Technical Innovation.	Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery plan,Anti virus	General Secretary

Section III – Enterprise Heat Map



Conclusion

Notwithstanding the nature or extent of the Services performed under this engagement, responsibility for the governance, risk management and internal control processes of the PSCBC remains solely with the PSCBC and its management.

The Services performed by Namusi Chartered Accountants constituted a non-assurance engagement. Accordingly, we do not express an audit opinion, review conclusion, assurance opinion or any other form of attestation on the matters addressed, nor on the information upon which our work was based. The procedures performed did not constitute an audit, review or examination conducted in accordance with International Standards on Auditing, International Standards on Review Engagements, or any other assurance standards issued by the IRBA or relevant professional bodies.

Information used in the performance of this engagement was provided by the PSCBC or obtained from sources considered appropriate and was not independently verified, audited or validated by Namusi Chartered Accountants. We accept no responsibility for the accuracy, completeness or reliability of such information.

Namusi Chartered Accountants shall not be liable for any loss, damage, cost or expense arising directly or indirectly from fraudulent acts or omissions, wilful misrepresentation or wilful default by the PSCBC, its management directors, officers, employees or agents.

This report and all related deliverables have been prepared solely for the use of PSCBC's management, the Council and the Audit Committee for internal purposes. They may not be distributed to, quoted from, or otherwise disclosed to any third party, in whole or in part, without the prior written consent of Namusi Chartered Accountants. No responsibility or liability is accepted to any third party who may obtain access to or place reliance on this report or its contents.

We express our appreciation to PSCBC's management and staff who participated in the report development and the risk assessment process.

Should you require any further information or clarification, please do not hesitate to contact

us. Yours sincerely,



Namusi Chartered Accountants

Per: Portia Ravhuhali CA(SA)

Director

09 February 2026



@pscbc_sa



Public Service
Co-Ordinating
Bargaining Council



@pscbcnews



PSCBC Bargaining
Council



PSCBC Channel



pscbc4

Tel: 012 644 8100
Fax: 012 644 5834
Email: info@pscbc.org.za
Address: 260 Basden Avenue Lyttelton 0176



PSCBC

PUBLIC SERVICE CO-ORDINATING BARGAINING COUNCIL